

# Astronomica

ASTRONOMICA

Manilius

*translated by Thomas Creech (1700)*

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## An Account of Manilius

*Prefixed by Creech to his translation (1700), in the form of a letter.*

SIR,

THE Campaign being over, and Councils not yet begun, the World is very much at quiet; nor can I find News enough to fill a Letter: But to keep up our usual Correspondence, I send you an Account of an old *Latin Poet*, very little known, tho' as worthy your Acquaintance, as many of those who are in Credit. He lay buried in the *German Libraries*, not heard of in the World, till *Poggius* Publish'd him from some old Manuscripts found there; and tho'<sup>1</sup> *Burde Cotzus*, thinks *Lucian* consulted this Poet when he wrote his little Treatise of *Astrologie*; tho' *Julius Firmizus* is<sup>2</sup> accus'd as an ungrateful Plagiary, for not acknowledging from whom he Transcrib'd the chiefest parts of his Books; yet there is no good Evidence, that any one Writer mention'd this Author before *Poggius*. *Pliny* is suppos'd to speak of him as a<sup>3</sup> *Mathematician*, and *Gerbertus*, as an<sup>4</sup> *Astrologer*; but concerning the *Poet*, there is as dead a silence as if he had never been; nor can his greatest Admirers find any Character of him in old Writers.

Yet it must be own'd, that he is an Author of some considerable Age; for the Manuscripts which *Poggius*, *Bonincontrius*, *Scaliger*, and *Franciscus Junius* us'd, were ancient: *Tanaquil Faber*, *Spanhemius*, and the severest Criticks allow him to be as old as *Theodosius* the Great, and pretend to find some particular Phrases in him, which are certain Characters of that Time.

Others, who believe they have very good Reasons to place him higher, find it very difficult to account for this universal silence: What they offer, is either bare May-be and Shift, and scarce ever amounts to a tolerable Reason: 'Tis true, they say, he is not mention'd by *Ovid* in his<sup>5</sup> Catalogue of *Poets*, and no wonder, since he did not begin to write before the<sup>6</sup> Banishment of *Ovid*, and Published nothing before his

Death; Perhaps he was one of those Young Men, —<sup>7</sup> *Quorum quod inedita cura est Appellandorum nil mihi juris adest.* or his Fame did not reach so far as *Pontus*: Otherwise they are confident there are too many Graces in his Poem to be neglected; at least, the singularity of his Subject would have deserved to be taken notice of, as well as that of<sup>8</sup> *Gratius*. But why *Quintilian* doth not propose him to his Orator, tho' he encourages him to<sup>9</sup> read *Macer* and *Lucretius*, and <sup>10</sup> affirms, that a competent skill in *Astronomy* is necessary to make him perfect in his Profession? Why the following *Philologists* never use his Authority, tho' it might very often have been pertinently cited by *Gellius* and *Macrobius*? Why the *Grammarians* and *Mythologists*, seem to be altogether unacquainted with his Writings? They confess these are Questions not easie to be answer'd.

Of this Poet, who is acknowledged by all Parties to have lain very long unknown, and about whom, since he first appear'd in the World, so many Controversies have risen, I am now to give you an account.

His Name is commonly said to be *Marcus Manilius*, which in some Copies of his Poem is shortned into *Manlius*, in others softned into *Mallius*: This variation is inconsiderable, and the common fault of unaccurate Transcribers; but<sup>11</sup> *Bonincontrius* affirms, that the Title of his very Ancient Copies was, *C. Manilii Poetae illustris Astronomicon*; and that he had seen a Medal, in which was the Figure of a Man, but in a Foreign Habit, with a Sphere plac'd near his Head, and this Inscription, *C. MANILL*.<sup>12</sup> *Lilius Gyraldus* mentions another of the same stamp; But that these Medals belong'd to this Poet, may be as easily deny'd, as 'tis affirm'd, or rather, as 'tis conjectured: However all Parties agree, that the most Ancient Copies constantly bear the Title of *Manilius*; but whether the Books of *Poggius* and *Bonincontrius*, which call him *Caius*, or those of *Scaliger* and others, in which we find *Marcus* written, are to be follow'd, is submitted to every Man's Discretion; the Matter is not of any Consequence, nor a fit Subject for Dispute, because impossible to be determin'd: Tho' if Conjecture may be admitted, I should fancy that it is more probable a Transcriber may err, when he puts *M.* before

*Manilius*, than when he writes a *C.* because in the former case, the Sound of the following Word, which is the most considerable in the Title, and consequently the chiefest in his Thoughts, may pervert him; but in the latter, He hath no temptation to mistake. This *M.* or *C.* *Manilius*, was born a *Roman*, and liv'd in *Rome* when *Rome* was in her Glory; commanding the biggest part of the known World, and full of the greatest Men that ever any time produc'd: For the same Age that saw *Manilius* enjoy'd *Varro*, *Lucretius*, *Cicero*, *Caesar*, *Virgil*, *Varius*, *Horace*, and (to close the Catalogue) *Augustus*. In the beginning of this *Astronomical Poem* that Emperour is<sup>13</sup> invok'd, that very Emperour who was the<sup>14</sup> adopted Son of *Julius Caesar*, who<sup>15</sup> beat *Brutus* and *Cassius* at *Philippi*,<sup>16</sup> overthrew *Pompey* the Great's Son,<sup>17</sup> who sent *Tiberius* to *Rhodes*,<sup>18</sup> who lost three Legions in *Germany* under the Command of *Varus*; who<sup>19</sup> routed *Anthony* and *Cleopatra* at *Actium*, and sav'd the *Roman Empire* by turning that overgrown dissolute Republick into a well regulated Monarchy. Here are so many Characters, that the Person cannot be mistaken, not one of them agreeing to any but the first Great *Augustus*. So that this Author liv'd in that Age to which He pretends by so many very particular Circumstances, or else He is a most notorious Cheat, and one of the greatest Impostors in the World.

It seems<sup>20</sup> *Tanaquil Faber* thought him to be so, since without giving any Reason He brings him down as low as the time of *Theodosius*:<sup>21</sup> *Vossius* was once of the same Opinion, having observed, as He then thought, some Measures, Words and Phrases peculiar to that Age, and therefore He concludes against *Scaliger*, that *Julius Firmicus* did not follow *Manilius*, but *Manilius* wrote in Verse what *Firmicus* had published in Prose under the Reign of *Constantine* the Great: But upon second Reading this<sup>22</sup> Critick alter'd his first Sentiments, and allows him to be as ancient as the Poet himself desires to be thought.<sup>23</sup> *Gassendus* often quotes him, and always sets him after *Firmicus*, as may be seen in many places of his Writings; but gives no reason why he constantly observes that order: But *Gevartius*, who had study'd and design'd to publish Notes upon this Author, says in a Letter to Mr. *Cambden*,<sup>24</sup> I have been long acquainted

with this Writer, and know him well, but cannot, with *Scaliger* and other learned Criticks, allow him to be as ancient as *Augustus*, for in my Notes I will demonstrate that he liv'd in the Age of *Theodosius* and his Sons *Arcadius* and *Honorius*, and that he was the same with *Manlius Theodorus*, upon whose Consulship *Claudian* writes a Panegyrick, in which he mentions his *Astronomicon*. The same thing he asserts in his Comments upon<sup>25</sup> *Statius*, and promises to do Wonders in his<sup>26</sup> *Electa* upon this Subject; what his performance was I do not find taken notice of by any of the *Criticks*, nor am I concern'd for it, being certain that he fail'd in his Attempt, because it was ridiculous and rash: Yet the learn'd *Ezechiel Spanhemius* endeavours to support this Conjecture of *Gevartius*,<sup>27</sup> and tells us, that *sub Armis*, a Phrase familiar to *Manilius*, as *lib. 1. v. 795*.

Lib. 4. v. 656.

And in another place, —*Quumque ipsa sub Armis Pax agitur*— was us'd in the time of *Theodosius*, as appears by the following passage in that Emperour's Code,<sup>28</sup> *Quicumque sub Armis Militiae munus Comitatus subierunt*. *Scaliger* himself unwarily gave a very great advantage to this Opinion, when he<sup>29</sup> affirm'd, that the word *Decanus*, which *Manilius* uses, was brought from the *Camp*, and that a *Sign* which govern'd *ten* Degrees was call'd *Decanus*, because an *Officer* who commanded *ten* Men in the Army had the same Title: But<sup>30</sup> *Salmatius*, who discover'd the Mistake, (for *Decanus* was not heard of in the *Roman Camp* before the time of *Constantine the Great*) hath so well corrected it, or rather<sup>31</sup> *Huetius* hath given so good an Account of that Word, that tho' an Argument drawn from it may be strong against the *Critick*, it will never be of any force against the *Author*. It is almost needless to mention the Exceptions of those Criticks who think his *Stile* impure, or, as they please to speak, too barbarous for the Age he pretends to; Indeed<sup>32</sup> *Gyraldus* endeavours by this very Argument to prove he was no *Roman* born: But<sup>33</sup> *Scaliger* laughs at him for his Attempt, tells him that he does not distinguish between *Idiotisms* and *Barbarisms*, and that *Vitruvius* (to whom he should have added *Lucretius*) might be call'd

barbarous as well as he:<sup>34</sup> *Franciscus Junius* commends the propriety of his Language, <sup>35</sup> *Salmatius* and <sup>36</sup> *Huetius* have approved many passages which lesser Criticks thought to be impure; And the accurate *Vossius*, <sup>37</sup> after he had studied and considered him well, found nothing in him inconsistent with the Age of *Augustus*, and the Politeness of his Court. Indeed most of the Instances that are produc'd upon this head, do not fasten on the Author himself, but on the Transcribers and Publishers of his Writings. There ought to be a new Edition of his *Astronomicon*, and I do not despair of seeing one which will have a pure genuine Text, and free that Text from many of his Interpreters Comments, especially from the Notes of the miserable wretched<sup>38</sup> *Fayus*.

You see, Sir, I have brought this diffus'd Controversie within a very narrow Compass; *Tanaquil Faber* and *Gassendus* keep their (if they had any) Reasons to themselves. Their Authority I confess had been perswasive, had they considered, and after a fair hearing determin'd the Controversie; but an incident declaration, and an unweigh'd Sentence concerning the Age of any Writer ought not to be submitted to, but appeal'd from: And therefore if I can shew the Observation of *Spanhemius* to be unconcluding, and refute the bold Conjectures of *Gevartius*, I shall leave *Manilius* in possession of that Age, which he so often, and with so much assurance claims. And here I am sure we should not have been troubled with *Spanhemius*'s Observation, had he been pleas'd to consider, that *sub Armis*, and *sub Armis Militiae*, being very different from one another, might be us'd in very different Ages of the Empire; and that he argues very ill, who says, the one was known in the Time of *Theodosius*, and therefore the other was not common in the Court of *Augustus*: 'Tis certain that it was, for *Virgil* (whom *Manilius* often imitates) hath —Sedet circum castella sub Armis, —Equitem docuere sub Armis Insultare solo— And in another place, —Ludunt Belli simulachra sub Armis. And this *Virgil* himself borrow'd from *Ennius*, who says, Ter me sub Armis malim vitam cernere. I could produce more Authorities, were not these sufficient to secure *Manilius* from *Spanhemius*'s Observation.

But *Gevartius*, as he is bolder, so he is much more unhappy in his Conjectures; he fixes upon the Man, and says this *Manilius* is *Mallius Theodorus*, celebrated by the Poet *Claudian*; for the Author of this *Astronomicon*, is in many of the old Copies call'd *Mallius*, and this *Mallius Theodorus*, was a good Astronomer, and a Writer of great Industry and Reputation: But did *Gevartius* ever meet with the *Astronomicon*, under the Title of *Fl. Mallius Theodorus*? Or of *Fl. Mallius* and not alwaies of *C.* or *M. Manlius*, *Mallius* or *Manilius*? Doth *Claudian* commend the Poetry of his Consul, or mention his Acquaintance with the Muses? or could a Poet forget, or not celebrate that Talent which he himself must look upon as a very great Perfection, and the Age would have highly valued, had he been the Author of this Poem? Doth he say he wrote Books of *Astronomy*, knew the Depths of *Astrology*, and was admitted into the Councils of the Stars? Here was a large Field for that luxuriant Wit to have wanton'd in, and it cannot be thought he would have conceal'd the deserts of his Patron when he study'd to commend him: But instead of this he praises his Justice, Integrity, Clemency and Honor; he extols his Eloquence, and prefers the sweetness of it before all the delicate Charms of Poetry and Musick.

And tho' all the Muses are concern'd for him, and busie in his Service, yet he is devoted to none of them but *Urania*, who assisted him in his *Astronomical Diversions*.

*Gevartius* very well observes that this Consul *Mallius* was an Astronomer.

That he publish'd some admir'd Books <sup>39</sup> Consul per populos, idemque gravissimus Author Eloquij, duplici vita subnixus in aevum Procedat, libris pariter, fastisque legendus. But how doth it appear that *Astronomy* was his Subject, when *Claudian* himself tells us it was the *Origine* and *Constitution* of the *World*? He represents him as well vers'd in all the several *Hypotheses* of the Natural and Moral Philosophers, acquainted both with the *Physicks* and *Ethicks* of the *Greeks*, and able to discourse of their Opinions very properly, and very elegantly in *Latin*.

But when he speaks of his Writings he says he describ'd the *Origine* and *Disposition* of the World,<sup>40</sup> and gave very convincing proofs of his own Wit, Capacity, and Judgment, by his exact account of the beautiful Order, and regular Contrivance of that wonderful *Machine*.

From these Verses and other passages in *Claudian*, as —<sup>41</sup> Quae vis animaverit Astra, Impuleritque Choros, quo vivat Machina motu; it may be inferr'd that this Consul *Mallius*, was as to Natural Philosophy a *Stoick*, and built his World according to the *Hypothesis* of that Sect, and therefore wrote something very like what we find at large in the first Book, and hinted at in several passages of the other Books of *Manilius*. But this being the least part of our Author, and subservient to his greater and general design, it must not be suppos'd that *Claudian* should enlarge only upon this, and leave his whole *Astrology* untoucht; unless we think *Claudian* as ridiculous as that Painter would be, who being to fill his Canvas with a noble Family should draw a single Servant, or paint only a Finger or a Nail when he had a large beautiful Body to represent.

I have been the more particular in this matter, because *Gevartius* pretends to demonstration, tho' to confute his conjecture it had been sufficient only to observe, that it is the most ridiculous thing in the World to imagine that *Mallius* a Man well known both for his personal Endowments and publick Employments, who had been Governour of several Provinces, and at last Consul should publish a Treatise under his own Name, and yet in almost every Page of the Book endeavour to perswade his Readers it was written four hundred years before. For it must be granted that the Prince whom he<sup>42</sup> invokes in the beginning of his Poem, who is stiled *Patriae Princepsque Paterque*, who is deify'd whilst<sup>43</sup> alive, and (not to repeat the other particulars I have already reckon'd up) whose<sup>44</sup> *Horoscope* was *Capricorn*, was the first Great *Augustus*, and therefore there is no need of calling in the Authorities of<sup>45</sup> *Horace*,<sup>46</sup> and<sup>47</sup> *Suetonius* to prove it.



This last Character puts me in mind of another Objection that may be drawn from *F. Harduin's*<sup>48</sup> Observation, for he says that *Suetonius* was himself deceiv'd, and hath deceiv'd all those who have thought *Capricorn* was concern'd in the Nativity of *Augustus*: For if this be true all the Pretences of *Manilius* are ruin'd; but since that Writer doth not back his Assertion with any Reasons, I shall not submit to his bare Authority, nor wast my time in guessing what Arguments he may rely on, being not bold enough to conjecture what the daring Author may produce. Having thus fixt the Age of this Author, and prov'd him to have liv'd in the time of *Augustus Caesar*, I shall venture farther to affirm that he was born under the Reign of that Emperour, not only a *Roman*, but of illustrious Extraction, being a branch of that noble Family the *Manilij*, who so often fill'd the *Consul's* Chair, and supply'd the best and greatest Offices in the *Roman* Commonwealth. And here I must oppose many of the *Criticks*, and be unassisted by the rest: For<sup>49</sup> *Scaliger* confesses, that from his own Writings, it cannot be known what Countryman he was, and no other Authors give us any Information. *Bonincontrius* and *Gyraldus* endeavour to prove from the Medal already mention'd, that he was no *Roman*; the Learned<sup>50</sup> *Isaac Vossius* thinks he was a *Syrian*, and all who look upon him to be the same with that *Manilius* mention'd by *Pliny*, *Nat. Hist. lib. 35. cap. 17.* say he was a Slave: Only *Petrus Crinitus*<sup>51</sup> affirms, he was Nobly Born, and Mr. *Tristan* will<sup>52</sup> have him to be that *Manilius*, of whom *Pliny* gives a very Honourable Character, in the Tenth Book and Second Chapter of his Natural History; where he says, *He was of Senatorian Dignity, an excellent Scholar, and (If we believe Mr. Tristan) a very good Astronomer.* But since *Crinitus* doth not prove what he says, and Mr. *Tristan* but conjectures at best, and upon Examination, will be found to be very much mistaken in his Conjectures, therefore I cannot expect any assistance from either of these Authors. Now it is not certain that the Gentleman whom *Pliny* speaks of in the Second Chapter of his Tenth Book was Nam'd *Manilius*. Copies differ, and in the *M. SS. of Salmasius*<sup>53</sup> he is call'd *Mamilius*: *Pliny* doth not say one word of his skill in

Astronomy; he only<sup>54</sup> affirms, That he was the first of all the Romans who wrote concerning the *Phoenix*, that never any Man saw it feed, that in *Arabia* it is Sacred to the Sun, that it lives 660 Years, and that with the Life of this Bird is consummated the Conversion of the Great Year, in which the Stars return again to their first points, and give significations of the same Seasons as at the beginning: And all this any one may write who is in an entire Ignorance of the Courses and Influence of the Stars: But when Mr. *Tristan* farther observes that *Pliny* insinuates, besides a particular respect, a kind of Intimacy and Acquaintance between this *Manilius* and himself, he gives us a very convincing Argument against his own conjecture: for there is good reason to believe this *Manilius* the Poet dy'd before *Augustus*, and therefore could not be intimate with *Pliny*.

To set this whole matter in its due light, I shall, as the learned and ingenious Sr. *Edward Shirburn* hath already done in his Preface to the Sphere of *Manilius* take a view of those, who have been by the name of *Manilius* deliver'd down to Posterity as Men of Letters, and then consider which of all those, or whether any one of them was this *Manilius* the Poet.

Of that *Manilius* whom *Pliny* mentions in the second Chapter of his tenth Book I have already said enough; and about that *Manilius*, whom *Varro*<sup>55</sup> cites, I shall not be concern'd, there being no ground to think he was the Author of this Poem.<sup>56</sup> *Pliny* lib. 35. cap. 17. tells us of one *Manilius* surnam'd *Antiochus*, who with *Publius Syrus*, and *Staberius Eros* were brought to *Rome*, all three of Servile Condition, but persons of good Literature. His words are these, *Pedes Venalium trans mare advectorum [Creta] denotare instituerunt Majores; Talemque Publium [Syrum] mimicae Scenae conditorem, et Astrologiae consobrinum ejus Manilium Antiochum, item Grammaticae Staberium Erotem, eadem navi advectos videre Proavi*. Our Ancestors us'd to mark with Chalk the Feet of those Slaves who were brought over from beyond Sea to be sold; And such an one was *Publius [Syrus]* the Founder of the Mimick Scene, and his Cousin German *Manilius Antiochus* of Astrology, and *Staberius*

*Eros* of Grammar; whom our great Grandfathers saw in that manner brought over in one and the same Ship: This *Manilius Laurentius Bonincontrius* (who near two ages agoe commented on our Author) conceives the same with *Manilius* who wrote this Astronomical Poem, to confirm which opinion he produces the evidence of a Silver Medal in his possession whereon was the figure of a Man, in an Exotick Habit with a Sphere plac'd near his Head, and this Inscription *MANILI*: The same is affirm'd says *Lilius Gyraldus* by *Stephanus Dulcinus*, and the said *Gyraldus* farther assures us that a familiar Friend of his, one *Nicolaus Trapolinus*, had another Medal of the like Stamp and Inscription.

But against this opinion of *Bonincontrius* and *Gyraldus*, *Scaliger* opposes a double Argument, one drawn from the seeming inveracity of that suppos'd Evidence; no such Medal being at this day to be found in the Cabinets of any, no not the most curious Antiquaries; the other from the reason of Time, for *Manilius Antiochus* being brought to *Rome* in the beginning of *Sylla's* days (for he was brought in the same Ship with *Staberius Eros*, who open'd his Grammar School in *Rome* whilst *Sylla* was alive) must needs, if he were the Author of this Poem have been 120 Years old when he began to write, this piece being written in the latter years of *Augustus*. Besides, the Author in the Proem of this work wishes for long life to compleat his intended Poem, and therefore certainly he was not of that Age, it being ridiculous for a Man to wish for long life, when he is at the Extream already.

The same *Pliny*, lib. 36. cap. 10. speaks of one *Manilius* a *Mathematician*, who when the *Obelisk* which *Augustus* erected in the *Campus Martius* for finding out the Hours of the day by the Shadow of the Sun, with the Increase or Decrease of the Days and Nights, plac'd a gilded Ball, *Cujus Vertice Umbra colligeretur in semetipsam, alia atque alia incrementa jaculantem Apice, ratione (ut ferunt) à capite hominis intellecta*, says *Pliny*, who commends the design.

To this Person *Scaliger* conceives this work may with fairer probability be ascrib'd than to the former; which Opinion is by divers other

judicious Men embrac'd.

The excellently learn'd *Isaac Vossius* conceives yet, that the *Manilius Antiochus*, and the *Manilius Mathematicus* before mention'd are not two distinct Persons, but one and the same under different Titles and Appellations, and the very Author of the Poem we now publish, whose particular Sentiments upon this Subject, and Arguments confirming the same, he was pleas'd not long since to impart to me, by his most obliging Letter, in answer to some *Queries* by me propounded in one of mine to him upon occasion of my intended publication of this piece, which for the Readers satisfaction, I shall here make publick, tho' not in his own words, yet as near as may be in his own Sense.

And first in answer to *Scaliger's* Argument drawn from Reason to Time, against *Manilius Antiochus*, upon the supposition of *Staberius Eros* (one of the Three before mention'd) set open his Grammar School in the time of *Sylla* ninety five years before the death of *Augustus*; and that therefore *Manilius* could not probably be (according to *Scaliger's* Computation) less than 120 Years old at the time when this Poem was written; he urges by way of reply, that *Suetonius* (from whom *Scaliger* takes the ground of his Argument) doth not say that *Staberius Eros* open'd his School in *Sylla's* time, but that he taught *gratis* the Children of those who in *Sylla's* time were proscrib'd. The Words of *Suetonius* are these, *Sunt qui tradunt tanta eum (Staberium) honestate praeditum, ut temporibus Syllanis Proscriptorum liberos gratis, et sine mercede ulla in Disciplina receperit.* How long that was after the times of Proscription will be needless here to declare; and that *Manilius* was not so old as *Scaliger* conceives, when this piece was written, may be made out from this, that he was the Cousin German of *Publius Syrus*, who that he was brought a young Boy to his Patron, *Macrobius* affirms, from whom likewise, and from the Verses of *Laberius* it may be collected, that he was but a Youth when he came upon the Stage against *Laberius*, which was but a little before the death of *Julius Caesar* and *Laberius* also; to whom he succeeded on the Mimick Stage in the second year of 184 Olympiad, that is in the Year of *Rome* 711, as *Eusebius* testifies. And

therefore seeing it is, manifest that *Manilius* publish'd this Poem soon after the *Varian* Defeat, which happened in the Year 762 of *Rome*, it is as evident likewise that between the Youth or Adolescence of *Manilius*, and the time wherein he wrote this piece, there could not pass above one and fifty Years, and consequently there is no reason to assign so great an Age to *Manilius*, as *Scaliger* here doth, since perhaps he was not seventy years old when he had finish'd this his *Astronomical Poem*.

As to what *Scaliger* subjoyns touching *Manilius* his wish for *long life together with a cheerful old Age*, and the Inference he thence makes that *he could not reasonably be thought to be old then, who wish'd he might live to be so*. The Argument is but weak, for *Senium* is one thing, and *Senium Annosum* is another; Nor doth he simply wish for *Vitam Annosam*, but *Vitam Annosam quae conjuncta sit cum molli Senecta*, which may be wish'd for even by those who are very old.

As for the name of *Antiochus*, he seems to have taken it from the famous Philosopher *Antiochus Ascalonita*, often mention'd by *Cicero*, *Plutarch*, *Sextus Empiricus*, and others, whose School not only *Cicero*, but *Varro*, *Brutus*, and divers others are said to have frequented, and in all probability this our *Manilius* also, as being not only of the same Nation, but happily born in the same Town (*Ascalon*.) So that it may seem no wonder if after the manner of those times, he took upon him the Name of his worthy Tutor and Instructor. For that he was a *Syrian* is not only manifest from his Consanguinity with *Publius Mimus*, but may likewise be collected from the Title or Inscription of this work, which is an ancient and excellent Manuscript in the Possession of *Vossius* is this *M. MALLII POENI ASTRONOMICON DIVO OCTAVIO QUIRINO AUG.* That the *Phaenicians* were by the *Romans* called *POENI* is manifest out of *Horace*, *Cicero apud Nonium*, and our Author in this very Poem; he concludes therefore than this our *Manilius*, or (as he is rather pleased to call him) *Manlius* was a *Phaenician*, and in all probability Native of the same Town as *Antiochus* his Tutor, whose name he assum'd.

From this Dedication of his Work to *Augustus*, by the Name of *Quirinus*, as the Inscription shews, will appear the Error of those, who who imagine the same to be Dedicated to *Tiberius*, or some later *Roman Emperour*: And the Reason of attributing the Name of *Quirinus* to *Augustus*, may be made clear from the Words of *Suetonius*, *Censentibus quibusdam Romulum appellari oportere quasi et ipsum conditorem Urbis, &c.* *Dion* likewise tells us [...], That *Augustus Caesar* extremely desir'd to be call'd *Romulus*: and *Joannes Philadelphensis* (*Scripto de Mensibus in Aug.*) [...] *Octavianus Son of Octavius* was after his great Victories honoured with divers Names, for by some he was called *Quirinus*, as another *Romulus*, &c.

As to that *Manilius* stiled by *Pliny Mathematicus*, he conceives that titular distinction to make no difference in the Person, but that he is the same with the former, further adding, *Omnino existimo et illum quoque de nostro Manilio accipi debere.* And whereas *Salmasius* affirms that the name *Manlius* or *Manilius* is not to be found in that place of *Pliny* in any ancient Manuscripts, he makes it appear that *Salmasius* is extremely mistaken by the testimony of several antient Manuscript Copies of *Pliny* in his Possession, one of which was written above 8 or 900 Years agoe, in all which the Word *Manlius* is found, though with some small difference in writing of the name. Nor doth he think the name of *Marcus* prefix'd to *Manilius* ought to be scrupled at, upon the Account that none of the *Manlian* Family after the 360th Year from the building of *Rome* could or did use that *Praenomen*, seeing the prohibition as *Cicero* intimates is only to be understood of the *Patrician Race*, Now that this *Manilius*, or (as he calls him) *Manlius* was before his Manumission a Slave, not only the place of *Pliny* already cited, but the very *Agnomen* of *Antiochus* sufficiently demonstrates, for as much as a Greek *Agnomen* joyn'd to a *Roman* Name is always a most certain Token of a Servile Condition.

Thus far *Sir Edward Shirburn*, who is very much inclin'd to rest satisfied with this rational discourse of the incomparable *Vossius*, and thinks others should be so too; but upon examination it will appear that *Scaliger's* Objections are still in force, and that *Vossius's* his reasonings

are all to little purpose. It must be granted that the *Agnomen Antiochus* proves that *Manilius* to be of *Servile Condition*, tho' there is no need of this Argument, since *Pliny* in very express Terms asserts that he is so: 'Tis likewise true that that *Manilius* was a *Syrian*, being a near Kinsman to *Publius Syrus*, and brought to *Italy* in the same Ship with him: But that that *Manilius* the *Syrian* was the same with *Manilius* the Poet, is a Question that still returns, and will not, I fear, be determin'd by the Title of that ancient and excellent Manuscript of *Vossius*: For if instead of *M. MALLII POENI*, we read *M. MALLII POETAE*, which is found in other Manuscripts, (and every body knows there is so little difference in the traits of the Letters of those two words in ancient Copies, that they may very easily by Ignorant Transcribers be mistaken for one another) then the Evidence drawn from this Inscription is lost: Besides that Title is not to be regarded, it not being written by the Author but affixt by some heedless Copyer of the Poem: For it is *Divo Octavio*, whereas *Augustus* was never stil'd *Divus* though often *Deus* before his Death, and the Writer of the *Astronomicon*, as will by and by appear, dy'd before *Augustus*.

To speak out what I think will not be deny'd, *Manilius* the Author of this Poem was young when he wrote it, and dy'd young; and therefore cannot be that *Manilius Antiochus* whom *Scaliger* reckons to be 120, and *Vossius* is forced to confess was 70 years of Age about the time *Varus* was defeated by the *Germans*. The first part of this Assertion may be demonstrated from almost all the Pages of his Book, in which we meet with many things that are not to be accounted for on the *Hypothesis* of *Sixty*: He is too fierce and fiery for that Age, and bounds every Step he takes: In a Man of years when we find a Warmth we feel it to be regular, he never starts, his Pace is equal, and seldom varies but when his Subject forces him to a more than ordinary quickness.

Judgment appears all thro', and a strength well govern'd: When he rises he doth not affect to climb but to walk, like a sober Traveller, who knowing his own force seeks the easiest ascent, when his Ground is uneven, or he is oblig'd to take the advantage of a Prospect. But 'tis not

so in Youth whose Fancies as well as Passions are impetuous; that pleases them most which is most daring, finding they have strength they use it to the utmost, and when at last they sink they seem rather worn out, than tired. I cannot compare the Spirit of Poetry possessing a Youth, of a strong generous Imagination and vigorous Constitution, to any thing better than to a Flame seizing on the Body of a *Meteor*, the whole Mass blazes, and mounts upon a sudden; but its motion is all the way uneven, and it quickly falls in a despicable Gelly: He that looks on the *Latin* of *Manilius* will see that I do him no Injury when I compare him to this *Meteor*, for even when he is oblig'd to give rules, and is ty'd almost to a certain form of words, he struggles against those necessary Fetters, he reaches after the strongest *Metaphors*, uses the boldest *Catachresis*, and against all the rules of Decency labours after an *obscure Sublime*, when he should endeavour to be plain, intelligible and easy: But as soon as he hath room to get loose, how wildly doth he rove? he is not free but licentious, and strives to err greatly. 'Tis needless to produce particulars, since they are so visible in the Prefaces, Fables, and Descriptions thro' his Books: And upon the whole it may be affirm'd, there are so many *boldnesses* scatter'd thro' his Poem, and so much of *Toysomness* just by them, that a Man may read his Youth in his writings, as well as his Contemporaries could do it in his Face.

I would mention and enlarge upon his conspicuous Vanity, and from thence endeavour to support the Judgment I have already pass'd; but that I consider that fault when it hath once possess'd a Man is not to be cool'd by all the Frost and Snow of Age: Yet from the Vanity of *Manilius* I think a particular Argument may be drawn to prove him to be young, for he had a design to rival or perfect the inimitable *Virgil*. This is evident from the Preface to his third Book: —<sup>57</sup> *Romanae Gentis Origo, Totque Duces Orbis, tot bella, tot otia, et omnis In Populi unius leges ut cesserit Orbis Differtur*— For here it is plain he had this mighty project in his head, and after he had prepar'd himself by this Astronomical Poem, rais'd his Fancy and got a good turn of Verse, was resolv'd to prosecute it with his utmost vigour; he saw the vastness of the design



—<sup>58</sup> *Spatio majore canenda Quam si tacta loquor*— Yet he hop'd to live to finish it, though in the beginning of this Poem he wishes for *old Age* that he might compleat the Work he then had in hand; yet having gone through the most difficult part of it sooner, and with more ease than at first he thought he should have done; he sets up for new Schemes and thinks he shall have years enough before him prudently to begin, and Strength succesfully to carry on so great an Undertaking. In this very Preface he reckons up a great many other Subjects fit to employ a Poet, but in express terms lays them all aside. *Colchida nec referam, &c. Non annosa canam, &c.* But the *Roman History* is in his Thoughts tho' he will not begin to write, till his greater leisure gives him opportunity to do it.

These two Observations perswade me, that *Manilius* was Young when he began this Poem, and that he dy'd Young, and did not live to finish his design, or accurately Revise what he had written, will I think be very evident from what follows: It cannot be deny'd, that this Poet had advanc'd very far in his Work, whilst *Tiberius* was at *Rhodes*, for in his fourth Book, he gives this Character of that Island: <sup>59</sup> *Virgine sub casta felix Terraque Marique, Et Rhodos, Hospitium recturi Principis Orbem, Tuque domus verè solis, cui tota sacrata es, Cum caperes lumen magni sub Caesare Mundi.*

Now<sup>60</sup> *Tiberius* retired to *Rhodes*, when *C. Antistius* and *L. Balbus*, were Consuls; he continu'd there Seven <sup>61</sup> Years, and return'd in the Consulship of *P. Vinicius* and *P. Alfinius Varus*; and yet in the first Book we meet with the<sup>62</sup> Description of the Prodigies that appeared before the defeat of *Varus* in *Germany* which hapned when *Poppaeus Sabinus* and *Q. Sulpicius Camerinus* were Consuls, about eight years after the Return of *Tiberius* from *Rhodes*: What shall we say then? was the fourth Book written and publish'd before the first? or would the Poet have strain'd for that Complement to *Rhodes* after the *Varian* Defeat? with what Propriety could that Island be call'd *Hospitium recturi Principis Orbem*, or with what Truth could it be said to contain the most glorious Luminary next to *Caesar*, when that imagin'd Star had not for

many years been in that Horizon, and now shone in other quarters of the World? No, this had been Banter and inexplicable Riddle: But if we suppose *Manilius* to have had this Work under his hand several years, to have revis'd it, and added what he thought would adorn his Poem, then we can easily give an account why his fourth Book should appear to be eight years younger than his first: A little before *Tiberius's* return from *Rhodes* he wrote his fourth Book, after that he compos'd his fifth, and sixth which is now lost; then at several times revising his Work, and about the time of the *Varian* Defeat being upon the end of his first Book, he added to his discourse of *Comets* a short Account of those prodigious Meteors that then appeared, and which Historians<sup>63</sup> tell us were the most amazing that were ever seen: Soon after this he dy'd before he had corrected the fourth Book, as appears from the Character which in that Book he gives the Island *Rhodes*, and which his last and finishing hand could not have left there.

These Observations will help us to give some tolerable account of the other difficulties relating to this Author, for to any one who enquires why the first Book is more correct than the rest? why the Impurities of *Stile* the Criticks charge upon him are for the most part pickt out of the four last Books? I would answer, we have only the first and rude Draughts of them; and that as Poets and Painters are said to be very near ally'd, so they agree in nothing more than they do in this, that though in their *Scetches* we see the *Master*, yet we may find something that the *Finisher* would correct: To him who asks why there is no mention of this Poet in any of the *Antients*, I would reply, That *Manilius* having left an unfinisht Piece, his Family was studious both of his Credit and their own, they carefully preserv'd the Orphan, but would not expose it: In that Age when Poetry was rais'd to its greatest highth, it had argued the utmost Fondness or the extreamest Folly in a Noble Family to have publish'd a crude uncorrect Poem, and thereby engage their Honors to defend it.

Besides, *Augustus* who was infinitely jealous of his reputation (—*Si palpere recalcitrat undique tutus*, says *Horace* who knew his Temper

very well) would not have born the too officious Complement of being invok'd, unless the Poem had been as correct as *Virgil's Georgicks*, and fit for his *Genius* to inspire. *Lucan* afterward suffer'd for the like Complement, though indeed upon a far different account: He lost his Life for pretending to be inspir'd by *Nero*, when he made better Verses than the Emperour himself; his Flattery to *Nero* was too great, as this of *Manilius* to *Augustus* had been too little, and a Defect in such Addresses was as dangerous under the wise, as an Excess in them was under the vain Emperors of *Rome*.

You are sufficiently tired, I fear, with this long Discourse about *Manilius* full of guesses and conjectures, yet I cannot dismiss this Subject without adding something concerning his Quality, and place of Birth. His Quality he carries in his name, the *Manilij* being one of the best Families in *Rome*, which so often fill'd the Consul's Chair, and was employ'd in the greatest Offices of that Commonwealth. Indeed some have affirm'd that he was of *Servile Condition*, and being made free, according to Custom, took the name of his Patron: But since I have already prov'd, that he was not the *Manilius Antiochus* in *Pliny*, there is no reason left for any one to say he was a *Slave*; he himself very expressly, I think, declares himself to be a *Roman* born, for in his fourth Book he shews a Concern for the Interests of the *Roman* Commonwealth down as low as the Age of *Hannibal*.<sup>64</sup> *Speratum Hannibalem nostris cecidisse catenis*: which he could not with any Propriety have done, had his relation to that State commenc'd so lately, or had his Ancestors had no Interest in the then Losses or Victories of *Rome*. And seeing he was born a *Roman*, and of the Family of the *Manilij*, we may farther from some other Evidences conclude that he sprung from a very considerable, if not one of the noblest Branches of it; for if we reflect that tho' he dy'd young, yet he had been well instructed in the several *Hypotheses* of the Antient Philosophers, accurately taught the Doctrine of the *Stoicks*, led thro' all the intricate mazes and Subtilties of *Astrology*, that he was acquainted with the *Mathematicks*, knew all the *Mythology* of the Antients, and had run thro'

the *Greek* Poets, we shall find in him all the signs of a very liberal and costly Education, and consequently of a considerable Quality, or at least a great Fortune. But if we reflect farther that he was conversant at Court, and acquainted with the modish, and nicest Flattery of the Palace, that he made his Complements in the same Phrase that the most intimate and finisht Courtier ever us'd, we may raise another probable Argument that his Quality was great: Now this reflection may be supported by one observation made on the Complement he pays *Tiberius* when at *Rhodes*: He stiles him<sup>65</sup> *Magni Mundi Lumen*, using the very same Word, which we meet with in *Velleius Paterculus*, who wrote all Court Language, upon the very same occasion.<sup>66</sup> *Alterum Reipublicae Lumen* is *Tiberius*, and he retir'd to *Rhodes*, *ne Fulgor suus orientium Juvenum, C. et L. Caes. obstaret initiis*, says that Historian.

As to his place of Birth, since we find him at *Rome* when he wrote this Poem, <sup>67</sup> *Qua genitus cum fratre Remus hanc condidit Urbem*: and no Author settles him any where else, it may with some shew of Probability be concluded, that he was born in that City, in which we are certain he both studeid, and led his life: But if we consider farther that he takes all occasions to shew his respect for *Rome*, that with Zeal he mentions those extravagant Honours which the Flattery<sup>68</sup> of *Asia*, and the Vanity of her own Citizens had put upon her, we shall find so much Veneration in his Writings, that it could not well rise from any other Spring than that Piety which Men of generous Sense and Spirit always retain for the Places of their Birth.

To close this Discourse, I have prov'd this Author was not the *Manilius Antiochus* mention'd by *Pliny*, *Nat. Hist. lib. 35. cap. 17*. Nor that *Manilius lib. 10. cap. 2*. and that both *Vossius* and Mr. *Tristan* are very much mistaken in their Conjectures. There remains another *Manilius* whom the same<sup>69</sup> *Pliny*, commends for his Skill in *Mathematicks*; this Mathematician *Scaliger* thinks to be the same with the Poet, because he liv'd in the time of *Augustus*, and was conversant in the same Studies with our Author; These I must own are not convincing proofs; but as

there are no good Arguments for, so there are no Objections against his pretences, and therefore he still stands fairest for the Person.

This *Manilius* of a Noble Family, born in *Rome*, and living in the Age of *Augustus*, had a liberal Education suitable to his Quality and the time in which he liv'd: his Writings shew him to be well acquainted with the Principles of the several Sects of Philosophers, but addicted to the *Stoicks*, whose *Hypothesis* in all its out-lines bears a very near resemblance to some of the Theories that are now in Fashion. The Modern Philosophers build Worlds according to the Models of the Antient Heathens, and *Zeno* is the Architect.

The *Stoicks* Principles were in short these: They say there is one Infinite, Eternal, Almighty Mind, which being diffus'd thro' the whole Universe of well order'd and regularly dispos'd Matter, actuates every part of it, and is as it were, the Soul of this vast Body: The Parts of this Body they say are of two Sorts, the *Celestial*, viz. the Planets and the fixt Stars, and the *Terrestrial*, viz. the Earth, and all the other Elements about it: The Celestial continue still the same without any Change or Variation; but the whole Sublunary World is not only liable to Dissolution, but often hath been, and shall again be dissolv'd by Fire: From this *Chaos* which, because it is made by Fire, they call *Fire*, they say another *System* would arise, the several particles of it settling according to their respective Weights: Thus the Earth would sink lowest, the Water would be above that, the Air next, and the Fire encompass the other Three: But because all the Earthy parts are not equally rigid, nor equally dispers'd thro' the *Chaos*, therefore there would be Cavities and Hollows in some places fit to receive the Water, and to be Channels for Rivers: In other places Hills and Mountains would rise, and the whole *System* appear in that very form and figure which it now bears. They farther add, that this Infinite Mind hath made one general decree concerning the Government of the lower World, and executes it by giving such and such Powers to the Celestial Bodies, as are sufficient and proper to produce the design'd Effects: This *Decree* thus executed they call *Fate*, and upon this Principle their

whole System of *Astrology* depends: That some things happen'd in the World which were very unaccountable every days Experience taught them; they learn'd also or pretended to have learn'd from very many accurate, and often repeated Observations, that there was a constant Agreement between those odd unaccountable Accidents and such and such Positions of the Heavenly Bodies, and therefore concluded that those Bodies were concern'd in those Effects: Hence they began to settle Rules, and to draw their scatter'd Observations into an Art; And this was the State of the *Hypothesis* and *Astrology* of the *Stoicks*, (I must call it so for distinction sake, tho', neither the *Hypothesis* it self, nor the *Astrology* built upon it was invented by *Zeno*, but deliver'd down to him and his Scholars by the *Chaldeans* and other Philosophers of the East) 'till the *Greeks* ambitious of making it appear their own, endeavour'd to establish support and adorn it with their Fables, and by that means made that which before seem'd only precarious, (as all Arts which are drawn from bare Observation and not from any settled Principles in Nature must appear to be) ridiculous Fancies, and wild Imaginations: But I do not design an Account, nor a defence of the *Astrology* of the Antients: You know, Sir, it hath been spoken against and derided on the one Hand, and supported and applauded on the other by Men of great Wit, Judgment, Piety, and Worth: and he who shall take a View of it, will always find enough in it to divert his leisure, if not to satisfie his Curiosity, and raise his Admiration.

This is the *Hypothesis* which *Manilius* endeavour'd to explain in *Latin* Verse: Had he liv'd to revise it, we had now had a more beautiful and correct piece; he had a *Genius* equal to his Undertaking, his Fancy was bold and daring, his Skill in the Mathematicks great enough for his Design, his Knowledge of the History, and Acquaintance with the Mythology of the Antients general: As he is now, some of the *Criticks* place him amongst the Judicious and Elegant, and all allow him to be one of the useful, instructive, profitable Poets: He hints at some Opinions which later Ages have thought fit to glory in as their own

Discoveries. Thus he defends the *Fluidity of the Heavens* against the *Hypothesis* of Aristotle.

He asserts that the *fixed Stars* are not all in the same concave Superficies of the Heavens, and equally distant from the Center of the World: He maintains that they are all of the same Nature and Substance with the *Sun*, and that each of them hath a particular Vortex of his own; and lastly he affirms that the *Milkie Way* is only the undistinguish'd Lustre of a great many small Stars, which the Moderns now see to be such, thro' the Glass of *Galilaeo*: In short, we do not give him too great a Character, when we say he is one of the most discerning *Philosophers* that Antiquity can shew.

In my Version I have endeavoured to render this Author intelligible and easie, and therefore have been sometimes forc'd to take a larger Compass than a strict Translation would allow; and have added some Notes to make him less obscure: Amongst those Notes you will find one relating to the *Theory of the Earth*, which I must desire you to lay aside, it being written and printed several years ago, and before I had well considered the weak unphilosophical Principles, and pernicious Consequences of that vain *Hypothesis*.

And now, Sir, you are near the End of this long Letter, give me leave to tell you, that I have not tired you half so much, as at first I design'd to do; having left unsaid a great many things relating both to the Author and his Writings: Those perhaps will appear at the Head of a *Latin* Edition of his Works, which I shall think my self oblig'd to undertake, unless a very learned Gentleman, from whom I have long expected it, frees me from that trouble, and obliges the World with his own Observations.

I am Your Humble Servant, T. C.

All-Souls, Octob. 10. 96.

## Book I

*After a short Account of his Design, and a complemental Address to Augustus, he begins, 1. With the Rise and Progress of Astronomy, and other Arts: 2. Discourseth of the several Opinions concerning the Beginning of the World: 3. Describes the Order of it: 4. Proves the Earth to be the Centre of the World: 5. Proves it to be round: 6. Asserts the Soul of the World: 7. Reckons up the Signs of the Zodiack: 8. Describes the Axis: 9. The Northern Constellations: 10. The Constellations between the Tropicks and the South-pole: 11. Explains the Figures of the Constellations: 12. Asserts Providence against Epicurus: 13. Discovers the Bigness of the World: 14. Treats of the movable and immovable Circles: 15. Makes a long description of the Milky-way: 16. Reckons up the Planets: 17. Discourseth of Comets and Meteors, and concludes that they presage.*

### The Subject of the Poem.

1.1

STars conscious of our Fates and Arts <sup>70</sup> Divine,

1.2

The wondrous work of Heaven's first wise design,

1.3

In numerous Verse I boldly first inclose;

1.4

Too high a Subject, and too great for Prose.

1.5

At what the Ancients with a wild amaze

1.6

And ignorant wonder were content to gaze,

1.7

My Verse brings down from Heav'n, design'd to show

1.8

Celestial secrets to the World below:



1.9

What yet the *Muses Groves* ne'er heard, I sing,

1.10

And bring unusual offerings to their spring.

## The Invocation.

1.11

*Rome's Prince and Father*, Thou whose wide command

1.12

With awfull sway is stretcht o'er Sea and Land,

1.13

Who dost *deserve* that Heaven thy Love bestow'd

1.14

On thy great *Father*, Thou thy self a *God*,

1.15

Now give me Courage, make my Fancy strong,

1.16

And yield me vigour for so great a Song.

1.17

Nor doth the *World* this curious search refuse,

1.18

It kindly courts the daring of my Muse,

1.19

And will be known; whilst You serenely reign,

1.20

Instruct our Labour, and reward our Pain.

1.21

Wings raise my Feet, I'm pleas'd to *mount* on high

1.22

Trace all the Mazes of the *liquid* Sky,

1.23

Their various turnings, and their whirls declare,

1.24

And live in the vast regions of the Air:

1.25

I'll know the Stars, which yet alone to gain

1.26

Is knowledge mean, unequal to the Pain;

1.27

For doubts resolv'd it no delight affords,

1.28

But fills soft empty heads with ratling words:

1.29

I'll search the Depths, the most remote recess,

1.30

And flying *Nature* to Confession press;

1.31

I'll find what Sign and Constellation rule,

1.32

And make the difference 'twixt the Wise and Fool;

1.33

My Verse shall sing what various *Aspect* reigns

1.34

When *Kings* are doom'd to Crowns and *Slaves* to Chains.

1.35

I'll turn *Fate's* Books, there reade proud *Parthia's* doom,

1.36

And see the sure *Eternity* of *Rome*.

## The Difficulty.

1.37

Two *Temples* rais'd with sacred Incense shine,

1.38

I bow at *Nature*'s and the *Muses* shrine;

1.39

Both aids I need, for *double* Cares do throng,

1.40

And fill my Thought; the *Subject* and the *Song*:

1.41

And whilst I'm bound to Verse with Orbs immense

1.42

The *World* rouls round me, and distracts my sense;

1.43

Vast is my *Theme*, yet *unconceiv'd*, and brings

1.44

Untoward words scarce *loosned* from the Things.

1.45

Who first below these wondrous secrets knew?

1.46

Who stole that knowledge which the *World* withdrew?

1.47

Whose soaring mind those Airy mazes trod

1.48

And spight of *Heaven* desir'd to seem a God!

1.49

Open the Skies, and teach how Stars obey,

1.50

And run their race as *Nature* marks the way,

1.51

Their Power and Influence, what directs their Course

1.52

What whirls them round, and what confines their force.

## I. The Rise and Progress of Astronomy

1.53

First *Mercury* disclos'd these mysteries,

1.54

By Him we view the *Inside* of the Skies,

1.55

And know the Stars, and now Mankind admires

1.56

The *Power*, not onely *Lustre* of their Fires:

1.57

By Him all know how great, how just and wise,

1.58

And good is the Contriver of the Skies;

1.59

At whose Command the Stars in order met,

1.60

Who times appointed when to rise and set;

1.61

That *Heaven's* great secrets may lie hid no more,

1.62

And Man instructed gratefully Adore.

1.63

*Nature* disclos'd her self, and from her Springs

1.64

Pure streams deriv'd o'erslow'd the Minds of *Kings*,

1.65

*Kings* next to *Heaven*, who o'er the *East* did sway,

1.66

Where swift *Euphrates* cuts his rapid way,

1.67

Where <sup>71</sup> *Nile* o'erflows, and whence the Whirl restores

1.68

The Day to Us, and passing burns the Moors.

1.69

And next o'er *Priests*, whose constant Cares employd

1.70

In publick service did oblige the God,

1.71

His *Presence* did their holy minds inspire

1.72

With sacred flames, and rais'd their fancies higher,

1.73

Till by degrees to due perfection wrought

1.74

He made himself the *Object* of their thought:

1.75

Such were those wondrous Men who first from far

1.76

Lookt up, and saw *Fates* hanging at each *Star*:

1.77

Their thoughts extended did at once comprise

1.78

Ten thousand revolutions of the Skies,

1.79

They markt the Influence, and observ'd the Power

1.80

Of every *Sign*, and every fatal *Hour*;

1.81

What *Tempers* they bestow'd, what *Fortunes* gave,

1.82

And who was doom'd a *King*, who born a *Slave*;

1.83

How *Aspects* vary, and their change creates,

1.84

Though little, great variety in Fates.

1.85

Thus when the Stars their mighty Round had run,

1.86

And all were fixt whence first their Race begun,

1.87

What Hints *Experience* did to search impart

1.88

They join'd, and *Observation* grew to Art;

1.89

Thus Rules were fram'd, for by *Example* shown

1.90

They knew what *would be*, from what *had been* done;

1.91

They saw the Stars their *constant* Round maintain

1.92

Perform their Course, and then return again;

1.93

They on their *Aspects* saw the Fates attend,

1.94

*Their* change on their *Variety* depend;

1.95

And thence they fixt unalterable Laws,

1.96

Settling the *same* Effect on the *same* Cause.

1.97

Before that time *Life* was an artless State

1.98

Of Reason void, and thoughtless in debate:

1.99

*Nature* lay hid in deepest Night below,

1.100

None knew her *wonders*, and none car'd to know:

1.101

Upward men look, they saw the circling light,

1.102

Pleas'd with the Fires, and wondred at the sight:

1.103

The *Sun*, when Night came on, withdrawn, they griev'd,

1.104

As *dead*, and joy'd next Morn when he reviv'd;

1.105

But why the *Nights* grow long or short, the *Day*

1.106

Is chang'd, and the *Shades* vary with the Ray,

1.107

Shorter at his approach, and longer grown

1.108

At his remove, the Causes were unknown:

1.109

For *Wit* lay unimprov'd, the desert plains

1.110

Were unmanur'd, nor fed the idle Swains:

1.111

Ev'n *Gold* dwelt safe in Hills, and none resign'd

1.112

Their lives to Seas or wishes to the Wind;

1.113

Consin'd their search, they knew themselves alone,

1.114

And thought that onely worthy to be known:

1.115

But when long time the Wretches thoughts resin'd,

1.116

When *Want* had set an edge upon their Mind;

1.117

When Men encrease, and Want did boldly press,

1.118

And forc'd them to be witty for redress;

1.119

Then various Cares their working thoughts employ'd,

1.120

And that which *each* invented *all* enjoy'd.

1.121

Then *Corn* first grew, then Fruit enrich the grounds,

1.122

And barbarous *noise* was first confin'd to sounds:

1.123

Through Seas unknown the *Sailer* then was hurl'd,

1.124

And gainfull Traffick joyn'd the distant World:

1.125

Then Arts of *War* were found, and Arts of *Peace*,

1.126

For *Vse* is always fruitfull in encrease.

1.127

New hints from settled Arts *Experience* gains,

1.128

Instructs our Labour, and rewards our Pains:

1.129

Thus into many Streams one Spring divides,

1.130

And through the Valleys rous refreshing Tides.

1.131

But these were little things compar'd, they knew



1.132

The *voice* of *Birds*, in Entrails *Fates* could view;

1.133

Burst *Snakes* with charms, and in a *Bullock's* bloud,

1.134

See *Rage* appeas'd, or fear an *angry* God.

1.135

They call'd up *Ghosts*, mov'd deepest Hell, the Sun

1.136

Could stop, and force a Night upon his Noon;

1.137

Then make him rise at Night, for all submit

1.138

To constant *Industry*, and piercing *Wit*.

1.139

Nor stopt they here, unwearied *Industry*

1.140

Rose boldly up and mounted through the Sky,

1.141

Saw all that could be seen, view'd *Nature's* Laws,

1.142

And *young* Effects still lying in their Cause.

1.143

What wings the *Lightning*, why from watry Clouds

1.144

The *Thunder* breaks, and roars the wrath of Gods.

1.145

What raiseth *Storms*, what makes the *Winds* to blow,

1.146

Why *Summer's* Hail's more stiff than *Winter's* Snow:

1.147

What *fires* Earth's Entrails, what doth *shake* the Ball,

1.148

Why *Tempests* rattle, and why *Rain* doth fall:

1.149

All this she view'd, and did their *modes* explain,

1.150

And taught us to admire no more in vain.

1.151

*Heaven* was disarm'd, mad *Whirlwinds* rul'd above

1.152

And *Clouds* and *Vapors* thundred instead of *Jove*.

1.153

These things explain'd, their hidden Cause known,

1.154

The *Mind* grew strong, and ventur'd boldly on;

1.155

For rais'd so high, from that convenient rise

1.156

She took her flight, and quickly reacht the Skies;

1.157

To every *Constellation* Shapes and Names

1.158

Assign'd, and markt them out their proper frames

1.159

Then view'd their Course, and saw the *Orbs* were mov'd

1.160

As *Heaven* did guide, and as the *World* approv'd;

1.161

That *Chance* was baffled whilst their Whirls create

1.162

The interchang'd *Variety* of Fate.

1.163

This is my *Theme*, ne'er yet in Numbers wrought,

1.164

Assist me, *Fortune*, and improve my thought;

1.165

Equal my Mind to my vast task; prolong

1.166

My life in ease, smooth as my flowing Song;

1.167

That while my *Muse* is working o'er the Heap,

1.168

And forms this *Chaos* to a pleasing shape,

1.169

I may with equal care, and equal heat,

1.170

Declare the *Little* and disclose the *Great*.

1.171

But now since *Fate* and *Verse* do joyntly flow

1.172

From *Heaven*, and both rule equally below.

1.173

First let my *Muse* whole Nature's Face design,

1.174

Its Figure draw, and finish every Line.

## II. Different Opinions about the beginning of the World.

1.175

Whether from *Seed* it ne'er <sup>72</sup> began to be,

1.176

Secure from *Fate*, and from *Corruption* free;

1.177

Knew no *Beginning*, and no *Ending* fears,

1.178

But was, and will be, as it now appears.

1.179

Or huddled <sup>73</sup> *Chaos* by a wondrous Birth

1.180

Archt the vast Sky and fixt the solid Earth;

1.181

And when this shining World once rais'd its Head

1.182

To Shades *Infernal* banisht *Darkness* fled.

1.183

Or whether unseen <sup>74</sup> *Atoms* blindly thrown

1.184

Compos'd it, and as Years whirle nimbly on,

1.185

It must dissolve, and as it first was wrought

1.186

From almost Nothing, fall to almost Nought.

1.187

Or rose from working <sup>75</sup> Fire's enlivening Rays,

1.188

Which form Heaven's Eyes, and live in every Mass.

1.189

In *Thunder* roar, and in the *Lightning* blaze.

1.190

Or whether <sup>76</sup> *Water* which combines the Frame

1.191

Compos'd, and keeps it from the loosning Flame.

1.192

Or whether <sup>77</sup> Water, Air, and Flame and Earth

1.193

Knew no beginning, no *first* seeds of Birth;

1.194

But first in Being from themselves arose,

1.195

And as four Members the vast *God* compose;

1.196

In which Thin, Thick, Hot, Cold, and Moist and Dry,

1.197

For mutual Actions mutual parts supply.

1.198

From whose agreeing disagreement springs,

1.199

The numerous odd Variety of Things.

1.200

These Qualities to act provoke the Seed,

1.201

Make *Vital* Elements and Bodies breed.

### III. The Order of the Frame.

1.202

What 'twas at first, and whence the *All* began

1.203

Is doubted, and the Doubt too deep for Man;

1.204

And let it be, but whencesoe'er it came

1.205

Its Face is certain, 'tis an *order'd* Frame.

1.206

Upward the <sup>78</sup> *Flame* on active Pinions fled,

1.207

To Heaven's high Arch it rais'd its shining Head,

1.208

There stopt as weary grown, and round the Frame

1.209

For Nature's Bullwark roll'd a Wall of Flame.

1.210

Then liquid *Air* spread through the empty space

1.211

Less light and active took the second place.

1.212

But next the Flame the lightest parts aspire

1.213

To waste themselves, and feed the greedy Fire.

1.214

The heavier *Water* makes an humbler Claim,

1.215

And lies the third in order in the Frame;

1.216

That Vapours rising may, like Seed, repair

1.217

What Fire destroys, and feed decaying Air:

1.218

Weight sank round *Earth* to the remotest place,

1.219

And floating Sand in clinging Mud's embrace

1.220

Stuck fast, whilst *Seas* squeez'd out flow'd o'er the Mass:

1.221

As those grew limpid, and diffus'd the Waves,

1.222

Through spacious Hollows and descending Caves

1.223

Rocks started forth, their Heads the Mountains rear'd,

1.224

And Earth surrounded by the Floud appear'd.

1.225

Lowest of all, and in the midst it lies

1.226

Compass'd by Seas, and cover'd by the Skies.

1.227

The Place doth fix it, for still rising higher

1.228

The *other Elements* equally retire,

1.229

And that by falling stops its farther fall,

1.230

And hangs the *midst* and *lowest* of them all,

1.231

Its parts to *one* fixt point press jointly down,

1.232

And meet, and stop each other from moving on.

#### IV. The Earth lies in the midst of the World.

1.233

For did not *Earth* hang *midst* the airy space,

1.234

How could the *Sun* perform his constant race?

1.235

Drive on the Day, fall headlong down the West,

1.236

Force up the Stars, and rise again at East?

1.237

How could the *Moon* her usual Round maintain,

1.238

Rise, set, and rise near the same point again?

1.239

Or *He* that leads the Stars at Night return

1.240

To East again, and usher forth the Morn?

1.241

But since *Earth* did not to a *Bottom* fall,

1.242

But hangs, and yielding Air surrounds the Ball,

1.243

The way is open, and no stop to force

1.244

The *Stars* return, or to impede their course.

1.245

For who can think that when the <sup>79</sup> *Sun* doth rise

1.246

He's born anew, or when He sets He dies?

1.247

That when one Day He hath display'd his Light

1.248

His Race is finisht, and goes out at Night?

1.249

Since *He the same* doth every Morn appear,

1.250

And as He drives a *Day* He whirls a *Year*.

1.251

From the same *East* He comes with equal pace,

1.252

To the same *West* He still directs his Race;

1.253

And not *one Change* is seen in Nature's Face.



1.254

The same *Moon* shines, and at a certain Day,

1.255

Her light encreases, and Her Horns decay.

1.256

The track she made *Nature* doth still pursue,

1.257

Nor like a Novice wanders in a new.

1.258

*Phoebus* still warms those signs where first he shone,

1.259

And Day goes round with *one eternal* Sun.

1.260

Thus prov'd: because by *just Degrees* the Hours

1.261

In different Countries are the same with Ours.

1.262

The *Eastern* Nations view the rising Fires

1.263

Whilst Night shades us, and lazily retires.

1.264

And as to distant West we nimbly run,

1.265

That still removes, nor can we reach the Sun.

1.266

No East *begins*, no West his race doth bound,

1.267

But he drives on in one continued *Round*.

1.268

Nor is it wondrous that *one single* Ball

1.269

Should *hang*, since 'tis the Nature of the *All*.

1.270

No prop supports, but as their motions prove,

1.271

The whole World *hangs*, and all that whirls above.

1.272

The *Sun* doth drive his Race through yielding Skies,

1.273

Wheel round the liquid Bound, and set and rise.

1.274

Through *Aether*, *Moon* and *Stars* direct their Race,

1.275

Like these *Earth* unsupported keeps its place,

1.276

Though no *fixt Bottom* props the weighty Mass.

## V. The Earth is round.

1.277

Well then, the Earth hangs midst the yielding Air

1.278

Not stretcht into a *Plain*, but every where

1.279

It rises and declines into a *Sphere*.

1.280

In other Parts this Figure Nature drew,

1.281

The Sun and Stars, if we exactly view,

1.282

Seem round, the Moon is vary'd every Night,

1.283

Nor with an equal Face receives her Brother's Light.

1.284

This proves her round since different rays adorn,

1.285

Now shape, now bend, now fill her borrow'd Horn,

1.286

This Form's *Eternal* and may justly claim

1.287

A Godlike Nature, all its parts the same;

1.288

Alike and equal to its self 'tis found,

1.289

No End's and no Beginning in a Round.

1.290

Nought can molest its Being nought controul,

1.291

And this enobles and confines the Whole.

### First Argument.

1.292

Hence every Countrey sees not every Sign,

1.293

What Sailer views the bright <sup>80</sup> *Canopus* shine

1.294

O'er *Egypt*'s Shores, and when its Rays appear

1.295

Who sees the little Circles of the *Bear*?

1.296

For Earth still rising to a Round denies,

1.297

A larger Scene, and bounds our feeble Eyes.

1.298

This Truth the <sup>81</sup> *Moon* confirms when deep in Night

## Second Argument.

1.299

Earth interposes, and diverts her Light,

1.300

She doth not all the World at once surprize,

1.301

But now seems dark to these, now other Eyes.

1.302

The *Eastern* Parts first view her darkned Face,

1.303

Then o'er the *South* she rolls her broken Rays;

1.304

And then still prest by the obscuring shade,

1.305

She hears the *Western Brass* resounding to her Aid.

1.306

Now if the Earth were *flat* the darkned Moon

1.307

Would seem to *all* Eclypst as well as *one*.

1.308

At once presenting to the common view

1.309

Her gloomy looks, and prove this fancy true.

1.310

But since its Figure's round, dim *Cynthia's* beams

1.311

By just degrees must visit the Extremes;

1.312

Not all at once; she must divide the Skies,

1.313

And while she sets to *some*, to *others* rise.

1.314

For in the mighty *Concave* whirl'd above

1.315

She *rising* must, and must *declining* move;

1.316

Now climb this rising, and her Glories show,

1.317

Then sink again, and scatter Beams below.

1.318

This proves (nor shall the subtlest Wits escape

1.319

These twining Reasons) the disputed Shape.

1.320

By various Animals this *Globe*'s possest,

1.321

The Common House of Man, of Bird, and Beast;

1.322

The *Northern*<sup>82</sup> parts rise high, the *Southern* fall

1.323

Beneath our Fee, the *Adverse* of the Ball.

1.324

Yet as it lies its surface a *Flat*,

1.325

Though false, its bigness doth improve the Cheat,

1.326

And take the *Roundness* off, though every where

1.327

It riseth and declines into a *Sphere*.

1.328

Hence when with setting Beams the Sun withdrawn

1.329

Beholds our *East*, they see the *Morning* dawn;

1.330

And when their Toils He with his Light restores,

1.331

Sleep sits on Us, and gently easeth Ours.

## VI. God the Soul of the World.

1.332

The *Sea*<sup>83</sup> runs round, and with its circling Waves

1.333

The *Floud* at once divides, and joyns the Halves.

1.334

To that vast Frame in which four parts conspire

1.335

Of different form, Air, Water, Earth and Fire,

1.336

United<sup>84</sup> *God* the World's Almighty Soul

1.337

By secret methods rules and guides the Whole;

1.338

By unseen passes He himself conveys

1.339

Through all the Mass, and every part obeys.

1.340

To proper Patients He kind Agents brings

1.341

In various Leagues binds disagreeing Things.

1.342

Makes some Powers act, and some receive their Force;

1.343

And thus whilst *Nature* keeps her Vital Course,

1.344

Though *different Powers* the several Things divide,

1.345

The World seems *One*, and all its parts ally'd.

## VII. The Signs of the Zodiack.

1.346

Now *Constellations*, Muse, and *Signs* rehearse,

1.347

In order, let them sparkle in thy Verse.

1.348

Those which *obliquely* bound the burning Zone,

1.349

And bear the *Summer* and the *Winter* Sun,

1.350

Those first: then those which roll a different way

1.351

From West: nor Heaven's *Diurnal* whirl obey:

1.352

Which Nights serene disclose, and which create

1.353

The steady Rules, and six the Laws of *Fate*.

1.354

First *Aries*, glorious in his Golden Wool,

1.355

Looks back, and wonders at the mighty *Bull*,

1.356

Whose back-parts first appear: He bending lies

1.357

With threatening Head, and calls the *Twins* to rise,

1.358

They clasp for fear, and mutually embrace;

1.359

And next the *Twins* with an unsteady pace

1.360

Bright *Cancer* rolls: Then *Leo* shakes his Mane:

1.361

And following *Virgo* calms his Rage again:

1.362

Then Day and Night are weigh'd in *Libra*'s Scales,

1.363

Equal a while, at last the Night prevails,

1.364

And longer grown the heavier *Scale* inclines

1.365

And draws bright *Scorpio* from the Winter Signs:

1.366

Him *Centaur* follows with an aiming Eye

1.367

His Bow full drawn and ready to let fly:

1.368

Next narrow Horns the twisted *Caper* shows,

1.369

And from *Aquarius* Urn a floud o'erflows.

1.370

Near their lov'd Waves cold *Pisces* take their Seat,

1.371

With *Aries* joyn and make the *Round* compleat.

## VIII. The Axis.

1.372

Now view the point where turn the shining *Bears*,

1.373



And from their height look down on other Stars.

1.374

Which never set but onely change their Sites

1.375

To the same point; and whirl the meaner Lights;

1.376

Thither the *Axis* runs, whose adverse Poles

1.377

Bears the poiz'd World, and Heaven about it rolls;

1.378

No *solid substance* that the weight might bear

1.379

But an *imagin'd Line* stretcht through the Air;

1.380

Begun from either Pole the Line extends

1.381

*Earth's Centre* through, and in the other ends.

1.382

For since the frame turns round, that fancy'd Line

1.383

Which cuts the middle, too minutely thin

1.384

By turning round it self to measure space,

1.385

But still confin'd to one imagin'd place,

1.386

Is call'd the *Axis*; cause unapt to move

1.387

It sees *Stars* whirl, the shining *Planets* rove,

1.388

And swiftly measure the vast space above.

1.389

Fixt near the *Pole* appear those friendly Stars

## IX. The great Bear.

1.390

Well known to wretched greedy Mariners;

1.391

Which guide their Sails, and which direct their Oars,

1.392

When mad for gain they fly to foreign Shores.

1.393

(Whilst *Heaven* it self befriends their Avarice,

1.394

What Pleas may wretched *Mortals* make for Vice?)

1.395

Seven equal Stars adorn the *greater Bear*,

1.396

Which measure larger Circles of the Sphere,

1.397

And teach the *Grecian* Sailers how to steer.

## The little Bear.

1.398

The smaller *Bear*, though less in size and light

1.399

In narrower Circles she commands the Night,

1.400

Yet *Tyre* prefers, for through the *Ocean* tost

1.401

They sail by her and find the foreign Coast;

1.402

These stand not front to front, but each doth view

1.403

The others Tayl, pursu'd as they pursue.

## The Serpent.

1.404

Betwixt and round these two the *Serpent* twines,

1.405

At once divides, and to their place confines;

1.406

Secure from meeting they're distinctly roll'd,

1.407

Nor leave their Seats, and pass the *dreadfull* fold:

1.408

These keep the *Vertex*, but betwixt the Bear

1.409

And shinning *Zodiack* where the Planets Err,

1.410

A Thousand Figur'd Constellations roll,

1.411

Some near the *Zodiack*, some plac'd near the Pole:

1.412

Whose differing Powers by tempering Skies combin'd

1.413

Make Seasons fruitfull, and refresh Mankind.

## Hercules.

1.414

First near the *North*, as conscious of his shame

1.415

A *Constellation* kneels without a Name;

## Bootes.

1.416

And next *Bootes* comes, whose order'd Beams

1.417

Present a Figure driving of his Teams.

1.418

Below his Girdle, near his Knees, He bears

## Arcturus.

1.419

The bright *Arcturus*, fairest of the Stars.

## The Crown.

1.420

Behind his Back the radiant *Crown* is view'd,

1.421

And shines with Stars of different magnitude;

1.422

One plac'd i'th' front above the rest displays

1.423

A vigorous light, and darts surprizing rays.

1.424

This shone since *Theseus* first his faith betray'd,

1.425

The Monument of the forsaken Maid.

## The Harp.

1.426

Nor far from these distended *Lyra* lies,

1.427

Well strung, the sounding glory of the Skies.

1.428

This *Orpheus* struck when with his wondrous Song

1.429

He charm'd the Woods, and drew the Rocks along;

1.430

When Hell obey'd, when Death resign'd her Chain,

1.431

And loos'd his dear *Eurydice* again;

1.432

This gain'd it Heaven, and still its force appears,

1.433

As then the Rocks it now draws on the Stars.

1.434

The *Planets* dance, and to the tunefull sound

1.435

The *Heaven* consents, and moves the *fatal* Round.

## Ophiuchus.

1.436

Next *Ophiuchus* strides the mighty Snake,

1.437

Untwists his winding Folds, and smooths his Back,

1.438

Extends its Bulk, and o'er the slippery Scale

1.439

His wide stretcht Hands on either side prevail:

1.440

The Snake turns back his Head, and seems to rage,

1.441

That War must last where *equal Powers* engage.

### The Swan.

1.442

Next view the *Swan*, whom *Jove* advanc'd above,

1.443

That Form's reward by which He caught his Love.

1.444

When shrouded in the fair deceitfull shape,

1.445

He cheated trusting *Leda* to a Rape:

1.446

Now grac'd with Stars his Wings stretcht o'er the Skies.

### The Arrow.

1.447

And next the *Swan* the shining *Arrow* flies:

### The Eagle.

1.448

The towring *Eagle* next doth boldly soar,

1.449

As if the thunder in his Claws he bore:

1.450

He's worthy *Jove*, since He, a Bird, supplies

1.451

The Heaven with sacred Bolts, and arms the Skies.

## The Dolphin.

1.452

Next rais'd from Seas the *Dolphin's* Tail appears,

1.453

The Glory of the Floud and of the Stars.

1.454

Whom while the *Horse* (one radiant Star doth grace

## The Horse.

1.455

His generous Breast) pursues with eager pace,

1.456

His Legs before, as running, He extends,

## Andromeda.

1.457

But clos'd in fair *Andromeda* he ends.

1.458

Her *Perseus* joyns, her Foot his Shoulder bears

## Perseus.

1.459

Proud of the weight, and mixes with her Stars.

1.460

Five splendid Stars in its *unequal* Frame

## The Triangle.

1.461

*Deltoton* bears, and from the shape a Name;

1.462

But those that grace the sides dim Light display

1.463

And yield unto the *Basis* brighter Ray.

## Cepheus and Cassiopcia.

1.464

Next with her *Cepheus Cassiopeia* shines,

1.465

Her posture sad, and mourns amongst the Signs;

1.466

She sees her *Daughter* chain'd, the rolling Tide

1.467

The *Monster* spout, and curses her old Pride:

1.468

She fears that *Perseus* will inconstant prove,

1.469

And now in Heaven forget his former Love;

1.470

But He attends, and bears the *Gorgon's* head,

1.471

His *Spoil*, and *witness* of a coming aid.

## Heniochus.

1.472

Near the bent *Bull* a seat the *Driver* claims,

1.473



Whose skill conferr'd his Honour and his Names,

1.474

His Art great *Jove* admir'd, when first he drove

1.475

His rattling Carr, and fixt the Youth above.

### The Hoedi.

1.476

Next stormy *Hoedi* shine which shut the Main,

1.477

And stop the Sailers hot pursuit of gain.

### The Goat.

1.478

Then shines the *Goat*, whose Brutish Duggs supply'd

1.479

The Infant *Jove*, and nurst his growing Pride.

1.480

From that wild Food He did to Heaven aspire,

1.481

Fierce Thunder throw, and dart the blasting Fire.

1.482

Then mindfull of her Care the gratefull God

1.483

Repaid her with those Skies which she bestow'd.

### The Pleiades and Hyades.

1.484

Then *Pleiades* and *Hyades* appear,

1.485

The sad Companions of the *turning* Year.

1.486

Born by the *Bull* they lead they Tempests forth,

1.487

And close the *Constellations* of the *North*.

## X.

1.488

Farewell cold *North*, thy Ice benums my Muse,

1.489

I fly from Thee, and warmer Regions chuse;

1.490

Betwixt the *Tropicks* of the Traveling Sun,

1.491

I'll trace the Signs that burn the *torrid* Zone,

1.492

Then pass those bounds and view the Stars that roll

1.493

Between cold *Caper* and the lower *Pole*.

## Orion.

1.494

First next the *Twins*, see great *Orion* rise,

1.495

His *Armes* extended stretch o'er half the Skies:

1.496

His stride as large, and with a stately pace

1.497

He marches on, and measures a vast space.

1.498

On each broad Shoulder a bright Star's display'd,

1.499

And three obliquely grace his hanging Blade.

1.500

In his vast Head immerst in boundless spheres

1.501

Three Stars less bright, but yet as great, he bears.

1.502

But farther off remov'd, their Splendor's lost,

1.503

Thus grac'd and arm'd He leads the Starry Host.

### The Dog-Star.

1.504

Next barks the *Dog*, and from his Nature flow

1.505

The most afflicting Powers that rule below,

1.506

*Heat* burns his *Rise*, *Frost* chills his setting *Beams*,

1.507

And vex the World with opposite Extremes.

1.508

He keeps his Course, nor from the Sun retreats,

1.509

Now bringing Frost, and now encreasing Heats:

1.510

Those that from *Taurus* view this rising Star,

1.511

Guess thence the following state of Peace and War,

1.512

Health, Plagues, a fruitfull or a barren Year.

1.513

He makes shrill Trumpets sound, and frightens Peace,

1.514

Then calms and binds up *Iron War* in Ease.

1.515

As he determines, so the Causes drawn,

1.516

His *Aspect* is the World's supremest Law.

1.517

This Power proceeds from the vast Orb He runs,

1.518

His Brightness equals or exceeds the Sun's.

1.519

But far remov'd he through the distant space

1.520

Darts feeble splendour from his Azure face.

1.521

Yet others He excells, no fairer Light

1.522

Ascends the Skies, none sets so clear a bright.

## Procyon.

1.523

Next *Procyon* view, view, and next the nimble *Hare*,

## The Hare.

1.524

Then *Argo* sailing through the liquid Air;

## Argo.

1.525

Advanc'd from all the Dangers of the Tides,

1.526

Which first she stem'd, she now securely rides.

1.527

Heaven is her Port, and now she rules the Flouds,

1.528

A Goddess made for saving of the Gods.

## The Serpent.

1.529

Close by the *Serpent* spreads; whose winding Spires

1.530

With order'd Stars resemble scaly Fires.

## The Crow.

1.531

Next flies the *Crow*, and next the generous *Bowl*

## The Cup.

1.532

Of *Bacchus* flows, and cheers the thirsty Pole.

1.533

The *Centaur* next in double shapes exprest,

1.534

A Humane Body joyns a Horse's Breast.

## The Altar.

1.535

The World's great *Temple* next, and Altar lies

1.536

Grac'd with the Gifts of *conquering* Deities,

1.537

When Earth-born Giants did the Skies invade,

1.538

The *lesser* Gods implor'd the *greater's* Aid;

1.539

His Power *Jove* doubted when he view'd from far

1.540

The threatning force of the unequal War.

1.541

When He inverted *Nature's* Frame beheld,

1.542

That Earth rose upward, and that All rebell'd.

1.543

That Hills on Hills heap'd, rais'd their threatning Head,

1.544

And frighted Stars approaching Mountains fled;

1.545

When impious Armies at a monstrous Birth

1.546

Broke through the Bowels of the gaping Earth,

1.547

Of disagreeing Forms, and frightfull Makes,

1.548

Vast *Humane* Bodies twisted into *Snakes*.

1.549

E'er this no Danger and no fear was known,

1.550

And wanton *Jove* sate idly in his Throne.

1.551

But lest some greater Power (soft ease betray'd

1.552

His Mind to doubt) should yield the Rebels aid,

1.553

He rais'd this *Altar*, and the Form appears

1.554

With Incense loaded, and adorn'd with Stars.

1.555

Next on his Belly floats the mighty *Whale*

## The Whale.

1.556

He twists his Back, and rears his threatening Tail;

1.557

He spouts the Tide, and cuts the foaming Way,

1.558

Wide gapes his Mouth, as eager on his Prey;

1.559

Such on *Andromede* He rusht, and bore

1.560

The troubled Waves beyond their usual shore.

## The Southern Fish.

1.561

Next Swims the *Southern Fish*, which bears a Name

1.562

From the South-wind, and spreads a feeble Flame.

## The Flouds.

1.563

To him the *Flouds* in spacious windings turn,

1.564

One Fountain flows from cold *Aquarius* Urn;

1.565

And meets the other where they joyn their Streams

1.566

One Chanel keep, and mix the Starry Beams.

1.567

Betwixt th' *Eclyptick* and the latent Bears

1.568

Whose creaking Axis turns the rolling Spheres,

1.569

Those stranger Skies are painted with these Stars.

1.570

Which ancient Artists in their wondrous Lines

1.571

Transmit to Fame, and call the Southern Signs.

1.572

The other part lies hid, the vast abode

1.573

Of unknown Nations, by our Feet untrod.

1.574

From the *same Sun* they take their common Light,

1.575

But different Shades: in an inverted site,

1.576

Their Signs o'th' *left Hand* <sup>85</sup> set, and rise o'th' *right*.

1.577

Their Skies as large, their Stars as splendid run,



1.578

Equal i'th' *rest*, but are excell'd by *One*,

1.579

By *Caesar's* Star which doth o'er us preside,

1.580

Earth's present joy, and Heaven's future pride.

1.581

For that the *lower Pole* resemblance bears

## The Southern Pole.

1.582

To this Above, and shines with equal Stars;

1.583

With *Bears averse*, round which the *Draco* twines,

1.584

At once divides them, and at once consines,

1.585

That there as many *Constellations* move,

1.586

We must believe from what we find above.

1.587

For Fancy, which decaying Sense supplies,

1.588

Not onely feigns a *Vertex* like to This,

1.589

But all resembling Beauties of the Skies.

1.590

These are the *Stars* which scattered o'er the Pole

1.591

In different Places fixt complete the Whole;

## XI. The Figures of the Constellations onely fansied.

1.592

But raise thy thought from sense, nor think to find

1.593

Such *Figures* there, as are in *Globes* design'd;

1.594

Nor think that Stars *set close* compose the Frames,

1.595

Or that the Signs are all *continued* Flames.

1.596

For then we soon should see the *World* expire,

1.597

Frail *Nature* could not bear so great a Fire;

1.598

Some Places vacant conscious of her State

1.599

She leaves, unable for so vast a Heat.

1.600

For 'tis her kind intent alone to show

1.601

By *certain* Stars, those *Signs* that rule below;

1.602

Such notice give, and such fair hints impart;

1.603

As Men may take, and may improve to Art:

1.604

The Stars mark out the Shapes, the *lower* Beams

1.605

Answer the *high*, the *middle* the *extremes*.

1.606

Fansie those parts that lie *obscur'd* between,

1.607

For 'tis enough that *some* of them are seen:

1.608

But chiefly then when *Cynthia's* beams are clear,

1.609

And full, but few, though still the same, appear;

1.610

And whilst the vulgar fly, their place possess;

1.611

Nor lose their Light, nor mingle with the Less.

1.612

Yet these still keep *one* Course, They still pursue

1.613

Their *constant* track nor vary in a *New*.

1.614

From *one* fixt point they start, their Course maintain

1.615

Repeat their whirl, and visit it again:

1.616

And this is strange, and this doth more surprize

1.617

Than all the other wonders of the Skies,

1.618

That such unwieldy frames their signs should draw,

1.619

As mov'd by *Reason*, and confin'd by *Law*;

1.620

No *change* in distance nor in site appear,

1.621

Though great their Number, long the rolling year.

## XII. Providence against the Epicureans.

1.622

A most convincing Reason drawn from Sense,

1.623

That this vast Frame is mov'd by *Providence*.

1.624

Which like the Soul doth every Whirl advance;

1.625

It must be *God*, nor was it made by *Chance*;

1.626

As *Epicurus* dreamt, He madly thought

1.627

This beauteous Frame of heedless *Atoms* wrought,

1.628

That Seas and Earth, the Stars and spacious Air

1.629

Which forms New Worlds, or doth the Old repair,

1.630

First rose from these, and still supply'd remain,

1.631

And All must be, when Chance shall break the Chain,

1.632

Dissolv'd to these wild *Principles* again.

1.633

Absurd and Nonsense! *Atheist* use thine Eyes,

1.634

And having view'd the order of the Skies,

1.635

Think, if Thou canst, that Matter blindly hurld,

1.636

Without a Guide should frame this wondrous World.

1.637

But did *Chance* make, and *Chance* still rule the Whole

1.638

Why do the Signs in constant order roll?

1.639

Observe set Times to shut and open Day,

1.640

Nor meet, and justle, and mistake their Way?

1.641

Perform their Course as if by Laws confin'd,

1.642

None hasten on, and leave the rest behind.

1.643

Why every Day doth the discovering Flame,

1.644

Show the *same* World, and leave it still the *same*?

1.645

E'en then when <sup>86</sup> *Troy* was by the Greeks o'er-thrown,

1.646

The *Bear* oppos'd to bright *Orion* shone;

1.647

She near the Pole in narrow Rounds did move,

1.648

He fac'd her then, and measur'd the vast space above.

1.649

And e'en at Night when Time in secret flies,

1.650

And veils himself in Shades from humane Eyes;

1.651

They by the Signs could know how fast He fled,

1.652

And in the Skies the hasty Minutes read.

1.653

How many Towns have fall'n, what well-built States,

1.654

Since *Troy*, have sunk below oppressing Fates?

1.655

How many Times hath sporting Fortune hurld

1.656

The Chance of *Rule* and *Slavery* through the World?

1.657

How hath she now reverst *Troy's* ancient Doom,

1.658

And built her Relicks greater up in *Rome*?

1.659

Reviv'd old *Ilium* doth new Spoys enjoy,

1.660

And *Greece* now bends beneath the Fate of *Troy*.

1.661

Why should I count how oft the Earth hath mourn'd

1.662

The Sun's *retreat*, and smil'd when he *return'd*?

1.663

How oft he doth his various Course divide

1.664

'Twixt *Winter's* Nakedness and *Summer's* Pride?

1.665

All Mortal Things must change. The fruit full Plain,

1.666

As Seasons turn, scarce knows her self again;

1.667

Such various forms she bears: large *Empires* too

1.668

Put off their *former* Fance, and take a *new*.

1.669

Yet safe the World, and free from Change doth last,

1.670

No Years encrease it, and no Years can waste;

1.671

Its Course it urges on, and keeps its Frame,

1.672

And still will be, because 'twas still the same.

1.673

It stands secure from *Time*'s devouring Rage,

1.674

For 'tis a *God*, nor can it change with Age.

1.675

And that the *Sun* ne'er drives the rising Day

1.676

From *North* to *South*, nor leaves the beaten way;

1.677

That weary grown He still falls down the West

1.678

At Night, nor turns his Horses to the East;

1.679

That Light by just Degrees the *Moon* adorns,

1.680

First shews, then bends, then fills her borrow'd Horns,

1.681

And that the Stars in constant order roll,

1.682

Hang there, nor fall, and leave the liquid Pole;

1.683

'Tis not from *Chance*; The Motion speaks aloud

1.684

The wise and steady conduct of the *God*.

1.685

These equally dispos'd in Order lye,

1.686

Make various Shapes, and chequer all the Skie.

1.687

*Above them nought; To the World's Top they rose,*

1.688

Painting the Roof of Natures Common House;

1.689

Which in a wide Embrace doth all contain,

1.690

The spacious Air, the Earth, and raging Main;

1.691

These *Set* in order, and in order *Rise*,

1.692

As *West* drives down, or *East* brings up the Skies.

### XIII. The bigness of the World.

1.693

But now how vast the Arch, how next immense

1.694

The *Zodiack's* Round, though far remov'd from Sense,

1.695

Plain Reason shews; whose Active Force can pierce,

1.696

The deep Recesses of the Universe.

1.697

No Bars can stop it, through the *World* it flies,

1.698

And *Heaven* it self lies open to its Eyes.

1.699



As great a space as Earth, and humble Seas

1.700

From Heaven divide, so great two Signs possess.

1.701

The World's <sup>87</sup> *Diameter* by Art is found,

1.702

Almost the *third Division* of the Round.

1.703

Therefore as far as four bright Signs comprize,

1.704

The distant *Zenith* from the *Nadir* lies.

1.705

And two thirds more almost surround the Pole,

1.706

The Twelve Signs measure, and complete the Whole.

1.707

But since the *Earth* hangs midst the spacious All,

1.708

The *Solid* Centre of the *Liquid* Ball,

1.709

Therefore as far as e'er our Eyes can pass

1.710

Upward, or downward, could they pierce the Mass,

1.711

Till bounding Sky the wearied Sight confines,

1.712

Is equal to the distance of *two* Signs.

1.713

And six such spaces the vast Round complete

1.714

Where All the Signs their constant Whirls repeat,

1.715

And each lies distant in an equal Seat.

1.716

Nor must you wonder such Varieties

1.717

Of *different Fates* from the same Stars should rise.

1.718

Since great their Empire, and unlike their force,

1.719

Their Seats so large and so immense their Course.

#### XIV.

1.720

Thus far advanc't my towring Muse must rise,

1.721

And sing the *Circles* that confine the Skies,

1.722

Describe the track, and mark the shining Way,

1.723

Where *Planets* Err, and *Phoebus* bears the Day.

1.724

One towards the North sustains the *Shining Bear*

#### The Northern Polar Circle.

1.725

And lies divided from the *Polar* Star;

1.726

Exactly <sup>88</sup> *six divisions* of the Sphere.

## The Tropical Circle of Cancer, or Summer Solstice.

1.727

Another drawn through *Cancer's* Claws confines,

1.728

The utmost Limits of the *Fatal* Signs;

1.729

There when the *Sun* ascends his greatest height

1.730

In largest Rounds He whirls the lazy Night.

1.731

Pleas'd with his Station there He seems to stay,

1.732

And neither lengthens nor contracts the Day.

1.733

The *Summer's Tropick* call'd.—

1.734

It lies the fiery *Sun's remotest* Bound,

1.735

Just *five Divisions* from the other Round.

## The Equinoctial.

1.736

A third twines round, and in the midst divides

1.737

The Sphere, and see the *Pole* on both its sides.

1.738

And there when *Phoebus* drives, He spreads his Light,

1.739

On all *alike*, and equals Day and Night.

1.740

For in the midst, He doth the Skies divide,

1.741

And chears the *Spring*, and warms the *Autumn*'s Pride.

1.742

And this large Circle drawn from *Cancer*'s Flame,

1.743

Just four Divisions parts the Starry Frame.

1.744

Another Southward drawn exactly sets

## The Tropick of Capricorn.

1.745

The Utmost Limits to the *Sun*'s retreats;

1.746

When hoary *Winter* calls his Beams away,

1.747

Obliquely warms us with a feeble Ray,

1.748

And whirls in *narrow Rounds* the freezing Day.

1.749

To Us his Journey's short, but where He stands

1.750

With Rays direct, He burns the barren Sands.

1.751

To wisht-for Night he scarce resigns the Day,

1.752

But in vast Heats extends his hated Sway.

1.753

The last drawn round the *Southern* point confines

## The Southern Polar Circle.

1.754

Those *Bears*, and lies the Utmost of the Lines.

1.755

Wise *Nature* constant in her Work is found:

1.756

As five Divisions part the *Northern* Bound;

1.757

From the *North* point, This *Southern Round* appears

1.758

Just *five Divisions* distant from its *Bears*.

1.759

Thus Heaven's divided, and from Pole to Pole

1.760

Four *Quadrants* are the Measure of the Whole.

1.761

The Circles *five*, by these are justly shown,

1.762

The *Frigid*, *Temperate* and the *Torrid* Zone.

1.763

All these move *Parallel*, they set, they rise,

1.764

At equal Distance moving with the Skies;

1.765

Turn'd with the Orbs the common Whirl repeat,

1.766

Are fixt, nor vary their *allotted* Seat.

## The Colure.

1.767

*From Pole all round to Pole two Lines exprest,*

1.768

*Adversely drawn, which intersect the rest*

1.769

*And one another; They surround the Whole,*

1.770

*And crossing make right Angles at each Pole:*

1.771

*These into four just parts, by Signs, the Sphere*

1.772

*Divide, and mark the Seasons of the Year.*

## The Aequinoctial Colure.

1.773

*One drawn from Heaven's high top descends from far,*

1.774

*And cuts the Serpent's Tail, and the dry Bear:*

1.775

*The Equinoctial Scales, the Snake's Extremes,*

1.776

*And next the Southern Centaur's middle Beams;*

1.777

*Then thwarts the Adverse Pole, and next divides*

1.778

*The mighty Whale, and parts its scaly sides;*

1.779

*Bright Aries point, and splendid Trigon past,*

1.780

*The fair Andromeda below the Waste,*

1.781

*And next her Mother's Head it cuts, and then*

1.782

The *Pole*, and closeth in it self agen.

## The Solsticial Colure.

1.783

Cross this, and from the *Pole* doth first appear

1.784

The Other, through the *forefeet* of the Bear,

1.785

And through its *Neck*; (which when the Sun retires

1.786

First shines, and spreads black Night with feeble Fires)

1.787

Then parts the *Twins* and *Crab*, the *Dog* divides,

1.788

And *Argo's* keel that broke the frothy tides.

1.789

And then the *Pole* and other *Circle* crost

1.790

To *Caper* turns contracted in his Frost:

1.791

The *Eagle* cuts, and the inverted Lyre,

1.792

Black *Dracos* folds—

1.793

The *hinder Paws o'th' Bear*, and near the Pole

1.794

It's *Tail*, and closing there compleats the Whole.

1.795

These *Rounds immovable*, their site the same,

1.796

Here Seasons fix, nor vary in the frame.

## The Meridian.

1.797

Two more are *movable*: one from the *Bear*

1.798

Describ'd surrounds the *middle* of the Sphere,

1.799

Divides the Day, and marks exactly *Noon*

1.800

Betwixt the rising and the setting Sun:

1.801

The *Signs* it changes as we move below,

1.802

Run *East* or *West*, it varies as You go;

1.803

For 'tis that Line, which way soe'er we tread,

1.804

That cuts the Heaven exactly o'er our head,

1.805

And marks the *Vertex*; which doth plainly prove

1.806

That it must change as often as we move.

1.807

Not one *Meridian* can the World suffice,

1.808

It passes through each portion of the Skies;

1.809

Thus when the Sun is dawning o'er the East

1.810

'Tis their *sixth* hour, and sets their *sixth* at West:



1.811

Though those two hours we count our days extremes,

1.812

Which feebly warm us with their distant Beams.

## The Horizon.

1.813

To find the *other Line* cast round thine Eyes,

1.814

And where the Earth's high surface joyns the Skies,

1.815

Where Stars first set, and first begin to shine,

1.816

There draw the fancy'd Image of this *Line*:

1.817

Which way soe'er you move 'twill still be new,

1.818

Another Circle opening to the view;

1.819

For now this half, and now that half of Sky

1.820

It shews, its Bounds still varying with the Eye.

1.821

This *Round's* Terrestrial, for it bounds contains

1.822

That Globe, and cut the middle with a *Plain*;

1.823

'Tis call'd the *Horizon*, the *Round's* design,

1.824

(For 'tis to bound) gives title to the Line.

## The Zodiack.

1.825

Two more Oblique, and which in adverse Lines

1.826

Surround the Globe, Observe: One bears the Signs

1.827

Where *Phoebus* drives and guides his fiery Horse

1.828

And varying *Luna* follows in her Course.

1.829

Where *Planets* err as Nature leads the Dance,

1.830

Keep various measures undisturb'd by Chance;

1.831

Its highest Arch with *Cancer's* beams do glow,

1.832

Whilst *Caper* lies, and freezes in the low:

1.833

Twice it divides the *Equinoctial* line,

1.834

Where fleecy *Aries*, and where *Libra* shine.

1.835

Three Lines compose it, and th' *Ecliptick's* found

1.836

Ith' midst; and all decline into a *Round*.

1.837

Nor is it hid, nor is it hard to find,

1.838

Like others open onely to the Mind;

1.839

For like a *Belt* with studs of Stars the Skies

1.840

It girds and graces; and invites the Eyes:

1.841

To twelve Degrees its Breadth, to thrice sixscore

1.842

Its Length extends, and comprehends no more:

1.843

Within these bounds the wandring *Planets* rove,

1.844

Make *Seasons* here, and settle *Fate* above.

1.845

The other *Round* from *Bears* oppos'd begun

## XV. The Milky way.

1.846

Runs adverse to the Chariot of the Sun,

1.847

It leaves the *Pole*, and from its *Round* retires,

1.848

And cuts inverted *Casiopeia's* Fires:

1.849

Thence still descending and obliquely drawn

1.850

It passes through the Body of the *Swan*,

1.851

Then *Cancer's* fires, the headlong *Bird of Jove*,

1.852

The *Line* and *Zodiack* where the Planets rove:

1.853

And thence in various windings turns to meet

1.854

The other *Centaur*, and entwines his feet:

1.855

And thence to mount through *Argo's* Sails begins,

1.856

The *Line*, and lowest portion of the *Twins*;

1.857

Then joyns the *Driver*, and from thence ascends

1.858

O'er *Perseus*, and to *Cassiopeia* tends,

1.859

There 'tis receiv'd in her inverted *Chair*,

1.860

In *her* the Round begins, and ends in *Her*.

1.861

Twice cuts the *Tropicks*, *Zodiack* and the *Line*,

1.862

And is as often cut by those agen.

1.863

Nor need we with a prying Eye survey

1.864

The distant Skies to find the *Milky way*,

1.865

It must be seen by *All*, for every night

1.866

It forcibly intrudes upon our sight,

1.867

And will be mark'd for shining streaks adorn

1.868

The Skies as opening to let forth the Morn.

1.869

And as a beaten Path that spreads between

1.870

A troden Meadow, and divides the Green.

1.871

Or as when Seas are plow'd behind the Ship,

1.872

Foam curls on the green surface of the Deep.

1.873

In Heaven's dark surface such this *Circle* lies,

1.874

And parts with various Light the Azure Skies.

1.875

Or as when *Iris* draws her radiant Bow

1.876

Such seems this Circle to the World below.

1.877

It all surpriseth, our inquiring sight

1.878

It upward draws, when through the Shades of Night

1.879

It spreads its Rays, and darts amazing Light.

1.880

Fond Men the sacred Causes strive to find,

1.881

And vainly measure with a feeble Mind:

1.882

And yet they strive, they madly whirl about

1.883

Through various Causes, still condemn'd to Doubt.

## Various Opinions about the Milky way.

1.884

Whether the Skies <sup>89</sup> grown old, here shrink their Frame,

1.885

And through the Chinks admit an upper Flame.

1.886

Or whether here the Heavens two Halves are joyn'd

1.887

But odly clos'd, still leave a Seam behind:

1.888

Or here the parts in <sup>90</sup> Wedges closely prest,

1.889

To fix the Frame, are thicker than the Rest,

1.890

Like Clouds condens'd appear, and bound the Sight,

1.891

The Azure being thickned into *White*.

1.892

Or whether that old <sup>91</sup> Tale deserves our Faith,

1.893

Which boldly says, that this was once the Path

1.894

Where *Phoebus* drove; and that in length of Years

1.895

The heated track took Fire and burnt the Stars.

1.896

The Colour chang'd, the Ashes strew'd the Way,

1.897

And still preserve the marks of the Decay:

1.898

Besides, Fame tells, by Age Fame reverend grown,

1.899

That *Phoebus* gave his Chariot to his Son,

1.900

And whilst the Youngster from the Path declines

1.901

Admiring the strange Beauty of the Signs;

1.902

Proud of his Charge, He drove the fiery Horse,

1.903

And would outdoe his Father in his Course.

1.904

The North grew warm, and the unusual Fire

1.905

Dissolv'd its Snow, and made the Bears retire;

1.906

Nor was the Earth secure, each Countrey mourn'd

1.907

The *Common* Fate, and in its City's burn'd.

1.908

Then from the scatter'd Chariot Lightning came,

1.909

And the whole Skies were one continued Flame.

1.910

The World took Fire, and in new kindled Stars

1.911

The bright remembrance of its *Fate* it bears.

1.912

Thus Fame, nor must the softer Fable die

1.913

That *Juno's* Breast o'erflowing stain'd the Skie,

1.914

And made that Milky way, which justly draws

1.915

Its Name, *the Milky Circle* from its Cause.

1.916

Or is the spacious Bend serenely bright

1.917

From little Stars, which there their Beams unite,

1.918

And make one solid and continued Light?

1.919

Or Souls which loos'd from the ignoble Chain

1.920

Of Clay, and sent to their own Heaven again,

1.921

Purg'd from all dross by Vertue, nobly rise

1.922

In *Aether* wanton, and enjoy the Skies.

1.923

Great *Atreus* Sons, *Tydidēs* fixt above,

1.924

And stout *Achilles* equal to our *Jove*;

1.925

With three-ag'd *Nestor*: He that bravely stood

1.926

The Dangers of the Land and of the Fload.

1.927

*Vlysses*, Nature's Conquerour, enjoy

1.928

The Skies deserv'd; with all the *Chiefs* at *Troy*.

1.929

*Jove*'s Son *Sarpedon*, He that *Lycia* sway'd:

1.930

The black *Merione*, the Martial Maid,

1.931

Had Fate stood Neuter, *Troy*'s securest Aid.



1.932

With all those Kings that *Greece* or *Asia* bore,

1.933

Or *Pella* <sup>92</sup> greatest in her Conquerour.

1.934

Next these the grave and prudent *Heroes* rise,

1.935

Whose solid Riches lay in being Wise;

1.936

There good *Zealeucus*, stout *Lycurgus* shine,

1.937

*Solon* the just, and *Plato* the Divine.

1.938

His *Master* next, whose Bloud unjustly spilt

1.939

On *Athens* still reflects a real Guilt.

1.940

Next *Persia*'s Scourge who strew'd the joyfull Floud

1.941

With *Xerxes* fleet, and check'd the growing God:

1.942

Who broke his Force, when *Neptune* bore the chain,

1.943

And prov'd his juster Title o'er the Main.

1.944

Here *Romans* joyn'd, the greatest Croud, reside,

1.945

The Kings, e'er *Tarquin* stain'd the Throne with Pride.

1.946

The *Horaces* our Army in our Wars,

1.947

The Town which he defended, *Cocles* bears;

1.948

Next *Clelia* rides, the brightest Maid in Fame,

1.949

And *Scevola* more glorious by his Maim.

1.950

Then *He* on whom the *Helping Crow* bestow'd

1.951

A Name, and in the Figure brought a God.

1.952

*Camillus* who the Stars deserv'd to gain

1.953

For saving *Jove*, when Thunder roar'd in vain;

1.954

Patient of wrongs, and whilst alive ador'd,

1.955

The *Founder* of that *Rome* that He restor'd.

1.956

Next *Brutus* sits, and next, unlearn'd in Fear,

1.957

The fierce Revenger of the *Pyrrick* War,

1.958

*Papyrius* shines; The *Decii*, o'er their Foes

1.959

In Triumphs *Equal*, *Rivals* in their Vows.

1.960

*Fabritius*, *Curius*, for their Country bold,

1.961

Alike in Courage, and too great for Gold.

1.962

*Marcellus*, Sword of *Rome*, the third that bore

1.963

A Royal spoyl, and *Cossus* grac'd before:

1.964

Next *Fabius* sits, who left the Common way

1.965

To Victory, and Conquer'd by Delay.

1.966

*Livy* and *Nero* glorious for the fall

1.967

Of haughty *Carthage* in her *Asdrubal*.

1.968

The *Scipio*'s Africks Fate both joyn'd in One,

1.969

The latter ending what the first begun.

1.970

*Pompey* by Thrice the Conquer'd World ador'd,

1.971

Before God *Caesar* stoopt to be our Lord:

1.972

The fam'd *Metelli*; *Tully*, *Rome*'s defence,

1.973

Deserving Heaven for pretious Eloquence.

1.974

The *Claudian* Race, and the *Emilian* Line

1.975

With Fortune's Conquerour great *Cato* shine.

1.976

But *Venus Julian* race, who drew their rise

1.977

From Heaven return again and fill the Skies;

1.978

Where great *Augustus*, with his partner *Jove*

1.979

Presides, and views his Father fixt above.

1.980

*Quirinus* joyns him, and is pleas'd to see

1.981

The *Caesars* grow *Rome's Founders* more than *He*.

1.982

The highest Arch contains the greater Gods,

1.983

The Godlike *Heroes* fill these next Abodes;

1.984

Those generous Souls, that ran an equal race

1.985

In Vertues Paths, and claim a second place.

1.986

Thus far my *Muse* hath with success been crown'd,

1.987

Or sound no stops, or vanquisht those she found.

1.988

And thus encourag'd now she boldly dares

1.989

To sing the Fatal compacts of the Stars.

1.990

But stop thy flight, sing all the Fires that shine

1.991

And influence too, and finish thy design.

## XVI. The Planets.

1.992

Seven Fires refuse the Worlds Diurnal force,

1.993

From *West* to *East* they roll their proper Course.

1.994

Cold *Saturn*, *Jove*, fierce *Mars*, the fiery *Sun*,

1.995

With *Mercury* 'twixt *Venus* and the *Moon*.

1.996

Some swift some slow, they measure different *Years*,

1.997

And make the wondrous Musick of the *Spheres*.

## XVII. Meteors.

1.998

But these are *constant*, these adorn the *Night*,

1.999

Whilst Others seldom shine and then affright.

1.1000

For few have view'd a *Comet*'s dreadful train,

1.1001

Which Wars foretells, and never shines in vain,

1.1002

Soon catch on *Fire*, and die as soon again.

1.1003

The Reason's this; when days serenely fair

1.1004

Have chas'd the *Clouds*, and cleans'd the *lower Air*,

1.1005

And *mists* breath'd out from *Earth* rise through the *Sky*,

1.1006

The *moister* parts are conquer'd by the *Dry*.

1.1007

And *Fire* entic'd by the Convenient *Mass*

1.1008

Descends, and lights it with a *sudden blaze*:

1.1009

But since the Body's thin, the Parts are *rare*

1.1010

And *Mists*, like *smoak*, lie scattered through the Air;

1.1011

As soon as e'er begun, the feeble fire

1.1012

Must waste, and with the blazing Mass expire.

1.1013

For did they *long* exist, their constant Light

1.1014

Would seem to bring new Day upon the Night;

1.1015

Whole Nature's Course would change, and from the Deep

1.1016

The *Sun* would rise, and find the *World* a-sleep.

### Several sorts of Meteors.

1.1017

But since in various Forms the *Mists* must rise,

1.1018

And shine in the same Figures o'er the Skies,

1.1019

These sudden Flames thus born by Chance at Night,

1.1020

Must shew as much variety of Light.

### Stella Crinita.

1.1021

Some *equally diffus'd*, like flaming Hair,

1.1022

Draw fiery Tresses through the Liquid Air.

1.1023

And streight the Mass that fiery Locks appear'd

## Barbara▪

1.1024

Grows short, and is contracted to a *Beard*.

1.1025

Whilst some in *even* and *continu'd* streams,

## Trabs.

1.1026

Are round like *Pillars*, or are squar'd like Beams.

## Pithetes.

1.1027

And some with *Belly'd* Flames large *Tuns* present,

1.1028

Alike in shape, and equal in extent.

## Bostruchias.

1.1029

Some ty'd in *knots* like hairy Curls are spread,

1.1030

A narrow Covering o'er the *Comets* Head.

## Lampadias.

1.1031

The *Meteor Lamp* in parted Flames appears,

1.1032

The *Sheaf* uneven shakes her bended Ears.

## Stipulae ardentēs.

1.1033

But still when wandring Stars adorn the Night,

## Stella cadens.

1.1034

The *falling Meteors* draw long trains of Light.

1.1035

Like Arrows shot from the Celestial Bow,

## Acontiae.

1.1036

They cut the Air, and strike our Eyes below:

1.1037

*Fire* lies in every thing, in Clouds it forms

1.1038

The frightfull Thunder, and descends in storms.

1.1039

It passes through the Earth, in *Aetna* raves,

1.1040

And imitates *Heaven's Thunder* in its Caves.

1.1041

In hollow vales it boyls the rising Flouds,

1.1042

In Flints 'tis found, and lodges in the Woods,

1.1043



Or tost by storms, the Trees in *Flames* expire,

1.1044

So warm are *Nature's* parts, so fill'd with Fire.

1.1045

Therefore when *Mists*, which wandring *Flames* retain,

1.1046

Pursue and catch, and leave as soon again,

1.1047

Blaze o'er the Skies when through the parted Frame

1.1048

The *Meteors* break in one continued Flame,

1.1049

Or when midst Rain, or through a Watry Cloud

1.1050

Quick Lightning flies, or Thunder roars aloud,

1.1051

Wonder no more; for o'er the spacious All

1.1052

Is fire diffus'd, and must consume the Ball.

1.1053

When eating Time shall waste confining Clay,

1.1054

And fret the feeble Body to decay.

1.1055

Thus far through paths untrod my Muse has gone,

1.1056

Found different Causes, but not fixt on One,

1.1057

Such various Flowers in *Nature's* field invite

1.1058

Her gathering Hand, and tempt her greedy sight;

1.1059

That drawn by many she scarce one enjoys,

1.1060

Lost in the great Variety of Choice.

1.1061

For *Earthy Mists* involving Seeds of Flame

### Different Opinions about Meteors.

1.1062

May rise on high, and fiery *Comets* frame;

1.1063

Or little Stars by Nature joyn'd in One

1.1064

May shine, though undiscover'd when alone.

1.1065

Or they are *constant* Stars, whose *Natural* Course

1.1066

The Sun o'er powers by his prevailing Force,

1.1067

Draws from their Orbs, and shadows by his Light,

1.1068

Then frees again, and opens to our sight.

1.1069

Thus *Mercury*, thus *Venus* disappears,

1.1070

Then shines again, and leads the *Evening* Stars.

1.1071

Or God in pity to our Mortal state

## Comets presage.

1.1072

Hangs out these Lights to shew approaching Fate;

1.1073

They never idly blaze, but still presage

1.1074

Some *coming* Plague on the unhappy Age.

1.1075

No Crop rewards the cheated Farmer's toil,

1.1076

He mourns, and curses the ungratefull Soil;

1.1077

The meagre Ox to the *successless* Plow

1.1078

He yokes, and scarce dares make another Vow.

1.1079

Or wasting Plagues their deadly Poisons spread,

1.1080

Encreasing the large Empire of the Dead.

1.1081

Men die by Numbers, and by heaps they fall,

1.1082

And mighty Cities make one Funeral.

1.1083

On groaning Piles whole huddled Nations burn,

1.1084

And Towns lie blended in one *Common* Urn.

## The Plague of Athens.

1.1085

Such Plagues *Achaia* felt, the fierce Disease

1.1086

Laid *Athens* waste, and spoil'd the Town in Peace.

1.1087

It bore the helpless Nation to the Grave,

1.1088

No Physick could assist, no Vows could save;

1.1089

Heaps fell on Heaps, and whilst they gasp'd for Breath,

1.1090

Heaps fell on those, and finisht half their Death.

1.1091

None nurst the Sick, the nearest Kinsmen fled;

1.1092

None stay'd to bury, or to mourn the Dead.

1.1093

The *Fires* grown weary dy'd beneath their Spoils,

1.1094

And heapt-up Limbs supply'd the place of *Piles*.

1.1095

Vast Emptiness and Desolation reign'd,

1.1096

And to so great a *People* scarce one *Heir* remain'd.

1.1097

Such are the Plagues that blazing Stars proclaim,

1.1098

They light to *Funerals* their unlucky Flame.

1.1099

They shew not onely private Plagues to come,

1.1100

But threaten Mortals with the Day of Doom.

1.1101

When Piles *Eternal* Heaven and Earth shall burn,

1.1102

And sickly Nature fall into her Urn.

## Wars.

1.1103

They sudden Tumults, and *strange* Arms declare,

1.1104

And when close Treach'ry shall start up to War.

1.1105

When faithless *Germans* did of late rebell,

1.1106

And tempt their Fate, when Generous *Varus* fell,

1.1107

And three brave *Legions* bloud the Plains did drown,

1.1108

O'er all the Skies the threatning *Comets* shone.

1.1109

E'en Nature seem'd at War, and Fire was hurld

1.1110

At Fire, and Ruin threatned to the World.

1.1111

These things are strange, but why should these surprise,

1.1112

The Fault is Ours, since we with heedless Eyes

1.1113

View Heaven, and want the Faith to trust the Skies.

1.1114

They Civil-Wars foretell, and Brothers rage,

1.1115

The Curse and the disgraces of an Age.

1.1116

Never more *Comets* drew their dreadfull Hair

1.1117

Than when *Philippi* saw the World at War.

1.1118

Scarce had the Plains drunk up the former Bloud,

1.1119

On scatter'd Bones and Limbs the *Romans* stood

1.1120

And fought again; disdaining meaner Foes,

1.1121

(A wretched Conquest where the Victors lose)

1.1122

Our *Empire's* power did its own self oppose;

1.1123

And great *Augustus* o'er the slaughter'd Heaps

1.1124

Pursu'd bright Victory in his *Father's* steps.

1.1125

Nor did the Rage end here, the *Action* fight,

1.1126

That bloody dowry of a wanton Night,

1.1127

Remain'd, and rais'd by *Cleopatra's* Charms

1.1128

The headlong Nations ran again to Arms.

1.1129

The Chance for the whole World was thrown again,

1.1130

And the *Skies Ruler* sought upon the Main,

1.1131

Then War obey'd a *Woman*, *Timbrels* strove

1.1132

With Thunder, Isis with the Roman Jove.

1.1133

Nor stopt it here, but the *degenerate* Son

1.1134

Stain'd all the Glory that his *Father* won.

1.1135

The Seas great *Pompey* freed He seiz'd again,

1.1136

His Pirates lay like Tempests on the Main.

1.1137

The Relicks of the Wars, the Impious Slaves

1.1138

Were arm'd for fight, and ravag'd o'er the Waves.

1.1139

Till the torn fleet di'd all the Seas with Bloud,

1.1140

And *Asia*'s Chains reveng'd the *injur'd* Floud.

1.1141

Let this, O Fates! suffice; Let *Discord* cease,

1.1142

And raging Tumults be confin'd by Peace.

1.1143

Let *Caesar* triumph, let the World obey,

1.1144

And long let *Rome* be happy in his Sway.

1.1145

Long have him here, and when she shall bestow

1.1146

A God on Heaven enjoy his Aid below.

## *The End of the First Book.*

### Book II

*Manilius takes care frequently to tell his Reader that he is the first that ever ventur'd on an Astrological Poem; He seems mightily pleas'd with his undertaking, hugs it as his First-born, and the Son of his strength, and is very troublesome in acquainting us with the pains which he suffered at its Birth; and then reckons up the Beauties of the Child, and what great hopes he conceives of it: If ever he deserv'd Scaliger's Character, that he knew not when to leave off, it must be acknowledged that this is the Case in which it may be chiefly apply'd: We need look no farther than the beginning of this Book to be satisfied in this matter; He spends about sixty Verses in reckoning up the chief Subjects of Homer, Hesiod, Theocritus and others; all which being laid aside, he declares his design to be wholly new; and then begins, 1. To prove the World to be one Animal: 2. The Influence of the Heavens: 3. He Describes the several species of the Signs. 4. The various configurations or aspects of the Signs; and tells us what are Trines, what Quadrates or Squares; what Hexagons or Sextiles; and what are Right and Left in each of these. 5. What Signs are said to be conjoyn'd, what not, and what oppos'd; to what Sign each part of Man's body is appropriate; what Signs are said to hear, what to see one another; what are friendly, and what not. 6. The friendly and unfriendly aspects of the Signs, and the various aspects of the Planets in the Signs. 7. The Twelfths or Dodecatemoria of the Signs and Planets. 8. The twelve Celestial Houses, and assigns to each its proper Planet.*

2.1

IN lasting Verse the mighty Homer sings

Homer.

2.2

The Trojan Wars, the King of fifty Kings,

2.3



Stout *Hector's* brand, the bloody dreadful Field,

2.4

And *Troy* secure behind the *Hero's* Shield:

2.5

*Vlysses* wandrings, and his travelling years,

2.6

In time and glory equal to his Wars:

2.7

How twice with conquering Fleets he plough'd the Main,

2.8

Whilst *Scylla* roar'd, and *Neptune* rag'd in vain.

2.9

And how at Home he fixt his tottering Throne,

2.10

Redeem'd his *honour*, and secur'd his Son:

2.11

Usurping *Woers* felt his thundring Sword,

2.12

And willing Nations knew their Native Lord.

2.13

His Subjects these, and from his boundless Spring

2.14

THE *mighty Bard* in lasting Numbers sings

Homer.

2.15

*Ilium's* long Wars, the King of fifty Kings;

2.16

Brave *Hector's* Brand, the bloody dreadful Field,

2.17

And *Troy* secure behind the *Hero's* Shield.

2.18

He sings *Vlysses*, and his wandring Years

2.19

In Time and Glory equal to his Wars:

2.20

He sings how twice He conquering plough'd the Main

2.21

Whilst *Scylla* roar'd, and *Neptune* rag'd in vain,

2.22

And how at Home He fixt his tottering Throne,

2.23

Redeem'd his Honour, and secur'd his *Son*:

2.24

Usurping *Woers* felt his thundering Sword,

2.25

And willing Nations knew their Native Lord.

2.26

His Subjects these, from whose <sup>93</sup> abundant Spring

2.27

Succeeding *Poets* draw the Songs they sing;

2.28

From *Him* they take, from *Him* adorn their Themes,

2.29

And into little Channels cut his Streams, rich in his store—

Hesiod.

2.30

Next *Hesiod* sings the Gods Immortal Race,

2.31

He sings how *Chaos* bore the *Earthy* Mass;

2.32

How Light from Darkness struck did Beams display,

2.33

And Infant-Stars first stagger'd in their way:

2.34

How Name <sup>94</sup> of Brother vail'd an Husband's Love,

2.35

And *Juno* bore unaided by her *Jove*:

2.36

How twice-born *Bacchus* burst the Thunderer's Thigh,

2.37

And all the Gods that wander through the Sky.

2.38

Hence *He* to Fields descends, manures the Soil,

2.39

Instructs the Plowman, and rewards his Toil:

2.40

He sings how *Corn* in Plains, how *Vines* in Hills

2.41

Delight, how Both with vast Encrease the *Olive* fills:

2.42

How Foreign Graffs th'Adulterous Stock receives,

2.43

Bears stranger Fruit, and wonders at her Leaves:

2.44

An useful Work, when Peace and Plenty reign,

2.45

And Art joyns Nature to improve the Plain.

## Eratosthenes.

2.46

The *Constellation*'s Shapes <sup>95</sup> some make their Themes,

2.47

Sing whence they came, and how adorn'd with Beams,

2.48

*Andromeda* enjoys kind *Perseu's* Aid,

2.49

The *Sire* unbinds, the *Mother* mourns the Maid:

2.50

*Callisto* ravisht now the Pole surveys,

2.51

Nor grieves to change her Honor for her Rays:

2.52

The *Little Bear* that rock'd the mighty *Jove*,

2.53

The *Swan* whose borrow'd Shape conceal'd his Love

2.54

Are grac'd with Light, the Nursing *Goat's* repaid

2.55

With Heaven, and Duty rais'd the Pious *Maid*;

2.56

The *Lion* for the Honors of his *Skin*,

2.57

The squeezing *Crab*, and stinging *Scorpion* shine

2.58

For aiding Heaven, when *Giants* dar'd to brave,

2.59

The threatned Stars; and *Thunder* fail'd to save:

2.60

And now the *Fish* ignoble Fates escape

2.61

Since *Venus* ow'd her Safety to their Shape:

2.62

The *Ram* having pass'd the *Sea*, serenely shines,

2.63

And leads the Year, the Prince of all the Signs.

2.64

Thus whilst by Fables They the Stars advance,

2.65

They vainly make the *Heaven* one large Romance;

2.66

Earth fills the Sky, the Mass ignobly reigns,

2.67

And Heaven's upheld by that which it sustains:

2.68

Fables absurd, which Nature's Laws reject,

2.69

To make the *Cause* depend on the *Effect*.

2.70

The sweet *Theocritus* with softest Strains

## Theocritus.

2.71

Makes piping *Pan* delight *Sicilian* Swains;

2.72

Thro' his smooth Reed no Rustick Numbers move,

2.73

But all is Tenderness, and all is Love;

2.74

As if the *Muses* sate in every Vale,

2.75

Inspir'd the Song, and told the melting Tale.

## Macer.

2.76

Some *Birds*, some Wars of *Beasts*, or *Serpents* write,

2.77

*Snakes* in their Poems hiss, and *Lions* sight:

## Nicander.

2.78

Some Fate in *Herbs* describe, some Sovereign *Roots*,

2.79

Or see gay Health spring up in *saving* Fruits:

## Some old Poet who describ'd Hell.

2.80

One breaks thro' Nature's stubborn Bars, invades

2.81

The rest, and sacred Silence of the *Shades*,

2.82

Turns up the inside of the World, and Night,

2.83

And brings Eternal Darkness into Light.

2.84

Of every Subject now the *Muses* sing,

2.85

And Floods confus'd come tumbling from their Spring,

2.86

Yet dry as fast, nor can *Parnassian* Streams

2.87

Suffice the Throngs that crowd to *common* Themes.

2.88

I seek new Springs which roul refreshing Waves

2.89

Thro' Plains untrod, and Purls in hidden Caves,

2.90

Kept pure for *Me*, which Birds did ne'er profane,

2.91

And thirsty *Phoebus* oft hath sought in vain:

2.92

My Verse shall be my *Own*, not *stoln*, but *wrought*;

2.93

*Mine*, not the Labor of *Another's* Thought.

2.94

My Vessel's trimm'd, tho' never launch'd before,

2.95

I spread my Sails, and boldly leave the Shore:

2.96

I'll sing how *God* the World's Almighty Mind

## 1. The World an Animal, and God the Soul of it.

2.97

Thro' *All* infus'd, and to that *All* confin'd,

2.98

Directs the Parts, and with an equal Hand

2.99

Supports the *whole*, enjoying his Command:

2.100

How All agree, and how the Parts have made

2.101

Strict Leagues, subsisting by each others Aid;

2.102

How All by Reason move, because one soul

2.103

Lives in the Parts, diffusing thro' the whole.

2.104

For did not all the Friendly Parts conspire

2.105

To make one Whole, and keep the Frame intire;

2.106

And did not Reason guide, and Sense controul

2.107

The vast stupendous Machine of the whole,

2.108

*Earth* would not keep its place, the *Skies* would fall,

2.109

And universal Stiffness deaden All;

2.110

*Stars* would not wheel their Round, nor *Day*, nor *Night*,

2.111

Their Course perform, be put, and put to flight:

2.112

*Rains* would not feed the Fields, and *Earth* deny

2.113

Mists to the *Clouds*, and Vapors to the *Sky*;

2.114

*Seas* would not fill the *Springs*, nor *Springs* return

2.115

Their grateful Tribute from their flowing Urn:

2.116

Nor would the *All*, unless contriv'd by Art,

2.117

So justly be proportion'd in each part,

2.118

That neither *Seas*, nor *Skies*, nor *Stars* exceed



2.119

Our Wants, nor are too scanty for our Need:

2.120

Thus stands the Frame, and the *Almighty* Soul

2.121

Thro' all diffus'd so turns, and guides the whole,

2.122

That nothing from its settled Station swerves,

2.123

And *Motion* alters not the Frame, but still preserves.

## 2. The Influence of the Heavens.

2.124

This *God* or Reason, which the Orbs doth move,

2.125

Makes Things below depend on *Signs* above;

2.126

Tho' far remov'd, tho' hid in Shades of Night,

2.127

And scarce to be descry'd by their own Light;

2.128

Yet Nations own, and Men their Influence feel;

2.129

They rule the Publick, and the Private Will:

2.130

The Proofs are plain. Thus from a different Star

2.131

We find a fruitful, or a barren Year;

2.132

Now Grains encrease, and now refuse to grow;

2.133

Now quickly ripen, now their growth is slow:

2.134

The *Moon* commands the Seas, she drives the Main

2.135

To pass the Shores, then drives it back again:

2.136

And this Sedition chiefly swells the Streams,

2.137

When *opposite* she views her Brother's Beams;

2.138

Or when she neer in close *Conjunction* rides

2.139

She rears the Flood, and swells the flowing Tides;

2.140

Or when attending on his yearly Race

2.141

The *Equinoctial* sees her borrow'd Face.

2.142

Her Power sinks deep, it searches all the Main,

2.143

*Testaceous* <sup>96</sup> Fish, as she her Light regains,

2.144

Increase, and still diminish in her Wain:

2.145

For as the Moon in deepest Darkness mourns,

2.146

Then Rays receives, and points her borrow'd Horns,

2.147

Then turns her Face, and with a Smile invites

2.148

The full Effusions of her Brother's Lights;

2.149

They to her Changes due proportion keep,

2.150

And shew her various *Phases* in the Deep.

2.151

So *Brutes*, whom Nature did in sport create,

2.152

Ignorant both of themselves, and of their Fate,

2.153

A secret Instinct still erects their Eyes

2.154

To Parent Heaven, and seems to make them wise:

2.155

One at the New Moons <sup>97</sup> rise to distant Shores

2.156

Retires, his Body sprinkles, and adores:

2.157

Some see Storms gathering, or Serenes foretel,

2.158

And scarce our *Reason* guides us half so well.

2.159

Then who can doubt that *Man*, the glorious Pride

2.160

Of All, is nearer to the Skies ally'd?

2.161

Nature in *Man* capacious Souls hath wrought,

2.162

And given them *Voice* expressive of their Thought;

2.163

In *Man* the God descends, and joys to find

2.164

The narrow Image of his greater Mind.

2.165

But why should all the other Arts be shown,

2.166

Too various for Productions of our own?

2.167

Why should I sing how different Tempers fall,

2.168

And Inequality is seen in All?

2.169

How many strive with equal Care to gain

2.170

The highest Prize, and yet how few obtain?

2.171

Which proves not *Matter* sways, but *Wisdom* rules,

2.172

And measures out the Bigness of our Souls:

2.173

Sure Fate stands fixt, nor can its Laws decay,

2.174

'Tis *Heaven's* to rule, and *Matter's* Essence to obey.

2.175

Who could know *Heaven*, unless that *Heaven* bestow'd

2.176

The Knowledge? or find *God*, but part of *God*?

2.177

How could the Space immense be e're confin'd

2.178

Within the compass of a narrow Mind?

2.179

How could the Skies, the Dances of the Stars,

2.180

Their Motions adverse, and eternal Wars,

2.181

Unless kind Nature in our Breasts had wrought

2.182

Proportion'd Souls, be subject to our Thought?

2.183

Were Heaven not interested to advance our Mind,

2.184

To know *Fate's* Laws, and teach the way to find,

2.185

Did not the Skies their kindred Souls improve,

2.186

Direct, and lead them thro' the Maze above;

2.187

Discover Nature, shew its secret Springs,

2.188

And tell the Sacred Intercourse of things,

2.189

How impious were our Search, how bold our Course,

2.190

Thus to assault, and take the *Skies* by force?

2.191

But to insist on tedious Proofs in vain,

2.192

The *Art* defends it self, the *Art* is plain;

2.193

For *Art* well grounded forces to believe,

2.194

It cannot be deceived, nor can deceive;

2.195

Events foretold fulfil the Prophesie,

2.196

What *Fortune* seconds, how can *Man* deny?

2.197

The Proofs are *Sacred*, and to doubt would be

2.198

Not Reason's Action, but Impiety.

2.199

Whilst on these Themes my Songs sublimely soar,

2.200

And take their Flight, where Wing ne're beat before;

2.201

Where none will meet, none guide my first Essay,

2.202

Partake my Labors, or direct my way,

2.203

I rise above the Crowd, I leave the Rude,

2.204

Nor are my Poems for the Multitude.

2.205

Heaven shall rejoyce, nor shall my Praise refuse,

2.206

But see the *Subject* equall'd by the *Muse*;

2.207

At least those *favour'd few*, whose Minds it shows,

2.208

The Sacred Maze, but ah! how few are Those!

2.209

Gold, Power, soft Luxury, vain Sports, and Ease

2.210

Possess the World, and have the luck to please:

2.211

Few study Heaven, unmindful of their state,

2.212

Vain stupid Man! but this it self is *Fate*.

2.213

My Subject this, and I must this pursue,

### 3.

2.214

This wondrous Theme, tho read, and prais'd by few;

2.215

And first the *Signs* in various Ranks dispose,

2.216

As *Nature* prompts, or their *Position* shows:

### 4. Male and Female Signs.

2.217

Six *Male* from *Aries*, from the Bull comprise

2.218

(See how he rises backward in the Skies)

2.219

Six *Female* Signs; but intermixt they fall

2.220

In order turn'd, <sup>98</sup> one Female, and one Male.

### 5. Humane and Brute Signs.

2.221

Some Signs bear <sup>99</sup> *Humane* Shapes, some Signs exprest

2.222

In single Figures bear the Form of *Beast*:

2.223

These Shapes direct us, and from those we know

2.224

How each inclines, what Tempers *Signs* bestow;

2.225

Their *Figures* will not let their Force escape,

2.226

Their Tempers are agreeing to their Shape.

## 6. Single and Double Signs.

2.227

These Signs are *Single*, now observe the <sup>100</sup> *Pairs*,

2.228

*Double* Shapes confess a *double* Force in Stars:

2.229

And each Companion still in each creates

2.230

A Change, and vast Variety in Fates:

2.231

Ambiguous Force from both exprest combines,

2.232

No *Single* Influence flows from *Double* Signs.

2.233

What Powers, or good or bad, one Part displays,

## 7. Pairs.

2.234

They may be alter'd by the others Rays:

2.235

Two of this kind in all the round of Sky

2.236

Appear, the *Pisces* and the naked *Gemini*:

2.237

These different Powers, tho both *Pair Signs*, possess,



2.238

Because their Parts Position disagrees;

2.239

For tender *Gemini* in strict embrace

2.240

Stand clos'd, and smiling in each others Face:

2.241

Whilst *Pisces* glide in two divided Streams,

2.242

Nor friendly seem, nor mix agreeing Beams.

2.243

Thus tho in *Both* two parts compose the Frame,

2.244

In Form alike, their Nature's not the same.

## 8. Double Signs of different Species.

2.245

These *Pairs* alone an equal Frame can boast,

2.246

No stranger parts are mixt, no parts are lost

2.247

From their due Form; whilst other *Pairs* are join'd

2.248

Of Natures disagreeing in their kind;

2.249

Such is the *Goat*, he twists a *Scaly* Train,

2.250

The *Centaur* such, half *Horse*, and half a *Man*.

2.251

Observe this well, in these Mysterious Arts

2.252

Whether the Signs are fram'd of *different* parts,

2.253

Or only *Pairs*, it much imports to know,

2.254

For hence comes great Variety below.

2.255

Midst double Signs the Pious *Maid* may claim

## 9. Double Signs by Place.

2.256

A place, not from the Figure of her Frame,

2.257

But 'cause in Her the *Summer*'s Heats decay,

2.258

And gentler *Autumn* spreads a weaker Ray.

2.259

But to be short; the same account defines

2.260

That *Double* still precede the *Tropick* Signs,

2.261

Because in those *two Seasons* mixt unite

2.262

Their Powers, and make them *double* by their Site.

2.263

Thus of the *Twins* the one the *Bull* requires,

2.264

The other feels the *Crab*'s unruly Fires;

2.265

One sees the fading Flowers, and Spring decline,

2.266

The other Boy leads on the hottest Sign:

2.267

But naked both, for both feel scorching Rays

2.268

As *Summer* comes, or as the *Spring* decays.

2.269

Thy Face, bright *Centaur*, *Autumn*'s Heats retain,

2.270

The softer Season suiting to the *Man*;

2.271

Whilst *Winter*'s shivering *Goat* afflicts the *Horse*

2.272

With Frost, and makes him an uneasy Course.

2.273

Thus thou midst *double* Signs mightst doubly claim

2.274

A place, both from thy Seat, and from thy Frame:

2.275

The like in *Pisces* is observ'd, one brings

2.276

The *Winter*'s end, the other leads the *Springs*;

2.277

In them *Spring*'s Dews, with *Winter*'s Rage combine,

2.278

Both moist, and both agreeing to the *Sign*:

2.279

How wise, and how obliging in her Grants

2.280

Is Nature's Bounty suited to our Wants!

2.281

With Moisture she the *Watry Signs* supplies,

2.282

And they enjoy their *Ocean* in the Skies.

2.283

But there is War, Sign disagrees with Sign,

2.284

And *Three* rise *adverse* to the other *Nine*:

## Signs of natural or unnatural Postures.

2.285

*Bull's* Back, *Twins* Feet, *Crab's* Shell do first appear,

2.286

And stop the progress of the rising year;

2.287

Whilst others in their *usual* Postures rise,

2.288

Nor shew unnatural Figures in the Skies:

2.289

Since then thro' *adverse* Signs the *Summer's* Sun

2.290

Makes way, no wonder that he drives so slowly on.

2.291

How vast this Knowledge, and how hard to gain,

2.292

The Subject still encreasing with the Pain;

2.293

Yet my swift Muse, like Larks on towring Wings

2.294

Mounts to the Skies, and as she mounts she sings:

2.295

She sees Signs various in her Aiery Flight

2.296

Some Signs of *Day*, and other Signs of *Night*:

## Day Signs and Night Signs.

2.297

Not so distinguish'd Cause those Signs maintain

2.298

Those times distinctly, and then choose to reign:

2.299

For then as Years roul round, the Circling Lights

2.300

Would all be of one kind *Day's* all, or all the *Night's*.

2.301

But 'cause wise Nature in her first Designs

2.302

By Laws Eternal fixt them to these Times:

2.303

The *Centaur*, *Lion*, and the golden *Ram*,

2.304

*Fish*, *Crab*, and *Scorpio* with his venom'd Flame

2.305

Or near in Site, or in an equal space

2.306

By two alike divided, are the *Day's*:

2.307

The rest the *Night's*. But who can hope to see

2.308

Opinion's join, or find the World agree!

2.309

Some with the *Ram* begin, and thence convey

2.310

The *Five* in Order following to the *Day*.

2.311

The rest from *Libra* are to *Night* confin'd:

2.312

Whilst others sing *Male* Signs affect the *Light*,

2.313

And *Female* safely wanton in the *Night*.

2.314

But others, this is plain from common sense, demand

## Earth and Water Signs.

2.315

Some Signs for *Sea*, and other Signs for *Land*:

2.316

Thus watery *Pisces*, and the *Crab* retain

2.317

Their proper Nature, and respect the *Main*:

2.318

The *Bull* and *Ram* possess their old Command,

2.319

They led the Herds, and still they love the *Land*,

2.320

Tho' there the *Lion's* Force their Rest invades,

2.321

And poysonous *Scorpio* lurks in gloomy Shades;

2.322

The Danger is despis'd, the *Ram*, the *Bull*

2.323

Keep *Land*, so powerful is the Lust of Rule:

2.324

The *Twins*, the *Centaur*, and the *Scales* dispose

2.325

In the same Rank; and join the *Maid* with those.

2.326

Of middle Nature some with Both agree,

2.327

One part respects the *Land*, and one the *Sea*:

2.328

The double *Goat* is such, whose wild Command

2.329

Now *Sea* affects, and now enjoys the *Land*:

2.330

And young *Aquarius* pouring out his Stream

2.331

Here spreads a *watry*, there an *Earthy* Beam.

2.332

How shall these things, yet they reward thy pain,

2.333

Reason's in All, and nothing's fram'd in vain:

### Fruitful and Barren Signs.

2.334

The *Crab* is fruitful, and a numerous Brood

2.335

Pierce *Scorpio* yields, and *Pisces* fill the Flood;

2.336

The *Lion*'s barren, and no Vows can gain

2.337

The *Maid*; *Aquarius* spends his Youth in vain,

2.338

Ah too remov'd, too far disjoyn'd to prove

2.339

The fruitful Pleasures of encreasing Love!

2.340

'Twixt these two kinds a Third nor *fruitful* Beams

2.341

Nor *Barren* spreads, but joyns the two Extreame:

2.342

The *Goat* all *Beast* above, and *Fish* below,

2.343

The *Centaur* glorious in his *Cretian* Bow,

2.344

The *Scales* that Autumn's Equinoctial rule,

2.345

The *Twins*, and *Ram*, to whom we join the *Bull*.

2.346

Nor must you think it undesign'd, a Cast

2.347

Of busie Nature as she wrought in haste;

## Signs of different Postures.

2.348

That some shew *running* Postures in their frame,

2.349

The *Lion*, *Centaur*, and the turning *Ram*;

2.350

*Erected* some, *Aquarius* rears his Head,

2.351

The *Twins* are upright, and the pious *Maid*:

2.352

Some *crouching* Signs a lazy Posture show,

2.353

Thus *Taurus* bends, as wearied by the Plough;

2.354

The *Scales* press'd down appear, and *Caper* lies

2.355



By his own Frost contracted in the Skies:

2.356

The *Crab* and *Scorpio* flat are found, they show

2.357

The Postures there which they maintain below,

2.358

Whilst watry *Pisces* low, and gently glide

2.359

In Streams divided, always on their side.

### Maimed and intire Signs.

2.360

But search minutely, and you find a *Maim*

2.361

In many Signs, the mighty *Bull* is lame,

2.362

His Leg turns under, *Scorpio*'s Claws are lost

2.363

In *Libra*'s Scales, nor can the *Centaur* boast

2.364

A Form compleat, tho' we distinctly find

2.365

One Eye, the other's lost, and *Cancer*'s blind.

2.366

Thus Heaven to wretched Mortals sends Relief

2.367

By these Examples it corrects our Grief,

2.368

Since *Signs*, on which our Fates depend, do share

2.369

The like Misfortunes, which we grieve to bear.

## Season Signs.

2.370

The different Seasons likewise share the Signs,

2.371

From *Pisces* Spring, and Summer from the *Twins*,

2.372

From *Centaur* Winter, Autumn from the *Maid* begins:

2.373

Each hath three Signs, and as the Seasons fight

2.374

In the Years *Round*, so these lie opposite.

2.375

Nor is't sufficient that my *Muse* defines

2.376

The Kinds, and Figures of the *Single* Signs,

2.377

They work by Compact, they their Beams unite

2.378

To mutual Aid determin'd by their site.

2.379

From *Aries* rightways draw a Line, to end

2.380

In the same *Round*, and let that Line subtend

2.381

An equal *Triangle*; now since the Lines

2.382

Must three times touch the *Round*, and meet three Signs,

## The various Configurations or Aspects.

2.383

Where e're they meet in *Angles* those are *Trines*. [See Fig. 1]

2.384

Because they are at equal distance seen

2.385

On either side, and leave *three* Signs between.

2.386

Thus *Aries* sees on either side below

2.387

The *Lion* roar, and *Centaur* draw his Bow:

2.388

The *Bull* with *Caper* and the *Maid* are found

2.389

In *Trine*: Thus fix the others of the *Round*.

## Trines.

2.390

Signs *Left* and *Right* are in the *Trines* agreed;

2.391

The *Left* still follow, and the *Right* precede;

2.392

The *Maid* is *Left*, and *Caper* to the *Bull*

2.393

Is *Right*: Thus fix the others by this Rule.

2.394

But more, in *Quadrates*; not in *Trines* alone

2.395

Signs *Right* and *Left* are by Position shown;

## Quadrates.

2.396

In *Quadrates*: which to know, the Round divide [See Fig. 2]

2.397

By *Squares* exactly equal on each side;

2.398

Where *Angles* close the *Perpendiculars*

2.399

There lie the *Signs* agreeing in the *Squares*.

2.400

To give an Instance then, observe the Site,

2.401

The narrow *Goat* sees *Libra* on the Right,

2.402

Oth' Left the *Ram*, at equal distance lies

2.403

The *Crab*, and on the Left sees *Libra* rise,

2.404

To make a *Square* agreeing in the Skies.

2.405

This single Instance all the rest declares,

2.406

And shews that *twice six Signs* compose three *Squares*.

## Cautions concerning Squares and Trines.

2.407

But now should any think their Skill designs

2.408

The *Squares* aright, and well describes the *Trines*,

2.409

And that they hit the Rule when e're they' give

2.410

*Four Signs* to *Squares*, to *Trines* allotting *Five*;

2.411

And thence presume to guess what mutual Aid

2.412

The *Signs* afford, they'll find their Work betray'd:

2.413

For though on every side *five Signs* are found

2.414

To make the several *Trines* that fill the Round,

2.415

Yet Births in each Fifth Sign no Fates design

2.416

To share th' united Influence of the *Trine*.

2.417

They lose the Thing, though they preserve the Name,

2.418

For *Place* and *Number* still oppose their Claim:

2.419

For since the *Round* where *Phoebus* guides his Reins

2.420

Three hundred, and thrice twenty parts contains,

2.421

One third of those, as we the *Round* divide

2.422

By *Trines*, to every *Trine* must make one side;

2.423

But *Sign* apply to *Sign*, not *Part* to *Part*,

2.424

This Number's lost; and therefore false the Art.

2.425

For tho *Three* Signs appear to interpose

2.426

Between the Two in which the *Angles* close;

2.427

Yet take the *Scheme* as 'tis expos'd to sight,

2.428

And joyn the utmost parts of *Left* and *Right*;

2.429

Then count the number; on the slightest view

2.430

You'll quickly find it much exceeds the true:

2.431

Thrice fifty parts it holds, and thus one Line

2.432

Defrauds the other, and destroys the *Trine*;

2.433

And therefore though the several *Signs* retain

2.434

The Name of *Trines*, they claim the *Parts* in vain.

2.435

The like Mistake, when you design a Square,

2.436

Thy Art may baffle, and elude thy Care;

2.437

For as the *Round* we by *Degrees* divide

2.438

To every *Quadrante* Ninety make one side:

2.439

Now from the *first* from which begins the Line,

2.440

Toth' *last* degree of the *succeeding* Sign

2.441

If you count on, *twice sixty* parts prepare

2.442

To crowd upon thee, and deform the *Square*:

2.443

Or from *preceding Signs* last parts descend

2.444

To *Signs succeeding*, let the Reckoning end

2.445

I'th' *first Degree* of those: the space consines

2.446

But sixty parts, the number of *Two Signs*;

2.447

Thus count from *Fourth* to *Fourth*, Degrees too few,

2.448

Or else too many will thy Work pursue,

2.449

Elude thy Skill, and prove the *Scheme* untrue.

2.450

Then take Advice, nor from my Rules depart

2.451

Nor think thy Figures well design'd by Art,

2.452

'Cause *Four* in *Squares*, *Three* equal Lines in *Trines*

2.453

In *Angles* meeting there divide the Signs;

2.454

For in all *Trines* the single sides require

2.455

*Sixscore* Degrees to make the *Scheme* intire

2.456

*Squares* ninety ask: but more or less proclaim

2.457

The Figure, faulty, and destroy the Frame.

2.458

And where the several Lines in *Angles* close,

2.459

They there the *Trines*, or else the *Squares* dispose

2.460

These mutual Aid by Nature's Laws convey,

2.461

And jointly act with an agreeing Ray.

2.462

And therefore every Birth, that *Squares* or *Trines*

2.463

Enjoys, not always carries all the Lines;

2.464

And tho' the *Signs* the name of *Squares* may gain,

2.465

Or *Trines*, they never shall their Force obtain:

2.466

They cannot jointly act, their Rays unite,

2.467

Tho *Trines* they seem, and shew like *Squares* to sight:

2.468

For wide the difference, whether those Degrees,

2.469

The *Line* takes up, which to it Art decrees;

2.470

Or from the Numbers, which the Circle fill,

2.471

Detracting somewhat, it cludes thy Skill:

2.472

For then of Signs too many or too few

2.473

It will possess; and make the *Scheme* untrue.



## 21. The Intercourse of Trines and Squares.

2.474

Thus far of these: But now expect to share

2.475

More vigorous Influence from the *Trine* than *Square*;

2.476

For Lines that measure *Squares* remotely tend,

2.477

And almost close with the Celestial Bend;

2.478

But those that make up *Trines* to Earth repair,

2.479

Downwards they shoot, from Signs the Influence bear, [See Fig. 3]

2.480

And with a nearer Ray infect our Air.

## 22. Of Sentiles

2.481

From *Signs Alternate* little Friendship's due,

2.482

Asquint they look, and with a partial view;

2.483

The Line that measures them obliquely drawn,

2.484

Thro' various *Angles* goes not freely on; [See Fig. 4]

2.485

Many its stops, in every other Sign

2.486

The *Angle* closing still diverts the *Line*;

2.487

Forward it darts, but soon it meets a Bound,

2.488

And six times broak, it leisurely creeps round:

2.489

From *Taurus* stretcht to *Cancer*, thence it bends

2.490

To *Virgo*'s Sign, and thence to *Scorpio* tends;

2.491

Cold *Caper* meets it next, and thence it goes

2.492

To *Aries*, upward then to *Taurus* flows,

2.493

Where, whence it first began, we find the *Figure* close.

2.494

The *Other*, for the *Round* contains no more,

2.495

Meets all the Signs the *Second* mist before;

2.496

Then passing those already sung, go on,

2.497

To all the *Others* let the Lines be drawn,

2.498

And equal *Angles* make the other Hexagon.

2.499

You see their *Site*, and thus *Oblique* they lie,

2.500

And view each other with a squinting Eye,

2.501

Too near, because thus plac'd, for mutual Aid,

2.502

Which freely flows in Lines direct convey'd.

2.503

High in the *Concave Signs Alternate* lie,

2.504

The *Lines* that mark them almost touch the Sky

2.505

And therefore far from *Earth* thro' distant way

2.506

They dart their Influence with a feeble Ray.

2.507

And yet some Intercourse in these we find,

2.508

For *Signs Alternate* are alike in Kind;

2.509

In the first *Hexagon* six *Males* are found,

2.510

With *Females* only is the *Second* crown'd:

2.511

Thus Nature works, and, when the *Place* denies,

2.512

*Sex* makes Agreement, and unites the Skies.

## 23. Of Contiguous Signs.

2.513

In Concord no *Contiguous Signs* agree,

2.514

For what can love when 'tis deny'd to see?

2.515

They to themselves, which they behold alone,

2.516

Their Passion bend, and all their Love's their own

2.517

Alternately of different Kinds they lie,

## 24. Of Vnequal Signs.

2.518

One *Male* one *Female* fill the *Round* of *Sky*.

2.519

From Signs unequal any way *remove*

2.520

All Thoughts of Union, they're averse to Love:

2.521

Thus never think between the *Sixths* to find

2.522

An Intercourse, nor hope to see them kind;

2.523

Because the Lines, by which we mark their place,

2.524

In length unlike stretch thro' unequal space.

2.525

For take the *Zodiack*, from the *Ram* begin, *[See Fig. 4]*

2.526

And thence on either side extend the Line

2.527

To meet the *Sixth* from *Aries*, then dispose

2.528

A *Third*, and let the *Three* in *Angles* close;

2.529

Between the *Two* first Lines *Four* Signs are found,

2.530

The *Third* includes but *One*, for that fills up the *Round*.

## 25. Of Opposites.

2.531

But more, the *Signs* oppos'd in Site, that lie

2.532

With Beams directly darting thro' the Sky;

2.533

Tho' much remov'd they seem, yet mix from far

2.534

Their friendly Influence, or declare for War;

2.535

As the *Sun's* Aspect and the *Planet's* Fire

2.536

For Peace determine, or to Rage inspire.

2.537

These Signs <sup>101</sup> adverse would you distinctly note?

2.538

Let Summer's *Crab* oppose the Winter's *Goat*.

2.539

The *Scales* the *Ram* where Day and Night appear

2.540

Equal in adverse Seasons of the Year: [See Fig. 4]

2.541

The *Fish* oppose the *Maid*, the watry *Vrn*

2.542

With adverse Fires sees raging *Leo* burn.

2.543

When *Scorpio* fills the highest Arch of Skies,

2.544

Then bending *Taurus* in the lowest lies,

2.545

And when the *Centaur* sets the *Twins* arise.

2.546

Yet though in Site oppos'd these rowl above,

2.547

Yet joyn'd by *Nature* or by *Sex* they love:

2.548

Thus *Males* to *Males* strict Leagues of Friendship bind,

2.549

And *Female* Signs to their own Sex are kind.

2.550

The *Fish* and *Maid* oppos'd are friendly Signs,

2.551

For *Nature* couples what the *Place* disjoyns:

2.552

But *Nature* sometimes yields, the *Trines* prevail,

2.553

And *Females* *Females* fight, and *Males* the *Male*:

2.554

Tho' *Female* both the *Goat* the *Crab* defies

2.555

*Winter* in this, in that the *Summer* lies;

2.556

Here *Snow* makes white, and *Frost* binds up the *Fields*;

2.557

There *Sweat* o'reflows and *Winter's* *Rigor* yields;

2.558

Here *Day* exults, there *Night* extends her *Sway*,

2.559

And *Winter's* *Darkness* equals *Summer's* *Day*:

2.560

Thus *Nature* sights, nor must we hope to find

2.561

The Signs of *disagreeing* Seasons kind.

2.562

Tho' *differing* Seasons hold the *Scales* and *Ram*,

2.563

They are *half Friends*, and mix agreeing *Flame*:

2.564

In this gay *Flowers* the painted *Beds* adorn,

2.565

This fills the *Plains*, and stores the *Barns* with *Corn*

2.566

Their *Days* and *Nights* in equal *Balance* meet,

2.567

Not vext with too much *Cold*, nor too much *Heat*:

2.568

They *Summer's Wars* and *Winter's Rage* compose,

2.569

Nor will these Seasons let their *Signs* be *Foes*.

2.570

Thus are the several *Aspects* taught—

## 26. The Guardians of the Signs.

2.571

These things considered, press no more *Divine*

2.572

And know the *Gods* the *Guardians* of each *Sign*

2.573

Whom *Nature* order'd to controul their *Course*,

2.574

Direct their *Influence*, and assist their *Force*:

2.575

Great *Powers* are *Godlike*, we at least assign

2.576

Gods to great Powers, to make them seem Divine

2.577

For where *Things* want, high *Titles* there bestow

2.578

Admir'd Worth, and makes them great in show.

2.579

*Pallas* the *Ram* <sup>102</sup>, and *Venus* guides the *Bull*,

2.580

The Twins share *Phaebus*, and enjoy his Rule;

2.581

The Crab is *Mercury*'s, and *Jove* divides

2.582

His *Mother*'s Servant, and the *Lion* guides:

2.583

*Ceres* the *Maid*, for this her Sheaf declares,

2.584

And fighting *Scorpio* owns the God of Wars:

2.585

*Juno* pours out the *Vrn*, and *Vulcan* claims

2.586

The *Scales*, as the just Product of his Flames:

2.587

The frozen *Goat* kind *Vesta*'s Aid requires,

2.588

She cheers his cold, and warms him with her Fire

2.589

*Diana* draws the hunting *Centaur*'s Bow,

2.590

And mighty *Neptune* now is prov'd to know

2.591

The *Fish* above, which He had fed below.



2.592

And now that Reason guides, that Gods do move

2.593

The various Orbs, and govern all above,

2.594

Must needs erect thy Mind, it must impart

2.595

Strong Inclinations to pursue the Art;

2.596

Since Man securely may his Thoughts advance,

2.597

And hope to find, when undisturb'd by *Chance*.

## 27. Signs for the several parts of the Body.

2.598

Now learn what Signs the several Limbs obey,

2.599

Whose Powers they feel, and where Obedience pay.

2.600

The *Ram* defends the *Head*, the *Neck* the *Bull*,

2.601

The *Arms*, bright *Twins*, are subject to your Rule:

2.602

I'th' *Shoulders Leo*, and the *Crab's* obey'd

2.603

I'th' *Breast*, and in the *Guts* the modest *Maid*:

2.604

I'th' *Buttocks Libra*, *Scorpio* warms Desires

2.605

In *Secret Parts*, and spreads unruly Fires:

2.606

The *Thighs* the *Centaur*, and the *Goat* commands

2.607

The *Knees*, and binds them up with double Bands.

2.608

The parted *Legs* in moist *Aquarius* meet,

2.609

And *Pisces* gives Protection to the *Feet*.

## 28. Signs that See, Hear, Love, or Hate.

2.610

But Stars have proper Laws, and Signs maintain

2.611

An Intercourse, and Compact in their Reign;

2.612

Some *Hear* each other, some each other *See*,

2.613

Some fight and *Hate*, whilst some in *Leagues* agree:

2.614

Some Foreign Passions cautiously remove,

2.615

But make Themselves the Object of their Love.

2.616

Thus Signs in Sex by Nature closely join'd

2.617

Are Foes, whilst Signs in Sex oppos'd are kind;

2.618

And Signs, whose opposite Position tends

2.619

To Disagreement, breed the greatest Friends.

2.620

When God ordain'd this mighty Frame to rise,

2.621

He settled these Affections in the Skies,

2.622

That some might *Hear*, and some each other *See*,

2.623

Some *Hate* and fight, and some in *Leagues* agree;

2.624

Some *Love* themselves alone; All this appears

2.625

In *Men*, who take their Tempers from the Stars.

2.626

The *Ram*, as it becomes the Prince of Stars,

2.627

Is his own Council, and Himself he *hears*; [See Fig. 5. 6, 7, and 8]

2.628

He *Libra* sees, but unsuccessful proves

2.629

In loving *Taurus*, for in vain he *Loves*;

2.630

*Taurus* (for *Aries* finds but cold returns

2.631

For all those Fires with which he freely burns;

2.632

Nay more, by Treachery all his Love's repaid)

2.633

Sees, Hears the *Fishes*, and adores the *Maid*:

2.634

Thus from the *Tyrian* Pastures lin'd with *Jove*

2.635

He bore *Europa*, and still keeps his Love:

2.636

The *Twins* see *Leo*, and they hear the *Vrn*

2.637

Pouring out his Streams, but for the *Fishes* burn.

2.638

The *Crab* (as *Caper* adverse in the Skies)

2.639

First makes himself the Object of his Eyes;

2.640

He loves *Aquarius Vrn*, and then repays

2.641

The friendly *Goat* by hearkning to his Rays.

2.642

The *Lion* sees the *Twins* embracing Fires,

2.643

He hears the *Centaur*, and the *Goat* admires:

2.644

Mischief the *Maid* for *Sagittarius* brews,

2.645

She hears the *Scorpion*, and the *Bull* she views.

2.646

But *Libra* hears her self, her Mind applies

2.647

To following *Scorpio*, to the *Ram* her Eyes:

2.648

The *Scorpion* sees the *Fish*, the *Maid* he hears;

2.649

To *Leo Sagittarius* bends his Ears;

2.650

To young *Aquarius* he his Eyes resigns,

2.651

His Love prefers the *Maid* to other Signs.

2.652

The *Goat* admires, and loves himself alone,

2.653

(For since at <sup>103</sup> *Caesar's* Birth *Serene* he shone;

2.654

What *Glory* can be greater than his own?

2.655

He hears the *Crab*: *Aquarius* hears the *Twins*,

2.656

And sees the *Centaur*, and amidst the *Signs*

2.657

The tousing *Crab* alone his *Mind* can move,

2.658

And is the only *Object* of his *Love*.

2.659

Whilst *Pisces* to the *Bull* their *Ears* apply,

2.660

And view the *Scorpion* with a longing *Eye*.

2.661

These *Powers* the *Tempers* of their *Births* define,

2.662

Each carries the *Affection* of his *Sign*;

2.663

These love to *See* and love to *Hear* create,

2.664

And all the *Intercourse* of *Love* and *Hate*:

2.665

Hence some embrace, and some as odly fly

2.666

Each other; *Love* and *Hate*, but know not why.

2.667

Thus far of *single* *Signs*: But *Trines* engage

2.668

With *Trines*, and all the *Heaven* is full of *Rage*:

2.669

Signs War in Bodies, and in Parties fight,

2.670

As adverse in their *Manners*, as in *Site*:

2.671

The *Ram*, *Lion*, *Centaur* joyn'd in *Trine* oppose

2.672

The Heavenly *Scales*, and to their *Trine* are Foes.

2.673

And this on two Accounts; Three Signs to Three

2.674

Shine opposite, and who can hope to see

2.675

Two differing Natures, <sup>104</sup> *Man* and *Beast* agree?

2.676

For he that holds the *Scales* Celestial, bears

2.677

A *Humane* Shape, a *Brute* the *Lion* wears,

2.678

And therefore yields, for *Reason*'s Force controuls

2.679

*Brute* Strength, and *Bodies* still submit to *Souls*.

2.680

The *Lion* conquer'd to the Skies was thrown,

2.681

And fleecy *Aries* flead before he shone;

2.682

The *Centaur*'s Forepart still commands the rest,

2.683

So much the *Humane* Form exceeds the *Beast*.

2.684

No wonder therefore that with great Success

2.685

The *Scales* fight *Aries*, and his *Trine* oppress.

2.686

But this we may in one short rule comprise,

2.687

For view the Signs that fill the round of Skies,

2.688

And those that are in *Humane* Forms exprest

2.689

Are conquering Foes to all the shapes of *Beast*.

2.690

But yet their Hate not equally extends,

2.691

Signs have their proper Foes, as well as Friends;

2.692

The *Ram*'s Productions Friendly Leagues refuse

2.693

To all the *Fishes*, *Maid*, or *Scales* produce:

2.694

What *Scorpio*, *Cancer*, *Pisces*, *Scales* create

2.695

Are Foes to *Taurus*, and his Births they hate:

2.696

Whilst those Productions that the *Twins* design

2.697

Are Enemies to *Aries*, and his *Trine*.

2.698

Against the *Crab* and *Bull* the *Goat* declares,

2.699

And *Virgo* too, and *Libra* feels his Wars:

2.700

Nor shall (could I write curious Verse, my *Muse*

2.701

To shew her Art in Precepts would refuse;

2.702

I teach an Art, and 'tis by all confest

2.703

Instruction when 'tis plainest than 'tis best:)

2.704

The furious *Lion* rous'd with desperate Rage

2.705

With fewer Enemies than the *Ram* engage.

2.706

The double *Centaur* with his threatning Bow

2.707

Affrights the *Maid*, the *Bull* that bends his Brow,

2.708

With *Caper*, and with *Pisces* is her Foe.

2.709

O're *Libra*'s Sign a Crowd of Foes prevails,

2.710

The Icy *Goat*, the *Crab* which square the *Scales*,

2.711

With those of *Aries* Trine consent to hate

2.712

The *Scales* of *Libra*, and her Rays rebate.

2.713

Nor doth the Sign of fiery *Scorpio* find

2.714

Foes less in number, or of better Mind;

2.715

*The* Urn, *Twins*, *Lion*, *Bull*, *the Scales*, *the Maid*

2.716

He frights; and they of him are equally afraid:



2.717

Nor can the *Centaur's* Bow his Peace defend,

2.718

The *Twins*, *Vrn*, *Virgin* force his Sign to bend

2.719

By Nature's Law, nor are the *Scales* his Friend.

2.720

The same oppress thy Sign with equal Hate

2.721

Contracted *Caper*, and thy Force rebate.

2.722

Whilst those that are in *Brutal* Forms exprest

2.723

Afflict the *Vrn*, and all his *Trine* molest.

2.724

The neighbouring *Fish* the *Vrn* with Hate pursues,

2.725

And those the *Maid*, and those the *Twins* produce.

2.726

And those that own the *Centaur's* angry Star

2.727

He treats as Foes, and still afflicts with War.

2.728

These Rules are true, but somewhat else defines

2.729

The Friendship and the Enmity of Signs:

2.730

Thus *Thirds* are Foes, for with a squinting Ray

2.731

They view each other, and their Hate convey:

2.732

Signs *opposite*, whatever place they fill

2.733

Averse to Peace, and are unfriendly still:

2.734

Thus *Sevenths* their adverse *Sevenths* are doom'd to loath,

2.735

And *Thirds* from both, and which are *Trines* to both:

2.736

Nor is it strange that *Trines* unfriendly prove

2.737

When Kin to *Signs* that are averse to Love.

2.738

So many sorts of differing Signs dispose

## 29. A short digression concerning Friendship.

2.739

Mens Tempers, and produce such Crowds of Foes;

2.740

Look o're the World, see Force and Fraud increase,

2.741

Rapine in War, and Treachery in Peace;

2.742

But look for Truth and Faith, the Search were vain,

2.743

No Mind is Honest, and no Thoughts are plain:

2.744

What bulky Villanies bestride the Age!

2.745

What Envy pusheth on Mankind to rage!

2.746

Envy not to be dispossess, her Throne

2.747

Is firmly fixt, and all the World's her own!

2.748

Friends kill their Friends, a Husband stabs his Wife,

2.749

Sons sell their Father's and their Mother's Life;

2.750

Bold *Atrous* feasts, and at the barbarous sight

2.751

The Sun retires, and leaves the World to night.

2.752

Whilst Brothers poyson, with a smiling Face

2.753

They mix the Cup, and kill where they embrace:

2.754

No place is safe, no Temple yields Defence

2.755

Against secret Stabs, or open Violence;

2.756

And many a slaughter'd Priest profanely dies

2.757

On the same Altar with his Sacrifice.

2.758

Those most betray who kindness most pretend,

2.759

And Crowds of Villains skulk behind the Name of Friend.

2.760

The World's infected, Wrong and Fraud prevails,

2.761

Whilst Honesty retires, and Justice fails;

2.762

Nay Laws support those Crimes they checkt before,

2.763

And Executions now affright no more.

2.764

For disagreeing Stars that Men produce,

2.765

Their Tempers fashion, and their own infuse:

2.766

Hence Peace is lost, pure Faith we seldom find,

2.767

Kind Leagues are rare, and then but feebly bind;

2.768

For as the Signs above, so Things below

2.769

Do differing Minds and Inclinations show;

2.770

They form Men's Thoughts, and the obedient Clay

2.771

Takes disagreeing Tempers from their Ray.

2.772

Hence 'tis that *Friendship* is so thinly sown,

2.773

It thrives but ill, nor can it last when grown;

2.774

Rare it's Production: and the World pretends

2.775

To boast but one poor single pair of Friends:

2.776

One *Pylades* and one <sup>105</sup> *Orestes* name,

2.777

And you have all the Instances of Fame;

2.778

Once Death was strove for, 'twas a generous Strife,

2.779

Not who should keep, but who should lose a Life

2.780

Was their Dispute, contending to deny

2.781

Each other the great Priviledge to die.

2.782

The *Surety* fear'd his *guilty Friend*'s return,

2.783

The *Guilty Friend* did his own Absence mourn;

2.784

Careless of Life, impatient of Delay,

2.785

He broak thro' hindring Friends that choak'd his way,

2.786

And ran to Danger: Here they disagreed,

2.787

*One* hop'd to free, *One* fear'd to be so freed.

2.788

But now if you would know what Signs dispose

2.789

To Leagues, and Peace, and friendly Thoughts disclose;

2.790

The *Ram*'s bright Births you may securely joyn

2.791

As Friends to the Productions of his *Trine*:

2.792

But the *Ram*'s Births are more sincerely plain,

2.793

They give more Love than they receive again

2.794

From thine fierce *Leo*, or than his can show

2.795

That strides thro' Heaven, and draws the *Cretan* Bow:

2.796

For 'tis a *Sign* of thoughtless Innocence,

2.797

Expos'd to Harms, unpractis'd in Defence;

2.798

Unus'd to Fraud or Wrong, but gentle, kind,

2.799

And not more soft in Body than in Mind.

2.800

The others carry Fierceness in their Ray,

2.801

Their Nature's bruitish, and intent on Prey;

2.802

Ungrateful still, nor can they long retain

2.803

A sense of Kindness, and unjust for Gain:

2.804

But tho' by Nature these are both inclin'd

2.805

To frequent Quarrels, yet expect to find

2.806

More Force in that which is of *double* kind,

2.807

Than in the *Single Lion*: Hence increase

2.808

Some sudden Heats, but intermixt with Peace.

2.809

The *Bull* and *Goat* are equally inclin'd

2.810

To mutual Friendship, both alike are kind;

2.811

The *Bull's* Productions love fair *Virgo's* Race,

2.812

Yet frequent Jarrs disjoin their close Embrace.

2.813

The *Scales* and *Vrn* one friendly Soul inspire,

2.814

Their Love is settled, and their Faith intire;

2.815

To both their Births the *Twins* productions prove

2.816

The surest Friends, and meet an equal Love.

2.817

The *Crab* and *Scorpion* to their Births impart

2.818

A friendly Temper, and an open Heart;

2.819

Yet *Scorpio's* (Fraud amongst the Stars is found)

2.820

Tho' Friends they seem, yet give a secret Wound.

2.821

But those whom *Pisces* watry Rays create,

2.822

Are constant neither in their Love, nor Hate;

2.823

They change their Minds, now quarrel, now embrace,

2.824

And Treachery lurks behind their fawning Face.

2.825

Thus *Signs* or *Love*, or *Hate*: and These bestow

2.826

Their differing Tempers on their Births below.

2.827

Nor is't enough to know the Signs alone,

### 30. The friendly and unfriendly Aspects.

2.828

The *Planets* Stations must be justly known,

2.829

And all Heaven's parts, because the *Site* and *Line*

2.830

And *Aspect* change the Influence of the *Sign*:

2.831

Thus when *Oppos'd* the Signs this Influence bear,

2.832

In *Trine* a different they are known to share,

2.833

In *Sextile* this, another when in Square.

2.834

And thus the Sky now gives, now takes away

2.835

The Influence, now it points, now blunts the Ray

2.836

Here *Hate* infects them, when they thence remove;

2.837

They lose that Hate, or change the Rage to Love.

2.838

For *Signs*, or when they rise, or culminate,

2.839

Or set, send down a different sort of Fate.

2.840

To Hatred Signs *oppos'd in Site* incline,

2.841



The *Quadrates* Kinsmen aid, and Friends the *Trine*;

2.842

The Reason's obvious: The Celestial *Round*

2.843

Observe, there Signs of the same kind are found [See Fig. 1]

2.844

In each *fourth* place: In each *fourth* Sign appear

2.845

The several *Seasons* that command the Year;

2.846

Thus *Aries* gives the *Spring*, flat *Cancer* glows

2.847

With *Summer's* Heat; the generous Bowl o'reflows

2.848

In *Libra*, *Caper* scatters Winter's *Snows*.

2.849

Besides, by *Signs* in double Forms exprest

2.850

Each *fourth* Celestial place is found possest,

2.851

Two *Fishes* glide; two *smiling Boys* embrace,

2.852

A double Figure we in *Virgo* trace,

2.853

The *Centaur's* double with a single Face.

2.854

Next *Simple* Signs with their refulgent Stars

2.855

Fill each *fourth* space, and still are found in *Squares*.

2.856

Without a Rival *Taurus* fills his Throne,

2.857

The dreadful *Lion* shakes his Mane alone,

2.858

Th<sup>106</sup> unbodied *Scorpion* no Companion fears,

2.859

And still the *Vrn* a *simple* Sign appears.

2.860

Therefore to each *fourth* place the Stars assign'd

2.861

In *Time* agree, in *Number*, or in *Kind*;

2.862

This makes them *Kindred* Signs, and these preside

2.863

O're *Kinsmen's* Minds, and their Affections guide.

2.864

But those *four* Signs on which the *Hinges* move

2.865

Belong to *Neighbours*, and direct their Love.

2.866

The other *Square* with all its Stars attends

2.867

On *Guests*, *Acquaintance*, and remoter *Friends*.

2.868

Thus all the Signs as they are plac't obtain

2.869

Their Rule, and with unequal Vigor reign.

2.870

For tho' the Site and Form of *Squares* they bear,

2.871

They work not like the other Signs in *Square*;

2.872

For whilst the *Cardinals* more Force confess,

2.873

The rest, which we from Number nam'd express

2.874

*Double* or *Simple* Signs, still work with less.

2.875

The Line extended thro' the larger space

### Trines. See Fig. 1.

2.876

With *Trines* determines, and makes out their place,

2.877

Presides o're *Friends*, whose mutual Faiths supply

2.878

The room of Blood, and draw a closer Tie:

2.879

For as it measures a long space, to joyn

2.880

The distant, stretching out from Sign to Sign.

2.881

So those, whom Nature doth in spight remove,

2.882

It brings together; and knits in Bands of Love.

2.883

And *these* before the *others* most commend,

2.884

For tho' the nearest Kinsmen oft pretend

2.885

Deluding Kindness; who deceives a Friend?

2.886

No *Sign* nor *Planet* serves it self alone,

2.887

Each blends the others Vertues with its own.

2.888

Mixing their Force, and interchang'd they reign,

2.889

Signs *Planets* bound, and Planets *Signs* again.

2.890

All this my *Muse* shall orderly reveal,

2.891

And keep the Method she begun so well;

2.892

She'll sing what *Parts* the several *Signs* require,

2.893

In what the *Planets* spread commanding Fire;

2.894

This must be shown, if in your search for Fate

2.895

The *Signs* of Love you'd know from *those* of Hate.

2.896

Now with expanded Thought go on to know

### 31. Dedecatemorion.

2.897

A *Secret* great in Use, tho' small in show;

2.898

For which *our* scanty Language, poor in words,

2.899

No single fit expressive Term affords,

2.900

But *Greek* supplies, a Language born to frame

2.901

Fit Words, and show their Reason in the Name.

2.902

'Tis *Dodecatemorion* <sup>107</sup>, thus describ'd—

2.903

Thrice ten Degrees with every Sign contains

2.904

Let *Twelve* exhaust, that not one part remains;

2.905

It follows streight that every *Twelfth* confines

2.906

Two *whole*, and one *half* Portion of the Signs:

2.907

These *Twelfths* in Number, as the Signs, are *Twelve*,

2.908

And these the wise contriver of the Frame

2.909

Plac't in each Sign, that all may be the same.

2.910

The World may be alike, each Star may guide,

2.911

And every Sign in every Sign preside;

2.912

That all may govern by agreeing Laws,

2.913

And friendly Aids be mutual as their Cause.

2.914

And therefore Births; o're which one Sign aspires,

2.915

In Powers are various, different in Desires;

2.916

Males follow Females, and from Man deprest

2.917

Weak Nature sinks, and errs into a Beast:

2.918

For all on Signs depend, in which succeed

2.919

The different *Twelfths*, and vary in the Breed.

2.920

Now whose, and how dispos'd, the *Muse* must sing,

2.921

And draw deep Knowledge from its secret Spring;

2.922

Lest this unknown you should from Truth decline,

2.923

Mistaking the chang'd Influence of the *Sign*:

2.924

Each Sign's *first Twelfths* is by its self possest,

2.925

The others shar'd in Order by the rest;

2.926

Each hath its *Twelfth*, they take their equal Shares,

2.927

(Ambition is a Vice too mean for Stars)

2.928

Thus every Sign hath for its proper Throne

2.929

Two whole, and one half Portion of its own;

2.930

Of other Signs that rowl in order on

2.931

Each takes as much, till all the thirty parts are gone.

2.932

But there are many sorts, to find the true

2.933

Wise Nature orders we must all pursue;

2.934

This is her Will: Tho partial Search may fail,

2.935

Yet He's secure of Truth who seeks for All.

### 32. The Dodecatemoria of the Planets.

2.936

For Instance, grant it were thy great Concern

2.937

To know the <sup>108</sup> *Planet's Twelfths*; securely learn;

2.938

I'll shew the Method: As you count the Signs,

2.939

First mark that Sign's Degree where *Phoebe* shine

2.940

And views the new-born Child; that multiply

2.941

By Twelve: (because Twelve Signs adorn the Sky)

2.942

Observe the Product, and from thence assign

2.943

To those gay Stars where *Phaebe's* found to shine

2.944

Thrice ten Degrees: Then go in Order on,

2.945

Assigning Thirty till the Number's done;

2.946

And where the Number ends there fix the *Moon*:

2.947

That is her Twelfth. The following *Planets* lie

2.948

In following *Twelfths*, and there enjoy the Sky.

2.949

Another Method claims my next Essay,

2.950

Another differing from the former way;

2.951

This too I must explain, its Rules impart,

2.952

And fix the subtle Niceties of Art,

2.953

First take the <sup>109</sup> *Sun's* true place, and that confest,

2.954

Observe the Portion by the *Moon* possest:

2.955

Count those Degrees the middle Space contains,

2.956

Take all the *Thirtys* thence, and what remains

2.957

Dividing into *Twelfths*, from thence assign

2.958

To those gay Stars in which the *Moon* does shine

2.959

One *Twelfth*: To Signs that orderly come on

2.960

Apply their *Twelfths*, till all the Number's done,

2.961

And where the number ends there fix the Moon.

2.962

That is her *Twelfth*. The following *Planets* lie

2.963

In following *Twelfths*, and there enjoy the Sky.



2.964

The Task's not done: The *Muse* must next unfold

2.965

A nicer thing, in fewer Numbers told:

2.966

Which *less* in show and in extent appears,

2.967

Yet than the *Greater* more of Force it bears:

2.968

In every <sup>110</sup> *Twelfth* a *Twelfth* the Planets claim,

2.969

The Thing is different though we use the Name;

2.970

'Tis thus describ'd. Five half Degrees do lie

2.971

In every *Twelfth*, Five *Planets* grace the Sky,

2.972

And every Planet in its proper Course

2.973

One half Degree possessing there exerts its Force.

2.974

'Tis useful therefore to observe the Sign,

2.975

And mark the *Twelfth* in which the *Planets* shine;

2.976

For where the *Planets*, as they rowl their Course,

2.977

A *Twelfth* possess, they there exert their Force.

2.978

These must be *jointly* sung: yet these belong

2.979

To future Thoughts, and claim another Song:

2.980

'Tis now enough that I have clearly shown

2.981

Things hid before, and made their *Vses* known;

2.982

Let it suffice, that I have brought the *Muse*

2.983

Materials proper, and prepar'd for Use:

2.984

When all is ready, let her build the Frame,

2.985

And raise a lasting Monument of Fame:

2.986

The single *Elements* distinctly known

2.987

Thee sees her Way, and may go safely on;

2.988

And all the Parts describ'd the *Verse* will roul

2.989

With freer Force, and orderly erect the whole.

2.990

For as to Boys at School we first propound

2.991

The Letters, show their Form, and teach their Sound,

2.992

And then go on, instruct them how to Spell,

2.993

And join their Letters in a Syllable;

2.994

Then to frame Words, and thence their Fancies raise,

2.995

To bind these words in Verse, and reach the Bays.

2.996

And as the Boys proceed, they find their past,

2.997

And first Acquirements useful to their last;

2.998

For Precepts without Method got by pain,

2.999

Prove empty, and the labour is in vain:

2.1000

So since my Songs *Fate*'s dark Intrigues rehearse,

2.1001

Their Influence show, and bind the Stars in Verse;

2.1002

Since they mount high, and from the Signs above,

2.1003

Bring down the God, and open hidden *Jove*:

2.1004

All must be taught, and I must first impart

2.1005

The *Elements* peculiar to this Art;

2.1006

That thence, as she proceeds, my *labouring* Muse

2.1007

May draw Materials, and go on to Use.

2.1008

And as wise Builders, who design a Town,

2.1009

First clear the Field, and cut the Forest down,

2.1010

And streight new Stars behold as new a Sun:

2.1011

From Antient Seats, and Hospitable Glades

2.1012

The Beasts are forc'd, and Birds forsake their Shades.

2.1013

Some Stones for Walls, some Marble square for Shrines,

2.1014

And suit Materials to their great Designs;

2.1015

And when they have provided sit Supplies

2.1016

For future Art, the Piles begin to rise;

2.1017

Nor doth the interrupted work disgrac't

2.1018

By any stop, accuse their foolish haste:

2.1019

So I, that raise this mighty Work, must choose

2.1020

Materials proper to employ my *Muse*,

2.1021

Bare fit Materials; and not build one part

2.1022

'Till all lies ready to compleat the Art;

2.1023

Lest whilst my Thoughts the noble work pursue,

2.1024

As all Materials lay expos'd to view,

2.1025

They start surpriz'd, and stop amaz'd with new.

### XXXIII. The Celestial Houses.

2.1026

Be careful then, and with a curious Eye,

2.1027

Observe the <sup>111</sup> *four fixt Hinges* of the Sky;

2.1028

One constant point their *settled* place defines,

2.1029

Altho' they *vary* in their moving *Signs*:

### The Hinges. See Fig. 10.

2.1030

One fixt i'th' *East*, where with a gentle Ray

2.1031

The Sun views half the Earth on either way,

2.1032

And here brings on, and there bears off the Day.

2.1033

One in the *West*, from whose declining steep

2.1034

The Sun falls head-long, and enjoys the Deep:

2.1035

The Third in *Heaven's high point*, where midst the Course

2.1036

Bright *Phoebus* stops, and breaths his weary Horse;

2.1037

He stands a while, and with an equal Ray,

2.1038

Views *East* and *West*, and then drives down the Day.

2.1039

Oppos'd to this, the Fourth securely lies,

2.1040

The immoveable Foundation of the Skies;

2.1041

The lowest point, to which with steady Rein

2.1042

The Stars descend, and whence they mount again:

2.1043

These *Points* in Fate the greatest Interest claim,

2.1044

Because they settle, and support the Frame;

2.1045

In these fixt *Points* were not the *Quarters* ty'd.

2.1046

Oth' *Top*, oth' *Bottom*, and on either side,

2.1047

The *Ball* would cleave, the whirls would dissipate

2.1048

The agitated parts; and break strong Fate.

2.1049

Now different Powers these several *Hinges* grace

## The Medium Coeli.

2.1050

And vary with the dignity of Place;

2.1051

The chiefest that which on the *Top* doth lie,

2.1052

And with a narrow limit parts the *Skye*,

2.1053

There *Glory* sits in all her *Pomp* and state,

2.1054

The highest place requires the highest Fate;

2.1055

Thence Places, Dignities, Preferments flow,

2.1056

And all that Men admire and wish below;

2.1057

High Honours, Offices, in Suits success,

2.1058

Right to make Laws, and Power to give Peace;

2.1059

Thence Scepters, and supreme Command accrue,

2.1060

And Power to give them, where Rewards are due.

## The Imum Coeli.

2.1061

The next, (tho' lowest and contemn'd it lies)

2.1062

The fixt, and sure Foundation of the Skies,

2.1063

Great in effect, altho' it seems but small;

2.1064

It governs *Wealth*, and Wealth's the stay of all:

2.1065

It rules Estates, it shows what Mines contain,

2.1066

What secret Treasures we may hope to gain,

2.1067

Without this Power the other *Fates* were vain.

2.1068

As great in Power is that where Beams display

## The Horoscope. or Eastern Point.

2.1069

Their rising luster, and renew the Day;

2.1070

The *Greek* (no other scanty Tongues afford

2.1071

A single proper and expressive Word)

2.1072

Names this the *Horoscope*.

2.1073

This governs, Life, and this marks out our Parts,

2.1074

Our Humours, Manners, Qualities, and Arts;

2.1075

This when and where the Birth is born declares

2.1076

And guides the various Vertues of the Stars:

2.1077

By this they are settled, and as this defines

2.1078

The Birth, enjoys the influence of the Signs.

## The Western Point.

2.1079

The *Last*, the Point, whence Stars descending fall,

2.1080

And view the lower surface of the Ball;

2.1081

This rules the *Ends* of things, this *Point* declare

2.1082



The *Period*, and *Result* of all Affairs;

2.1083

This governs Marriage, and on this depends

2.1084

Religion, Recreation, Death, and Friends.

2.1085

These *Points* considered, Their Powers distinctly seen,

2.1086

Observe the *Spaces* that are plac't between;

2.1087

The *Points* are little, but the *Spaces* large,

2.1088

And every space has a proportion'd Charge.

### The intermediate Spacers.

2.1089

First then the *Space* that rising from the *East*

2.1090

Mounts upward, is by *Infancy* possest,

2.1091

There Childhood plays: From thence the *Western space*

2.1092

Gay *Youth* demands, and fills the second place.

2.1093

Next from the *Western Point* a *space* descends, [See Fig. 9]

2.1094

Thro' under Heaven, and in the *Lowest* ends;

2.1095

There *Manhood*, having past the various Maze

2.1096

Of *Infancy* and *Youth*, compleats its Race:

2.1097

To finish this; The *space* that upward tends,

2.1098

And creeping slowly o're the steep Ascends

2.1099

To join the Round at *East*, is made the way

2.1100

Of feeble *Age* and flitting *Life's* decay.

2.1101

But more all *Signs*, whatever Form they bear,

2.1102

The several Vertues of their Stations wear;

2.1103

With good or hurtful Powers those points their Ray,

2.1104

The *Places* govern, and the *Signs* obey:

2.1105

They turn the Round, and as they wheel their Course,

2.1106

The *Place* now gives, and now takes off their Force;

2.1107

For as the *Planets* thro' the *stations* Err,

2.1108

Those *Places* their own Influence transfer;

2.1109

And force them, whilst within their bounds, to take

2.1110

Their ruling Vertues, and their own forsake.

2.1111

Hence now they smile, and now severely frown

2.1112

With Foreign Influence that Commands their own:

2.1113

Here sovereign send, there showr malignant Rays,

2.1114

And spread the fatal Venom of their *Place*.

## The Twelfth and Sixth Houses.

2.1115

That *station* which above the *East* doth lie,

2.1116

The Third in order from the middle Sky,

2.1117

Is an unhappy *Seat*; destructive still

2.1118

To all Events, and too replete with Ill.

2.1119

Nor is this bad alone, the *Seat* that lies

2.1120

Below the *Western Hinge* oppos'd to this,

2.1121

Is like it: Nor doth this that *Seat* surpass,

2.1122

[...] Vertue of its Dignity of Place,

2.1123

Is near the nobler *Hinge*: But both decline, *[See fig 9th]*

2.1124

From both begin a wretched Round of time,

2.1125

Of *Labor* full, for here you fall, and there you climb.

## The Second and Eighth Houses.

2.1126

Nor is the World with better *stations* blest

2.1127

Above the *West*, nor yet below the *East*,

2.1128

That hangs above, this downward seems to bend,

2.1129

This in the neighbouring *Hinge* still fears an end,

2.1130

That unsustain'd is eager to descend. [*See fig. 9th*]

2.1131

Unhappy Seats! Here *Typho* rules alone

2.1132

And fills a dark inhospitable Throne:

2.1133

This *Typho* Earth produc't, when *Giants* strove

2.1134

To Conquer Heaven, and shook the Throne of *Jove*.

2.1135

When Monsters rose, and at a wondrous Birth

2.1136

In bigness equal to their Mother *Earth*,

2.1137

Vast Sons broke forth: But Thunder stopt their Course,

2.1138

And tumbling Mountains dasht the Rebels Force.

2.1139

*Typhorus* fell: Earth was too weak to save,

2.1140

And *War* and *He* lay buried in one Grave;

2.1141

Yet now he heaves in his *Aetnean* Tomb,

2.1142

And *Earth* still fears new struglings in her Womb

## The Eleventh house

2.1143

That next Heaven's topmost point, which riseth high,

2.1144

Almost it's equal in the middle Sky

2.1145

With fairer Hopes, and better Fortune blest,

2.1146

Erects its Head, and much excells the rest;

2.1147

Plac't near the highest *Hinge*, it riseth higher,

2.1148

This Empire's Seat, and almost fills desire:

2.1149

It's Title, the exalted Place may claim

2.1150

A glorious Patron, and as great a Name,

2.1151

Is *Happy*; *Happy*, if that word can fill

2.1152

The *Greek* Expression and commend my skill.

2.1153

Here *Jove* presides in all his Pomp and State, [*See fig. 9th*]

2.1154

And to this ruling *Fortune* trust thy Fate.

2.1155

Oppos'd, and next the bottom of the *Ball*

## The fifth House. See fig. 9th.

2.1156

There lies a *Seat* as wearied with its fall;

2.1157

And yet prepar'd, tho' with a world of Pain

2.1158

For other Labour, and to mount again:

2.1159

About to bear, and destin'd to obey

2.1160

The *Hinge*'s Power, submitting to its sway;

2.1161

Yet prest not by the *World*, it gives a Scope

2.1162

To haughty Thoughts, and still permits to hope

2.1163

In *Greek Demonie*: But our scanty Tongue

2.1164

Affords no proper word to grace my Song:

2.1165

Yet mind this *station*, it thy Thoughts may claim

2.1166

Observe its *Patron*, nor forget the Name:

2.1167

Tho' troublesome it seems, no toil refuse

2.1168

The *Labour*'s great, but equal'd by the *Vse*.

## The third and ninth Houses.

2.1169

Ith' *Ninth*, and *Third* gay strength and health Delight,

2.1170

Or Sickness arms its venom'd Darts for fight;

2.1171

Why Contraries should thus these *Seats* possess

2.1172

'Tis hard to find, but *Phoebus* aids my guess;

2.1173

The mighty *Patrons*, whom these *Seats* obey, [See fig. 9]

2.1174

In one determin'd time bear different sway

2.1175

And Day succeeds the Night, and Night the Day.

2.1176

That *Seat* which next the Highest *Hinge* doth lie

2.1177

The first declining from the middle Sky

## The ninth House.

2.1178

The *Sun* possesses: From his Rays we draw

2.1179

Our state of Health, He gives our Bodies Law:

2.1180

Its Title God.

## The third House.

2.1181

Oppos'd to this, which first begins to rise

2.1182

From Heaven's low bottom, and brings up Skies,

2.1183

A Seat appears just tipt with Light, and guides

2.1184

The Starry Night, in this the *Moon* presides.

2.1185

The *Moon* that sees her Brother's adverse Ray,

2.1186

That looks up to him as he guides the Day.

2.1187

And imitates his Influence the wrong way:

2.1188

She rules our Bodies, but her Face derives

2.1189

Moist rotting Powers, and wastes the Health *He* gives.

2.1190

It's Title *Goddess*: But how mean these words

2.1191

Compar'd with those, expressive *Greece* affords?

## The tenth House.

2.1192

But as for Heaven's *high top*, the utmost point

2.1193

Of Rising, and beginning of Descent,

2.1194

Where 'twixt the *Eastern* rise, and *Western* fall [See fig. 9]

2.1195

*Jove* hangs the *Beam* at which He weighs the Ball;



2.1196

This *Venus* graceth, here she seats her Throne,

2.1197

And in the World's high Face erects her own;

2.1198

That Face, whose awful force Mankind admires,

2.1199

And yields Obedience to her pleasing Fires:

2.1200

Her Charge is *Marriage*, for what else can prove

2.1201

The Office of the beauteous Queen of Love?

2.1202

Pleasure's her aim, yet she forgets her Ease,

2.1203

And puts on Providence on design to please.

2.1204

*Fortune*'s the station's Name; observe the Place;

2.1205

My *Muse* grows weary, and contracts her pace,

2.1206

Refusing to expatiate in her Race.

### The fourth House.

2.1207

But now go on, the *lowest point* of all

2.1208

The fixt Foundation of the solid Ball,

2.1209

Which looking upward, sees the circling Light,

2.1210

And lies it self immerst in deepest Night,

2.1211

Is Saturn's Seat; tho' once he rul'd above, [*See fig. 9*]

2.1212

Enjoy'd that Power, and fill'd the Throne of Jove;

2.1213

But thence thrown down, he makes his last retreat

2.1214

To this low place, and fills this humble Seat:

2.1215

Himself a Father, He pretends to bear

2.1216

Respect to *Fathers*, and makes Age *his* care:

2.1217

This only *station* double Cares enlarge,

2.1218

For *Sons* and *Fathers* Fortune are its charge:

2.1219

Severe and thrifty; This the *Greeks* proclaim

2.1220

*Demonium*, its power expressing in its Name,

## The first House.

2.1221

Now turn thine Eye, and view the *Eastern* Plain,

2.1222

The space whence Stars renew their Course again;

2.1223

Where moistned *Phoebus* from the Floods retires,

2.1224

Climbs up, and shakes the Water from his Fires,

2.1225

Then gathers Beauties, whose enlivening Heat

2.1226

First strike thee, *Mercury*, and refresh thy Seat. [See fig. 9]

2.1227

O happy Seat, on whom the Art that sways

2.1228

O're Heaven it self, bestows its <sup>112</sup> Authors rays!

2.1229

The Fates of *Children* this is doom'd to bear,

2.1230

And all the Hopes of Parents are its care.

## The seventh House.

2.1231

One *Seat* remains, from whose declining steep,

2.1232

The Stars fall headlong, and enjoy the Deep,

2.1233

Which turns the World, and now can only trace

2.1234

The back of *Phoebus*, that once view'd his Face:

2.1235

No wonder Nature doth this Seat bequeath

2.1236

To *Pluto*, and inexorable *Death*;

2.1237

For here the Day expires, this draws the light

2.1238

From all the World, and buries Day in Night,

2.1239

Nor is this all its care, on this depends,

2.1240

Faith, solid Constancy, and Friends,

2.1241

So great that *Place*'s power, which waste the Ray,

2.1242

Which takes in *Phoebus*, and puts out the Day.

2.1243

The *stations* these, to which in constant Course

2.1244

The Stars arriving give and take new Force,

2.1245

Where *Planets* touching as they wheel their round,

2.1246

Mix foreign Powers, and with their own confound:

2.1247

Admitted once they make the Seat their own,

2.1248

And turn Usurpers in another's Throne.

2.1249

But this, if Fate my Life and Health prolong,

2.1250

Shall make the <sup>113</sup> subject of a future Song:

2.1251

Now ends the Book, which hath describ'd at large

2.1252

The Heavenly Houses, Guardians, and their Charge;

2.1253

For which the Masters of the Art have found

2.1254

A proper *Name*, but of a foreign Sound;

2.1255

'Tis Octotopos.

2.1256

With mighty labour I these Rules prepare,

2.1257

Forgetting Pleasure, and possest with Care:

2.1258

So hard it is in numerous Verse to close

2.1259

Unwieldy Words, and smooth uneven Prose.

*The End of the Second Book.*

### Book III

*Manilius begins this Third Book as he did the Second, reckoning up and slighting the several Subjects which have imploy'd other Poets, and declaring his Design to be new and difficult: Then he proceeds to shew, 1. That the Twelve Signs of the Zodiack are the chief Disposers, and principal Governours of Fortunes. 2. That there are Twelve Lots belonging to these Twelve Signs. 3. He names and describes these Lots: The first is Fortune: The Second Warfare and Travelling: The Third, Civil Employments: The Fourth, Pleadings, and all the concerns of the Bar: The Fifth, Marriage Acquaintance, Guests: The Sixth, Plenty, Wealth, and the means of preserving it. The Seventh, Dangers: The Eighth, Nobility, Honour, Reputation: The Ninth, Children, Education. The Tenth, Manners, Institution, Family. The Eleventh, state of Health, Physick: The Twelfth, Wishes, and the ends of them. 4. He teaches how to suit these Lots, Labours, or Athla to the several Signs, when the Birth belongs either to Day, or Night. 5. He proposeth Rules how to find the Horoscope. 6. Refuting the Method prescrib'd by the Chaldaeans. 7. And shewing how to find the different lengths of Days and Nights, together with the several Risings and Settings of the Signs in order to find the Horoscope. 8. He resumes the Dispute against the Chaldaeans, and subjoins an Account of the several lengths of Days and Nights, in the three different Positions of the Sphere,*

*Direct, Oblique, and Parallel. 9. He proposes another way to find the time of the Signs Rising and Setting. 10. He particularly Discourses of the Days Encrease from Capricorn to Cancer. 11. He shews what are the proper Years, Months, Days, and Hours of the Signs, and Confutes the Opinion of some Astrologers concerning them. 12. He sings how many Years belong to each Sign, and station. 13. And Concludes the Book with an Account of the Tropick Signs. I am not to Answer for the Astronomy, it is enough if I have made the Poet speak intelligible English.*

3.1

Whilst I new ways attempt my groveling Name

3.2

To raise from Earth, and wing my Flight for Fame;

3.3

Thro' Woods untrodden whilst I take my way,

3.4

Ye Muses lead; for I extend your Sway

3.5

To larger Bounds, and make the World obey.

3.6

No Heaven's besieg'd, no Thunder thrown from far

3.7

Intombs the Giants, and concludes the War:

3.8

No fierce Achilles tells brave Hector's Spoil,

3.9

Nor Priam bears the Hero to his Pile.

3.10

No barbarous <sup>114</sup> Maid betrays her Father's trust,

3.11

Nor tears her Brother to secure her Lust.

3.12

No Bulls breath Fire, no Dragons guard the Prize,

3.13

Nor from the poysnous seed *Arm'd Harvests* rise:

3.14

No *Youth* returning here renews the *Old*,

3.15

Nor treacherous *Presents* carry *Flame* in Gold.

3.16

Nor will I sing the Babes *Medea* bore,

3.17

Got by much Guilt, but ah! destroy'd by more.

3.18

The *Theban* Siege, the highest Pride of Fame,

3.19

Nor how the Town by Thunder sav'd from Flame

3.20

Lost whilst it <sup>115</sup> conquer'd; nor how *Spartans* fought

3.21

Round old *Messana*, shall enlarge my thought.

3.22

No *Sons* <sup>116</sup> and *Brothers* shall be joyn'd in one,

3.23

Nor *Mother* bear a *Granchild* in a *Son*;

3.24

No *Murder'd Babes* <sup>117</sup> shall feast their injur'd *Sire*,

3.25

Nor *Days* break off, and frighted *Suns* retire.

3.26

None shall defy the *Sea*, the Floods enslave,

3.27

Sail o're the Mountains <sup>118</sup>, and walk o're the Wave:

3.28

No *Asian* Kings. And thee, O mighty *Rome*,

3.29

Thy *Arms*, thy *Conquests*, and thy *World* o'recome

3.30

Thy *Laws*, thy *Wars*, thy *Leagues* my Verse refuse,

3.31

Those claim the leisure of a greater Muse.

3.32

Smooth Seas the Artless Sailer safely tries,

3.33

And Flowers undress'd in fruitful Gardens rise;

3.34

He works securely, who in Gold designs,

3.35

When e'en the rude unpolisht Metal Shines;

3.36

On specious Subjects common Wits compose,

3.37

For where the Matter takes, the Fancy flows;

3.38

And every vulgar Author writes with ease,

3.39

Secure of Credit, where the Themes can please.

3.40

This way some take to Fame: Thro' Words unknown,

3.41

And things abstruse my *Muse* goes boldly on,

3.42

Observes all Interchange of Times, compares

3.43

The fatal turns, and views the Leagues of *Stars*,

3.44

Things so remote, so intermixt, and wrought



3.45

With Parts in Parts; they are too fine for thought.

3.46

To know them is too much, but to explain

3.47

How great! to bind in Verse shews more than Man.

3.48

Then come, who e're thou art that bring'st a Mind

3.49

To know high Truth, and patient Thoughts to find;

3.50

Hear solid Reason, and go on to gain

3.51

True serious Knowledge, but neglect the vain:

3.52

No Kings at *Aulis* sworn, no tales of *Troy*

3.53

With *Priam's* tears, or *Helen's* fatal Joy,

3.54

Nor hope sweet Verse, and curious turns to find,

3.55

I'll leave thy Passions, and instruct thy Mind:

3.56

And tho' some Words of foreign Stamp appear,

3.57

Seem harsh, untun'd, uneasie to thy Ear;

3.58

This is the *Subject's* not the *Writer's* fault,

3.59

Some things are stiff, and will not yield to thought;

3.60

I must be plain: And if our Art hath found

3.61

Expressions proper, it neglects the *Sound*.

3.62

Thy Mind well purg'd from vainer Cares compose,

3.63

For now my *Muse* is eager to disclose,

3.64

The nicest Secrets; which observ'd, impart

3.65

*Fate*'s Laws, and prove the surest Guides to Art.

## 1.

3.66

When *Nature* order'd this vast Frame to rise,

3.67

*Nature*, the Guardian of these Mysteries,

3.68

And scatter'd Lucid Bodies o'er the Skies;

3.69

When she the *Concave*, whence directly fall

3.70

Streight Lines of Influence round the solid *Ball*,

3.71

Had fill'd with Stars; and made *Earth*, Water, Air,

3.72

And *Fire*, each other mutually repair;

3.73

That Concord might these differing parts controul,

3.74

And Leagues of mutual Aid support the whole;

3.75

That nothing which the *Skies* embrace might be

3.76

From *Heaven's* supreme Command and Guidance free,

3.77

On *Man* the chiefest Object of her Cares

3.78

Long time she thought, then hung his Fates on *Stars*;

3.79

Those *Stars*, which plac'd i'th' Heart of Heaven, display

3.80

The brightest Beams, and share the greatest sway;

3.81

Which keep a constant Course, and now restrain

3.82

The *Planets* Power, now yield to them again;

3.83

Thus sometimes ruling, sometimes rul'd, create

3.84

The strange and various Intercourse of Fate.

3.85

To these her Powers wise Nature's Laws dispense

## 2. The twelve Lots of the twelve Signs.

3.86

Submitting all things to their Influence:

3.87

But then as *Emperours* their Realms divide,

3.88

And every Province hath its proper Guide,

3.89

So 'tis in *Signs*; they have not equal Shares

3.90

Of common Power, each *Fortune* claims its Stars.

3.91

Our Studies, Poverty, Wealth, Joy and Grief,

3.92

With all the other Accidents of Life

3.93

She parcels out; to proper Stars confines

3.94

The *Lots* in number equal to the Signs.

3.95

These grac'd with proper Names and Place contain

3.96

The various Fortunes incident to Man,

3.97

Yet so contriv'd, that they are always found

3.98

In the same <sup>119</sup> Order, in the fatal Round.

3.99

Yet are not *Lots* thus fixt to Signs to lie

3.100

Possessing the same <sup>120</sup> *Station* in the Sky;

3.101

And from one place directing down to Earth

3.102

An equal Influence work on every Birth;

3.103

But still the *Time* of every Birth confines

3.104

These *Lots* to Seats, and makes them change their Signs,

3.105

That every *Lot* from every *Sign* may flow,

3.106

And vary the *Nativity* below.

3.107

But lest Confusion too much Change produce,

3.108

And make the *Art* too intricate for *Vse*;

3.109

'Tis order'd thus:—

3.110

That when the Birth's first Minute hath decreed

3.111

The first *Lot*'s Station, then the rest succeed

3.112

In following *Signs*; each *Fortune* takes its Seat

3.113

In proper Order, till the *Round*'s compleat:

3.114

Take these short Rules till flowing Verse dilate,

3.115

Unfolding all the Mysteries of Fate.

3.116

These *Lots* which thus decreed to *Signs* contain

3.117

The various Fortunes incident to Man;

3.118

As *Planets* joyn with a malignant Ray,

3.119

Or Kind; or as the rolling Skies convey

3.120

To different *Hinges*, so the *Fortune* spreads,

3.121

And well or ill the whole Design succeeds:

## 3.

3.122

Their Names and Kinds obliging *Muse* rehearse,

3.123

And sing their Titles in no vulgar Verse,

3.124

That late Posterity with Joy may throng

3.125

To Themes unknown, and crowd to learn my Song.

## First Lot.

3.126

*Fortune's* the first: This Name our Art bestows,

3.127

And what it signifies the *Title* shows.

3.128

Here *House* is found, with all that may conduce

3.129

To *House*, either for Ornament or Use: [Vid. Fig. 11]

3.130

What train of *Servants*, what extent of *Field*

3.131

Shall aid the *Birth*, or give him room to build:

3.132

When large *Foundations* may be safely laid,

3.133

Or *Houses* roof'd; if Friendly *Planets* aid.

## Second Lot.

3.134

*Warfare's* the next: And 'tis in *This* decreed

3.135

How every *Native* shall in *Arms* succeed:

3.136

What Dangers wait them when abroad they roam,

3.137

To pick up Follies which they miss at home.

### Third Lot.

3.138

Civil Employments in the Third we find,

3.139

Tho those too justly may be styl'd a kind

3.140

Of *Warfare*; when two different Interests jarr,

3.141

Oppos'd in sides, and make a sort of War.

3.142

Here's *Patronage*, and here our Art describes

3.143

What breaks its bands, what draws the closer ties,

3.144

Shows what Rewards our Services may gain,

3.145

And how too often we may court in vain:

3.146

All this as *Planets* friendly Aids conspire,

3.147

Or temper *Signs* with their unlucky Fire.

## Fourth Lot.

3.148

Proceed, my *Muse*, for in the *next* appear

3.149

The *Court* Concerns, and Fortunes of the Bar,

3.150

The pleading *Patron* with the fearful Throng

3.151

Of trembling *Clients* hanging on his Tongue.

3.152

The smooth Perswader who shall teach the Laws,

3.153

And settle Right, whilst Truth supports the Cause;

3.154

For from this *Lot* the *Planets* Rays dispense

3.155

The various Powers of winning *Eloquence*.

3.156

The *Fifth* to Marriage Sacred yet pretends

## Fifth Lot.

3.157

To Guests, Acquaintance, Company, and Friends;

3.158

Here we discern the Common League that binds

3.159

The Equal Souls, and joyns agreeing Minds.

## Sixth Lot.

3.160



But in the *sixth*, rich Plenty takes her Throne,

3.161

With *Preservation*: And from *this* 'tis known

3.162

What stores of Wealth shall come, how long their stay,

3.163

As *Planets* tamper with their ruling Ray:

3.164

The *Seventh* in horrid *Dangers* shall engage

### Seventh Lot.

3.165

The Birth, if *Planets* not correct its Rage.

### Eighth Lot.

3.166

The *Eighth* Nobility pretends to claim,

3.167

Where *Honour* sits with her attendant *Fame*;

3.168

Where *Family* erect maintains her Place,

3.169

And smiling *Favour* with her winning Face.

3.170

The *Ninth* the doubtful Lot of *Children* bears

### Ninth Lot.

3.171

With all the Pious *Parents* hopes and Fears,

3.172

The *Tutor's* Industry, and *Guardian's* Cares.

## Tenth Lot.

3.173

The *next* to this the *Act of Life* contains,

3.174

And shews how far a good Example reigns:

3.175

How by their *Masters* form'd *Slaves* take their way

3.176

To Tasks assign'd, and chearfully Obey.

## Eleventh Lot.

3.177

The *following* is a *Lot* of high concern,

3.178

For hence the state of *strength* and *Health* we learn,

3.179

When griev'd, we live obnoxious to Disease,

3.180

Or free from Sickness, and consign'd to Ease:

3.181

Let none who value Health, this *Lot* refuse,

3.182

When they would time for wholesome *Physick* choose;

3.183

For hence we are with most exactness taught

3.184

To gather Drugs, or mix the saving Draught.

## Twelfth Lot.

3.185

The *Last*, and which the Round concludes, contains

3.186

The *End* of all our Wishes and our Pains,

3.187

Shews if to what our several Aims address

3.188

Obtain'd, shall crown our Studies with Success;

3.189

Whether with fauning Arts we court the Great,

3.190

Or shunning Crouds, to Privacy retreat;

3.191

Whether we Plead at the Contentious Barr,

3.192

Or Plough the Sea, and gather Wealth from far;

3.193

Or tear the Earth, to crowd our stores with Grain,

3.194

Or bring unruly *Bacchus* to the Press again.

3.195

For these, if *Planets* prosper the Effect,

3.196

You may fit moments, and fit Days expect

3.197

From this one *Lot*, and all the rest neglect.

3.198

These *Planets* 8 Powers, and how their Rays infuse,

3.199

Or Good, or Bad, shall then engage my Muse,

3.200

When their Effects she Sings—

3.201

But now lest hudled things confusedly wrought,

3.202

Distract thy Mind, and discompose thy Thought;

3.203

Let Verse in Method orderly impart

3.204

The single naked Elements of Art;

3.205

And since my ventrous Muse hath bound in Rhime,

3.206

The various *Labours* of the *Round* of Time,

3.207

(What *Greece* calls *Athla*, happy *Greece* in Song,

3.208

Are now call'd *Labours* in a meaner Tongue)

3.209

Which to Twelve *Lots* conveniently assign'd

3.210

Determine all the *Fortune* of Mankind:

#### IV. How the Lots are to be suited to the Signs.

3.211

Her Theme pursuing, she will next comprise

3.212

The several *Signs* with which the *Labours* rise;

3.213

For to one *Seat* they are not always ty'd,

3.214

Nor from one *Sign* at every Birth preside;

3.215

They change their *station*, as the Round they move,

3.216

Yet still their *Order* is the same above.

3.217

But lest you should imperfect *Schemes* compleat,

3.218

Nor justly suit each *Labour* to its Seat;

3.219

First find the place by *Fortune's Lot* possesset,

3.220

(*Fortune* the first, and Leader of the rest)

3.221

That done, to following *Signs* in order join

3.222

The *Lots*, and give each *Labour* to its *Sign*:

3.223

And to secure thy search for *Fortune's* place

3.224

Two Rules shall guide thee, and enfold the Maze.

When the Birth belongs to Day.

3.225

The moment known when first the Birth began,

3.226

The *Planets* join'd to *Signs* to form the Plan,

3.227

And *Scheme* erected for the future Man;

3.228

If then the *Sun* with an exalted Ray

3.229

Above the *East* and *West* commands his way,

3.230

Then safely fix, and give the Birth to *Day*:

3.231

But if through lower Skies he wheels the Light,

3.232

The *Day* resigns, and yields the Birth to *Night*.

3.233

This settled, if the Birth belongs to *Day*,

3.234

The Rule is short, and not obscure the Way;

3.235

From that Degree, where then the <sup>121</sup> *Sun* presides,

3.236

To that Degree where gloomy *Luna* rides:

3.237

Count thro' the *following signs*, and as you pass,

3.238

Exactly mark what Numbers fill the space:

3.239

Thence from the *Eastern point*, which artful *Greece*

3.240

Hath stil'd the *Horoscope*, an equal number of Degrees,

3.241

Following the circling *Zodiack* as it bends,

3.242

Count thro' the *Signs*; and where the Number ends,

3.243

There fix the Seat of *Fortune*; thence confine

3.244

In order, every *Labor* to its *Sign*.

3.245

But if when *Night* her sable Wings hath spread,

## When to Night.

3.246

The Birth starts forward from his Genial Bed;

3.247

In different manner, then thy Numbers range,

3.248

With *Nature's* Order, let thy <sup>122</sup> *Method* change;

3.249

The *Moon*, who imitates her Brother's Light,

3.250

And governs in her own Dominion, *Night*,

3.251

Observe: Thence thro' the *Signs* in order run,

3.252

To find how far she's distant from the Sun.

3.253

The *Native's* *Horoscope* be next thy Care,

3.254

And from that Point, begin to count as far

3.255

As those Degrees permit thy Thoughts to pass;

3.256

And where they stop, there settle *Fortune's* place.

3.257

And then to following *Signs* the rest confine

3.258

In order, every *Labor* to its *Sign*.

## V. How to find the Horoscope

3.259

Perhaps these *Precepts* may appear too nice,

3.260

For who can find the *Horoscope* in Skies

3.261

Immense, still circling with impetuous force,

3.262

In Motion restless, and so swift in Course?

3.263

Yet this not rightly fixt, our Art can boast

3.264

No certainty, and all our *Labour's* lost:

3.265

As wretched Travellers are doom'd to stray,

3.266

When those mistake, who should direct the Way.

3.267

Because the *Points* which all the rest controul,

3.268

Misplac'd at first, must influence the whole,

3.269

And since the rouling Skies move swiftly on,

3.270

A different Face is every moment shown,

3.271

The *Scheme* must be uncertain, and the *Birth* unknown.

3.272

Yet tho' of greatest Vse, 'tis hard to gain

3.273

This Knowledge; and our Search is oft in vain:



3.274

For who can in his narrow Breast comprise

3.275

The World immense, and who observe the Skies,

3.276

Which with eternal Revolutions move,

3.277

And Circling, measure the vast Orb above?

3.278

What Diligence can e're describe its Face,

3.279

What Art can fix in so immense a space?

3.280

Those Points where *East* and *West* exactly fall,

## VI. The Chaldaeans refuted.

3.281

Which Crowns the Top, and which supports the Ball?

3.282

I know the Method, the <sup>123</sup> *Chaldaean* Schools

3.283

Prescribe, but who can safely trust their Rules?

3.284

To each ascending Sign, to find their Powers,

3.285

They *equal* time allow, that time *two Hours*:

3.286

And then from that Degree, from which the Sun

3.287

Begins to start, his daily Course to run,

3.288

Two Hours to each succeeding *Sign* they give,

3.289

Still thus allowing, 'till their search arrive

3.290

At the Degree and Sign they seek, for where

3.291

The Number ends, the *Horoscope* is there.

3.292

But false the Rule; Oblique the *Zodiack* lies,

## The first Argument against the Chaldaeans.

3.293

And Signs as near, or far remov'd in Skies,

3.294

Obliquely mount, or else directly rise:

3.295

In *Cancer*, so immense his *Round*, the Ray

3.296

Continues long, and slowly ends the Day;

3.297

Whilst Winter's *Caper* in a shorter Track

3.298

Soon wheels it round, and hardly brings it back:

3.299

*Aries* and *Libra*, equal Day with Night,

3.300

Thus *middle* <sup>124</sup> Signs to the *Extreams* are opposite

3.301

And Signs *Extream* too, vary in their Light.

3.302

Nor are the *Nights* less various than the *Days*

3.303

Equal their measure, only Darkness sways,

3.304

In Signs <sup>125</sup> adverse to those that bore the Rays:

3.305

Then who can think when Days and Nights are found,

3.306

In length so differing thro' the Yearly Round,

3.307

There should be given to every Sign in Skies,

3.308

An *equal* Space, an *equal* Time to rise?

3.309

But more than this: The <sup>126</sup> Hours no certain space

## The Second Argument.

3.310

Of time contain, but vary with the Days:

3.311

Yet every Day in what e're Sign begun,

3.312

Beholds six Signs above the *Horizon*,

3.313

Leaves six below; and therefore Rules despise,

3.314

Because the Hours no equal time comprise,

3.315

Which give *two Hours* to every Sign to rise.

3.316

The Hours in number *Twelve* divide the Day,

3.317

And yet the Sun with an unequal Ray

3.318

Now makes a shorter, now a longer stay.

3.319

Nay farther, tho' you many ways pursue

## VII. How to find the different lengths of Days and Nights, and to find the Horoscope.

3.320

To find their length you'l never meet the true,

3.321

But thus: Take all that space of time the Sun

3.322

Meets out, when every daily Round is Run,

3.323

Let equal Portions next that time divide;

3.324

And then those Portions orderly apply'd

3.325

To Days, will shew their length, from thence appears

3.326

Their varying Measures through the rouling Years.

3.327

The Standard this, by which our Art Essays

3.328

Winter's slow Nights, and tries the Summer's Days.

3.329

This must be fixt, when from th' *Autumnal* Scales,

3.330

The Day declines, and *Winter's* Night prevails:

3.331

Or in the *Ram* whence *Winter's* Nights retire

3.332

The Hours restoring to the *Summer's* Fire:

3.333

In those two Points, the Day and Night contain

3.334

Twelve equal Hours. For with an even rein

3.335

The *Sun* then guides, and whilst his Care doth roul

3.336

Thro' Heaven's midd Line, he leans to neither *Pole*:

3.337

But when remov'd, he to the *South* declines,

3.338

And in the <sup>127</sup> Eighth Degree of *Caper* shines,

3.339

The *Winter's* hasty Day moves nimbly on,

3.340

Nine <sup>128</sup> Hours and half; so soon the Light is gone.

3.341

But Night drives slowly in her gloomy Carr,

3.342

Takes fourteen Hours and half for her unequal share;

3.343

Thus twice twelve Hours in Day and Night are found,

3.344

To fill the natural Measure of the daily Round.

3.345

Thence Light encreases still, as Nights decay,

3.346

'Till *Cancer* meets her in the Fiery way,

3.347

And sets sure bounds to her encroaching sway.

3.348

Then turns the Scene, and *Summers* day descends

3.349

Thro' *Winter's* Hours, still losing as it bends:

3.350

And then the Days of equal length appear,

3.351

With Nights, 'th' adverse Season of the Year,

3.352

And *Nights* with *Days*: For by the same Degrees

3.353

That once they lengthened, now the Times decrease,

3.354

These Times our Art can shew, but these belong

3.355

To future Rhimes, and claim another Song.

3.356

Thus measure those, who live where fruitful *Nile*,

3.357

With *Summer* Torrents swoln o'reflows the Soil;

3.358

Whose seven large Mouths; the Skies can boast no more

The rising and Setting of the Signs first. By  
Stadia: and Hours.

3.359

Of *Planets*, vomit with impetuous Roar,

3.360

And beat the Ocean from the foaming Shore.

3.361

Now learn what <sup>129</sup> *Stadia*, learn what times in Skies

3.362

Signs ask to *Sett*, and what they claim to *Rise*:

3.363

Observe, *short* rules my *Muse*, but *full* she brings,

3.364

And *Words* roul from Her, crowded up with *Things*.

3.365

For *Aries*, Prince of all the Signs comprise

3.366

Full *forty Stadia*, for his time to rise,

3.367

But *Eighty* give him when He leaves the Skies:

3.368

One Hour, and one third part his rise compleats,

3.369

This space of time, He doubles when He sets.

3.370

The following Signs to *Libra rising*, claim

3.371

Eight *Stadia* more, and *Setting* lose the same.

3.372

And thus in order following Signs require

3.373

Still sixteen Minutes more to raise their Fire,

3.374

And lose as much, when setting they retire:

3.375

Thus signs to *Libra*, <sup>130</sup> as they rise increase;

3.376

And thus they lose when they descend to Seas:

3.377

For all the Signs that do from *Libra* range,

3.378

Take equal measures, but the Order change;

3.379

For Signs adverse to equal times engross,

3.380

But setting Gain, and still arise with loss.

3.381

Thus *Hours* and *Stadia* which bright *Aries* gets

3.382

When rising, *Libra* loseth when she sets;

3.383

And all the time, which when He leaves the Skies,

3.384

The *Ram* possesses, *Libra* takes to rise:

3.385

By this Example, all the rest define,

3.386

The following imitate the leading Sign.

3.387

This rightly fixt, if you these Rules pursue,

3.388

The *Horoscope* lies open to thy view;

3.389

Securely work, since you can fix in Skies

3.390

The times, and *Stadia*, for the Signs to rise:

3.391

From that Degree and Sign, in which the *Sun*

3.392

Begins to start, his daily Course to run,



3.393

Count fairly on, and all the work is done.

3.394

Another method, if you this refuse,

## Another Method.

3.395

Shall lead thee right, and be as plain to use:

3.396

For if the *Horoscope* you seek by Day,

3.397

Observe these Rules, which shew the surest Way;

3.398

First find what <sup>131</sup> Hour, the Birth is born, and then

3.399

Add five to that, and multiply by Ten:

3.400

Add five, for every Hour the Signs ascend

3.401

Thrice five Degrees, in the Celestial Bend:

3.402

This done, take that Degree in which the Sign

3.403

Then rous the Sun, and to this Number join;

3.404

From this whole Sum, one *Thirty* parts apply'd

3.405

To the Sun's Sign, nor to the rest deny'd,

3.406

As following they in order lie, will show

3.407

The thing you sought for, and design to know:

3.408

For where the Number ends, that *Sign* and *Part*

3.409

Is *Horoscope*: Thus speak the Rules of Art.

3.410

By *Night* your search demands a different way;

3.411

To the *Nights* Hour, <sup>132</sup> add all the twelve of *Day*,

3.412

From this whole Sum the *Thirty* parts apply

3.413

To following *Signs* as they in order lie;

3.414

And where the Number ends, that *Sign* and *Part*

3.415

Is *Horoscope*: Thus speak the Rules of Art.

3.416

Thus you may find the *Horoscope* in Skies,

3.417

And tho' *Oblique* the Circling *Zodiack* lies,

3.418

This Point determin'd, you may fix them all,

3.419

What Crowns the *Top*, and what supports the Ball:

3.420

The *Signs* true Setting, and true Rising trace,

3.421

Assign to each their proper Powers and Place,

3.422

And thus what stubborn Nature's Laws deny,

3.423

Our Art shall force, and fix the rowling Skie.

### VIII. Third Argument against the Chaldaeans.

3.424

Nor is o're all the Earth, the length of *Night*,

3.425

And *Day* the same; they vary with the sight;

3.426

Nor, would the *Ram* alone and *Scales* agree,

3.427

In *Day* and *Night*; in every *Sign* would be

3.428

The *Equinox*, if as these Rules devise,

3.429

*Two Hours* were given to every *Sign* to rise.

### The length of Days and Nights in a Direct Sphere.

3.430

In that Position where *Direct*'s the Sphere,

3.431

And in the *Horizon* both Poles appear;

3.432

The *Day* maintains an equal length to *Night*,

3.433

And that Usurps not on the others Right:

3.434

No Inequality in Skies is found,

3.435

But equal *Day*, and equal *Night* goes round.

3.436

Those Days and Nights which Spring and Autumn bear,

3.437

They see unvary'd thro' the rowling Year,

3.438

Because the circling *Sun* in every Sign

3.439

Runs round, and measures still an equal Line;

3.440

Whether thro' *Cancer*'s height he bears the Day,

3.441

Or thro' the *Goat* oppos'd He bends his way,

3.442

The *Day*'s alike, nor do the *Nights* decay.

3.443

For tho' Oblique the *Zodiack* Circle lies,

3.444

Yet all the *Zones* do at right Angles rise

3.445

Still Parallel; and whilst the Sphere is *Right*

3.446

Half Heaven is Hid, and half expos'd to sight.

### In an Oblique Sphere.

3.447

Hence take thy way, and o're Earth's mighty Bend

3.448

From this midst Region move to either End,

3.449

As weary Steps convey thee up the Ball

3.450

By Nature rounded and hung midst the All

3.451

To either Pole; whilst you your way pursue

3.452

Some parts withdraw, and others rise to view.

3.453

To you thus mounting as the Earth doth rise

3.454

So varies the Position of the Skies,

3.455

And all the Signs that rose *Direct* before

3.456

*Obliquely* mount, and keep that Site no more;

3.457

Oblique the *Zodiack* grows, for whilst we range,

3.458

Tho fixt its place, yet ours we freely change;

3.459

'Tis therefore plain that here the Days must prove

3.460

Of different Lengths, since Signs *obliquely* move,

3.461

Some nearer roul, whilst some remoter rove,

3.462

And measure still unequal Rounds above.

3.463

As nearer to the *Arctick* Round you go

On this side the Arctick Circle.

3.464

The Hours increase, and Day appears to grow;

3.465

The *Summer* Signs in ample Arch invade

3.466

Our Sight, the *Winter* lie immerst in Shade;

3.467

The more you *Northward* move, the more your Eyes

3.468

Their Lustre lose; they set as soon as rise:

### Beyond the Arctick Circle.

3.469

But pass this *Round*, as you your way pursue,

3.470

Each Sign withdraws with all its parts from view,

3.471

Then Darkness comes, and chaces Light away,

3.472

And thirty Nights excludes the Dawn of Day:

3.473

Thus by degrees Day wasts, Signs cease to rise,

3.474

For bellying Earth still rising up denies

3.475

Their Light a Passage, and confines our Eyes.

3.476

Continued Nights, continued Days appear,

3.477

And *Months* no more fill up the rouling Year.

3.478

Should Nature place us where the *Northern* Skies

## In an erect or parallel Sphere.

3.479

Creak round the Pole, and grind the propping *Ice*;

3.480

Midst Snows eternal, where th' impending *Bear*

3.481

Congel'd leans forward on the frozen Air;

3.482

The World would seem, if we survey'd the whole,

3.483

*Erect*, and standing on the nether Pole.

3.484

Its sides, as when a *Top* spins round, incline

3.485

Nor here nor there, but keep an even Line,

3.486

And there *Six Signs* of *Twelve* would fill the sight

3.487

And never setting at an *equal* Hight,

3.488

Wheel with the Heavens, and spread a constant Light.

3.489

And whilst thro' those the Sun directs his way

3.490

For long Six Months with a continued Ray

3.491

He chases Darkness, and extends the Day.

3.492

But when the Sun below the *Line* descends

3.493

With full Career, and to the lower bends,

3.494

Then one long Night continued Darkness joins,

3.495

And whilst he wanders thro' the *Winter's* Signs

3.496

The *Arctick* Circle lies immerst in Shade,

3.497

And vainly calls to feeble Stars for Aid:

3.498

Because the Eyes that from the Pole survey

3.499

The bellying Globe, scarce measure half the way,

3.500

The Orb still rising stops the Sight from far,

3.501

And whilst we forward look, we find a Bar:

3.502

For from the Eyes the Lines *directly* fall,

3.503

And Lines *direct* can ne'er surround the Ball;

3.504

Therefore the Sun to those low Signs confin'd

3.505

Bearing all *Day* and leaving *Night* behind,

3.506

To those that from the *Pole* survey denies

3.507

His chearful Face, and Darkness fills their Eyes:

3.508

Till having spent as many Months, as past

3.509

Thro' Signs, he turns, and riseth to the *North* at last:



3.510

And thus, in this *Position* of the Sphere

3.511

*One* only Day, *one* only *Night* appear

3.512

On either side the *Line*, and make the Year.

3.513

What different sorts of Days and Nights are known

3.514

In all *Positions* thus my Muse hath shown;

3.515

Her Work goes on, and she must next comprise

3.516

What *Signs* appear, what *Times* they claim to rise

3.517

In all *Positions* of the moving Skies:

3.518

That when you follow Art, and boldly press

3.519

To find the *Horoscope*, a just Success

3.520

May meet thy search, and into knowledge raise thy guess.

3.521

But who can all their various times rehearse?

3.522

Compute so much, and state Accounts in Verse?

3.523

Therefore this part let general Rules define,

3.524

Let those that follow my advanc'd Design

3.525

Apply them right, but let the Rules be mine.

## 9. Another way to find the Trine the Signs Rising and Setting by Hours.

3.526

Where-ever plac'd; by these few Rules proceed,

3.527

By Nature settled, and by Art decreed;

3.528

First count how many <sup>133</sup> Hours compleat the Night

3.529

Or Day, when *Cancer* in the Summer's height

3.530

Bears *Phoebus*, and short darkness bounds the light.

3.531

Day's Hours by Six divide, one sixth devise

3.532

To following *Leo* as his time to rise:

3.533

Night so divided too one *Sixth* bestow

3.534

On *Taurus*, that his rising time will show:

3.535

But then observe the *difference* of the time

3.536

Which *Leo* takes, and which the *Bull* to climb,

3.537

That into *Three* divide, and thence apply,

3.538

Beside the time which *Taurus* takes to mount the Sky,

3.539

One single Third to Naked *Gemini*.

3.540

The like to *Cancer*, and the like Account

3.541

To fiery *Leo* as his time to mount;

3.542

Then reckon all, you'll find the Sum the same

3.543

Which from the first Division to *Leo* came,

3.544

When one *sixth* part of *Day* was given to raise his Flame.

3.545

By the same Method *Virgo*'s time define:

3.546

But this Condition runs thro' every Sign,

3.547

The following keeps those Hours the Sign before

3.548

Obtain'd to rise, and vulgarly adds more:

3.549

As these an orderly Encrease maintain,

3.550

So Signs from *Libra* still decrease again;

3.551

But different Order they observe in Skies,

3.552

The Hours these claim to Set, those take to *Rise*.

By *Stadia*.

3.553

But if you count by *Stadia*, change the Name,

3.554

But keep the Method, for the Rule's the same:

3.555

Seven Hundred Twenty Stadia *fill the Round*,

3.556

No more in Day, no more in Night are found:

3.557

Hence take as many as compleat the Night,

3.558

When glowing *Cancer* in the Summer's hight

3.559

Bears *Phoebus*, and short darkness bounds the light.

3.560

The rest by *Six* divide, one *Sixth* devise

3.561

To fiery *Leo* as his time to rise;

3.562

Night's *Stadia* so divide, one *Sixth* bestow

3.563

On *Taurus*: Take the *Difference* twixt the Two,

3.564

That Sum divide by *Three*, and thence apply,

3.565

Beside the *Stadia Taurus* takes to mount the Sky,

3.566

One single *Third* to naked *Gemini*.

3.567

Thus to the rest proceed, but still confine

3.568

To following Signs the *Stadia* of the former Sign,

3.569

With one *Third Part*'s Encrease; till *Libra*'s Ray

3.570

This Reckoning stops, and shews another way:

3.571

For Signs from *Libra* different Rules comprise,

3.572

A different Order they observe in Skies,

3.573

The *Stadia* others claim to *Set* they take to *Rise*.

3.574

Those *Stadia* too in which the rest ascend

3.575

These *Winter* Signs in slowly setting spend.

3.576

Thus having fixt the *Stadia*, now pursue

3.577

The *Horoscope*, 'tis open to thy view;

3.578

From that Degree in which the Sun doth mount

3.579

Observe my Method, and begin to count;

3.580

Give proper *Hours* to every Sign to rise,

3.581

And proper *Stadia* to ascend the Skies,

3.582

Work by those Rules which I have shewn before,

3.583

Securely work, for you can err no more.

## 10. How Days encrease from Capricorn to Cancer.

3.584

By what advance the Winter Months encrease,

3.585

(For they advance not by the same Degrees

3.586

Thro' every Sign, till on the *Ram* they light,

3.587

Which equals Time, and Day adjusts to Night)

3.588

Must next be shewn to all that press to learn,

3.589

Short are the Rules, but yet of great Concern.

3.590

First take the measure of the shortest Day

3.591

And longest Night, when with unequal Ray

3.592

Thro' *Caper Phoebus* drives the narrow way.

3.593

Then count the <sup>134</sup> Hours which Day must yield to Shade,

3.594

And in three Portions let the Sum be laid;

3.595

One of these Parts to th' *Middle Sign* apply'd

3.596

Shews the Increase of Day on either side:

3.597

For as the *First* is by the *Midst* surpass'd

3.598

One *Half*, so that's exceeded by the *last*.

3.599

Thus thro' *Three Signs* the Day's Increase is shown,

3.600

The following takes what to the Last was grown,

3.601

And adds an equal Portion of its own.

3.602

For Instance: To the Conquest Night assign

3.603

Full *Fifteen* Hours, and give the Day but *Nine*:

3.604

Three Hours the difference. Now the Goat hath Power

3.605

To lengthen Day the space of *half an Hour*,

3.606

One Hour *Aquarius* adds, the *Fishes* joyn

3.607

As much as Both, and with the rest combine;

3.608

Thus three Hours fill'd, adjusted Time they bring

3.609

To *Aries*; and he equals Day and Night in Spring.

3.610

The *Sixth* part of the Time, or more or less,

3.611

Whate're it proves, is the first *Sign's* Increase;

3.612

The *Second* doubles what the *First* surpass'd,

3.613

And gives it to be *trebled* by the last.

3.614

But from the <sup>135</sup> *Equinoctial* point the Day

3.615

Receives increase, but in another way;

3.616

For *Aries* takes as many Hours from Night,

3.617

As *Pisces* seiz'd before in their own Right;

3.618

And to compleat the Rapine *Taurus* joins

3.619

One Hour, one Half is added by the *Twins*;

3.620

Thus whilst these Signs the Time to *Day* restore,

3.621

*Night* justly loses, as it gain'd before.

3.622

From *Caper* thus *Decreasing* Nights appear,

3.623

And Heaven turns up the right side of the Year;

3.624

The Day proceeds to lengthen all the way,

3.625

Till high in *Cancer* rais'd it finds a Stay;

3.626

The *Solstice* then: when *Day* and *Night* are found

3.627

Equal to *Night* and *Day* that drove the Winter round.

3.628

Then by the same degrees again the Light

3.629

Decreasing, what it took returns to Night.

3.630

Thus far advanc't in Art my Verse defines

## 11. The Years, Months, Days, and Hours of Signs.

3.631



The proper *Years, Months, Hours, and Days* of Signs:

3.632

These must be shewn; for Signs have Days & Hours,

3.633

And Months, and Years when they exert their Powers.

3.634

First then, that Sign in which the *Sun* appears,

3.635

Because the Sun measures out the time in *Years*,

3.636

Claims the first Year: On following Signs bestow

3.637

The following Years as they in Order go.

3.638

And so the *Moon*, for as she rounds the Skies,

3.639

She measures *Months*, to Signs the Months applies.

3.640

Of *Days* and *Hours* the *Horoscope* possest

3.641

Of the first parts, to following. Signs commits the rest.

3.642

This Nature orders, all her *Months* and *Years*,

3.643

And *Days*, and *Hours*, she parcels out to Stars;

3.644

That as they run their Course they all may find

3.645

The different Signs, and vary in their kind.

3.646

This Nature orders too; and hence there springs

3.647

That various Discord that is seen in Things;

3.648

In one continued Stream no *Fortune* flows,

3.649

Joy mixes Grief, and Pleasures urg'd by Woes:

3.650

Inconstancy in every part appears,

3.651

Which Wisdom never trusts, but Folly fears.

3.652

Thus Years from Years, and as they roul the round

3.653

The Months from Months, and Days from Days are found

3.654

To differ; no returning Hours restore

3.655

That sort of *Fortune* which they brought before:

3.656

Because the *Times*, as round their Course they run,

3.657

Meet different Signs, and are not bound to One;

3.658

The Days and Hours their ruling Signs obey,

3.659

The Month's the influence which they give convey

3.660

And temper all things by their fatal Ray.

## Some Astrologers Opinion. concerning the Years, Months and Days of Signs.

3.661

Some Author's Write, (for who can hope to see

3.662

Opinions join, or find the World agree?)

3.663

That from the *Horoscope* our Art defines

3.664

The Days, the Hours, the Years, and Months of Signs;

3.665

From that alone let the Account begin,

3.666

And all the rest will orderly fall in:

3.667

And whilst the others, as before 'twas shown,

3.668

*Three* Heads of reckoning ask, the *Moon*, the *Sun*,

3.669

And *Horoscope*, these still demand but *One*:

3.670

Yet still as great, their difference must appear,

3.671

Month disagrees with Month, and Year with Year,

3.672

And Hours and Days: For with uneven pace,

3.673

Tho' starting all together, they run the Race,

3.674

And never make Returns in equal space:

3.675

Twice to the Signs each <sup>136</sup> Hour the Days restore

3.676

Twice every Month, brings round the Days, and more:

3.677

Once every Year the Months to Signs are born,

3.678

And when Twelve Years are run, the Years return.

## Refuted.

3.679

'Tis hard to think, and Nature's Laws reject

3.680

One *single Time*, so differing in effect:

3.681

That when *one Sign* for *Years* and *Months* appears,

3.682

Bad Fate should clog the *Months*, Good Crown the *Years*:

3.683

Or that the *Sign* which thro' the *Months* conveys

3.684

Bright Fortune, should with Black infest the Days:

3.685

Or that the *Star*, which with afflicting Power,

3.686

The *Day* oppreseth, should exalt the Hour.

3.687

Vain therefore their attempt, who fondly hope,

3.688

The *Times* to reckon from the *Horoscope*,

3.689

And think because with an unequal Date,

3.690

They come to *Signs*, that these Returns create

3.691

Their different, odd varieties of Fate.

3.692

Absurd Opinion! which with fruitless pain,

3.693

They strive to prop with mighty Names in vain,

3.694

It sinks, and falls with its own stupid weight again.

## 12. How many Years belong to each Sign and Station.

3.695

This sung, and Times to Signs apply'd, the Muse

3.696

Would beg release, and further Task refuse;

3.697

But lo the Subject grows: The next must show

3.698

What length of Times the several Signs bestow:

3.699

This must be known when in your search for Fate

3.700

You measure Life, and fix the gloomy Date.

3.701

Ten Years and One, but one third part withdrawn,

3.702

The <sup>137</sup> *Ram* extends the wretched Life of Man;

3.703

Poorly he gives, as frugal of his Store,

3.704

Whilst *Taurus* adds two Years to these; the *Twins* two more.

3.705

Full sixteen Years Eight Months, from *Cancer* flow,

3.706

But two Years more the *Lion's* rays bestow.

3.707

From *Virgo* twenty Years, eight Months convey'd,

3.708

Enlarge the Birth: The *Scales* give equal to the *Maid*:

3.709

*Scorpio's* as much as *Leo's* Rays dispense,

3.710

The *Centaur* equals *Cancer's* influence:

3.711

Of Years, twice seven, eight Months the *Goat* conveys;

3.712

Though young *Aquarius* shines with feebler rays,

3.713

Four Years he *trebles*, and *doubles* six score Days.

3.714

To the same space, with which the *Ram* began,

3.715

The *Fish* plac't, next extend the Age of Man.

3.716

But farther yet, 'tis not enough to know

3.717

The length of time which *single signs* bestow;

3.718

For you may Err, when in your search for Fate,

3.719

You measure Life, and fix the gloomy Date;

3.720

Because the Heavenly Stations claim their share,

3.721

As *Planets* intermix their Force declare,

3.722

In this Contrivance, and make Life their Care.

3.723

To *single stations* now what Years belong,

3.724

(With *Planets* join'd, they claim <sup>138</sup> another Song)

3.725

In well wrought Numbers let the *Muse* impart,

3.726

And teach the simplest Elements of Art;

3.727

This done, these things prepar'd and sitly join'd,

3.728

With greater Ease, she'll raise the Work design'd,

3.729

If when the *Moon* is in the Hinge at *East*,

3.730

The Birth breaks forward from its native rest;

3.731

Full Eighty Years, if you two Years abate,

3.732

This *Station* gives, and long defers its Fate:

3.733

But if in Heav'ns midst point, this large Decree

3.734

She shortens, giving fewer Years by three:

3.735

With Eighty Courses in the *Zodiack* Round,

3.736

Substracting Four, the *Western Hinge* is Crown'd.

3.737

The lowest *Hinge* on all its Births, derives

3.738

Years sixty two, and then concludes their Lives. [Vid. Fig. 9]

3.739

The *ninth*, which makes upon the Right the *Trine*,

3.740

Gives sixty Years, and bates but *One* of *Nine*.

3.741

The *Fifth* o'th' *Left*, as frugal of its store,

3.742

Gives sixty *three*, and can enlarge no more;

3.743

Th' *Eleventh* station, that which rises high,

3.744

Almost an equal of the *Middle Skie*,

3.745

Yields six score Springs, and lest that Gift should be

3.746

Too scanty, lengthens that vast Summ by *Three*.

3.747

The *Third* which lies at equal space below

3.748

The *Eastern* point, doth *fifty* Years bestow,

3.749

Mean is the station, and its Gift is so.

3.750

The second *Forty* Courses of the *Sun*,

3.751

And two bestows, and when that term is done,



3.752

The Man goes off, e're half his race be run.

3.753

The *Twelfth* gives *twenty three*, then hasty Death,

3.754

Comes on, and in his Bloom, the Youth resigns his Breath.

3.755

The *Eighth* next o're the *Western* Hinge can bring

3.756

But *fourteen* Years, nor adds another Spring.

3.757

The *sixth* but *Twelve* bestows, then Death destroys

3.758

The Parents Hopes, and crops the growing Boys;

3.759

Diseases following, from their Birth create

3.760

A feeble Frame, and sit the Prey for Fate.

3.761

Now nicely view the *Tropick* Signs that lie

### 13. The Tropick Signs

3.762

Oppos'd in the four Quarters of the Skie;

3.763

Call'd *Tropick Signs*, because when these appear,

3.764

The World then *Turns* the Seasons of the Year:

3.765

Thus *Spring* in *Cancer*, in Autumnal *Scales*

3.766

The *Summer* turns, in *Caper* Autumn sails;

3.767

Thence shivering *Winter* creeps congeal'd with Frost,

3.768

Yet melts again; and in the *Ram* is lost:

3.769

These loose the Seasons, to their full Career,

3.770

And make the Course of the Revolving Year;

3.771

And these being Hingers of the World, create

3.772

New Powers in *Stars*; and fix new Rules for *Fate*.

## Cancer.

3.773

In Heavens high Arch, and on the utmost Line

3.774

Of *Summers* prograss, *Cancer* seats his Sign:

3.775

There stretches out the greatest length of Day,

3.776

And then declines, and makes it soon decay;

3.777

But all the time which, as he bears the Light

3.778

He takes from Day, He still conveys to Night.

3.779

Then Corn grows yellow on the fruitful Soil,

3.780

And lusty Reapers bare their Limbs for toil:

3.781

Then Seas grow warm, the Floods forbear to roar,

3.782

And Billows languish on the quiet Shore.

3.783

Then *Mars* goes forth, nor is the *Scythian* Coast

3.784

From *Roman* Arms defended by her Frost:

3.785

And whilst their Pools and Marshy Grounds are dry,

3.786

Fearing our Force, the conquer'd *Germans* fly:

3.787

Then *Nile* o'reflows, and *Egypt*'s fruitful Plain,

3.788

Rich Harvests yields, nor needs the aid of Rain.

3.789

Thus lies the World, when with exalted Ray,

3.790

I'th' *Summer Solstice* *Phoebus* bears the Day

3.791

Thro' *Cancer*'s Sign, and drives the highest Way.

3.792

Oppos'd the Goat in narrowest rounds of Light,

## Capricorn

3.793

Wheels *Winter* on, but long extends the Night;

3.794

Yet soon *Ascending*, He contracts the *Shade*,

3.795

To Day returning all the waste he made;

3.796

The Fields unwrought, then lie, unplough'd the Seas,

3.797

And *Mars* in Quarters, lies consign'd to *Ease*:

3.798

Rocks cleave with Frost; and by the Cold, oppress,

3.799

All Nature's Powers, are stiffned into Rest.

3.800

The next in Power are those two *Signs* that rise

3.801

With equal Revolutions of the Skies;

## Aries.

3.802

Which times of Day and Night adjust, and bring

3.803

The *Autumn* on, or else advance the *Spring*.

3.804

The *Sun* returning in his Yearly Race,

3.805

To *Cancer*'s *Sign* meets *Aries* midst the Space,

3.806

Seated between the Point, from whence he bends

3.807

His upward Course, and that in which he ends.

3.808

There plac'd as Umpire in the midst oth' way,

3.809

Contracted Night, he well adjusts to Day.

3.810

And as thro' him the *Sun* goes on to climb

3.811

The Heavenly steep, He makes a change in time;

3.812

For *Day*, that shorten'd in the *Winter* Bend,

3.813

The *Ram* first lengthens; and the next extend,

3.814

'Till rais'd in *Cancer*, to the utmost height

3.815

Of *Summer*'s pitch, He wheels the longest Light.

3.816

Then Seas lie husht: Then Earth grows bold to bear,

3.817

And trusts young Flowers to the serener Air:

3.818

Then Beasts in Fields, and Birds in every Grove,

3.819

Press on with Fury to consummate Love.

3.820

With joyful Songs the vocal Forests Ring,

3.821

And various Leaves adorn the gawdy Spring:

3.822

With such brisk Powers are Nature's parts possest,

3.823

When wak'd, she rouses from her *Winter*'s Rest.

3.824

Oppos'd to *Aries*, *Libra*'s Stars appear

## Libra.

3.825

With the like power to sway the rouling Year,

3.826

She equals *Day* and *Night*: But soon the *Scale*

3.827

O'repois'd by Darkness, lets the *Night* prevail;

3.828

And *Day*, that lengthned in the *Summer*'s height,

3.829

Shortens 'till *Winter*, and is lost in *Night*.

3.830

Then from the burthen'd *Elms*, the generous Vine

3.831

Descends, and Presses over-flow with Wine:

3.832

Then Wheat is sown, whilst *Autumn*'s heats remain

3.833

To loose the Clods, and mollifie the Grain.

3.834

These have their Powers, and as these *Signs* create

3.835

A turn in Seasons, so they doe in Fate:

3.836

From *Tropick Signs* (for by their name, we guess

3.837

Their *turning* Natures) who can hope for less?

3.838

But wide in their mistake, who think to see

3.839

These Powers spread equally in each Degree;

3.840

Not every Portion of the *Tropick Signs*

What Degrees in the Tropick Signs are to be  
considered.

3.841

Turns Seasons, and the *Planets* force confines,

3.842

But one *Day* only, in the blooming Prime

3.843

Of *Spring*, in Autumn *One* adjusts the Time,

3.844

One Day in *Aries* doth to Time restore

3.845

Equality, and *Libra* boasts no more;

3.846

One *Longest Day* in *Cancer's* Sign is born,

3.847

One *Night* of equal length in *Capricorn*:

3.848

The other *Days* roul on with different Light,

3.849

Now gaining from, now losing time to *Night*.

3.850

Thus *One Degree* in *Tropick Signs* creates

3.851

A change in Heaven, and turns the Rules of Fates;

3.852

No fixt Decree's secure, their boundless sway,

3.853

Extends to all, and makes the Stars obey.

3.854

But which that is that governs, *Fate's* Decree,

3.855

There Authors differ, nor can Art agree;

3.856

For some the *Eighth*, and some the *Tenth* assign,

3.857

The *First* Degree—is only Thine,

3.858

Thine, but the Muse with scorn, forbears the Name;

3.859

Unworthy mention, and too mean for Fame.

*The End of the Third Book.*

## Book IV

*After a short Reflection on the vain Cares of Mankind, he brings several Arguments to prove Fate: 1. Several unaccountable passages in the Roman and Grecian Histories: 2. Sudden Death, and unexpected Recoveries, contrary to all the powers of Art and Physick: 3. The difference between the Children of the same Parents: 4. The fewness of Worthy Men, and the certainty of Death: 5. The ill successes of Wise and Good Men, and the prosperity of Knaves and Fools 6. Monstrous Births: 7. Prophecy: And then endeavours, 8. to take off some Objections that might be rationally propos'd against this Doctrin: Then. 9. He shews what Tempers and Inclinations the twelve Signs singly consider'd do bestow, and to what Arts they incline: 10. Vnder the Ram, are born all sorts of workers in Wool, Broakers, Men of unsettled Fortunes, fearful, inconstant, and covetous of Praise: 11. Vnder the Bull, Plowmen, Aspiring, Reserv'd, Strong, and Amorous: 12. Vnder the Twins, Musicians, Songsters, Men of merry Tempers, and Astronomers: 13. Vnder the Crab, Covetous Fellows and Vsurers: 14. Vnder the Lion, Hunters, Beast-keepers, Plain, Open-hearted, easily provok'd, and easily appeas'd: Vnder the*



Maid, Philosophers, Orators, Notaries, shamefac'd and indifferently good: 16. Vnder the Scales, Measurers, Gagers, Accountants, Lawgivers, Lawyers, and Judges: 17. Vnder the Scorpion, Hunters, Gladiators, Men of Warlike and Military Dispositions: 18. Vnder Sagittarius, Chariot-Racers, Horse-breakers, Tamers of Wild Beasts, Men of acute Vnderstandings, and strong and nimble Bodies: 19. Vnder the Goat, Miners, Coyners, Goldsmiths, Bakers, Broakers, Inconstant and Lascivious in their Youth: 20. Vnder Aquarius, Men skill'd in making Aqueducts, and Water-works, and Spheres, and Globes, tractable and prodigal: 21. Vnder Pisces, Mariners, Pilots, Shipwrights, Rowers, Fishers, Fruitful but Inconstant: 22. He Discourses of the Tenths of each Sign, and what Sign is Lord of each third part of every Sign: 23. He encourages his Scholar to go on, tho the Task seems to grow upon him, and to be very difficult, because 'tis a Noble Study, and the Object truly great: 24. He shews what degrees of each Sign are hurtful, what not: 25. He Teaches, that the Tempers of those that are Born when the Sign riseth, are different from those that are Born at other times: 26. He draws a Map of the Earth and Seas, and Teaches what Signs govern particular Countries: 27. He shews what Signs are call'd Eccliptick, and why: 28. He proposeth such Objections as are made to deter Men from this curious search, and answereth them.

## Short Reflections on the Cares of Men.

4.1

WHy should our Time run out in useless years,

4.2

Of anxious Troubles and tormenting Fears?

4.3

Why should deluding Hopes disturb our ease,

4.4

Vain to pursue, yet eager to possess?

4.5

With no Success, and no Advantage crown'd,

4.6

Why should we still tread on th' *unfinisht* Round?

4.7

Grown gray in Cares, pursue the senseless strife,

4.8

And seeking how to Live, consume a Life?

4.9

The more we have, the meaner is our Store;

4.10

The unenjoying craving *Wretch* is Poor:

4.11

But *Heaven* is kind, with bounteous Hand it grants

4.12

A fit supply for Nature's sober wants:

4.13

She asks not much, yet Men press blindly on,

4.14

And heap up more, to be the more undone:

4.15

By *Luxury*, they *Rapine*'s Force maintain,

4.16

What that scrapes up, flows out in *Luxury* again;

4.17

And to be squander'd, or to raise debate,

4.18

Is the great only use of an Estate.

4.19

Vain Man forbear, of Cares, unload thy Mind,

4.20

Forget thy Hopes, and give thy Fears to Wind;

4.21

For *Fate* rules all, its stubborn Laws must sway

4.22

The lower World, and *Man* confin'd obey.

4.23

As we are Born we Dye, our Lots are cast,

4.24

And our first Hour disposeth of our last.

4.25

Then as the influence of the Stars ordains,

4.26

To Empires *Kings* are doom'd, and *Slaves* to Chains.

4.27

Then Poverty, that common Fate comes down,

4.28

(Few Stars are Regal, and design a Crown)

4.29

What make a *Wit*, a *Knave*, a *Saint*, or *Dunce*,

4.30

Are hudled then together, and fixt at once.

4.31

The Ills that are *ordain'd* we must endure,

4.32

From not *Decreed* how fatally secure?

4.33

Prayers are too weak to check fixt Destinies,

4.34

And Vows too slow to catch the Fate that flies.

4.35

Whether with Glory rais'd, or clogg'd with Scorn,

4.36

The State, that then is *settled*, must be born.

## 1. The first Argument for Fate.

4.37

For did not *Fate* preside, and Fortune lead,

4.38

Had parting Flames the good <sup>139</sup> *Aenaeas* fled?

4.39

Had *Troy*'s sunk Fortune been sustain'd by <sup>140</sup> one?

4.40

And only Conquer'd then, when overthrown?

4.41

And did not Stars the rise of States dispose,

4.42

Had mighty *Rome* from such beginnings rose?

4.43

Had 3 *Shepherds* built, or Swains without controul

4.44

Advanc'd their 4 Cottage to a Capitol?

4.45

Plac'd on whose heights, our *Caesars* now survey

4.46

The lower Earth, and see the *World* obey?

4.47

From their 5 burnt Nest, had Conquering Eagles flown,

4.48

And the World yielded to a ruin'd Town?

4.49

Had *Jove* been storm'd; or <sup>141</sup> *Mutius* safe return'd

4.50

From baffled Flames, or vanquish'd whilst he burn'd?

4.51

Our Towns and Bridges guard, had <sup>142</sup> *Cocles* stood,

4.52

Or the weak <sup>143</sup> *Virgin* swam rough *Tiber's* Flood?

4.53

Had one <sup>144</sup> *Horatius* our sunk hopes restor'd,

4.54

Or *Three* have fall'n beneath a single Sword?

4.55

O Glorious Victory! what Arms before,

4.56

E're won so much, none ever fought for more;

4.57

*Rome* and her hopes of Empire hung on *One*,

4.58

His o're matcht Lot was Hers, a Yoke or Throne.

4.59

Why should I <sup>145</sup> *Cannae's* bloody Plains relate,

4.60

And *Africk's* Ensigns threatning at our Gate,

4.61

How *Thrasymene* Drown'd *Flaminius's* Shame,

4.62

And after *Fabius*, wise Retreats o'recame,

4.63

The Conquer'd *Carthage* shone with *Roman* flame?

4.64

How *Hannibal* on the *Campanian* Plains,

4.65

*Rome's* Terror once, then destin'd to our Chains;

4.66

Whilst waiting on his Proud *Bithynian* Lord,

4.67

Stole a base Death, and scap't our Nobler Sword?

4.68

But turn and view the 9 Civil Wars of *Rome*,

4.69

There opens wide a various Scene of Doom:

4.70

See *Marcus* ride with *Cimbrian* Lawrels Crown'd,

4.71

Then in the Dungeon stretcht upon the groun'd;

4.72

Now Slave, now Consul, Consul, Slave again,

4.73

His *Curule* Chair, succeeded by a *Chain*;

4.74

Now a mean Ruin on the *Lybian* Sands

4.75

Despis'd he lies, and streight the World Commands;

4.76

Like Thunder from low Earth exhal'd, he rose

4.77

From the *Minturnian* Pools,

4.78

And scatter'd Vengeance on his haughty Foes.

4.79

These wondrous Changes *Fate* and *Stars* advance,

4.80

O mighty turns, and much too great for *Chance*!

4.81

Who <sup>146</sup> *Pompey* could (that saw thy Conquering Fleet

4.82

Regain the Seas, and Kings beneath thy Feet,

4.83

Proud *Pontus* yield, fierce Tyrants make thy Train,

4.84

And crowding Monarchs beg thy leave to Reign,

4.85

That saw Victorious Lawrels Crown thy Head,

4.86

And Worlds in thy repeated Triumphs lead;

4.87

And all that Glory which thy Sword had won,

4.88

Fixt and supported by as great a <sup>147</sup> Son)

4.89

Have thought that Thou, upon a Foreign Sand,

4.90

Should'st steal a Burial from a common Hand;

4.91

That shatter'd Planks, the Sea's dishonest spoil

4.92

Should hiz beneath thy *Trunk*, and be thy Pile?

4.93

That Thou, the mighty Thou, should'st want an Urn,

4.94

What Power, but *Fate*, could work so strange a turn?

4.95

E'en <sup>148</sup> *Caesar* sprung from Heaven, and now a Star,

4.96

Tho' midst the dangers of the Civil War,

4.97

Secure He stood, and careless of Repose,

4.98

Was ne're surpriz'd by his most watchful Foes;

4.99

Yet Crown'd with Peace, in all his Pomp and State

4.100

He fell a Victim to o're-ruling Fate:

4.101

No dark suspitions, but bright hints were brought,

4.102

He knew what *Cassius* spoke, and *Brutus* thought;

4.103

How far advanc'd, how far they meant to go,

4.104

And saw the minute of the fatal Blow:

4.105

Yet dark Oblivion did his Memory blot,

4.106

He all his warnings, and *Himself* forgot;

4.107

And in the Senate, whilst his Right Hand held

4.108

The faithful Bill, which all the Plot reveal'd;

4.109

To prove that *Fate* will sway, and *Stars* controul,

4.110

He fell, and with his Blood defac'd the Scroul:

4.111

O mighty power of Fate, and prov'd too well!

4.112

The Best, the Wisest, and the Greatest fell.

4.113

Why should I mention *Kings* 13 and *Empires* falls,

4.114

Shew Conquering 13 *Cyrus* on the *Sardian* Walls?

4.115

Or *Croesus* shrinking at the rising Flame?



4.116

Or 13 *Priam's* Trunk, a thing without a Name?

4.117

Unhappy Prince! the Beasts and Vultur's spoil,

4.118

His *Troy* was burnt, but *Priam* wants a Pile.

4.119

The Wreck of 13 *Xerxes*, who wou'd scourge the Gods,

4.120

A Wreck, much greater than the threatned Floods?

4.121

Or 13 *Tullus's* Reign, who by the power of Fate,

4.122

Was born a Slave, yet Rul'd the *Roman* State?

4.123

Or shew 13 *Metellus* snatch the *Vestal* Fire,

4.124

And as he pass'd, prophaner Flames retire?

## II. Second Argument.

4.125

How oft do *suddain Deaths* the Healthy seize,

4.126

Without the formal warning of Disease?

4.127

And yet how often from the *Piles* retire,

4.128

E'en 14 fly themselves, and wander thro' the Fire?

4.129

Thus some have from their Graves return'd, and known

4.130

Two *Lives*, whilst others, scarce enjoy but *One*.

4.131

A *small* Disease destroys, whilst *greater* spare,

4.132

Good Methods fail, and Men are lost by Care.

4.133

Some *temperate Diet*, with Diseases fills,

4.134

And Poyson's Innocent, when *Physick* Kills.

### III. Third Argument.

4.135

Some *Children* prove a mean degenerate Race,

4.136

Some shew their Father's *Mind*, as well as *Face*;

4.137

In *One*, their Vertue, and their Fortune rise

4.138

To greater height, and in *Another* dyes.

4.139

One 15 mad in Love, to *Troy* will carry War,

4.140

Or swim the Flood, and view the Torch from far,

4.141

The *Other* is determin'd to the Bar.

4.142

A *Son* his *Father*, *Father* kills the *Son*

4.143

On mutual Wounds two headlong *Brothers* run;

4.144

These Combats prove the force of ruling Powers,

4.145

For they are too unnatural to be *Ours*.

#### IV. Fourth Argument.

4.146

That every Age no new *Camilli's* breath,

4.147

The <sup>149</sup> *Decij* dye, or <sup>150</sup> *Cato* conquer Death,

4.148

'Tis not but that the *Seed* can still receive

4.149

As noble *Stamps*, but Fates refuse to give.

4.150

To fewer Days they do not cramp the *Poor*,

4.151

Nor brib'd by Wealth, enlarg'd the *Rich* with more;

4.152

There Riches lose their force, the shining Years

4.153

Of glorious *Tyrants* must be turn'd in Tears;

4.154

They dig a Grave for *Kings*, and fix the Day;

4.155

How great must be that Power which Crowns obey!

#### V. Fifth Argument.

4.156

Successless *Vertue* sinks whilst *Vice* prevails,

4.157

And *Folly* wins the Prize when *Prudence* fails:

4.158

He argues ill that from the *Fortune* draws

4.159

The goodness or the badness of a Cause:

4.160

Success or *Merit* do not always Crown,

4.161

Midst good and bad Men they are blindly thrown,

4.162

Without *Respect*, sixt fatally on *One*.

4.163

For some superior Power's impetuous force

4.164

Marks out our way, and still directs the Course;

4.165

The Years that we must run, the length, the pace,

4.166

And all the various turnings of the Race.

## VI. Sixth Argument.

4.167

Besides, what *Monstrous Births*, the Nurses fear

4.168

And Mother's shame, half Man, half Beast appear?

4.169

Such wondrous Creatures ne're from *Seed* began,

4.170

For what hath *Beast* that's common to a *Man*?

4.171

And what mean Soul would with his Lust comply,

4.172

And Sin on purpose for a *Prodigy*?

4.173

No; *Stars dispose*, they Counterfeit a Rape,

4.174

And mix a *Monster* of amazing shape.

## VII. Seventh Argument.

4.175

Besides, were not *Events* by *Fates* enrol'd,

4.176

How can their certain Order be foretold?

4.177

How can the *Prophets* Sing of future Doom,

4.178

And in the present read the Age to come?

## VIII. An Objection answer'd.

4.179

To this there's one Objection; *Fate* denies

4.180

Rewards to *Vertue*, and must plead for Vice:

4.181

Absurd; for who less hates a *Poysonous Weed*

4.182

Because 'tis bred from *Necessary Seed*?

4.183

Or who loves *Corn* the less; who hates the *Vine*.

4.184

Because by *Nature* rais'd, and not *Design*?

4.185

Thus Virtuous Minds deserve the greater Love,

4.186

Since *Heaven* consents, and all the *Stars* approve;

4.187

And we should hate those more whom *Fates* have sent

4.188

To commit Crimes and suffer Punishment;

4.189

For how, or whence these noxious faults begin

4.190

No matter, since each is certainly a Sin.

4.191

Nay this Opinion's settled by Debate,

4.192

'Tis *Fate* that we should thus dispute of *Fate*.

## IX. The Influence of the Signs.

4.193

This settled, I must now attempt to climb

4.194

Celestial steps, and run the *Round* of Time,

4.195

The *Zodiack* travel, go through every Sign,

4.196

Their Powers rehearse, and sing how all incline.

## X. Of Aries.

4.197

First *Aries* shines, and as he oft doth lose

4.198

His *Fleece*, and then as frequently renews,

4.199

'Twixt sudden Ruin, and a fair Estate

4.200

He fixes the variety of Fate;

4.201

He *gets*, then *loseth*, then returns to Gain,

4.202

Then Loss steals in, and empties all his pain;

4.203

He rears new *Lambs*, he doth encrease the Fold,

4.204

And makes the *Rams* to shine in native Gold;

4.205

Betters the Wool, and whilst the Subject grows

4.206

He forms Mens Minds to use what he bestows;

4.207

To *Pick*, to *Card*, to *Spin*, and *Weave*, to deal

4.208

In Cloath with gain; to Buy, Exchange, and sell:

4.209

All useful Arts, whose constant Works supply

4.210

Mens real Wants, not only Luxury:

4.211

This <sup>151</sup> *Pallas* owns, nor doth disdain to claim

4.212

*Arachne*'s conquest as her greatest Fame.

4.213

These are the manners, these the various Arts

4.214

Which *Aries* Rays, and secret force imparts;

4.215

To anxious fears he troubled Minds betrays

4.216

And strong Desires to venture all for Praise.

4.217

Dull Honest *Plowmen* to manure the Field

## XI. Of Taurus.

4.218

Strong *Taurus* bears, by him the Grounds are till'd:

4.219

No gaudy things he breeds, no Prize for worth,

4.220

But Blesseth Earth, and brings her Labour forth:

4.221

He takes the Yoke, nor doth the Plough disdain,

4.222

And teacheth Farmers to manure the Plain:

4.223

He's their Example, when he bears the Sun

4.224

In his bright Horns, the noble toyl's begun:

4.225

The useful Plowshare he retrieves from Rust,

4.226

Nor lies at ease, and wants his strength in Dust.

4.227

To him the <sup>152</sup> *Curij*, and to him we owe

4.228



The brave *Serrani*, he i'th' Fields did *Rods* bestow,

4.229

And sent a great *Dictator* from his Plow.

4.230

Reserv'd, aspiring Minds, Limbs slow to move

4.231

But strong in Bulk his powerful Rays improve,

4.232

And on his <sup>153</sup> Curled Front sits wanton *Love*.

4.233

Soft *Gemini* to easier Arts incline

## XII. Of Gemini.

4.234

For softer Studies fit an *Infant* Sign.

4.235

They tune rough Words, or they incline to Sing,

4.236

To stop the Pipe, or strike the speaking String;

4.237

Through Reeds they blow the Natural Sound in Measure,

4.238

Gay their delight, and e'en their Pains are Pleasure;

4.239

Wars they avoid, Old Age they chace with Song,

4.240

And when *late* Death o'retakes them they are Young.

4.241

Sometimes to *Heaven* they mount, and trace the Stars,

4.242

Then fix in *Globes*, or turn the Signs in *Spheres*:

4.243

Their Wit reigns o're their Nature, and refines

4.244

Its Powers; This is the Influence of the Twins.

4.245

But glowing *Cancer* (where the Summer Sun

### XIII. Of Cancer.

4.246

With fiery Chariots bounds the *Torrid* Zone,

4.247

Drives fiercely up, then with a bending Rein

4.248

Sinks down, and runs in lower Rounds again.)

4.249

As close in's Shell he lies, affords his Aid

4.250

To greedy Merchants, and inclines to *Trade*:

4.251

His Births shall sail, through Seas and Dangers tost

4.252

To reap the Riches of a Foreign Coast.

4.253

What thrifty Nature hath but thinly sown

4.254

In *Many* Countries, they shall bring to *One*;

4.255

Intent on gain ne're heed the Poors complaint

4.256

But thrive on *Scarcity*, and live on *Want*:

4.257

For Wealth undaunted gather every Wind,

4.258

Out-sail good Fame, and leave Repute behind,

4.259

And when their greedy Hands have seiz'd the Store

4.260

Of this, search other Worlds, and seek for more.

4.261

Or else at home prove griping *Vsurers*,

4.262

Complaining at the slowness of the Years,

4.263

Wish swifter Suns, and set too vast a rate

4.264

On *Time* it self, to raise a quick Estate:

4.265

Their Bodies shall be *Strong*, inur'd to Pain,

4.266

Their Wits *Contriving*, and intent on gain:

4.267

What Inclinations *Leo's* Rays dispense

#### XIV. Of Leo.

4.268

Is quickly known, 'tis plain to Common Sense,

4.269

He gives his *Own*; for he the Woods infests

4.270

The mighty Terror of the meaner Beasts:

4.271

He lives on Rapine, ranges all the Day,

4.272

And sullenly at Night groans o're his Prey.

4.273

Hence he inclines Mens Minds to *Hunt*, and fills

4.274

Our *Nobles* spacious Halls with grinning spoyls;

4.275

There Skins and Horns do spread a dismal grace,

4.276

And stand as certain *Heraulds* of their Race;

4.277

This Beast was mine, and that my Father's Game,

4.278

They cry, these are the *Annals* of their Fame:

4.279

That generous Youth which *France* and *Spain* did fear

4.280

Now prove the *Humble* Terror of a Deer.

4.281

Nay some in <sup>154</sup> Towns pursue this wild delight,

4.282

There barbarous grow, and breed up Beasts to fight;

4.283

Then bring them out for sight in Theaters,

4.284

And feast their Luxury with *Bruitish* Wars;

4.285

Cruel in Sport: Their *Posts* are grac't with Spoyl,

4.286

And they get shameful Honour without Toyl:

4.287

He makes Men *warm*, their Passions quickly rais'd,

4.288

Like Boys soon angry, and as soon appeas'd:

4.289

But *Plain* and *Honest* all their Thoughts sincere;

4.290

Pure as the Sun, and like the Water clear.

## XV. Of Virgo.

4.291

But modest *Virgo*'s Rays give polisht parts,

4.292

And fill Mens Breasts with Honesty and Arts;

4.293

No tricks for Gain, nor love of Wealth dispense,

4.294

But piercing Thoughts, and winning Eloquence;

4.295

With words persuasive, and with *Rhetorick* strong

4.296

They rule, and are e'en *Monarchs* by their *Tongue*.

4.297

Through Nature's Secrets too, they boldly press,

4.298

Tho' deeply hid, and meet a just success;

4.299

In *Short-Hand* skill'd, where little Marks comprise,

4.300

Whole words, a Sentence in a Letter lies;

4.301

And whilst Obedient hands their Aid afford,

4.302

Prevent the Tongue, and *Fix* the falling Word.

4.303

But bashful *Modesty*, casts down their Eyes,

4.304

The best of Vices, yet 'tis still a Vice,

4.305

Because it stifles, checks, or nips like Frost

4.306

A blooming Vertue, and the Fruit is lost.

4.307

Besides, though strange such Influence should come

4.308

From *Virgo's* Rays, she gives a fruitful Womb.

## XVI. Of Libra.

4.309

*Libra*, whose Scales, when *Autumn* turns the Signs,

4.310

And ruddy *Bacchus* treads the juicy Vines;

4.311

In equal Balance, poize the Night and Day,

4.312

Teach how to measure, and instruct to weigh:

4.313

And Rival <sup>155</sup> *Palamed*, (who Numbers found,

4.314

And into Letters fram'd unpolisht sound;

4.315

To *Him* the Art of Words, and Speech we owe,

4.316

Till then Men *only* Spoak, but knew not how.)

4.317

Besides, He'll know the *Niceties* of Law;

4.318

What guard the Good, and what the Guilty awe,

4.319

What Vengeance wait on Crimes, with Skill declare,

4.320

His *private* Chamber, still shall be the *Bar*.

4.321

What He determines, that for *Right* shall stand,

4.322

As *Justice* weigh'd her Balance in his Hand.

4.323

This Rul'd at <sup>156</sup> *Servius*'s Birth, who first did give

4.324

Our *Laws* a *Being*, rather than *Revive*;

4.325

The *Tables* seem'd Old, Reverend Senseless Lines,

4.326

Meer waxen Things, and fit to serve Designs,

4.327

As Fools mistook, or Crafty Knaves would draw;

4.328

Till He infus'd a Soul, and made them *Law*.

## XVII. Of Scorpio.

4.329

Bright *Scorpio* Arm'd, with poys'nous Tail prepares,

4.330

Mens Martial Minds, for Violence and Wars;

4.331

His Venom heats, and boyls their Bloods to Rage,

4.332

And Rapine spreads o're the unlucky Age.

4.333

Yet, when the *Sun* drives there, Men tear the Earth,

4.334

And cast their Seed to an increasing Birth,

4.335

As if he led mistaken Men to toil,

4.336

And sweat for Matter for a future spoil.

4.337

Yet 'tis not *Prey* they seek, as much as *Blood*,

4.338

For e'en in *Peace* they fiercely trace the Wood,

4.339

O're Forests range, and every Plain infest,

4.340

Now Fight with Man, and now Engage with Beast;

4.341

To please the Crowd, they unprovok'd engage,

4.342

And sell their Lives, to the dishonest Stage;

4.343

And when calm *Peace* doth *Publick* Rest bestow,

4.344

Yet still to Fight, each seeks himself a Foe.

4.345

They spend their leisure Hours in fierce Alarms,

4.346

And all their *Recreation* is in Arms.



## XVIII. Of Sagittarius.

4.347

The double *Centaur* different Tempers breeds,

4.348

They break the Horse, and tame the fiery Steeds;

4.349

They love the sounding Whip, the Race, the Rein,

4.350

And whirl the Chariot o're the dusty Plain:

4.351

Nor is their Humor to the Fields confin'd,

4.352

They range the Woods, and tame the Savage Kind;

4.353

Young *Bears* they break, and *Tygers* heats asswage,

4.354

And hear Young *Lions* roaring without Rage.

4.355

Discourse the <sup>157</sup> *Elephant*, and Teach the Mass

4.356

A mimick Action, and a decent Grace;

4.357

To Act in Plays, or raise th' unweildly load,

4.358

To Dance, and be the Darling of the *Crowd*.

4.359

For in the Frame, in double forms exprest,

4.360

The Man is *uppermost*, and rules the Beast;

4.361

His Bow full drawn implies, his Rays impart,

4.362

*Strength* to the Limbs, and *Vigor* to the Heart.

4.363

Quick active Motions, full of warmth and heat,

4.364

Still pressing on, unknowing to retreat.

## XIX. Of Capricorn.

4.365

But Sacred *Vesta* guards thy fatal Fire,

4.366

And thence 'tis guess'd, what Minds thy Rays inspire,

4.367

Contracted *Goat*; by thee that Art's infus'd,

4.368

Which Fire assists, and where a Flame is us'd;

4.369

By thee the *Miners* burn the Womb of Earth;

4.370

And see the place of Metals fatal Birth:

4.371

By thee they melt; by thee they work the Mould,

4.372

Refine, and Stamp it into mighty Gold:

4.373

By thee, the Silver, Iron, Gold, and Brass,

4.374

The Forge dissolves, and forms the easie Mass:

4.375

By thee, the *Ovens* heat, and *Baths* acquire,

4.376

And Happy <sup>158</sup> *Chymists* blow enriching Fire:

4.377

Thy Cold (for thou o're Winter Signs dost reign,

4.378

Pull'st back the *Sun*, and send'st us Day again)

4.379

Makes Brokers Rich, for whilst you spread your Ice,

4.380

Their Wares go off, and they enhance the Price:

4.381

From thee our Youth unconstant Tempers prove,

4.382

And eagerly pursue unlawful Love,

4.383

'Cause *Goat* above; but these the *Fish* behind

4.384

Corrects in Age, and fixes the soft Mind.

## XX. Of *Aquarius*.

4.385

*Aquarius* pouring out his Urn, imparts

4.386

An useful Knowledge in resembling Arts,

4.387

To find out Springs, and with new Streams supply

4.388

The Barren Countries, and refresh the dry;

4.389

To raise in Pipes, or to extend in Beams,

4.390

And in high Rooms imprison Foreign Streams;

4.391

Affront the *Sea*, for *State*, not *use*, restrain

4.392

The Waves with Moles, and curb the raging Main;

4.393

Or Engins raise, whence Waters mount above,

4.394

And mix the lower, with the higher *Jove*.

4.395

A thousand other Arts, which Waters sway,

4.396

As Channels lead, or else as Pipes convey,

4.397

Depend upon the *influence* of his Ray.

4.398

And to his Births the World oblig'd shall owe

4.399

*Spheres*, *Cycles*, *Orbs*, and turn *new* Skies below.

4.400

Soft, easie Tempers, loving Coin for use,

4.401

Not sorbid, but inclin'd to be profuse;

4.402

Not pinch't, nor yet too swelling in Estate;

4.403

Thus flows the *Vrn*, and fixes this for Fate.

## XXI. Of Pisces.

4.404

Last *double Pisces*, from their shining scale,

4.405

Spread watry influence, and incline to Sail;

4.406

To trust their Lives to Seas, to plow the Deep,

4.407

To make fit Rigging, or to build a Ship.

4.408

In short, what e're can for a Fleet be fram'd,

4.409

A thousand Arts, too numerous to be nam'd.

4.410

Beside to steer, observe the *Stars*, and guide

4.411

As they direct, and never lose the Tide;

4.412

To know the Coasts, the Winds, the Ports, and Shores;

4.413

To turn the Helm, or ply the bending Oars;

4.414

To sweep smooth Seas with *Nets*, to drag the Sand,

4.415

And draw the leaping *Captives* to the Land,

4.416

Lay cheating *Wires*, or with unfaithful bait,

4.417

The Hook conceal, and get by the deceit:

4.418

To fight at Sea, to stain the Waves with blood,

4.419

Whilst *War* lies floating on th' unstable flood:

4.420

Fruitful their Births, of Pleasure fond, engage

4.421

In Love, are quick, but changing with their Age.

## XXII. The Tenths and the Lords of the third part of each sign.

4.422

Thus rule the *Twelve*, these Powers they *singly* own,

4.423

And these would give if they could work alone.

4.424

But none rules *All* its own degrees, they joyn

4.425

Their friendly forces with some other Sign,

4.426

As 'twere compound, and equal parts receive

4.427

From *Other* Signs, as they to *Others* give:

4.428

Thus each hath *Thirty* parts, and each resigns

4.429

Two *Thirds* of those degrees to other Signs:

4.430

We call these portions (Art new words will frame,)

4.431

The Tenths, <sup>159</sup> the *Number* doth impose the Name:

4.432

So hid is Truth, so many Vails are spread

4.433

Coy *Nature's* Face, and hide her Gloomy Head,

4.434

So many are the little Niceties,

4.435

So intricate, and puzling are the Skies,

4.436

Not easie to be read by common Eyes.

4.437

For one appearance in another lies,

4.438

Conceals its Powers, and Acts in disguise;

4.439

And that which *Lurks*, and subtly interferes

4.440

Hath different *Powers* from that which then appears.

4.441

Not Day, but piercing Thought must clear this Sky,

4.442

The Labour of thy *Mind*, not of thy *Eye*;

4.443

Press bravely on, and pass the Gloomy Cloud,

4.444

Enter, and view the inside of the God;

4.445

The Path is dark, and lest thy Mind should stray

4.446

I'll boldly lead, and shew the nearest way;

4.447

I'll Sing what League the different Parts combines,

4.448

And shew how others Rule in other Signs.

Of Aries.

4.449

For instance, *Aries* shakes his shining Fleece,

4.450

And governs the *First Ten* of his Degrees:

4.451

But next the *Bull*, and next the *Twins* do claim

4.452

The second, and third Portions of the *Ram*:

4.453

Thus three times Ten Degrees the *Ram* divide,

4.454

And *He*, as many others as preside

4.455

In his Degrees, so many Fates affords

4.456

His proper Powers being temper'd by his *Lords*.

## Of Taurus.

4.457

Thus lies the *Ram*, next view the threatning *Bull*,

4.458

His case is different, he hath *none* to Rule:

4.459

For in his *First Ten Parts* the *Crab's* obey'd,

4.460

I'th' Second *Leo*, and i'th' Third the *Maid*.

4.461

Yet he seems stubborn, and maintains his Throne,

4.462

And all *Their* Powers he mixeth with his *Own*.



## Of Gemini.

4.463

The feeble *Twins* just *Libra's* Scales possess,

4.464

Then *Scorpio*, and the rest of their Degrees

4.465

Bold *Sagittarius* subjects to his flame,

4.466

With Bow full drawn, as to defend his claim.

4.467

An *equal* share in Empire all maintain,

4.468

But keep not the *same* order in their Reign.

## Of Cancer▪

4.469

For *Cancer's* Sign, as in the *Goat* he sways,

4.470

Resigns his first third Portion to *His* Rays:

4.471

For when he bears the Sun oppos'd in site,

4.472

*His* Day is equal to the *Others* Night:

4.473

This is the Reason why these Two combine,

4.474

And each hath the same Portion in each Sign.

4.475

His second part the *Vrn* with watry Beams

4.476

O're-flows, and *Pisces* rule in the Extreame.

## Of Leo.

4.477

The *Lion* minds his Partner in the *Trine*,

4.478

And makes the *Ram* first Ruler in his Sign;

4.479

And then the *Bull*, with whom he makes a *Square*,

4.480

I'th' Second Reigns; His *Sextile* *Twins* declare

4.481

Their Third pretence, and Rule the other share.

## In Cancer.

4.482

The *Crab* is chiefly Honour'd by the *Maid*,

4.483

The first place his, and there his Sway's obey'd;

4.484

The next is *Leo*'s, and the last her own,

4.485

She Rules unenvy'd in her petty Throne.

## In Libra.

4.486

The *Ram*'s Example *Libra* takes, and bears

4.487

A likeness in this Rule, as in the Years;

4.488

For as *He* in the *Spring*, *Her* Scales do weigh

4.489

In *Autumn* equal Night with equal Day:

4.490

The first *She* Rules her self, next *Scorpio's* plac't,

4.491

And *Sagittarius* Lords it o're the last:

### In Scorpio.

4.492

In *Scorpio's* first Degrees the *Goat* presides,

4.493

Next Young *Aquarius* pours his flowing Tides;

4.494

Next *Pisces* Rules, for they in Waves delight,

4.495

The Flood pursue, and claim an easie Right.

### In Capricorn.

4.496

The grateful *Goat* doth *Cancer's* Gift repay,

4.497

His *First Third* part resigning to his Ray;

4.498

I'th' *next* the *Lion* shakes his flaming Manc,

4.499

The last feels modest *Virgo's* gentle Rein.

### In Aquarius.

4.500

The Young *Aquarius Libra's Scales* command,

4.501

Restrain his Youth, and check his turning Hand;

4.502

The *next Ten* parts bright *Scorpio's* Rays enjoy,

4.503

Then *Sagittarius* Rules the giddy Boy:

### In Pisces.

4.504

*Pisces* comes last, and sheds a watry flame,

4.505

Its *First Degrees* resigning to the *Ram*:

4.506

The *Bull's* the *next*, his own the *last* are found,

4.507

Content with the last Portion of the Round.

4.508

This thing consider'd well thy Mind prepares

### The usefulness of this Doctrin of the Lords.

4.509

To know the secret guidance of the Stars;

4.510

They *interchange* their Powers, they mix their Laws,

4.511

And all agree to make one Common Cause;

4.512

For these *Divisions* do unite the Sky,

4.513

The more they *part* the *closer* is the Tye.

4.514

But now, lest Error should thy Mind surprise,

4.515

Believe not the *Appearance* of the Skies;

4.516

They make a shew, they spread a Glaring Light

4.517

To lead thee on, but never guide thee right;

4.518

Let *Active Thought* assisting Sense pursue

4.519

Goy Truth's retreat, and take an open view:

4.520

What ever Things are born, their Minds receive

4.521

The fatal Temper which that sign can give

4.522

That governs in the *Tenths*, the Foreign Ray,

4.523

Tempers the Mass, and forms the easie Clay.

4.524

A Thousand Reasons for this Truth appear

4.525

From *different* Births belonging to *One* Star;

4.526

Of all those Creatures, that at once do see

4.527

The Light, scarce Two can perfectly agree;

4.528

But different Tempers all the shapes adorn,

4.529

As various as the Bodies that are born:

4.530

For though one *Chiefly* Rules, yet others joyn

4.531

And change the *proper* influence of that Sign:

4.532

These Interchanges all our Thoughts distract,

4.533

We think on other Signs, whilst others Act.

4.534

Thus neither *singly* will the *Ram* bestow

4.535

A Love to Cloathing, nor the *Bull* to Plough;

4.536

To Hunt the *Lion*, nor the *Crab* to Trade;

4.537

Learning the *Twins*, nor Eloquence the *Maid*;

4.538

The *Scales* to weigh, to measure, and to gage,

4.539

Nor Poys'nous *Scorpio* arm unhappy Rage;

4.540

The *Fish* to Sail, nor the *Youth's* Urn inspire

4.541

To work in Water, nor the *Goat* in Fire.

4.542

But many joyn, and these mixt Signs bestow

4.543

Mixt Inclinations on the Births below:

## XXIII. Encouragements to this Study.

4.544

A subtle and surprizing Task is shown,

4.545

Much have I past, yet still you lead me on;

4.546

These things seem dark, whilst I the rest explore,

4.547

Enjoy my Precepts, and complain no more.

4.548

'Tis God you search for, by my Aid you trie

4.549

To climb, and view the inside of the Sky;

4.550

Confin'd by Fate, you search its boundless sway,

4.551

And seek to know the Laws you must Obey:

4.552

The narrow Bounds of your own Breast you pass,

4.553

Enjoy the *World*, and rove in the vast space:

4.554

Painful, but always noble things are hard,

4.555

Great is the Task, but equal the Reward:

4.556

Nor let the various Maze thy Thoughts repress,

4.557

Enter, and you are certain to possess.

4.558

Is *Gold* thy Aim? What mighty Pains attend?

4.559

Mountains are level'd, and the Mines descend

4.560

Through *Earth's* deep Center; though she hides her Store

4.561

We tear her up, and reach the hidden Oar:

4.562

For shining *Gems* we cut the burning Zone,

4.563

Such Dangers are the value of a *Stone*:

4.564

The fearful *Farmer* makes his Yearly Vow,

4.565

And Pain still presseth the deceiving *Plow*:

4.566

In *War* no Danger's shun'd, we fight for Spoil,

4.567

E'en lazy *Luxury* leads us on to Toyl;

4.568

For Food, and Cloaths from *East* to *West* we run,

4.569

And *Spendchrists* often sweat to be undone.

4.570

Are *perishing Goods* worth so much Pains and Cost,

4.571

Hard to be got, and in injoyment lost?

4.572

Then what must *Heaven* Deserve? <sup>160</sup> That *Gold*, that buys

4.573

The rest, how disproportionate a Price!

4.574

It asks a higher value, and to gain



4.575

The *God*, lay out *thy self*, The Price is *Man*:

## XXIV. The Good and Bad Degrees of each Sign.

4.576

Thus *Fate*'s dispos'd, but yet the Work's not done;

4.577

For though the Powers of all the Signs are known,

4.578

And how they joyn, how each rules every part,

4.579

The Skill is small, and incompletion the Art:

4.580

Observe the numerous parts of the *Degrees*

4.581

What *Heat* doth scorch or what the *Cold* doth freeze,

4.582

(Unfruitful both) where *too much Moisture* flows,

4.583

Or *Drought* doth drain, and various Fates dispose:

4.584

For different Qualities in Signs controul,

4.585

There's nought all-over-equal in the whole.

4.586

For view the *Earth*, the gliding Streams, or Flood,

4.587

Faults are on all sides, Bad is mixt with Good.

4.588

Thus *Barren* Seasons midst the *Best* appear,

4.589

And a small Turn blasts all the Blooming Year.

4.590

A *Port* turns *Shelf*, and the inglorious Sand

4.591

Forfeits that Praise which once its Safety gain'd.

4.592

Now Streams through Plains in *smooth Meanders* play,

4.593

Then Roar o're Rocks, and force a *rugged* way.

4.594

Such *Inequality* above appears,

4.595

And thus the Sky is vary'd in the Stars;

4.596

As Sign from Sign, so from it self the same

4.597

Doth disagree, and spread unequal Flame;

4.598

And Signs, whose *Sovereign* influence Births do find

4.599

In *One* Degree, are in the next *unkind*:

4.600

Those things these parts o're-rule, no Joys shall know

4.601

Or little Pleasure *over-mixt* with Woe.

The difficulty of putting this Doctrin into Verse.

4.602

These parts, if such can be to Verse confin'd,

4.603

My *Muse* must Sing, and ease my troubled Mind;

4.604

For though 'tis *various*, yet the *Subject's* bound

4.605

To words but *few*, and all of *equal* sound;

4.606

So that it must be mean, it must refuse

4.607

The turn of Verse, though fashion'd by a *Muse*.

4.608

And that, though labor'd, Line must bald appear

4.609

That brings ungrateful Musick to the Ear.

4.610

But since I must the *Laws of Fate* rehearse

4.611

The *settled Matter* must direct my verse;

4.612

No Room for Fiction, I must things declare,

4.613

Not as they may be *feign'd*, but as they *are*.

4.614

It is enough the *God* is barely shewn,

4.615

Rich in himself he shines, and great alone:

4.616

Nor should the World be so to *Words* betray'd

4.617

As to be thought ennobled by their Aid:

4.618

This spurs me on, and I forget my Ease,

4.619

The World must be oblig'd, and I must please;

4.620

I must, if plainly I these parts comprise;

4.621

Then learn the *noxious* portions of the Skies.

## The hurtful Degrees in Aries.

4.622

The *Fourth*, and the *Sixth* Portions of the *Ram*

4.623

Are hurtful parts, and spread unlucky flame;

4.624

Nor doth the *Seventeenth* or the *next* display

4.625

A kinder face, or shed a milder Ray:

4.626

The *Twenty First*, *Fifth*, *Seventh* spread noxious Beams

4.627

The *Twelfth*, and *Fourteenth* leaning to Extreame.

## In Taurus.

4.628

The *Bull's Ninth* portion, did the Sign depend

4.629

On me, should never shine upon a Friend:

4.630

Add *Three* to *Ten*, or double *Ten* and *Three*,

4.631

Take *Two* from *Thirty*, all these parts agree;

4.632

Twice *Twelve*, and twice *Eleven* count, and joyn

4.633

The *Seventeenth* part as *noxious* in this Sign,

4.634

Nor is the *Thirtieth* better than the Rest.

### In Gemini.

4.635

The *Twins First* part doth hurtful Rays dispense,

4.636

Nor doth their Childhood prove their Innocence;

4.637

They're froward, pettish, and unus'd to smile,

4.638

Their *Third*, and *Seventh* Degrees agree in Ill:

4.639

The *Fifteenth* equals these, and *Twenty* sees

4.640

Close on each side immoderate Degrees:

4.641

To *Twenty* reckon *Seven*, or *Five*, or *Nine*,

4.642

And all are hurtful portions of this Sign.

### In Cancer.

4.643

Should *Cancer* boast a kind and gentle Reign,

4.644

The *First*, and *Third*, and *Sixth* would plead in vain;

4.645

The *Eleventh*, *Fifteenth*, and the *Eighth* Degrees,

4.646

The *Twentieth* too could hope no more success:

4.647

The *Twenty Fifth*, *Seventh*, *Ninth*, *severely* sway,

4.648

The *Seventeenth* too with a malignant Ray

4.649

Rules o're the Birth, and stamps the easie Clay.

### In Leo.

4.650

The flaming *Lion* in the *First* we fear,

4.651

Nor doth the *Fourth* a milder Image bear;

4.652

The *Twenty Second*, the *Fifteenth*, *Tenth* *presage*

4.653

With th' *Eight and Twentieth* an unhappy Age.

4.654

With hurtful Powers the *Twenty Fifth* is Curst,

4.655

The *Thirtieth* too as noxious as the *First*.

### In Virgo.

4.656

The *First*, and the *Eleventh* of the Maid,

4.657

The *Sixth*, the *Fourteenth*, *Eighteenth* parts are bad:

4.658

The *Twenty First*, and *Fourth* this Sign disgrace,

4.659

Nor can the *Thirtieth* shew a better Face.

## In Libra.

4.660

Next view the *Scales*, the *Seventh*, and *Fifth* degree

4.661

Is bad, add *Eight* to *Ten*, or *Ten* to *Three*:

4.662

To *Ten* twice told add *Seven*, or *Four*, or *Nine*,

4.663

All like the *Thirtieth* hurtful in this Sign.

## In Scorpio.

4.664

*I'th'* First, Third, Sixth, and Tenth black Scorpio's Claws

4.665

And in the *Fifteenth* make Malignant Laws;

4.666

*The* Twenty Second, Eighth, Fifth, and Ninth betray

4.667

His poys'nous Rage in an unhappy Ray:

## In Sagittarius.

4.668

Would Fate allow thee choice, forbear to choose

4.669

The Centaur's *Fourth* Degree, the *Eighth* refuse;

4.670

The *Twelfth*, the *Sixteenth*, *Twentieth* parts portend

4.671

A wretched Life, and an untimely End:

4.672

The *Twenty Fourth*, *Sixth*, *Eighth Degrees* molest,

4.673

Nor is the *Thirtieth* better than the Rest.

### In Capricorn.

4.674

The *Thirteenth* of the *Goats* contracted Star,

4.675

Nor *Seventh*, nor *Ninth* shall be my earnest Prayer;

4.676

Nor that which *Twenty* doth of *One* deprive,

4.677

Or *Three*, or adding gives it *Six* or *Five*.

### In Aquarius.

4.678

To *Ten* add *One*, or *Five*, or *Nine*, or *Three*

4.679

And you are sure to find a bad Degree:

4.680

Add *One*, *Five*, *Nine* to *Twenty*, hurtful Streams

4.681

Flow from the *Vrn*, and spread unlucky Beams.

### In Pisces.

4.682

The *Fishes* close the *Signs*, their parts confest



4.683

As noxious, and as guilty as the Rest;

4.684

For *Three, Five, Seven*, or *Ten* when joyn'd with *Seven*,

4.685

Or *One*, mark hurtful Portions of the Heaven.

4.686

*Five* multiply'd by *Five* is hardly clear'd,

4.687

And *Seven* to *Twenty* added 's to be fear'd:

4.688

All these are noxious Portions of the Sky,

4.689

Too *Hot*, or *Cold*, or else too *Moist*, or *Dry*.

## XXV. How the Signs Act when they rise.

4.690

This known, the Work is not compleatly done,

4.691

The Labours still increase as you go on;

4.692

The Time makes difference, as they *Rise*, new force

4.693

They gain, and after *lose* it in their Course.

## Aries.

4.694

Thus when the *Ram* ascends, and proudly turns

4.695

His bending backward Neck before his Horns

4.696

To Mortal Eyes, the wretched Births are Curst

4.697

With Ravenous Tempers, and inflam'd with Lust:

4.698

All Modesty shall be to *Gold* betray'd,

4.699

Nor *Parents* Care secure the easie *Maid*:

4.700

These Tempers are his own; as Fancy leads

4.701

He roves, and wantons o're the flowry Meads:

4.702

Forward to push, and as the Grass renews

4.703

His wasted Strength, he Courts the willing Ews.

4.704

To *Travel* he inclines through Lands unknown,

4.705

He Ploughs new Seas, and makes the World his own:

4.706

This he prefigur'd when his Back convey'd

4.707

Young *Phryxus* safe, and lost the *falling Maid*.

## Taurus.

4.708

The *Bulls* bright part that first appears, creates

4.709

Vile *Pathicks* scandals to the other Fates.

4.710

The Cause, if it be fit to search for one

4.711

When Nature works, may easily be shewn;

4.712

His *Back-part* first appears, in that he bears

4.713

The narrow Cloudy Train of *Female* Stars:

4.714

And thus the *Posture*, and the *Sex* combine

4.715

To shew the Influence of the rising Sign:

4.716

He bends to Plow, and o're the Fruitful Plains

4.717

The Labouring Ox grows Fat upon his Pains.

## Gemini.

4.718

But when their *Feet* the rising *Twins* do shew,

4.719

And half appear *above*, half lye *below*,

4.720

The *Births* are happy, all their Parts refine,

4.721

And Arts enrich the Treasures of their Mind;

4.722

*Ready* their *Wit*, persuasive is their *Tongue*,

4.723

In *Musick* skill'd, and excellent in *Song*:

4.724

These are the Powers their rising Rays dispense,

4.725

They *Wit* bestow, and fix that *Wit* with *Sense*.

## Cancer.

4.726

When rousing *Cancer* riseth vail in Clouds,

4.727

I'th' Skies as deeply hid as in the Floods,

4.728

The Moon resembling when depriv'd of Light;

4.729

The *Births* are *Blind*, and wish in vain for sight:

4.730

By *Fates* a Verse condemn'd to *double* Death,

4.731

Dead whilst Alive, and Buryed whilst they breath:

4.732

But when the *Lion* shews his ravenous Jaws

## Leo.

4.733

Prepar'd for Rapine, and unsheaths his Paws,

4.734

A *Spendthrift*'s born, who minds himself alone,

4.735

He wrongs his Father, and he cheats his Son;

4.736

His Race in vain with expectation wait,

4.737

For in himself he buries his Estate;

4.738

So vast his Gluttony, his Lust so wild

4.739

That he devours himself, yet is not fill'd:

4.740

And whilst his Appetite proceeds to crave

4.741

He eats his Funeral, and he spends his Grave.

## Virgo.

4.742

When *Virgo* rises, (who whilst Right prevail'd

4.743

Rul'd here below, retreating when it fail'd)

4.744

To awful Honors all the *Births* must rise

4.745

Profoundly skill'd in Sacred Mysteries:

4.746

Good, Pious, Just, Devout, *unus'd to Rage*

4.747

And great Examples to the *looser* Age:

4.748

But when *Autumnal Scales* do first appear

## Libra.

4.749

Happy the *Birth*, he shall be known from far,

4.750

The Glory of the *Bench*, and of the *Bar*;

4.751

He justest Laws shall make, and Life and Death

4.752

Depend upon the Issues of his Breath;

4.753

Him Towns shall fear, the *Earth* observe his Nod,

4.754

And after Earth the *Heaven* enjoy a God.

## Scorpio.

4.755

Thus Act these Signs, but *Scorpio*'s Tayl displays

4.756

A *double* Influence from his *Forked* Rays;

4.757

For when that first appears, tho *Peaceful* Child

4.758

Shall Cities *Raise*, and be inclin'd to build;

4.759

The World shall see him with his <sup>161</sup> *Plow* surround

4.760

The place design'd, and mark the fatal Bound;

4.761

Or he shall wast what others Pains did raise,

4.762

Where Populous Cities stood, there Beasts shall graze,

4.763

Or Harvests grow; He leads to these *Extreams*,

4.764

And *Power* agreeing waits upon his Beams.

## Sagittarius.

4.765

Bold *Sagittarius*, when he first appears,

4.766

Heats the gay *Birth*, and makes him fam'd for Wars;

4.767

In Triumphs great, the Wonder of the Crowd,

4.768

By Captives carry'd, he almost a God

4.769

Shall climb the *Capitol*, bright Fame pursue,

4.770

*Old* Cities raze, or grace the Earth with *New*:

4.771

But ill success, (his Forehead's wreath'd with Frowns)

4.772

Shall wast his Fame, and blast his gather'd Crowns.

4.773

Thus Conquering *Hannibal*, by this Sign betray'd

4.774

Before his slight perceiv'd his Wreaths to fade,

4.775

He paid for *Trebia*'s and for *Cannae*'s fame,

4.776

And recompenc'd our Losses by his shame.

4.777

But when the narrow *Goat* erects his Tail

## Capricornus.

4.778

He drives to *Sea*, and much inclines to *Sail*,

4.779

Ignoble Trade then Ploughs the dangerous Main,

4.780

And precious Life is meanly stak'd for Gain.

4.781

The *Good*, the *Pious*, and the *Just* are born

## Aquarius.

4.782

When first *Aquarius* pours out his *Vrn*.

## Pisces.

4.783

But could I rule, could I the *Fates* design,

4.784

The rising *Fishes* ne're should govern mine;

4.785

They give a *Hateful*, *Pratling*, *Railing* Tongue,

4.786

Still full of *Venom*, always in the wrong;

4.787

That *blows* up Jealousies, and heightens Fears,

4.788

By muttering *Poys'nous Whispers* in Mens Ears.

4.789

*Faithless* the Births, and full of *wild* desire;

4.790

Their Faith is Treachery, and their Love is Fire.

4.791



For when the Skies grew weak, when *Giants* strove,

4.792

And snaky *Typhon* shook the Throne of *Jove*;

4.793

Fair *Venus* fled, and in a *Fish's* shape

4.794

(This *Syria* knows) secur'd her mean escape;

4.795

Then did she through the *Scaly Kind* inspire

4.796

New *Heats*, and with the *Ocean* mixt her Fire.

4.797

No *single Births*, for when this Sign begins,

4.798

*Twins* shall be Born, or those that shall have *Twins*.

4.799

Now learn what *Signs* o're different Lands controle,

4.800

But first take this short figure of the *whole*:

The winds call'd Cardinal.

4.801

*East*, *West*, and *North*, and *South*, on either side,

4.802

These *Quarters* lie oppos'd, the World divide:

4.803

As many *Winds* from these *four Quarters* flie,

4.804

And fight and rattle, thro' the empty Sky:

4.805

Rough *Boreas* from the *North*, bears Frost and Snows,

4.806

And from the *East*, the gentle *Eurus* blows.

4.807

Wet *Auster* from the torrid *South* is thrown,

4.808

And pleasing *Zephyrus* cools the setting Sun.

### The Collateral winds.

4.809

'Twixt these *two other* Winds their Seats do claim,

4.810

Alike in Nature, different but in Name.

4.811

Around the *Earth* the liquid *Ocean* plays,

4.812

The Ball enclosing with a soft Embrace;

4.813

But yet on many parts, *Earth's* bending sides,

4.814

Or *open Bays* receive the flowing Tides.

### The Mediterranean Sea and the several parts of it.

4.815

The Sea admitted from the *Western* Shores,

4.816

Doth on the Right Hand wash the swarthy *Moors*;

4.817

And *Lybia's* Sands, where once great *Carthage* stood,

4.818

Then o're the *Syrtes* whirls the rapid Flood;

4.819

And thence to *Egypt* it directly flows,

4.820

Where what dry Heaven denies, the *Nile* bestows.

4.821

The Left Hand Sea by *Spain* and *France* extends,

4.822

And follows Conquering *Italy* as it bends;

4.823

Till into Streights the barking *Sylla* draws,

4.824

And whirls it round *Charybdis* greedy Jaws;

4.825

Loos'd from these Streights, the Flouds spread wide again,

4.826

And freely flow in the *Ionian* Main:

4.827

Then on the left they turn, and winding flow,

4.828

Fair *Italy* surround, and drink the *Po*.

4.829

Then make rough *Adria*'s Gulph; the other side

4.830

*Illyrium* washes with a gentle Tide,

4.831

Sees *Epire*'s Cliffs, and *Corinth*'s lofty Towers,

4.832

Then winds round plain *Morea*'s open Shores.

4.833

Thence *Northward* into vast recesses tost

4.834

The Sea confines the Learn'd *Achaia's* Coast:

4.835

Thence *North* and *Eastward* the unwilling Flood

4.836

Consin'd by Streights, and stain'd with *Helle's* Blood

4.837

To fam'd *Byzantium* cuts its winding way,

4.838

And joyns *Propontis* to the *Euxine* Sea;

4.839

Behind whose back the Lake *Meotis* lies

4.840

Receives full *Tanais*, and the Sea supplies.

4.841

Hence when the Circling Waves return again

4.842

The weary Sailer to the *Open* Main,

4.843

He cuts th' *Icarian*, and th' *Aegaeon* Tide

4.844

By *Asia's* Coasts, and wonders at their Pride:

4.845

And whilst the left hand Course he still pursues

4.846

As many *Trophies*, as he places views;

4.847

A thousand Nations, <sup>162</sup> *Taurus* mount, that threatens

4.848

The Floods, the *Bay* that from the Sea retreats

4.849

Parcht *Syria's* Plains, and the *Cilician* Seats,

4.850

Till he at last to *Egypt* turns his Oars

4.851

And sees the Waves dye on the swarthy Shores.

4.852

Thus ruling Nature draws her bounding Lines,

4.853

Checks midland Seas, and all their Rage confines.

## The Islands of the Mediter-anean.

4.854

Yet midst this Sea a thousand *Islands* rise;

4.855

Shap'd like a Foot the low *Sardinia* lies

4.856

Near *Lybia*'s shores; *Trinacrid* fill'd with Fires,

4.857

But just cut off from *Italy*, retires,

4.858

And adverse *Greece Euboean* Cliffs admires.

4.859

*Jove*'s Birth-place *Crete* appears, a goodly Isle,

4.860

And *Cyprus* beaten by the adverse *Nile*.

4.861

A thousand lesser Isles Command these Seas,

4.862

*Rhodes*, *Delos*, and the equal *Cyclades*,

4.863

Fam'd *Aulis*, *Tenedos*, and by *Sardinia*'s side

4.864

Lies *Corsica*, and breaks the coming Tide;

4.865

Near the Streight's Mouth the *Baleares* Reign,

4.866

And strong *Ebusus* Triumphs o're the Main.

4.867

Ten thousand smaller Rocks the Waves disperse,

4.868

Too little to be nam'd, too mean for Verse.

4.869

Nor doth the *Ocean* but one single way

## The Caspian Sea.

4.870

Attempt the Earth, and force an open Bay,

4.871

It tries on every side, but Mountains bound

4.872

Insulting Billows, and preserve the Ground;

4.873

For 'twixt the Summer *East* and *Northern* Pole

4.874

Through narrow Channels secret Waters roul,

4.875

Till spread at last upon the open Plain

4.876

They make the *Caspian* like the *Euxine* Main.

## The Persian Gulph.

4.877

*Southward* encroaching Waters doubly press,

4.878

O' reflow the Earth, and in a vast recess

4.879

One part more *East* runs on, and breaks a way

4.880

Through *Persia's* Banks, and makes the *Persian* Bay:

4.881

More *West* the other soft *Arabia* beats

## The Arabian Gulph.

4.882

Where Incense grows, and pleasing Odor sweats,

4.883

Which sends us Gums soft *Luxury* to please,

4.884

And reconcile the angry Deities:

4.885

Strange that the same, when differently apply'd,

4.886

Should calm the Rage of Heaven, and serve our Pride.

4.887

This Bay is call'd th' *Arabian* Gulph, the Name

4.888

The Country gives it, and 'tis great in Fame.

## Africa.

4.889

Thus lie the Seas; Earth midst this mighty Flood

4.890

Contains, first *Africk*, where proud *Carthage* good;

4.891

Once great in Arms, and whose extended sway

4.892

O're *Libya* stretcht, and made the *Spains* obey:

4.893

When *Hannibal* wrapt *Alban* Towns in flame,

4.894

And eterniz'd the bloody *Trebia*'s Name;

4.895

When led by Fate he March'd to overcome,

4.896

And pour'd his swarthy *Libya* upon *Rome*:

4.897

When gasping *Consuls* groan'd on every Plain,

4.898

And *Canna*'s Fields were burd'ned with the slain.

4.899

Here Nature angry with Mankind prepares

4.900

Strange Monsters, Instruments 30 of future Wars;

4.901

Here Snakes, those Cells of Poyson, take their Birth,

4.902

Those living Crimes and grievance of the Earth;

4.903

Fruitful in its own Plagues, the Desart shore

4.904

Hears *Elephants*, and frightful *Lions* roar;

4.905

Serious it seems in all these Monstrous shapes,



4.906

But sports in the lewd Limbs of Mimick *Apes*.

4.907

The Country's large, the Barren Plains extend

4.908

A mighty space, and then in *Egypt* end.

## Asia.

4.909

Thence *Asia* spreads, a fruitful Soil, the Streams

4.910

Roul Golden Sand, the Ocean shines with Gems;

4.911

The Trees drop *Balsom*, and on all the Boughs

4.912

Health sits, and makes it Sovereign as it flows.

4.913

Thence *India* lies, a Land more large than thought,

4.914

The *Parthians* oft, though not securely fought;

4.915

They flying still delude *Rome*'s firmer Powers,

4.916

And yet Command a different World from Ours.

4.917

These *Taurus* bounds, whose threatning Mountains rise

4.918

To awful Hights, and wound the lower Skies;

4.919

A thousand Nations lie by *Tanais* flood

4.920

Which cuts the *Scythia's*, stain'd with humane blood;

4.921

By Lake *Meotis*, and the *Euxine* Tide

4.922

Which Nature sets as bounds to *Asia's* Pride.

## Europe.

4.923

*Europe* remains, which first the Beauteous load

4.924

Receiv'd, and where the *Bull* confess'd the God;

4.925

Hence came its Name, in that the grateful *Jove*

4.926

Hath Eterniz'd the Glory of his Love:

4.927

Here *Greece* is seen, with Ruin'd Antient *Troy*,

4.928

And shew'd what Fates attend unlawful joy:

4.929

A Country Rich in Men of wondrous parts,

4.930

The place of Learning, and the Seat of Arts:

4.931

Here *Athens* stands, which makes the best pretence

4.932

To Sovereignty in Wit and Eloquence:

4.933

For Courage *Sparta*, and for Deities

4.934

Fam'd *Thebes*, whose *Heroes* People half the Skies:

4.935

*Epirus, Thessaly*, whose lasting Praise

4.936

One single *Pyrrhus*, and *Achilles* raise.

4.937

To these *Illyrium* joyns, and Warlike *Thrace*,

4.938

The Seat of *Mars*, and breeds a stubborn Race.

4.939

Thence <sup>163</sup> *Germany*, a mighty Country runs,

4.940

And wonders at the vastness of her Yellow Sons.

4.941

Thence South and Westward in a fertile Plain

4.942

Lies *France*, for Tribute fam'd, for Battels *Spain*:

4.943

But *Italy* Crowns all, whom *Rome* hath given

4.944

Command of Earth, and joyns <sup>164</sup> her self to Heaven:

## What Signs govern each Country.

4.945

These Bounds the Earth, and these the Seas confine,

4.946

And *God* allots to every part a *Sign*;

4.947

No Land is free, no stately Town deny'd

4.948

The kind Protection of a Starry Guide:

4.949

For as in Man, the work of Hands Divine,

4.950

Each Member lies allotted to a Sign;

4.951

And as the Body is the common care

4.952

Of all the Signs, each Limb enjoys a share:

4.953

(The *Ram* defends the *Head*, the *Neck* the *Bull*,

4.954

The *Arms* bright *Twins* are subject to your Rule;

4.955

I'th' *Shoulders Leo*, and the *Crab's* obey'd

4.956

I'th' *Breast*, and in the *Guts* the modest *Maid*;

4.957

I'th' *Buttocks, Libra, Scorpio* warms desires

4.958

I'th' *secret parts*, and spreads unruly fires:

4.959

The *Thighs*, the *Centaur*, and the *Goat* Commands

4.960

The *Knees*, and binds them up with double bands.

4.961

The parted *Legs*, in cold *Aquarius* meet,

4.962

And *Pisces* gives protection to the Feet.)

4.963

So in the greater World, the Members share

4.964

Celestial Rulers, and enjoy their Care:

## Why different Countreys bear Men of different Shapes and Colours.

4.965

Hence different Men, in different Climes we view,

4.966

They vary in their shape, or in their Hue;

4.967

The Matter's common, and in all the same,

4.968

But private Stamps, distinctly mark the Frame.

4.969

Vast Yellow Offsprings are the *German's* Pride,

4.970

Whilst Neighbouring *France* is not so deeply dy'd:

4.971

But hotter Climates narrower Frames obtain,

4.972

And low-built Bodies are the growth of *Spain*:

4.973

*Hesperia* mixeth sweet with many Grace,

4.974

And temper'd *Mars* appears in every Face:

4.975

Whilst active *Greece* produceth finer parts,

4.976

Their looks betray their Exercise and Arts:

4.977

Short Curl'd up Hair the Sons of *Syria* grace,

4.978

Whilst *Ethiopia's* Blackness stains the Face,

4.979

With Horrid Shapes she does her Sons expose,

4.980

Distends their swelling Lips, and flats their Nose:

4.981

Less *India* blackens, less it Crusts the Mass,

4.982

And mixeth Colours in the Tawny Face:

4.983

But *Egypt*'s slimy Plains affect the sight

4.984

With brighter Colours, and approach to White.

4.985

Parcht *Lybia* burns her Sons, the vilest Shapes

4.986

She shews, and scarce divides her *Men* from *Apes*:

4.987

Whilst *Mauritania* doth disgust the Eye,

4.988

(Her Name betrays it) with the blackest Dye.

4.989

Tho' each Speech Organs fram'd alike employs,

4.990

How many Languages confound the Voice?

4.991

How different Vertues Reign, how different Crimes?

4.992

Mens Manners are as various as the Climes.

4.993

Like Trees transplanted by the Farmer's Toyl;

4.994

Vice turns to Vertue, in another Soyl.

4.995

Tho' Seed the same, yet different Fruits are born,

4.996

Thus Yellow *Ceres* varies in her Corn.

4.997

Nor doth the Vine on every Hill produce

4.998

Like Grapes, nor *Bacchus* press an equal Juice.

4.999

Rich *Cinnamon*, not every Country bears,

4.1000

Nor are all Fields bedew'd with *Myrrha*'s Tears.

4.1001

Nor is this great variety exprest

4.1002

In *Man*, and *Fruits* alone, but it divides the *Beast*:

4.1003

Here Lions roar, and there in dreadful Wars

4.1004

The high-built Elephant his Castle rears;

4.1005

Looks down on Man below, and strikes the Stars

4.1006

As many parts, so many Worlds appear,

4.1007

For every part is subject to a Star;

4.1008

They spread their Influence, and the Countreys pay

4.1009

A due compliance to the Fatal Ray.

## What Countreys are govern'd by Aries.

4.1010

Plac't midst the pleasing Vernal Signs, the *Ram*

4.1011

Commands the narrow *Streight* o're which he swam;

4.1012

When from the Mothers Rage, his Fleece convey'd

4.1013

The Brothers safe, and dropt the falling *Maid*;

4.1014

Content he swam, and with his Burthen pleas'd,

4.1015

He mourn'd his Loss, and griev'd to be so eas'd:

4.1016

The near *Propontis* too his Beams obeys,

4.1017

And *Syria* feels the Influence of his Rays:

4.1018

The loose Garb'd *Persians*, know his gentle Rule,

4.1019

Their Garments bear Relation to his Wool:

4.1020

With *Nile* that swells at Fiery *Cancers* Beams,

4.1021

And *Egypt* drown'd by its ore-flowing Streams.

4.1022

Cold *Scythia*'s Rocks; *Arabia*'s wealthy Groves,

## By Taurus.

4.1023



And powerful *Asia*, *Taurus* Empire proves,

4.1024

Rich in their Corn, and wanton in their Loves.

### By Gemini.

4.1025

The boisterous Euxine, bent like *Scythian* bows.

4.1026

Beneath the *Twins* subjection gladly flows,

4.1027

And they of *Ganges* infant Streams dispose.

### By Cancer.

4.1028

The swarthy *Indians* Fiery *Cancer* sways,

4.1029

His Rule the Blackness of their Hue betrays,

4.1030

And *Ethiopia*'s heated with his Ray.

4.1031

The *Phrygian* Plains the large *Bithynian* Woods

4.1032

The 33 Servant of the Mother of the Gods,

### By Leo.

4.1033

The *Lion* own, the *Cappadocian* Shoar

4.1034

With fierce *Armenia*, hear the *Lion* Roar.

4.1035

And *Macedon*, that all the World subdu'd,

4.1036

Submits to the Great Monarch of the Wood.

By *Virgo*.

4.1037

In happy *Rhodes* the gentle *Maids* ador'd,

4.1038

*Rhodes*, the retirement of our future 34 Lord:

4.1039

Blest Island truly Sacred to the Sun,

4.1040

E're since in thee the Glorious *Coesar* Shone,

4.1041

The World's great Light, whom with expecting Eyes;

4.1042

Mankind desires, and longs to see him rise.

4.1043

The *Dorick* Plains, the rich *Ionian* Towns,

4.1044

*Arcadia* Rival to the waining Moons:

4.1045

With Warlike *Caria* high in Antient Fame

4.1046

Owe all Subjection to her modest Flame.

By *Libra*.

4.1047

What Sign, could you dispose the Signs, should fall

4.1048

To *Latium*'s share, but that which poizeth all;

4.1049

To which by Nature, it must needs belong

4.1050

To value things, and separate Right from Wrong.

4.1051

In which the Times are weigh'd, and Day with Night

4.1052

Are met, the Darkness equal to the Light:

4.1053

The *Scales* rule *Italy*, where *Rome* Commands,

4.1054

And spreads its Empire wide to Foreign Lands:

4.1055

They hang upon her Nod, their Fates are weigh'd

4.1056

By her, and Laws are sent to be obey'd:

4.1057

And as her powerful Favour turns the Poize,

4.1058

How low some Nation's sink and others rise:

4.1059

Thus guide the *Scales*, and then to fix the Doom,

4.1060

They gave us <sup>165</sup> *Caesar*, Founder of our *Rome*.

## By Scorpio.

4.1061

The following Sign rules *Carthage* Conquer'd Towers,

4.1062

Subject they lie, to *Scorpio*'s Scaly Powers;

4.1063

With *Lybia*'s Sand, and *Egypt*'s fruitful Soil,

4.1064

The slimy <sup>166</sup> Gift of the o're-flowing *Nile*.

4.1065

Large Bounds, but yet too narrow to confine

4.1066

The vast Ambition of this craving Sign;

4.1067

He claims the Isles of the *Italian* Main,

4.1068

And low *Sardinia*'s subject to his Reign.

### By Sagittarius.

4.1069

To *Crete* the *Centaur* makes an hateful claim,

4.1070

And still keeps up the Memory of its shame:

4.1071

It bore a *Centaur* once, and that confines

4.1072

The Isle to the same Figure in the Signs:

4.1073

To him their Skill and Darts, the *Cretans* owe,

4.1074

And imitate the sureness of his Bow.

4.1075

*Trinacria* follows, *Crete*'s Example draws

4.1076

Her Sister Isle, and yields it to his Laws;

4.1077

And *Latium's* Shores, which narrow Friths disjoyn,

4.1078

Here baffle Nature, and in him combine,

4.1079

Nor would be differenc'd by another Sign.

### By Capricornus.

4.1080

The West, and Northern Parts, rich *France* and *Spain*,

4.1081

Contracted *Goat*, are subject to thy Reign,

4.1082

And *Germany*, since <sup>167</sup> *Varus* stain'd thy Shore,

4.1083

A Seat for Beasts, and fit for Man no more:

4.1084

This monstrous Sign hath variously engrost,

4.1085

(He Rules at Sea and Land) thy doubtful Coast,

4.1086

Now Earth appearing, now in Water lost.

### By Aquarius.

4.1087

But Young *Aquarius* with his watry Fires,

4.1088

From *Egypt* to the *Clydae* Isles retires;

4.1089

The stout *Cilicians*, and the Neighbouring Plain

4.1090

With Sailing *Tyre* are subject to his Reign.

## By Pisces.

4.1091

When Heaven grew weak, and a successful fight

4.1092

The *Giants* rais'd, and *Gods* were sav'd by flight;

4.1093

From Snaky *Typhon's* Arms, a *Fishe's* shape

4.1094

Sav'd *Venus*, and secur'd her from a Rape:

4.1095

*Euphrates* hid her, and from thence his Streams

4.1096

Owe all Obedience to the *Fish's* Beams.

4.1097

Wide *Parthia's* Plains confin'd by mighty Rocks,

4.1098

The Nations round, long bent unto its Yokes

4.1099

With *Tigris* Streams, the *Red-Sea's* shining Shores

4.1100

Are Subject to the Heavenly *Fish's* Powers.

What Influence these Signs have in the seveveral  
Countries subject to their Rule.

4.1101

Thus *Earth's* divided, these the *Signs* that sway

4.1102

Its Portions, and the Parts their Beams obey;

4.1103

These Signs the Tempers of their Empires show,

4.1104

The Parts above, directing those below,

4.1105

Their Powers infuse: And thus as Ruling Signs

4.1106

Are now *Oppos'd*, and now agree in *Trines*,

4.1107

Or other *Site* maintain, which *Site* directs

4.1108

Their Fatal Influence, various in Effects;

4.1109

So Towns with Towns, and roaring Seas with Seas,

4.1110

And Land with Land, or differs or agrees.

4.1111

And as these Signs direct, so Men should choose

4.1112

This Town, this Country, or that Seat refuse;

4.1113

Here Hate expect, there surest Friendship prove,

4.1114

As Heaven directs, and Stars decree above.

## XXVII. What Signs are Eccliptick.

4.1115

But now attend, for Signs Eccliptick claim

4.1116

Thy Care, and learn the Reason of the Name:

4.1117

For some, as weary'd in their tedious Race,

4.1118

Grow restiff, dull, nor keep their usual pace.

4.1119

Nor is this strange, for through the mighty Frame

4.1120

There's nothing that continues still the same:

4.1121

As Years wheel round, a change must needs ensue,

4.1122

Things lose their former State, and take a new.

4.1123

Now tir'd with Births, the Fields refuse to bear,

4.1124

Now unmanur'd, prevent the Tiller's care.

4.1125

Dilated Vapours tear the solid Earth,

4.1126

Strong the Convulsions at the Fatal Birth;

4.1127

Vast Mountains sink: And now his large Command

4.1128

*Neptune* extends, and Seas o're-spread the Land,

4.1129

Contemning Shores: Thus were the Towns o're-flow'd

4.1130

When Mankind's single Heir *Deucalion* stood

4.1131

On steep *Parnassus*, to repair the Stock,

4.1132

The spacious World possessing in one Rock.



4.1133

And when bold *Phaeton*, with unequal force

4.1134

The Chariot fill'd, and drove the Flaming Horse;

4.1135

The Earth took Fire, Heaven saw the Stars recoil,

4.1136

And frighted Nature fear'd one common *Pile*.

4.1137

So much as Years roul round, the mighty Frame

4.1138

Is chang'd, yet still returns to be the same:

4.1139

And so the Stars, whilst they revolve their Course,

4.1140

Now lose their Power, and now regain their force.

## Why call'd *Eccliptick*.

4.1141

The Reason's plain, for when depriv'd of Light,

4.1142

The Moon *Ecclipst*, lies vail'd in sudden Night;

4.1143

Whilst hindring Earth diverts her Brother's Ray,

4.1144

These Signs *Eccliptick* feel the same decay;

4.1145

They feeble grow, they hang their bending Head,

4.1146

And mourn, and pine, as if the *Moon* were dead.

4.1147

Now *Signs Eccliptick* (see the Name betray

4.1148

Unusual Languor, and a weak decay,)

4.1149

Grow weak by *Pavis*, and those not *Neighbouring Signs*,

4.1150

But *Opposite*; for thus our Art defines,

4.1151

Because the *Moon* then only feels decay,

4.1152

When *Opposite* unto her Brother's Ray.

4.1153

Nor is this Languor, nor these Times of Grief

4.1154

Alike to All, fome quickly find relief;

4.1155

Some Languish long, and e're their Mourning's done,

4.1156

The Sun goes round, and all the Year is run.

In what Order the Eccliptick succeed one another.

4.1157

But when their Grief is o're, the next in turn

4.1158

Begin to Languish, and prepare to Mourn;

4.1159

The next in turn, that are in Order plac't

4.1160

On either side, the Two that Languish't last:

4.1161

To speak distinctly, <sup>168</sup> those two Signs that view

4.1162

And leave the *Earth* before the former two.

4.1163

Not that the *Earth* doth noxious Powers dispense,

4.1164

Or Subject Heaven to its dull Influence;

4.1165

But since the World turns round, the Orb obeys,

4.1166

And Signs abate the vigour of their Rays,

4.1167

Not by *Earth's* Influence, but by their place.

XXVIII. This Artho' difficult, yet may be obtain'd.

4.1168

But what avail my Songs, if all refuse

4.1169

The profer'd Aid of my obliging Muse?

4.1170

If puny fear forbids our Hopes to rise,

4.1171

To enter boldly, and enjoy the Skies?

4.1172

What Nature hides, (for thus Objections teach)

4.1173

Is deeply hid, too deep for Man to reach.

4.1174

Vast the Recess! Though stubborn Fate should Reign,

4.1175

And we know this, yet all the search were vain,

4.1176

Since none can find the Links that make the Chain.

4.1177

Fond Mortals! why should we our selves abuse?

4.1178

Nor use those Powers which *God* permits to use?

4.1179

Basely detract from the Celestial mind,

4.1180

And close our Eyes, endeavouring to be blind?

4.1181

We see the Skies, then why should we despair

4.1182

To know the Fatal Office of each Star?

4.1183

To open Nature, to unveil her Face,

4.1184

Go in, and tread the Order of the Maze?

4.1185

Why should we not employ the Gifts bestow'd

4.1186

By Heaven, in knowing the kind Author of the Good?

4.1187

Our Work grows short, we may surround the Ball,

4.1188

Make the whole World our own, and live in all:

4.1189

Through what remains, we now with Ease may pierce,

4.1190

Take, and enjoy the Captive Universe:

4.1191

Our Parent Nature we, her parts, descry,

4.1192

And Heaven-born Souls affect their Father Skie:

4.1193

For who can doubt that *God* resides in Man,

4.1194

That Souls from Heaven descend, and when the Chain

4.1195

Of Life is broke, return to Heaven again?

4.1196

As in the Greater *World* aspiring Flame,

4.1197

Earth, Water, Air, make the Material Frame;

4.1198

But through these Members a Commanding Soul

4.1199

Infus'd, directs the Motions of the whole;

4.1200

So 'tis in *Man*, the lesser *World*, the Case

4.1201

Is Clay, unactive, and an Earthly Mass;

4.1202

Bloods Circling Streams the Purple Soul convey,

4.1203

The Ruling *Mind* uniting to the Clay:

4.1204

Then who can wonder that the *World* is known

4.1205

So well by Man, since he himself is One?

4.1206

The same Composure in his Form is shew'd,

4.1207

And *Man's* the little Image of the *God*.

4.1208

Now other Creatures view, how mean their Birth,

4.1209

The Rubbish, and the Burdens of the Earth:

4.1210

Some hang in Air, some float upon the Waves,

4.1211

Born for our use, and bred to be our Slaves.

4.1212

All their Enjoyments are confin'd to Sense,

4.1213

The easie Works of wary Providence.

4.1214

But since they Reason want, their Tongues are mute,

4.1215

How mean, how low a Creature is a Brute?

4.1216

No Mysteries disclos'd, commend their Parts,

4.1217

Nor are they Subjects capable of Arts;

4.1218

How hard the Labour, yet how often vain

4.1219

To bring them foolishly to Ape a Man?

4.1220

But ruling Man extends his larger sway

4.1221

Beyond himself, and makes the World obey;

4.1222

Wild Beasts are tam'd, The Fields are forc't to bear,

4.1223

And Recompence the Labours of the Share.

4.1224

In vain the Sea disjoyns the distant Shores,

4.1225

His Sails the Winds command, the Floods his Ores.

4.1226

Alone erect his Form doth nobly rise,

4.1227

Up to the Stars he lifts his Starry Eyes,

4.1228

And takes a nearer Prospect of the Skies:

4.1229

He searches *Jove*, and whilst his Thoughts do trace

4.1230

His kindred Stars, in them he finds his Race.

4.1231

No outside Knowledge fills his vast Desires,

4.1232

The more he riseth, he the more aspires.

4.1233

We think it Reason that in *Augury*

4.1234

We should on *Birds*, and slaughter'd *Beasts* rely;

4.1235

And can the *Fates* be less in *Stars* exprest,

4.1236

Than in a Bird, or Entrails of a Beast?

4.1237

When *God* his Mind in meaner things declares,

4.1238

Should he neglect the Glory of the Stars?

4.1239

Besides, the World is eager to be known,

4.1240

Our search provoking still; for rouling on

4.1241

It shews us all its parts, displays its Light,

4.1242

And constantly intrudes upon our Sight:

4.1243

His Face unvail'd, God doth so plainly shew,

4.1244

That if we will but look, we needs must know:

4.1245

He draws our Eyes, nor doth our search forbid;

4.1246

What Powers he hides not, he would not have hid:

4.1247

Then who can think it impiously bold

4.1248

To search what we're encourag'd to behold?

4.1249

Nor think thy force too small, too weak thy *Mind*

4.1250

Because to *Clay* unequally confin'd;

4.1251

Its Power is wondrous Great; how small a Mass

4.1252

Of Gold or Gems, exceeds vast Heaps of Brass?

4.1253

How little is the Apple of the Eye?

4.1254

And yet at once, he takes in half the Sky:

4.1255

Nor dreads the disproportion to the Sense,



4.1256

The Organ small, the Object is immense:

4.1257

And from the narrow limits of the Heart,

4.1258

The Active Soul doth vigorous Life impart

4.1259

To all the Limbs, its Sway the Members own,

4.1260

Wide is its Empire from its petty Throne.

4.1261

Man know thy Powers, and not observe thy Size,

4.1262

Thy noble Power in piercing *Reason* lies,

4.1263

And *Reason* conquers all, and rules the Skies.

4.1264

Nor must you vainly doubt that *Man's* allow'd

4.1265

To know *Heaven's* mind, since *Man* can make a God:

4.1266

A Star <sup>169</sup> new rais'd, the Skie enlarg'd contains,

4.1267

And *Heaven* must still encrease whilst *Caesar* Reigns.

*The End of the Fourth Book.*

## Book V

*Having explain'd the general influence of the Twelve Signs of the Zodiack, and given a particular account of their interchanges with one another, and how they incline when they rise; after a short Preface, in which he magnifies his own Industry, and unweary'd diligence in this Subject: He goes on, 1. To*

shew what Constellations rise with the several Degrees of the Twelve Signs, and then what Tempers they bestow, and to what Studies they incline: For instance, 2. The Northern Rudder of the Ship, riseth with the fourth Degree of Aries, and those that are then Born, shall be inclin'd to Sail, and prove good Pilots: 3. Orion riseth with the same Degree of Aries, and those that are Born under his Influence, shall be Men of busie, active Tempers, Solicitors, cringing Parasites and Flatterers: 4. Heniochus or the Driver, riseth with the fifteenth Degree of Aries, and makes Charioteers, Horse-Racers, and Men skill'd in all sorts of Horseman-ship: 5. With the Twentieth Degree of Aries, the Hoedi or the Kids rise, and those, being wanton Stars, produce nothing that is Vertuous or Noble: Their Births are wanton, light, and lustful, and never Couragious, but in pursuit of some shameful lewd Pleasure; some of their Births, are peculiarly delighted in feeding and keeping Goats: 7. With the Twenty-seventh Degree of Aries, rise the Hyades: And their Births are always turbulent and Seditious, prone to Factions, restless Phanaticks, or else, they give their Minds to Country Affairs, feed Cattle, or turn Waggoners: 7. With the Thirtieth Degree of Aries, the Goat riseth; and those that are Born under that influence, shall be fearful, jealous, suspicious, and inconstant, or else inclin'd to Travel: 8. He says the Pleiades rise with the sixth Degree of Taurus; and the Men that are then Born, shall be gay, and humorous, witty, but too effeminate and soft, minding nothing but Dress, Gate, and Love: 9. The Hare riseth with the seventh Degree of Gemini or the Twins; and her Births are active and nimble, fit for all sports, all feats of activity, and slight of hand: 10. The Asses rise with the first Degree of Cancer; and those that are Born under their influence, shall be employ'd in all sorts of Hunting and Fishing: 11. With the twenty-seventh Degree of Cancer, Procyon or the little Dog rises, and that produceth such as weave Nets, make Spears, and all other Instruments of Huntsmen: 12. The Great Dog riseth with Leo, and being himself a Constellation of excessive heat; those that are Born under his influence, shall be full of Passion, Hate, Jealousie, and ungovernable suspicion, and given to excess in Wine; their Heat shall lead them on to dangers, and engage them to hunt wild Beasts. 13. With the last Degree of Leo, the Bowl appears, and inclines to plant and dress Vines; the Births shall be somewhat intemperate,

inclin'd to Merchandise, and to trade in those Commodities, which cannot be brought to perfection without moisture: 14. With the fifteenth Degree of Virgo, the Crown of Ariadne riseth, and then the Births shall be Florists; they shall delight in making and perfuming Garlands, be Gay; Amorous, and affect neatness in their Habit. 15. The Sheaf riseth with the tenth Degree of Virgo, and inclines Men to look after Corn, to build Barns, to Grind and Bake Grain, and make it useful: 16. With the eighth Degree of Libra, the Arrow rises, and then are Born expert Darters, and good Bow-Men, such as Philoctetes, Teucer, and Alcon. 17. The Goat or Hoedus, riseth with some part of Libra, and produceth Tempers quick and active, fit for Business, and covetous of Employment: somewhat loose, but honest to their Country, and Enemies to Knaves. 18. The Harp rising with some part of Libra, breeds Songsters and Musicians; such as affect to Sing in Company, and are always humming to themselves. 19. The Altar rising with the eighth Degree of Scorpio, breeds Priests, Servants in Temples, and such as take care of and consult Oracles. 20. The Southern Centaur rising with the twelfth Degree of Scorpio, breeds Horse-Men, Charioteers, and Farriers. 21. With the fifth Degree of Sagittarius, Arcturus appears, and breeds Collectors of Customs, Treasurers for Kings, or Stewards for private Mens Estates. 22. With the thirtieth Degree of Sagittarius, the Swan rises; and then are Born all kinds of Fowlers such as Teach Birds to speak, to sing, or to decoy, &c. all their Employments shall be about Birds. 23. With some part of Capricorn, Ophieuchus, or the Snake-holder riseth, and produceth such as are skill'd in during poison'd Persons, and such as cannot be poison'd themselves. 24. With the last Degrees of Capricorn, the Southern Fish rising, breeds Anglers, Divers, Fishers for Pearls, &c. or at least, Traders for Fish and Pearls. 25. With some part of Capricorn the Harp, (or rather the Strings of it, for of the Shell Manilius hath already spoken) riseth, and produceth subtle Accusers, Justices that shall examine nicely, and determine justly; or such as shall torture, and force the Guilty to Confession. 26. With some Degree of Capricorn, the Dolphin riseth, and breeds all sorts of Swimmers, such as are nimble and active, and perform feats of activity, either in the Water, or on Land. 27. Cepheus rising with some Degree of Aquarius, breeds Men of Morose Tempers, such as are design'd for Guardians, or

Tutors, Tragick Poets, and sometimes Comedians, Stage-Players, Pantomimes, and all sorts of Actors. 28. With, the twelfth Degree of Aquarius, the Eagle riseth, and breeds Men of the most violent Tempers, head-strong, and bloody, greedy of spoyl, and destroying every thing that opposeth them; under-Officers in an Army, and Armor-bearers to a General. 29. Cassiopeia rising with the twentieth Degree of Aquarius, breeds Founders in Metals, Goldsmiths, Jewellers, &c. 30. With the twelfth Degree of Pisces, Andromeda riseth, and breeds Goalers, and all sorts of Executioners, cruel, pitiless and bloody. 31. With the twenty-first Degree of Pisces, the Horse riseth, and breeds strong, vigorous, active Men, excellent Horsemen, either for the Race or War, Farriers, and Physitians 32. With the thirtieth Degree of Pisces, the kneeling Constellation, or Hercules appears; and his Births are Lewd, Treacherous Villains, given to no useful Arts, at best Juglers and Rope-dancers. 33. With the same Degree of Pisces, the Whale riseth, and produceth Fishers, Fishmongers, makers of Salt, &c. 34. The Bears (Manilius tells us, what he means by their rising) are joyn'd with Leo and Scorpio, and breed such as are employ'd in breeding Beasts, and particularly Bears. 35. There follows a fragment, in which the Poet Treats of the several magnitudes or sizes of the Stars, that make up the several Constellations. It is confess'd that Manilius shews no great exactness in the Astronomical part of this Book but the Astrology is perfect and, may for the most part be apply'd to the most correct Astronomy.

## The design of the Fifth Book.

5.1

HEre at the Signs, those Paths of yearly light,

5.2

Weak Minds would stop; nor dare a farther flight:

5.3

But through the Planets Orbs would take their Course

5.4

At one full stoop from Heaven, and mark their force;

5.5

What *Mercury* design'd, what *Mars* did dare,

5.6

Or *Luna* thought on in her Gloomy care:

5.7

What *Sol* would work, how *Saturn* look'd on *Jove*,

5.8

And *Venus* manag'd her Intrigue of Love:

5.9

No farther would their feeble Thoughts aspire,

5.10

And other Stars had roul'd unheeded Fire.

5.11

But since *I'm* once on wing, and rais'd on high,

5.12

I'll boldly soar, and compass *all* the Sky;

5.13

I'll visit *every Star*, and strive to know

5.14

Their proper Powers, and how they Rule below:

5.15

Avoid no labour, and no toyl refuse,

5.16

Whilst constant *Industry* can aid my *Muse*.

## The Southern Constellations.

5.17

Here vast *Orion* Heaven's great part, the Streams,

5.18

Whose Spacious Windings mix agreeing Beams;

5.19

The *Hero's Ship* which now midst Stars doth Sail,

5.20

The frightful *Centaur*, and the gaping *Whale*,

5.21

The *Dog*, whose Fires o're all the World are rould,

5.22

The watchful *Keeper* of the growing Gold;

5.23

And Heaven's high *Altar* grac't with Gifts invite

5.24

My eager Muse to take a larger flight.

## The Northern Constellations.

5.25

There where the *Serpent* twines betwixt the *Bears*,

5.26

Where roulds the *Driver*, and still minds his Cares:

5.27

Where slow *Bootes* drives his lingring Teams,

5.28

Or *Ariadne's Crown* spreads Heavenly Beams:

5.29

Where *Perseus* soars with *Gorgon's* Spoils above,

5.30

And weilds his Fauchion to secure his Love:

5.31

Where wretched *Cepheus* and his *Wife* beside

5.32

The fair *Andromeda* still Curse their Pride;

5.33

Or where <sup>170</sup> oppos'd the scaly *Dolphin* lies

5.34

To the swift *Shaft*, or where the *Eagle* flies,

5.35

Or Starry *Horse* still runs, my Muse must move,

5.36

And boldly visit every Star above.

5.37

These I must Sing, their *proper* Powers explain,

5.38

How when they *rise*, how when they *set* they Reign:

5.39

And what Degrees they claim from every *Sign*,

5.40

And what extend their force, and what confine:

5.41

For when the *World* was Fram'd, the *Mighty Cause*

5.42

These Powers bestow'd, and did Enact these Laws;

5.43

How Signs should singly work, how Stars agree,

5.44

And settled all things by a firm Decree.

## II. What Constellations rise with Aries.

5.45

First Golden *Aries* Shines, (who whilst he swam

5.46

Lost part of's Freight, and gave the Sea a Name:

5.47

Whose <sup>171</sup> Skin destroy'd himself, whose Golden Spoyl

5.48

Forc't fierce *Medea*, from her Native Soyl;

5.49

Then Magick Arts to *Cholchis* Shores confin'd

5.50

First Sail'd abroad, and Poyson swell'd the Wind:)

5.51

And now as Victor o're the Conquer'd Deep

## The Ship.

5.52

He keeps his Power, and still Commands the *Ship*:

5.53

For when the <sup>172</sup> *Northern Rudder* rears its Flame,

5.54

And in the fourth Degree, first joyns the *Ram*:

5.55

Who ever's born, shall be to Sail inclin'd,

5.56

He'll Plow the Ocean, and he'll tempt the Wind;

5.57

He o're the Seas shall Love, or Fame pursue;

5.58

And other Months, another <sup>173</sup> *Phasis* view:

5.59

Fixt to the Rudder, he shall boldly Steer,

5.60

And pass those Rocks which <sup>174</sup> *Tiphys* us'd to fear.

5.61

Had no such Births been born *Troy's* Walls had stood,

5.62

No <sup>175</sup> Wind-bound Navy, bought a Gale with Blood;



5.63

No <sup>176</sup> *Xerxes Persia* o're the Ocean roul'd,

5.64

Dug a new Sea, nor yet confin'd an old.

5.65

No *Athens* sunk by <sup>177</sup> *Syracusan* Shores,

5.66

Nor *Lybia's* Seas been choakt with *Punick* Oars,

5.67

Nor had the World in doubt at *Actium* stood,

5.68

Nor <sup>178</sup> Heaven's great Fortune floated on the Flood:

5.69

Such Births as these their hopes to Seas resign,

5.70

Ships spread their Sails, and distant Nations joyn,

5.71

The *World* divided, mutual Wants invite

5.72

To close again; and Friendly Ships unite.

### III. Orion.

5.73

But when *Orion* on the left doth rise,

5.74

*Orion* <sup>179</sup> the large Portion of the Skies;

5.75

At whose appearance Day the Night invades,

5.76

And frighted Darkness folds her Gloomy Shades:

5.77

One fit for Business, quick of Mind is wrought,

5.78

Of Body nimble, and of Active Thought:

5.79

As if he were the <sup>180</sup> People, all the Town

5.80

He shall inhabit, every House his own:

5.81

And one Salute, when <sup>181</sup> Morning peeps, extend

5.82

Through every Street, to All a Common Friend.

#### IV. Heniochus, or the Driver.

5.83

But when the *Ram* first shews thrice five Degrees,

5.84

The *Driver* rears his Chariot from the Seas;

5.85

And climbs that Steep, whence blustering *Boreas* brings

5.86

His North-East Blasts, and shakes their freezing Wings.

5.87

He keeps his old Concern, and thence bestows

5.88

Those various Arts which here on Earth he chose.

5.89

To drive the <sup>182</sup> Chariot, to direct the Course,

5.90

And hang with forward Lashes on the Horse;

5.91

Now press directly, now wheel nimbly round,

5.92

Out-strip the Wind, nor raise the dusty Ground;

5.93

Or cross athwart, and force the rest to yield,

5.94

Disperse the Crowd, and clear the gapeing Field:

5.95

And tho' outstript, yet scorn to stoop to Fear,

5.96

But, drive on Hope, and leave behind Despair.

5.97

Or midst the Race from <sup>183</sup> Horse to Horse to leap,

5.98

Sport o're their Backs, and fix the dangerous step:

5.99

Or *singly* mounted break the Foaming Jaws,

5.100

Throw well the *Dart*, and force a just applause.

5.101

Hence influenc't at his Birth <sup>184</sup> *Salmon* strove

5.102

To vye with Lightning, and to Rival *Jove*;

5.103

His Brazen Bridge, and Chariots fiercely hurl'd

5.104

Must roar like Thunder, and must shake the World.

5.105

Vain the attempt: But yet his Pride was high,

5.106

And now he thought he had brought down the Sky:

5.107

Proudly he rode, but winged Bolts pursue,

5.108

And his feign'd *Thunder's* noise provok'd the True;

5.109

He fell, and by his sad Example shew'd

5.110

'T was Fate for *Man*, to be esteem'd a *God*.

5.111

The fam'd *Bellerophon* first view'd the Light

5.112

When *this* appear'd, and took his Aery Flight:

5.113

O're Seas and Land he fled, and first began

5.114

Through pathless Skies, a way unknown to Man.

## V. The Hoedi, or the Kids.

5.115

But when the *Ram* twice Ten Degrees doth shew,

5.116

Where on the Right rough *Boreas* Tempests blow;

5.117

The *Kids* appear: But never hope to find

5.118

Severe in Manners, nor correct in Mind

5.119

Their Births; from them no Censuring *Catos* come

5.120

To settle Vertue, and adorn their *Rome*.

5.121

No temperate *Scipio's*, whose obliging Charms

5.122

The *Spaniards* Conquer'd, and excell'd their Arms:

5.123

Too great a work for them, their Rays inspire

5.124

Soft *Love*, then heat that *Love* to fierce *Desire*:

5.125

Still urging on, they boyl that *Lust* to *Rage*,

5.126

And *Lust*, not *Courage*, make the Youth engage:

5.127

By *Death* bafe Pleasure is ignobly bought,

5.128

And the *Misfortune* hightned by the *Fault*:

5.129

By them are some to keeping *Goats* inclin'd,

5.130

The *Kids* being always mindful of their Kind:

5.131

Thence *Goatherds* rise, whose Pipes in every Vale

5.132

Soft *Love* inspire, and tell the moving Tale.

## VI. The Hyades.

5.133

But when the *Ram* hath doubled Ten Degrees,

5.134

And joyn'd seven more, then rise the *Hyades*;

5.135

Whose Births delight in Tumults, hate soft Peace,

5.136

Seditions seek, and live averse to Ease:

5.137

The Desks the <sup>185</sup> *Gracchi*, Souldiers crowd the Town

5.138

They love to see, and scorn the peaceful Gown.

5.139

They seek Contention, and when none appears

5.140

They heighten Jealousies, and nourish Fears.

5.141

Or meanly bent, they o're the fruitful Plain

5.142

Their Cattel feed, or drive the lazy Wain:

5.143

Such Minds these give, such Tempers these bestow,

5.144

Curst Influence! rais'd too high, or bent too low.

## VII. The Goat.

5.145

But when the *Ram* hath trebled Ten Degrees,

5.146

Shines all above, excluded all from Seas;

5.147

The Goat (whose Bruitish Dugs did once improve

5.148

The mighty Babe, and nurst the growing *Jove*;

5.149

Who gave him strength to Thunder) first appears,

5.150

Breeds timorous Births, and fills their Breasts with Fears.

5.151

On slight Occasions, they with Doubts are Curst,

5.152

Suspicious, jealous, fearing still the worst.

5.153

Or Travellers bent on foreign Lands they breed;

5.154

Thus o're the Rocks *Goats* wander as they feed:

5.155

Now seek this Plain, and then as fast pursue

5.156

What tempts their sight, leave old, and seize the new.

## VIII. What Constellations rise with Taurus.

5.157

Thus far the *Ram's* concern'd, and next the *Bull*

5.158

Joyns other Stars, and varies in its Rule:

5.159

For mounting upward in his backward rise

5.160

When Six Degrees appear, and grace the Skies,

## The Pleiades.

5.161

He shews the *Pleiades*: Whose Rays incline

5.162

To Joys of *Venus*, and the Charms of Wine:

5.163

Feasts their delight, where witty biting Drolls

5.164

Raise Mirth, and Health swims round in flowing Bowls.

5.165

Such are these Stars gay Births; their Face, their Dress

5.166

They chiefly mind, and 'tis their work to please:

5.167

Offended with their Sex, their Manly Hair

5.168

With Pumice kill, and Curse those Limbs that bear.

5.169

Female they seem; now borrow'd Curls must raise

5.170

Their Heads, and Love must play in every Maze:

5.171

Now Gems must bind them up, now loose behind

5.172

Their Locks must flow, and wanton in the Wind:

5.173

Affected in their Gate, grow *Fops* by Rule,

5.174

And with great study, finish *Nature's* Fool.

5.175

Yet high Ambition, and a Thirst to please

5.176

(The Name of Vertue covers the Disease:)

5.177

Still fire their Breasts, nor from their Souls remove,

5.178

They would not only *Love*, but would be known to *Love*.



## IX. What Constellations rise with the Twins.

5.179

The *Twins* succeed, and when their Seventh Degree

5.180

Swims rising o're the Surface of the Sea;

### The Hare.

5.181

The *Hare* appears, whose active Rays supply

5.182

A nimble force, and hardly Wings deny:

5.183

The *Whirlbats* falling Blow they nimbly shun;

5.184

And win the Race, e're they begin to run.

5.185

Let Feasts unbend the Clowns, let Labour yield

5.186

To Sport and Mirth, and Pastime Crown the Field;

5.187

None give so sure, and none avoid the Fall

5.188

So well; or catch and turn the flying Ball.

5.189

To vigorous stroak their active Arms command,

5.190

Or with their *Foot* supply the place of *Hand*.

5.191

Or when in Sport they shall the <sup>186</sup> Balls divide

5.192

From Hand to Hand, and toss on every side;

5.193

Now throw the flying Globes, and now retain,

5.194

Or play them back upon themselves again:

5.195

Now back, now forward, round, and every way

5.196

O're all their Limbs the active Balls shall play,

5.197

As taught to know their meaning, and obey.

5.198

Whilst Crowds admire, and think the constant cares

5.199

Of Art effect what is the work of Stars.

5.200

Wak't whilst asleep, they tame by active Pleasure

5.201

Their growing Troubles, and Sports employ their leisure.

## X. What Constellations rise with Cancer.

5.202

Thus those agree. And next my Songs comprise

5.203

Stars near the *Crab*, with whom the *Asses* rise:

5.204

Then Births appear, whose Skill infests the Woods,

The *Asses*.

5.205

Lay Snares for Beasts; nor do they spare the Floods:

5.206

On all they Prey, they boldly search the Caves;

5.207

Nor are the Fish secure in deepest Waves:

5.208

Then <sup>187</sup> *Meleager* rose, whose fatal Brand,

5.209

And Life too wasted in his Mother's Hand;

5.210

Unhappy Noble Youth! who must atone

5.211

Her wretched Brothers Slaughter by thy own!

5.212

Half bury'd whilst alive! Whom *Love* betray'd

5.213

To give the *Hero*'s Honors to the Maid;

5.214

To rob thy jealous Uncles of their Fame,

5.215

And by their Death secure the Beauty's claim.

5.216

Then *Atalante* rose, who prest for Fame

5.217

Through thickest Woods, and saw and overcame;

5.218

Her Dart first reacht the Boar, and wan the Prize,

5.219

She Conquer'd with her Arrow, and her Eyes;

5.220

The Monster groan'd, and *Meleager* found

5.221

As much disquiet, and as deep a Wound.

5.222

Some pitch strong Nets, and some the Woods surround

5.223

With <sup>188</sup> fear of Death, or slip the faithful Hound:

5.224

Some dig the treacherous Pits, some spread the Toyls,

5.225

Or hunt with Spears, and Grace their House with Spoyls.

5.226

Another puts to Sea, infests the Lakes,

5.227

Draws monstrous Fish, and starts at what he Takes.

5.228

Whilst some through Nets the wandring Waters strein,

5.229

Their Game they follow thro' the pathless Main,

5.230

Where no *Scent* lies, yet seldom Hunt in vain.

5.231

As if the Earth were not profusely stor'd,

5.232

They fly to *Seas*, they search what Floods afford,

## XI. Procyon, or the little Dog.

5.233

And *Nereus* from his Waves supplies the Glutton's Board:

5.234

But when the Crab hath doubled Tèn Degrees,

5.235

And rear'd seven more, bright *Procyon* leaves the Seas:

5.236

His Influence mean; But tho' his feeble Flame

5.237

No Hunters breeds, yet it supports the Game:

5.238

Inclines to Weave strong Nets, to Train the Hound,

5.239

To know the Breed, and to improve the Sound.

5.240

To shave the Spear, and follow every Trade,

5.241

That Love of Sport, and Hope of Gain persuade.

## XII. What Constellations rise with the Lion.

5.242

But when the *Lion's* gaping Jaws aspire,

5.243

The *Dog* appears, and foams unruly Fire.

5.244

In Caves scorcht *Neptune* mourns contracted Floods,

### The great Dog.

5.245

Herbs dye, and Beauteous Greenness leaves the Woods;

5.246

To other Climates Beasts and Birds retire,

5.247

And Feverish Nature burns in her own Fire.

5.248

So vast the Heat, such Flames increase the Sun,

5.249

As if all Heaven's great Fires were joyn'd in one.

5.250

Air's turn'd to Dust, the Earth's low Entrails burn,

5.251

And dying Nature fears one common Urn.

5.252

When this appears, his rising Beams presage

5.253

Ungovern'd Fury, and unruly Rage;

5.254

A flaming Anger, universal Hate

5.255

With Jealousie make up his Births unhappy Fate:

5.256

Each little Cause doth scorching Thoughts inspire,

5.257

Their Soul's inflam'd, and Words break out in Fire:

5.258

Yet crowd so fast, they jostle as they rise,

5.259

And part flies out in Sparkles through their Eyes.

5.260

Their Tongue's on Foam, and with their Teeth they break

5.261

Their Words, and *Bark* when they design to *Speak*.

5.262

Besides, excess in Wine inflames their Fire,

5.263

And *Bacchus* makes their Fury blaze the higher.

5.264

They fear no Rocks, nor Woods, but love to Gore

5.265

The furious Lion, and the Foaming Boar;

5.266

They dread no Beasts, but with blind Warmth engage,

5.267

And to their natural strength infuse their Rage:

5.268

Nor is it strange that from his Beams should rise

5.269

Such Tempers; for above through yielding Skies

5.270

Averse to Peace, he cuts his furious way,

5.271

And hunts the *Hare*, intent upon his Prey.

### XIII. The Bowl.

5.272

The *Lion* mounts, and with his last the *Bowl*

5.273

Studded with Stars comes up, and cheers the Pole:

5.274

And then who e're are born, their Minds incline

5.275

To water Meadows, and to dress the Vine.

5.276

To Hills, Lakes; Rivers: To what e're produce

5.277

The generous Liquor, and improve the Juice:

5.278

Now Bridegroom *Elms* they shall in order place,

5.279

And bring the blushing *Brides* to their embrace;

5.280

Entwine their Boughs: Or when the Stock's display'd

5.281

Without support, nor needs a Foreign Aid,

5.282

In Branches lead it; and uncurious grown

5.283

Trust reeling *Bacchus* to himself alone.

5.284

Or from the Stock, the hopeful Tendrils tear,

5.285

Plant them anew, and teach the Twigs to bear.

5.286

Use all improving ways that Art hath sought,

5.287

By long Experience, or wise Nature taught:

5.288

When ripe their Bowls the generous Wine shall Crown,

5.289

Soften their Cares, and all their Wishes drown;

5.290

They largely shall enjoy their Fruits, nor spare

5.291

The pleasing Recompences of their Care:

5.292

Happy this State; but *Stars* still force them on,

5.293

And urge their greedy Minds to be undone:



5.294

For Corn, and Foreign Stores which moisture yields,

5.295

They'll Plow the Ocean, and forsake their Fields

5.296

Till tost by Storms, they midst the Waves resign

5.297

Their baffled Hopes: And thus the *Bowl* inclines.

#### XIV. What Constellations rise with Virgo.

5.298

Next Shines the *Maid*, and when the *Maid* ascends

5.299

Thrice Five Degrees, the glorious *Crown* attends.

5.300

The *Crown*, since *Theseus* first his Faith betray'd,

#### The Crown[...]

5.301

The Monument of the forsaken *Maid*:

5.302

They give *Soft Arts*, for here the *Virgin* Shines,

5.303

And there the *Virgin's Crown*, and each combines

5.304

*Soft Beams* agreeing in the same Designs.

5.305

Births influenc'd then shall raise fine Beds of Flowers,

5.306

And twine their creeping *Jasmine* round their Bowers;

5.307

The Lillies, Violets in Banks dispose,

5.308

The Purple Poppy, and the blushing Rose:

5.309

For Pleasure shades their rising Mounts shall yield

5.310

And real Figures paint the gawdy Field:

5.311

Or they shall wreath their Flowers, their Sweets entwine,

5.312

To Grace their Mistress, or to Crown their Wine

5.313

The Odors fair *Arabia's* Groves dispense

5.314

Sovereign for Health, or grateful to the Sense,

5.315

Shall bath these Wreaths; for when the Sweets unite,

5.316

The new *Adultery* heightens the delight.

5.317

Besides they'll study Neatness, learn to dress,

5.318

Affected grow, and think it Art to please:

5.319

The present Pleasures Court, and gay desires;

5.320

For this the Virgin's Age; and this the Crown requires.

## XV. The Sheaf.

5.321

When with her Tenth Degree, the *Sheaf* appears,

5.322

Shews her full Corn, and shakes her loaden Ears:

5.323

The Fields may fear, for those that shall be born

5.324

Shall Plough the Ground, and be intent on Corn:

5.325

They'll trust their Seed to Clods, whose large produce

5.326

Shall yield the *Sum*, and give increase by *Vse*.

5.327

Build Barns for Grain, for Nature those contrives,

5.328

And in the *Ear* it self a Pattern gives;

5.329

In that the Corn lies safe, her Laws ordain

5.330

A proper different Cell for every Grain:

5.331

How blest the World, had this been only known,

5.332

Had *Gold* lain hid, and *Corn* been born alone!

5.333

Then Men were rich, when they could Want suffice,

5.334

And knew no Baits for Lust, and Avarice.

5.335

Yet had they still employ'd their Cares on Corn

5.336

Alone, those Arts would have been slowly born,

5.337

Which make Grain useful, and for Common good

5.338

Grind, Mould, and Bake, and work it up to Food.

## XVI. What Constellations rise with Libra.

5.339

Now Southward bend, and see in Southern Skies

5.340

With *Libra*'s Eighth Degree the *Arrow* rise:

5.341

Their Beams are strong: They curious Arts bestow,

5.342

To dart the Javelin, and to draw the Bow;

5.343

Or sling the Bullet; from the lofty Clouds

5.344

Swift Birds shall drop, nor shall the deepest Floods

5.345

Secure their Fish: But both shall surely feel

5.346

The fatal force of the unerring Steel:

5.347

What powerful Stars but these drew here below

5.348

Brave <sup>189</sup> *Philoctete*'s and sure <sup>190</sup> *Teucer*'s Bow?

5.349

One *Hector*'s Flames repell'd, the angry Fire

5.350

Did fear his Shafts, and sullenly retire;

5.351

The other bore *Troy's* Fate, more dreadful far,

5.352

He sate *Exil'd*, than all the *Greeks* in War.

5.353

He own'd those Stars, <sup>191</sup> who when the Serpent lay

5.354

Twin'd round his Child, and Suckt the Bleeding Prey;

5.355

Ventur'd to shoot: The pious Arrow fled

5.356

As sent by Fate, and pierc'd the Dragon's Head:

5.357

To be a Father then was Art, and Love

5.358

By Stars unaided, had but vainly strove;

5.359

They drew the Bow, restor'd the flying Breath

5.360

To the lost Boy, and wak'd the Youth from Death.

## XVII. The Goat.

5.361

But when the heedless *Goat* <sup>192</sup> Exalts his Beard,

5.362

Alone, as stragling from the other Herd;

5.363

Then Tempers quick, and piercing Minds are wrought,

5.364

With Cares unweary'd, and of active Thought:

5.365

They scorn that Rest, which private Minds enjoy,

5.366

But fawn upon the Crowd, and Court Employ;

5.367

That's their delight, and they're enlarg'd by Fate

5.368

To serve the Many, and be Slaves of State.

5.369

Whilst they survive, smooth *Knaves* shall fear to Cheat

5.370

In hopes of scapeing, or of grownig Great;

5.371

They shall espouse their injur'd Country's Cause,

5.372

And be severe, yet not exceed the Laws;

5.373

Imprison Cheats, or else with rigorous Fines

5.374

Break their Estates, and curb their lewd Designs.

5.375

Happy this Temper, would they still pursue

5.376

These useful Pleasures, and affect the True;

5.377

But they'll from Business, and from Court retire,

5.378

(Loose are their Words, and looser their Desire;)

5.379

Lewd Love and Wine indulge, and wast their Age

5.380

In Mimick Dancing, or affect the Stage.

## XVIII. The Harp.

5.381

Next shines the *Harp*, and through the Liquid Skies

5.382

The *Shell* as lightest, first begins to rise;

5.383

This when sweet *Orpheus* struck, to listning Rocks

5.384

He Senses gave, and Ears to wither'd Oaks;

5.385

Parch'd *Pluto's* <sup>193</sup> Cheeks grew moist, and *Death* resign'd

5.386

Her Spoil, and unrelenting *Fates* grew kind.

5.387

These skill in Musick, and in Songs impart;

5.388

How Sound is vary'd into Notes by Art

5.389

Their Births shall know: Their Mouths shall Pipes inspire

5.390

With voice; Their Hands shall strike the speaking Lyre:

5.391

At merry Feasts they shall the Guests delight,

5.392

Smooth Wine with Songs, and stay the flying Night.

5.393

Nay e'en when Troubles, and when Cares oppress,

5.394

Their Mournful Lays, shall give their Sorrows Ease.

5.395

Low Murmurs shall employ their warbling Tongue,

5.396

And their own Ears shall always hear a Song:

## XIX. What Constellations rise with Scorpio.

5.397

Below fierce *Scorpio*, when his Eighth Degree

5.398

Appears, the *Altar* riseth from the Sea:

5.399

No Lightning arm'd *Jove's* Hand, no Thunder roard

## The Altar.

5.400

Till here as Priest he stood, and first ador'd;

5.401

Then Powers unknown assisted, Clouds did swell

5.402

With Fire, and the Devoted *Giants* fell:

5.403

And who should then be born, but those that wait

5.404

On Sacred Temples, and converse with Fate?

5.405

That Hymn in Holy Quires, know what's to come,

5.406

Are almost *Gods*, and can dispose of Doom?

## XX. The Centaur.

5.407

With Twelve Degrees the *Centaur's* Form appears,



5.408

And gives a Temper from the shape he bears;

5.409

For he that then is born, and feels his force,

5.410

Shall harness Mules, or he shall drive the Horse;

5.411

Or he shall proudly mount the ratling Car,

5.412

Or Arm the Steed, and lead him forth to War;

5.413

Or he shall study what Disease infests,

5.414

And Ease apply to uncomplaining Beasts;

5.415

Or he shall keep them sound, his Art be shown

5.416

In sure Prevention, nor expect a Groan.

## XXI. What Constellations rise with Sagittarius.

5.417

Next *Sagittarius* mounts with threatning Bow,

5.418

Whose Fifth Degree doth bright *Arcturus* show:

5.419

And he that then is born shall ne're be Poor,

5.420

To him rich *Fortune* shall entrust her Store;

5.421

King's Treasures he shall keep, and Reign alone,

## Arcturus.

5.422

Whilst those sit only higher in the Throne:

5.423

Or if a *Private* House confine his Care,

5.424

Blest he shall live, and see the thriving Heir

5.425

In Wealth increast; Or he shall still defend

5.426

The People's Right, and be a Common Friend.

5.427

But when this *Centaur* hath advanc'd his Fire

## XXII. The Swan.

5.428

Thrice Ten Degrees, and shews his *Horse* entire;

5.429

The *Swan* displays his Wings; And then by Fate

5.430

The *Birds* for an Employment, and Estate

5.431

Are given to every Birth: Nor can the Skies

5.432

Make better claim to every Fowl that flies;

5.433

And hence to seize their own, they oft declare

5.434

Against the Sky it self an open War;

5.435

They take them flying, or they set their Toyls

5.436

On Boughs or Fields, and catch the Feather'd Spoils.

5.437

Sometimes besiege their Nestswith treach'rous Reed,

5.438

Or draw the Net, and take them whilst they feed:

5.439

Thus Luxury toyls; bold Luxury ventures far

5.440

To Foreign Lands, and Travels more than War:

5.441

*Numidia's* Plains, and *Cholcos* Woods afford

5.442

Delicious Tribute to the Glutton's Board.

5.443

Or Nature's stubborn Laws their Art shall break,

5.444

Enlarge Converse, and teach the Birds to speak.

5.445

The <sup>194</sup> *Swan* still shrouds a God, 'tis more than Fowl,

5.446

The Feather'd part confines a noble Soul;

5.447

And when cold Death comes on, the God dilates

5.448

His Powers, and softly murmurs o're his Fates.

5.449

Or they on *Doves* shall all their Cares employ,

5.450

To make them Thrive, or teach them to decoy,

5.451

Or carry Messages; the Birds convey

5.452

Their Masters Orders, nor mistake their way:

5.453

They know this Star, and they this Influence own,

5.454

Who carry sportive Birds about the Town;

5.455

Who with one *Sparrow* wretched Life maintain;

5.456

These are his Powers, and thus inclines the *Swan*.

### XXIII. With Capricorn riseth *Ophieuchus*.

5.457

When *Ophieuchus* mounts, and joyns the *Goat*,

5.458

Those that are born shall live an Antidote

5.459

To strongest Poyson; they may safely take

5.460

The frightful Serpent, and the Venom'd Snake

5.461

Into their Bosom: Whilst the Monster's Cling

5.462

About their Bodies kils their fiercest Sting.

### XXIV. The South Fish.

5.463

When the South *Fish* doth leave the Floods, and rise

5.464

To Airy Seats, and swims in Liquid Skies;

5.465

Those that are born in every Shore shall lay

5.466

Their Lines and Hooks, and catch the hanging Prey;

5.467

No Fish in their own Shells shall safely live

5.468

By Nature fortify'd, whilst these can dive,

5.469

All shall be dar'd; and they immerst shall rove

5.470

Thro' Depths, despair'd, and lost to those above;

5.471

Till with their dancing Prey they mount again;

5.472

So small is the reward of all this Pain!

5.473

Or Fish for Pearls, for *Avarice* cheats the Mind

5.474

By valuing Things not for their *Worth*, but *Kind*.

5.475

Vile *Shells*, which Nature midst the Floods hath laid,

5.476

Asham'd of the mean work that she hath made;

5.477

When drawn up hither equal Provinces;

5.478

Nor can the *Land* now bear the Riches of the *Seas*:

5.479

Such are the Tempers, and Success that waits

5.480

On these Stars Influence, and compleats their Fates.

5.481

Or free from danger they incline to gain

5.482

By Merchandise, what others get by Pain.

## XXV. The Strings of the Harp.

5.483

Before I sung the *Harp*'s Commanding Powers,

5.484

And taught the Influence of its fatal Hours;

5.485

Back to the same my Muse doth now retire,

5.486

Pleas'd with the sounding Vertues of the *Lyre*:

5.487

For when its gay Harmonious *Strings* appear,

5.488

Let Sin grow Pale, and Villains learn to fear:

5.489

For subtle Judges, whose Demands shall draw

5.490

Pale sculking Guilt within the reach of Law,

5.491

Shall then be born; or else the Births shall dare

5.492

To screw the Rack, and make the Wretch his Sin declare;

5.493

Steel'd against Pity, and averse to Spare.

5.494

All Pains inflict, be Cruel without Hate,

5.495

And make stern Justice wield the Sword of Fate:

5.496

Or if soft Methods can prevail, the Cause

5.497

They gravely shall determine by the Laws:

5.498

As Wisdom gave the Sentence, Strife shall cease,

5.499

Both sides be pleas'd, at least consent to Peace.

5.500

But when the *Dolphin's* Fires begin to rise

## XXVI. The Dolphin.

5.501

With Stars like Scales, and swim in Liquid Skies;

5.502

It shall be doubtful which shall most Command

5.503

The Inclination for the *Sea* or *Land*:

5.504

Both shall conspire, and in one Mass combind,

5.505

Now this way draw, now that way force the Mind:

5.506

For as the *Dolphin* mounts, now dives again,

5.507

Now turns, now leaps, and figures all the Main:

5.508

So those that shall be born shall now divide

5.509

With wide stretcht Arms, and beat the swelling Tide;

5.510

Now thrust them downward, and with secret Oars

5.511

Their Bodies row, and visit Foreign Shores;

5.512

Now tread the Water, with their Feet maintain

5.513

Themselves Erect, and wade the deepest Main,

5.514

As t'were a shallow; like the firmest Field,

5.515

The Floods shall bear them, and refuse to yield:

5.516

Now on their Backs or Sides securely keep

5.517

One constant place, and lie upon the *Deep*:

5.518

No Oar to Boy them up; but Floods forget

5.519

Their natural yielding, and sustain the Weight:

5.520

Or they shall dive, through boundless Oceans go,

5.521

And visit *Nereus*, and the *Nymphs* below;

5.522

Or take up Shipwracks, Merchants Spoils restore,

5.523

And rob the greedy Ocean of its Oar.

5.524

To these joyn those, who from an <sup>195</sup> Engine tost



5.525

Pierce through the Air, and in the Clouds are lost;

5.526

Or poize on Timber, where by turns they rise

5.527

And sink, and mount each other to the Skies:

5.528

Or leap through Fire, and fall on hardest Ground

5.529

As on soft Seas, unhurt, and safe from Wound:

5.530

Tho' void of Wings, their Bodies boldly rear,

5.531

And imitate their *Dolphin* in the Air.

5.532

Or if they want the skill, yet Nature's part

5.533

Perform'd, they shall be nimble without Art:

5.534

Not run, but rather fly, be swiftly born

5.535

O're Fields of Wheat, nor bend the standing Corn.

## XXVII. What Constellations rise with Aquarius. Cepheus.

5.536

When with *Aquarius Cepheus* mounts, require

5.537

No sportive Tempers from so grave a Fire:

5.538

But stiff, morose, severe, affected Fools,

5.539

With Looks as starcht, and heavy as their Souls:

5.540

Whose Guardian's roughness, or an Uncle's force

5.541

Praise, and in *Cato's* Sentences Discourse:

5.542

Design'd for Tutors, whom the noble Heir,

5.543

Altho' he keeps them, shall be forc'd to fear;

5.544

Shrink at their Nods, and of their Looks afraid,

5.545

Worship th' Imperious Idol he hath made.

5.546

Or *Tragick Poets*; Those whose *Style* must slay

5.547

In Paper, and be Barbarous in a Play:

5.548

Who must kill *Heroes* to delight the Crowd,

5.549

And seek to please with Horror, and with Blood:

5.550

*Antigone* <sup>196</sup> must fall the Tyrant's Spoil,

5.551

And *Brothers* disagree upon their Pile:

5.552

*Thyestes* eat his Babes, the Sun retire,

5.553

And jealous Rage the mad *Medea* Fire;

5.554

Her Father, Brother, Sons must Murder'd lie,

5.555

Whilst Dragons bear her through the Guilty Sky:

5.556

Or she must Youth renew; such Themes as these

5.557

Shall raise their Thoughts, and make them strive to please.

5.558

But then if softer Themes their Fancies move

5.559

In *Comedy*, the heated Youth shall Love;

5.560

The Maid be stoln, the witty Slave defeat

5.561

The covetous Father, and enjoy the Cheat.

5.562

Thus fam'd <sup>197</sup> *Menander* in immortal Rhymes

5.563

Exposeth Humour and instructs the Times;

5.564

Nature to him her Parts might safely trust,

5.565

His Words expressive, and his Thoughts were just;

5.566

And when he copy'd her, she hardly knew

5.567

Her own Original; he wrought so true.

5.568

But if unequal to a Poet's Rage

5.569

They cannot Write, yet they shall serve the Stage.

5.570

Their graceful action and their voice shall raise

5.571

The native value of another's Plays;

5.572

The *School's* Simplicity, the *Court's* Address,

5.573

The *Souldier's* Huff so decently express;

5.574

As if they acted not another's part;

5.575

And all was simple Nature, and not Art.

5.576

In one short view they shall present to sight

5.577

Whole Crowds, make Kings engage, and Armies fight:

5.578

Before the pleas'd Spectators *Troy* shall lye

5.579

In ruins, and the wretched *Priam* dye.

## XVIII. The Eagle.

5.580

But now the *Eagle* must my Songs employ,

5.581

He shines upon the left hand of the Boy,

5.582

Whom first from Earth he did to Skies convey,

5.583

And now with wide stretcht Wings hovers o're his Prey.

5.584

This Bird, the Armour-bearer of the Skies,

5.585

Brings back thrown Thunder, *Jove* with Arms supplies,

5.586

And with the *Youth*'s twelfth part begins to rise.

5.587

And then shall spring a violent ravenous Brood,

5.588

Eager to rob, and purchase Spoil with Blood:

5.589

On Men and Beasts with equal Lust they seize,

5.590

Nor make a difference between War and Peace.

5.591

Their Friends and Enemies alike they awe,

5.592

They every thing to wild contention draw,

5.593

Their Will their Ruler, and their Sword their Law.

5.594

But if their Violence aright they place,

5.595

Their Vice turns Vertue; conquer'd Spoils shall grace

5.596

Their happy Country; when in Arms they dare,

5.597

Success shall wait, and Victory crown their War.

5.598

But since the *Eagle* is employ'd above

5.599

Not to throw Thunder, but to wait on *Jove*,

5.600

And bring him Arms, they hope in vain to bear

5.601

The highest Office, and Command in War;

5.602

They must be meaner, equal to their Star:

5.603

Wait on a General, bear his ponderous Shield,

5.604

And serve him bravely in the dangerous Field.

## XXIX. Cassiopeia.

5.605

When mourning *Cassiopeia*, grac'd with Stars,

5.606

Upon the left hand of the *Youth* appears,

5.607

And joins twice ten Degrees, her Beams impart

5.608

In Metals skill, and fill the Births with Art:

5.609

The precious Matter they shall nobly mold,

5.610

And raise the native value of the Gold;

5.611

Hence shine our Temples, and our Roman *Jove*

5.612

Fills here a Heaven as bright as that above;

5.613

Happy this Art employ'd on things Divine,

5.614

To frame a Statue, or adorn a Shrine;

5.615

But now how low her Head she strives to hide,

5.616

Whilst chain'd to Luxury, and a Slave to pride!

5.617

Now precious Metals common Roofs enfold,

5.618

Rival the Temples, and we feast in Gold.

5.619

But great *Augustus* doth its state maintain,

5.620

Shews its old worth, and makes it rise again;

5.621

His Temples shine, and now such Works are wrought

5.622

As *Mithridates* lost when *Sylla* fought;

5.623

The Sun's outshone, and *Caesar's* glorious Gems

5.624

Excel the native lustre of his Beams:

5.625

And hence with joy we view that wondrous Prize,

5.626

The Monuments of <sup>198</sup> *Pompey's* Victories;

5.627

Though those did first a Lust for Gems inspire,

5.628

Which still burns new, and spreads a growing fire;

5.629

The Ornaments of Kings now serve to grace

5.630

A shape, and raise the value of a Face;

5.631

Now Neck, Feet, Hands are deckt, and every Dress

5.632

Shines with the Spoils of groaning Provinces;

5.633

Yet 'tis the *Ladies* Sign, their wants supply'd

5.634

Advance its worth, they love what decks their Pride:

5.635

Lest want of Matter should the Work restrain,

5.636

The Art grow idle, and the *Sign* be vain,

5.637

By the same Powers are wretched Men decoy'd

5.638

To dig for Oar, and work to be employ'd;

5.639

To turn the Globe to search where Metals breed,

5.640

And see young *Gold* first blushing in its Seed;

5.641

Harmless it lies, 'till the mistaken worth

5.642

Deludes poor Man, and brings the Monster forth.

5.643

And lest Temptations too obscure should lye,

5.644

Too far remov'd from every common Eye,

5.645

Mixt with the Sands they shine on every Shore,

5.646

These he shall gather, and extract the Oar,



5.647

Or dive for Jewels, and, intent on Gain,

5.648

Pierce thro the Floods, and search the deepest Main;

5.649

Draw Gold and Silver from the Waves embrace,

5.650

And work them singly, and adorn the Mass;

5.651

Or in *Electrum* both ignobly join:

5.652

These are the Powers and Tempers of this Sign.

### XXX. What Constellations rise with Pisces.

5.653

Next shines *Andromeda*; she leaves the Sea,

5.654

And on the Right joins *Pisces* twelfth Degree.

5.655

Bright she appears, and gay with sparkling Fires,

5.656

As when young *Perseus* first felt warm desires.

### Andromeda.

5.657

Unhappy Maid! expos'd to rage Divine,

5.658

A faultless Victim for her Mother's Sin:

5.659

When Seas let loose o'reflow'd the fruitful Plain,

5.660

And Earth now fear'd its ruin from the Main;

5.661

Nought could appease, but to the injur'd Flood

5.662

The Maid resign'd, to quench its rage with Blood.

5.663

This was her Bridal, in her Robes of State;

5.664

But not provided for so sad a Fate,

5.665

Glorious she lookt, and like the setting Sun,

5.666

Greater, tho not so sierce, her Beauty shone.

5.667

No joyful Torch its ominous Flames did spread,

5.668

No Vows were heard to crown her fruitful Bed;

5.669

But Groans and Tears, e're Death pronounc'd her doom

5.670

The *Maid* was born alive to her own Tomb.

5.671

Hence fly my Muse, and on the naked Shore

5.672

Leave the poor *Maid*, and dare to look no more;

5.673

'Twill melt thy Song to turn again to view,

5.674

The weeping Parents bid their last adieu;

5.675

To see her fetter'd, and expos'd to pain,

5.676

Design'd by Nature for another Chain:

5.677

To see her hang on Rocks, and by her side

5.678

Grim *Death* appear, and point to the swoln Tide.

5.679

Yet turn, and view how she her *Shape* retains,

5.680

How *fair* she looks, and *glorious* in her Chains:

5.681

With what becoming fear her flowing Vest

5.682

Forsakes her Limbs, and leaves her *naked* Breast:

5.683

What hidden Beauties are expos'd to sight,

5.684

Like *Lightning* glare, but must be lost in night.

5.685

By her the *Halcyons* mourn'd, and round the Coast,

5.686

That so much Beauty should in vain be lost,

5.687

The *Nymphs* repin'd; and *Nereis* from the Deep

5.688

Bewail'd her Fate, and did consent to weep:

5.689

The gentle *Breeze* that fann'd her golden Locks,

5.690

Turn'd into *Sighs*, and murmur'd to the Rocks:

5.691

All Nature seem'd concern'd, despairing Grief

5.692

Was general, but too weak to yield relief.

5.693

Then *Perseus*, glorious with the *Gorgon's* Spoil,

5.694

By *Love* directed to a nobler Toil,

5.695

Kind Fortune brought; and at the wondrous sight

5.696

He checkt his *Horse*, and stopt his airy flight;

5.697

His Hand scarce held his Spoil, *Medusa's* Eyes

5.698

He bore, but now grew stiff at this surprise;

5.699

The Chains that held her, and the burth'ned Stone

5.700

He *happy* call'd, and *envy'd* joys unknown.

5.701

Amaz'd a while he hung, her Form survey'd,

5.702

Then heard the Story from the weeping Maid;

5.703

Streight in his Breast *high generous* thoughts were bred,

5.704

To spoil the *Ocean* to adorn his Bed:

5.705

And should a thousand frightful *Gorgons* rise;

5.706

He would oppose them for so vast a Prize:

5.707

Fixt on these Thoughts he leaves the mournful Shore,

5.708

Her Parents chears, and bids them weep no more,

5.709

For *Aid* was come: And their Consent desir'd

5.710

Was granted soon, and *nobler* warmth inspir'd.

5.711

Back he returns: Now teeming Seas did roar,

5.712

Waves fled the *Monster*, and o'reflow'd the Shore;

5.713

High rais'd his Head, he spouts the Floods around,

5.714

All *Nereus* ecchoes, and the Shores resound:

5.715

Wide gapes his Mouth, and as on a vast Rock

5.716

Dasht on each Tooth the foaming *Billows* broke:

5.717

His winding Tail o're half the Main was spread,

5.718

The *Ocean* groan'd, Rocks fear'd, and Mountains fled:

5.719

Unhappy Maid! though such an *Aid* was near,

5.720

What was thy Mind, and how surpris'd with fear?

5.721

How pale thy Look? and how thy Spirit fled

5.722

In a deep sigh, and hover'd round thy Head?

5.723

How bloodless all thy Limbs, when from deep Caves

5.724

The *Monster* rush'd, and bore the foaming Waves

5.725

And Fate along? and all design'd for thee

5.726

A Prey how little, for so vast a Sea!

5.727

But *Perseus* nimble Aid descends, and hides

5.728

The *Gorgon's* Fauchion in his scaly Sides;

5.729

He twists upon the Wound, then strives to rear

5.730

His head, and shoots up forward thro the Air:

5.731

*Perseus* retires, and still deludes his Foe,

5.732

Hangs in the Sky, and aims a surer Blow:

5.733

He presses on, and casts his Jaws around,

5.734

Bites at the Air, but bites without a Wound.

5.735

Then tosses Seas to *Heaven*, spouts purple Floods

5.736

At his high [...]oe, and *drowns* him in the Clouds.

5.737

The *Maid* beheld this Fight, and, grateful grown,

5.738

Fear'd for his danger, but forgot her own;

5.739

Doubtful which way the various Fate inclin'd,

5.740

In *Body* less suspended than in *Mind*:

5.741

Her doubt not long; for now Success did prove

5.742

The great advantage, and the force of Love;

5.743

The *Monster* groan'd, and from his Wounds there flow'd

5.744

A mighty Stream, and stain'd the Seas with Blood.

5.745

Down deep he sinks, but soon he floats again,

5.746

And his vast Carcass covers all the Main;

5.747

Breathless he lay, yet then his shape did fright;

5.748

Tho dead, he was too dreadful for her sight.

5.749

Now big with Conquest, from the cleansing Flood

5.750

Bright *Perseus* rose, and more August he stood;

5.751

Then to the Rocks with eager haste he flies,

5.752

Unbinds the Virgin, and enjoys the Prize.

5.753

And thence *Andromeda* now shines a Star,

5.754

The Cause, and the Reward of such a War,

5.755

As freed the *Ocean*, and restor'd the Main

5.756

To *Neptune's* sway, and fixt him in his Reign.

5.757

And he that sees her *rising* Beams, shall draw

5.758

The Sword of *Justice*, and shall smite by Law;

5.759

Dungeons shall be, and Whips and Racks his care,

5.760

Steel'd against Pity, and averse to spare.

5.761

At his *stern feet* shall wretched Wives complain,

5.762

And *weeping* Mothers tell their grief in vain:

5.763

Though late at night to kiss a parting Son,

5.764

And draw his flying Soul into his own;

5.765

A *Father* sues, in unrelenting Ears

5.766

His Prayers are lost, nor shall he yield to Tears.

5.767

Or lean pale Hangmen shall her Beams create,

5.768

Those *solemn Murderers* and *Salves* to Fate:

5.769

Who on the Curses of the pitying Crowd

5.770

Ignobly thrive, and live on shedding Blood.

5.771

But he that sees her chain'd to Rocks, shall find



5.772

A meaner Fortune, though as fierce a Mind;

5.773

A *Goaler* he shall be, secure for pains

5.774

Poor Slaves, and be a <sup>199</sup> partner of their Chains.

5.775

With *Pisces* twenty first Degree to fly

### XXXI. The Horse.

5.776

The *Horse* begins, and beats the yielding Sky;

5.777

His Births shall Health, and vigorous Strength enjoy,

5.778

For Action quick, and nimble for employ.

5.779

They in *thick* rounds shall rein the *manag'd* Steed,

5.780

Or sweep the Plain, *deceiving* with their speed:

5.781

Or proudly *mounted* they shall boldly dare

5.782

Heroick Acts, and lead the *Crowd* to War:

5.783

Or else be *nimble Messengers*, and move

5.784

With greater swiftness than a flying Dove;

5.785

Send both with *like* Advice, the one shall bring

5.786

Returns, whilst t'other lags with *lazy* Wing.

5.787

Or they shall study *Herbs*, and strength impart

5.788

To *Beasts*, and e'en to *Man* enlarge their Art.

## XXXII. Hercules, or the Kneeling Constellation.

5.789

But now go on; with *Pisces* last Degrees,

5.790

*The humble* Constellation on his Knees

5.791

*O'th' Right* appears: And those that then are born

5.792

No vertuous Powers, nor useful Arts adorn,

5.793

But they're for treachery, mischief, spoil design'd,

5.794

*Guilt's* in their looks and *Rapine* in their mind.

5.795

Or if to *Arts* he shall incline the Breed,

5.796

Such, where the Danger doth the Skill exceed,

5.797

They chiefly follow; 'tis their only scope

5.798

To mount a Precipice, or dance a Rope;

5.799

Tread<sup>200</sup>. Airy steps, and whilst thro Clouds they reel,

5.800

Draw up the Crowd, and hang them at their heel.

5.801

But *on the Left* is open'd to our view

### XXXIII. The Whale

5.802

The *Whale*, who now doth thro the Skies pursue

5.803

With eager haste, as thro' the injur'd Flood

5.804

The fair *Andromeda*, and still thirsts for Blood.

5.805

And He that then is born shall be inclin'd

5.806

To *spoil* the Sea, and kill the *Scaly* Kind,

5.807

No Fish shall swim secure whilst Nets can sweep

5.808

The troubled Ocean, and confine the Deep:

5.809

Those that but now could wanton or'e the Main

5.810

Shall lye fast bound, and wonder at their chain;

5.811

Till with a touch He shall the Cords command,

5.812

And draw the *Dancing* Captives to the Land.

5.813

Or whilst He shoals expects e'en midst the Flood

5.814

Destroy, and stain the Ocean with their Blood.

5.815

Yet then his works not cease, or pains decay,

5.816

His *various Arts* encreasing with his prey:

5.817

For on the Shore He shall his spoil divide

5.818

For different uses. This when lightly dry'd

5.819

Is better Meat; and that when moist is good,

5.820

Whilst other parts are hardned into Food.

5.821

Could *Gluttons* see, they would not bear the sight

5.822

Of preparations for their Appetite,

5.823

Whilst Blood and Guts in a polluted Mass

5.824

Lye mixt, and are *corrupted* into Sauce;

5.825

Till all in filthy Gore distils to treat

5.826

The fashionable Palate of the Great.

5.827

Or if to meaner Arts his Thoughts encline,

5.828

Then *Salt's* his care; he shall the Floods confine

5.829

In narrow Pitts, and to the Beams expose,

5.830

Till what was liquid now a solid grows,

5.831

Then lay the crusted froth with careful hand

5.832

In heaps, and cleanse it, and divide the Sand.

5.833

And thus the *brackish* and unwholesom Flood

5.834

Proves *vital* Salt, and Poyson's turn'd to Food.

5.835

The *Great* and *Lesser Bear* which still maintain

### The rising of the two Bears.

5.836

One constant Round, and never touch the Main,

5.837

Scarce know a *Rise*; yet when *each front* appears,

5.838

Take that to be the *rising* of the Bears.

5.839

The *First* with *Leo*, and the *last* is join'd

5.840

With *Scorpio*, and prove friendly to their kind.

5.841

For those that then are born to *Beasts* shall bear

5.842

Kind tempers, and oblige them by their Care;

5.843

Give Law to *Lions*, with a Panther play,

5.844

Teach *Tigers* peace, and make a *Wolf* obey;

5.845

Maintain Converse, and give them Arts unknown,

5.846

And such as Nature never thought her own.

5.847

But yet their thoughts to *Bears* shall most incline,

5.848

And there improve the *Kindred* of their Sign.

5.849

Or ride the *Elephant*, his Bulk command,

5.850

And make the Monster tremble at their Wand.

5.851

Base the submission, where such strength in vain

5.852

Possess't must tamely yield to feeble Man:

## The several magnitudes of the Stars.

5.853

The third siz'd Stars the *Pleiad*'s form do grace,

5.854

They shine with virgin blushes in their face:

5.855

Four in the *Dolphin* are observ'd to rise,

5.856

And in *Deltoton* Three of equal size:

5.857

The same the *Eagle*, and the *Bear* display,

5.858

Nor can the *Draco* boast a greater ray;

5.859

Of size the Fourth and Fifth securely take

5.860

A measure from the others of the *Snake*.

5.861

But yet the greatest part we spare to note,

5.862

Too small to be discern'd, or too remote:

5.863

These lye obscure, and seldom spread their light,

5.864

But when the *Moon*'s withdrawn to lower Night,

5.865

When great *Orion* from the Skies retires,

5.866

Plunges in Waves, and quenches his bright Fires;

5.867

Or when gay *Phoebus* doth his sway resign

5.868

To shades, then They have a short leave to shine,

5.869

Then Heaven with little *Lights* is spangled o're,

5.870

That not the Sand upon the crooked Shore,

5.871

That not the Billows in Tempestuous Floods,

5.872

That not the leaves when *Autumn* shakes the Woods,

5.873

Can equal the great Train; they all surmount,

5.874

E'en Number is too short for the account.

5.875

And as in Cities, where in ranks decreed

5.876

First <sup>201</sup> *Nobels* go, and then the Knights succeed,

5.877

The next in order may the People claim;

5.878

The Rabble next, a Croud without a Name:

5.879

So is the Heaven by different ranks possess;

5.880

Some like the *Nobles* with more rays are drest,

5.881

Some shine with less, the numerous crowd with least:

5.882

Were these endow'd with a proportion'd heat,

5.883

Were they in Power, as they're in number great;

5.884

They long ago must have dissolv'd the Frame,

5.885

Nor could the world have born so fierce a Flame.

*The End of the fifth Book.*

## Notes

<sup>1</sup> Vid. Not. ad Lucianum.

<sup>2</sup> By Scaliger *and* Huetius.

<sup>3</sup> Nat. Hist. lib. 36. cap. 10.

<sup>4</sup> Gerbertus Rhemensis *Bishop of Ravenna, and afterward Pope of Rome, Epist.* 130. Age verò, Te solo conscio, ex tuis sumptibus fac mihi scribantur *Marcus Manilius* de Astrologia, *Victorinus* de Rhetorica, &c.

<sup>5</sup> De Ponto, lib. 4. Ep. 16.



<sup>6</sup> This *Huetius* affirms, but is undoubtedly mistaken.

<sup>7</sup> Ovid. *ibid.*

<sup>8</sup> *Aptaque venanti Gratius arma dedit.* Ovid. *ibid.*

<sup>9</sup> *Instit. lib. 10. Cap. 1.*

<sup>10</sup> *Instit. lib. 1. cap. 10.*

<sup>11</sup> *Praef.*

<sup>12</sup> *Lib. de Poet. Hist. dial. 4.*

<sup>13</sup> *Lib. 1. v. 7.*

<sup>14</sup> *Lib. 1. v. 10.*

<sup>15</sup> *Lib. 1. v. 906.*

<sup>16</sup> *Lib. 1. v. 918.*

<sup>17</sup> *Lib. 4. v. 763.*

<sup>18</sup> *Lib. 1. v. 896.*

<sup>19</sup> *Lib. 1. v. 912.*

<sup>20</sup> *Not. in Lib. 6. Lucretij.*

<sup>21</sup> *De Arte Gram. lib. 2. cap. 26.*

<sup>22</sup> *Lib. de Poet. Lat.*

<sup>23</sup> *Phys. Sect. 2. lib. 6. cap. 2. Ptolomaeus, Firmicus, Manilius primarij hujus Artis Script[...]*res. vid. etiam p. 717. & pag. 740.

<sup>24</sup> *vid. Cambd. Epist. p. 260.*

<sup>25</sup> *Vid. Not. in Statij. lib. 3. Syl. Carm. 3.*

<sup>26</sup> *His Electa were almost finisht A. D. 1618. vid. Cambd. Epist. p. 259.*

<sup>27</sup> *De praestantia & Vsu Numismatum. pag. 643.*

<sup>28</sup> *Cod. Theod. l. 38. t. 1. de Decur.*

<sup>29</sup> *Not. ad Manil.*

<sup>30</sup> *Sal. de An. Climact. p. 560.*

<sup>31</sup> *Not. ad lib. 4. v. 298.*

<sup>32</sup> *Lib. de Poet. 3. Dial. 4.*

<sup>33</sup> *Scal. Proleg. in Manilium. p. 3.*

- <sup>34</sup> Praef. ad Not.
- <sup>35</sup> Not. ad Aug. script.
- <sup>36</sup> Vid. Not. in Manil.
- <sup>37</sup> De Poet. Lat.
- <sup>38</sup> The Editor of Manilius in usum Delphini.
- <sup>39</sup> *ibid.* v. 332.
- <sup>40</sup> *Ibid.* v. 65.
- <sup>41</sup> *ibid.* v. 101.
- <sup>42</sup> Lib. 1. v. 7.
- <sup>43</sup> lib. 1. v. 9. et 924.
- <sup>44</sup> lib. 2. v. 509.
- <sup>45</sup> Car. lib. 1. Od. 2. Hic ames dici Pater atque Princeps.
- <sup>46</sup> Virg. Ec. 1. et Georg. 1.
- <sup>47</sup> [...] Aug. cap. 94.
- <sup>48</sup> de Num. Herod. p. 9.
- <sup>49</sup> Proleg. in Manil. p. 2.
- <sup>50</sup> Vid. Sir *Edward Shirburn's* Preface to the Sphere of *Manilius*.
- <sup>51</sup> De Poet. Lat.
- <sup>52</sup> Hist. Com. Tom. 1.
- <sup>53</sup> Vid Salmatium ad Solinum, p.
- <sup>54</sup> Vid Plin. Nat. Hist. lib. 10. cap. 2.
- <sup>55</sup> De Ling. Lat. lib. 4. et 6.
- <sup>56</sup> Sir Edward Shirburn's pref.
- <sup>57</sup> Lib. 3. v. 22.
- <sup>58</sup> Lib. 3. v. 21.
- <sup>59</sup> Lib. 4. v. 761.
- <sup>60</sup> Dion Cassius, p. 634.
- <sup>61</sup> Vell. Paterculus, lib. 2. cap. 99.

<sup>62</sup> lib. 1. v. 894.

<sup>63</sup> Dion Cassius, lib. 56.

<sup>64</sup> Lib. 4. v. 40.

<sup>65</sup> Lib. 4. v. 764.

<sup>66</sup> Lib. 2. cap. 99.

<sup>67</sup> Lib. 4. v. 7[...]5.

<sup>68</sup> Italia summà, quam rerum maxima Roma Imposuit terris, Coeloque adjungitur Ipsa. Lib. 4. v. 692.

<sup>69</sup> Lib. 36. cap. 10.

<sup>70</sup> Whether *Divinas* is to be rendred Divining or Divine is not yet agreed by the Interpreters of the Poet; by rendring it Divine, *Manilius* is freed from a redundancy of Words, and the Origine of Astronomy, which he so often inculcates in other places, is hinted at: beside, *Divinus* seldom signifies Divining, but when a Substantive follows which determines it to that sense, as *Divina imbrium*, and the like, and in that case I find *Milton* venturing at it in his Poem: —Divine of future Woe.

<sup>71</sup> It seems very plain that this whole description respects onely the Eastern Kings, and therefore *Manilius* must be reckoned amongst those who believed the head of *Nile* to be in the East; and lest he might be thought to have forgotten the Egyptians, I am inclin'd to think he includes them under the *Priests*, to whose care Astronomical Observations were peculiarly committed.

<sup>72</sup> This was the Opinion of *Xenophanes*, *Melissus*, *Aristotle* and others; and *Pliny* thus concludes in the second Book cap. 1. of his Natural History: 'Tis reasonable to believe that the World is a Deity, eternal and immense, that never had a beginning, and never shall have an end. As absurd an Opinion as ever was propos'd, and repugnant to all the Appearances of Nature; look upon the Rocks on the Sea shore, and having observ'd their continual wearing, consider how few thousands of years they must have stood: direct thy eye to Heaven, and view the several changes in that which was thought impassible; and in short, reflect on the essential vileness of matter, and its impotence to conserve its own being; and then I believe you will find reason to put this Opinion amongst those absurdities which Tully hath allotted to one or other of the Philosophers to defend.

<sup>73</sup> This blind fancy we owe to the Phoenicians, who (if *Philo Biblius's Sancuniathon* may be trusted) taught that the Principles of the Universe were a Spirit of dark Air, and a confus'd Chaos; this Spirit at last began to Love, and joyning with the

Chaos, produced [...] or slime, and thence fashioned the World. And hence likely the more sober part of the Greek Philosophers, (for they were but borrowers of Learning) who requir'd two eternal principles, the one *active* and the other *passive*, such as *Plato*, *Anaxagoras*, &c. took their notions, and having added some few new ornaments, vented them for their own.

<sup>74</sup> The Philosophy of *Epicurus* is too well known to need any explication.

<sup>75</sup> The Opinion of *Heraclitus*, concerning which see the first Book of *Lucretius*.

<sup>76</sup> *Thales* the Milesian endeavoured to establish this by Arguments drawn from the Origine and Continuation of most things: The seminal Principle of Animals is humid, Plants are nourished by mere Water; Fire it self cannot live without Air, which is onely water rarefied, and the Sun and Stars draw up vapors for their own nourishment and support. These were the considerations upon which he grounded his Opinion; and hence 'tis easie to guess that he kept up the credit of his School rather by those riches which he gain'd by his lucky conjecture at the scarcity of Olives, than by the strength of argument and reason.

<sup>77</sup> The Assertion of *Empedocles*, agreeable to which *Ovid* sings, Quatuor aeternus genitalia Corpora Mundus Continet—.

<sup>78</sup> There is something in this scheme of *Manilius* so like the ingenious conjecture of the excellent Authour of the *Theory of the Earth*, that what reflects on the one must have an influence on the other, and when the *fiction* is confuted the *serious discourse* will find it self concern'd: The *Stoicks* held the material part of their *Deity* to be changeable, and that too as often as the fatal Fire prevail'd, and reduc'd the Elements into one *Chaos*; in such a confusion the *Poet* supposeth the first matter of his World, and then makes the different parts separate, and take proper places, according as they were light or heavy: agreeable to this Opinion the *Theory of the Earth* supposeth a *Chaos*, which he defines to be a *Mass of Matter, fluid, consisting of parts of different sorts and sizes, blended together without any union or connexion*. The solid and heavier parts of this *Chaos* descend to the Centre, by their own weight, and there fixing and growing hard, compose the inward Body of the Earth; the lighter parts fly upward, and being continually agitated, make that Body which we call Air; the middle sort being somewhat heavier, and not so much agitated, cover-over the solid interiour Body of the Earth; and its fat and oily parts rising, and swimming on the surface, stop and detain those heavier particles which upon the first separation were carried up by the Air, and afterward according to their several degrees of Gravity fell back again toward the Centre: These particles sticking in this oily matter, made a soft crust, which in time being hardned by the Sun and those breezes which always attend

its motion, became the habitable Earth. This Earth thus form'd was solid, and without Caverns, nor had it any inequalities on its surface; as to its site, its Axis was parallel to the Axis of the Ecliptick, both its Poles being equally inclin'd to the Sun; and as to its figure it was Oval. These are the few easie principal parts of that excellent Hypothesis, settled on the obvious notions of Gravity and Levity, and on the acknowledged Nature, and allow'd Motion of a Fluid. And from these so many curious propositions are naturally deduced, so many difficulties concerning Paradise and the Floud happily explain'd, and all set off with that neatness and aptness of expression, and that variety of curious thought, that I am very much inclin'd to believe that Nature was never so well drest before, nor so artificially recommended. And it is pity that the first acknowledged Principles of Philosophy will not allow it to be true. Inherent Qualities are now generally exploded, as unphilosophical, not to be understood, and unfit to explain the Phaenomena of Nature. The Acceleration of a heavy Body in its descent (beside a thousand other Arguments) quite overthrows Gravity both as an accident of *Aristotle*, and as essential to Matter, according to the fancy of *Epicurus*; so that this motion proceeds onely from external impulse, and depends upon the present order of the World. So that Philosophy will not allow the supposition of Gravity or Levity in a confus'd Chaos, since it can sufficiently demonstrate that they are neither inherent qualities, nor essential to matter, and that it is in vain to look after them, before the system of the World was settled in the present order. From this hint it is easie to infer that the supposed Chaos would have still continued such, the solid Parts would have been agitated this or that way indifferently by the restless particles of the Fluid, but there could have been no orderly separation, because no Principle of it. But suppose such a separation, why must the outward Crust of the Globe be without Caverns in its Body, and Inequalities on its Surface? What Law of Nature doth necessarily prove that in such a confusion the solid parts must be equally dispersed through the Body of the Air? If we trust our Eyes, and look upon a Dust raised by the ruin of a House, or onely consider what Confusion is, it will be very hard to find such a regular and orderly disposition. And since these solid Bodies may be unequally dispers'd, and every one of them tends to the Centre by a direct Line, whenever they settle, the Body which they compose must be unequal in its surface. Yet to let this Difficulty pass, its Figure according to this Hypothesis will be much more Oval than common observation will allow, for since it is said to be Oval because the Motion of the Aequator is swifter than that of the Polar Circles, the figure must be almost as much Oval, as the Circle of the Aequator is bigger than the Circle of the Pole; there being nothing to hinder the utmost effect of this motion but the weight of the Fluid endeavouring to

reduce it self to a Levell, which of what moment it will be in this Case I leave to be considered. And as for its site, that renders the torrid and the frigid Zones uninhabitable; intolerable Heats still burning the former, and the continual gathering and dropping of the vapours making the others too cold and moist to entertain either Man or Beast. And this one concession, I am afraid, spoils most part of the Contrivance; for these portions of the Crust could never grow hard, being continually moistned by the Vapours, and so little expos'd to the Sun, or that breeze which attends its motion: And therefore, whenever Vapours were drawn from the Abyss in the Torrid Zone, these parts of the Arch being not firm enough to sustain themselves, must sink in; and those Vapors that were imprisoned between the surface of the Abyss and the solid part of the Crust of the Earth, might have found an easie passage through this soft portion of the Crust, and therefore could not contribute to the general dissolution of the Frame. Besides, from such a muddy Fountain what could be expected but streams unwholsome and corrupted, and unfit for that end for which they were design'd, and for that use, to which sacred Scripture tells us they were imploy'd? A great many other inconveniences in Nature may be observ'd to follow this Contrivance; but because this Hypothesis was not set up for its own sake, but to give an intelligible account of *Noah's* Flood; I shall close these reflexions with a few considerations upon that. And first the Authour pleads for an universal Flood, it being inconsistent with the demonstrated Nature of a Fluid, that Water should stand up in Heaps fifteen Cubits above the tops of the highest Mountains. This I am willing to admit, though there is no reason why Omnipotence might not be immediately concern'd in this, since he himself confesseth, that the forty days Rain cannot according to his Hypothesis be explain'd by any Natural Cause that he can find out. Secondly, He compares the height of the Mountains and the Depth of the Sea, and having as to both made allowable suppositions (though the Course of the longest River, even the *Nile* it self, will not prove its head to be above three foot higher than its mouth) he infers that eight Oceans will be little enough to make an universal Deluge: The Waters above the Firmament are exploded; the Rain would afford but the hundredth part of such a Mass of Water, unless the showers were continual, and over the face of the whole Earth, and the Drops came down ninety times faster than usually they do. (Though here a Man would be apt to think from the expressions in *Genesis*, *The Windows of Heaven were opened*, that there was somewhat very extraordinary in this Rain, and that all those requir'd conditions were observ'd.) The Caverns of the Earth, if they threw out all the Water they contain'd, could afford but little in comparison of the great store that was requir'd; And if the whole middle region of the Air had been condens'd, still

there had not been enough, because Air being turn'd into Water filleth onely the hundredth part of that space which it formerly possess'd. Though all the other ways by which some have endeavour'd to explain the Floud, were demonstrably insufficient, yet this last which gives an account of it from so natural and easie a Cause as the condensation of the Air deserved to be considered a little more; but it is the Art of a Disputer to touch that least which presseth most on that Opinion which he would advance. For it being allowed that Air by natural Causes may be chang'd into Water, and a *Vacuum* in this very Chapter being excluded, it necessarily follows, that as much Air as riseth fifteen Cubits higher than the tops of the Mountains is sufficient to make such a Deluge as is describ'd to have been in *Noah's* time. Because where there is no *Vacuum*, there can be no contraction into a less space, and every particle of Matter, whatever form or schematism it puts on, must in all conditions be equally extended, and therefore take up the same Room. But suppose a *Vacuum*, or (as it happens in our imperfect condensations) that a hundred cubical feet of Air would make but one foot of Water, yet sure the Region is large enough to make amends for this disproportion: Now since Nature is sufficient for condensation, and since its powers may be considerably invigorated for the execution of the Almighty's wrath; why must it be thought so difficult to explain a Deluge? and why should an excellent Wit waste it self in fashioning a new World, onely to bring that about which the old one would permit easily to be done? It is above the Province of Philosophy to make a World, let that be suppos'd to have been form'd as it is reveal'd, it is enough for us to search by what Laws it is preserv'd; and a system erected on this foundation will be agreeable both to Reason and to Religion.

<sup>79</sup> He explodes the Opinion of *Xenophanes*, and the Fancy of *Epicurus*. *Vid.* *Lucretius's* fifth Book.

<sup>80</sup> *Canopus* is a Star in the Southern Keel of the Ship *Argo*, of the first magnitude: These particulars as to the Appearance of the two Stars are not mathematically true, yet serve well enough for the Poets design, sufficiently proving the roundness of the Earth.

<sup>81</sup> This Argument being taken from the Eclipse and not from the increase or decrease of the Moon, the Poet must be understood, not as to divers moments of Time, for the Moon at the same instant is seen Eclips'd by all to whom she appears above the Horizon, but as to the diversity of Hours at which the Eastern or Western People reckon the Eclipse to begin or end.

<sup>82</sup> This is to be understood in respect of those who inhabit the Northern Hemisphere, to whom the North Pole is still elevated.

<sup>83</sup> It was the Opinion of the ancient Poets, and some others, that the Sea was as a Girdle to the Earth, that it ran round it as an Horizon, and divided the upper Hemisphere from the lower.

<sup>84</sup> Release this Soul from that union which the Stoicks foolishly assign'd, and then to hold a Soul of the World and Providence is all one.

<sup>85</sup> *Manilius* is not constant in his Position; most commonly as a Poet he turns his face to the West, and then the North is on his right hand, and the South on the left: sometimes as an Astronomer he turns his face to the South, and this is the position in this place.

<sup>86</sup> Alluding to the two Verses in *Homer's* sixth Iliad, [...] [...].

<sup>87</sup> Demonstrated by *Archimedes* in his [...], *Prop.* 3. That the Circumference of every Circle exceeds three times the Diameter thereof by a part that is less than 1/7th, and greater than 10/70.

<sup>88</sup> *Eudoxus* divided the Sphere into sixty parts, and this division *Manilius* follows, and according to that describes the Position of the Celestial Circles.

<sup>89</sup> The Opinion of *Diodorus*.

<sup>90</sup> *Macrobius* reports *Theophrastus* to be the Authour of this Fancy.

<sup>91</sup> From *Plutarch* we learn that *Metrodorus* and others asserted this, and *Achilles Tacius* fixes this foolish Opinion on *Oenopides Chius*.

<sup>92</sup> The learned Mr. *Hayns* dislikes *Scaliger's* reading, which I have followed, and thinks that he meant that *Pella* was a Woman; a more solemn foppery was never met with, and this Note, beside a great many others, may serve to credit the *Dauphin* Editions of the Classick Authours.

<sup>93</sup> *Manilius* having mention'd the chief Arguments of *Homer's* Poems, concludes with a high Character, stiling him the *Fountain* of all Poetry. *Ovid. Amor. lib. 3. El. 8.* to the same purpose, A quo, ceu Fonte perenni, Vatum Pieriis ora rigantur Aquis And *Longinus (de sublim. Sect. 13)* says not only *Stesichorus* and *Archilocus*, but *Herodotus* the Historian, and *Plato* the Philosopher, owe their chiefest Beauties to that Poet.

<sup>94</sup> Several Poems of *Hesoid* are lost, and *Scaliger* with other Criticks conjecture, That *Manilius* refers us to those lost Poems: But I think this and the preceding Verse ought to be Corrected, (of this Correction perhaps I may give an account



in a *Latin Edition* of this Author) and then they will be found in those pieces of *Hesiod* that are now extant.

<sup>95</sup> *Eratosthenes* a Greek Poet, flourished in the time of *Ptolemy Euergetes*, about the 138 *Olymp*. He wrote of the Stars and Constellations, and gave an account of all the Fables relating to them: I have not time to explain all these Fables and therefore shall only direct where they may be found. Concerning *Perseus*, *Andromeda*, her Father *Cepheus*, and her Mother *Cassiopeia*, *vid. Ovid. Metam. lib. 4. ver. 665*. Concerning *Callisto*, or the *great Bear*, *Ovid. lib. 2. ver. 405*. The Fable of the *Little Bear* may be found in *Diodorus Siculus, lib. 4*. Of the *Swan* in the First Book of *Manilius*. Of the *Goat* in the First Book of *Manilius*, and in *Casaubon's Animadversions on Athenaeus*: The *Maid* or *Erigone*, is said to be the Daughter of *Icarus*, who upon the Death of her Father, hang'd her self. The *Nemean Lion* being slain by *Hercules*, was plac'd amongst the Stars for his shining Skin. The *Crab* for pinching *Hercules* when he fought the *Hydra*: The *Scorpion* for Killing *Orion*, or rather, for assisting the Gods against the Giants. The Stories of *Venus* taking the shape of a *Fish* when she fled from the Giant *Typho*, and of the *Ram* who swam over the *Hellespont* with *Phryxus* and *Helle* on his Back, are well known, and may be found in *Manilius*, and *Selden de Diis Syris*.

<sup>96</sup> This was a Fancy of the Antients, which some are not asham'd, after Experience hath so often Confuted it, to maintain still.

<sup>97</sup> The Elephants do so, if we believe *Pliny: Nat. Hist. lib. 8. cap. 1*.

<sup>98</sup> *Aries* is Male. *Gemini* M. *Leo* M. *Libra* M. *Sagittarius* M. *Aquarius* M. *Taurus* Female. *Cancer* F. *Virgo* F. *Scorpius* F. *Capricornus* F. *Pisces* F.

<sup>99</sup> The Humane Signs are *Gemini*, *Libra*, *Virgo*, *Aquarius*. The Brute, *Aries*, *Taurus*, *Sagittarius*, *Capricornus*, *Leo*, *Cancer*, *Scorpius*, *Pisces*.

<sup>100</sup> Of Double Signs some are Pairs, as *Gemini*, and *Pisces*: Others are made up of two different Species, such as *Sagittarius* and *Capricornus*.

<sup>101</sup> The Signs which have an Opposite aspect are, *Aries*. *Taurus*. *Gemini*. *Cancer*. *Leo*. *Virgo*. *Libra*. *Scorpius*. *Sagittarius*. *Capricornus*. *Aquarius*. *Pisces*.

<sup>102</sup> The Guardians of the Signs. Of *Aries*. *Taurus*. *Gemini*. *Cancer*. *Leo*. *Virgo*. *Libra*. *Scorpius*. *Sagittarius*. *Capricornus*. *Aquarius*. *Pisces* *Pallas*. *Venus*. *Phoebus*. *Mercurius*. *Jupiter*. *Ceres*. *Vulcan*. *Mars*. *Diana*. *Vesta*. *Juno*. *Neptune*. The Reasons of this Assignment are to be taken out of the Old Fables.

<sup>103</sup> Whether *Capricorn* was in the Horoscope of *Augustus*, when he was Born, or when he was Conceived, Is disputed: However 'tis certain, *Augustus* took

*Capricorn* for his Sign, and many times its Figure is found upon his Coins. vid. Sueton. vit. Aug. cap. 94. and *Spanhemius de Nummis*. p. 210.

<sup>104</sup> See the Figures of these Signs on a Globe.

<sup>105</sup> *Pylades* and *Orestes* being taken Prisoners, *Orestes* was condemned to Die, but was allow'd to go and settle some Affairs, upon Condition that *Pylades* would stay behind, and engage his Life for his return: *Pylades* becomes Surety: *Orestes* goes, settles his Affairs, and returns at the Day appointed.

<sup>106</sup> So call'd, because in the Sign *Scorpius* we see nothing but the Claws.

<sup>107</sup> The *Dodecatemorion* is the Twelfth part, or two Degrees and an half of a Sign. Every Sign containing Thirty Degrees; for Twelve times two and an half make Thirty. *Scaliger* gives this Instance. Let the propos'd Degree be the *Thirteenth* Degree of *Gemini*, multiply *Thirteen* by *Twelve*, the Product is *one hundred fifty six*: Of these give *Thirty* to *Gemini* the propos'd Sign, *Thirty* to *Cancer*, *Thirty* to *Leo*, to *Virgo* *Thirty*, and *Thirty* to *Libra*: There remain *Six*, and therefore the *Dodecatemorion* of *Gemini* is in the *Sixth* Degree of *Scorpius*: But this instance doth not seem to agree with the Doctrine of *Manilius*.

<sup>108</sup> *Scaliger* affirms, that *Manilius* proposeth two ways to find the *Dodecatemoria* or *Twelfths* of the *Planets*; *Huctius* says he gives but one: This Dispute will be best determin'd by observing the Poet himself, and illustrating his Doctrine by two Instances: Let the *Moon* be in the *Sixth* Degree of *Aries*, multiply *six* by *Twelve*, the Product is *Seventy two*: Out of this *Seventy two* give the first *Thirty* to *Aries*, the second to *Taurus*, and then there remain *Twelve*; and therefore the *Dodecatemorion* of the *Moon* is in the *Twelfth* Degree of *Gemini*, that is, in the *Second* of the *Five* half Degrees of the *Dodecatemorion* of *Gemini*.

<sup>109</sup> To this Method *Scaliger* applies this Example: Let the *Sun* be in the *Thirteenth* of *Gemini*, the *Moon* in the *Twenty Third* of *Scorpius*, the Arch of the *Zodiack* between the two *Planets*, contains one Hundred and *Sixty* Degrees: In this Number there are five *Thirties*, which being taken away there remain *Ten*; divide these *Ten* by *Twelfths*, or *two and an half*, the Quotient is *four* *Twelfths*, or *Dodecatemoria*; of which give one to *Scorpius*, another to *Sagittarius*, a third to *Capricorn*, and the fourth falling in *Aquarius*, shews the *Moons* *Dodecatemorion* to be in the *twenty third* Degree of that Sign.

<sup>110</sup> The third sort of *Dodecatemorion* is this. In every *Dodecatemorion* or *Twelfth*, there are *five* half Degrees, and the *Planets* (which the Antient Astrologers counted but *five*, not reckoning the *Sun* and *Moon* amongst the *Planets*) have in each *Dodecatemorion* or *Twelfth*, one half Degree assign'd to every one of them.

<sup>111</sup> From this Verse to the end of this Book, *Manilius* treats of the Twelve Celestial Houses, which he divides into the Four *Cardines* or *Hinges*, and the Eight Spaces that lie between these *Hinges*: The *Hinges* are the *Eastern Point*, the *Middle Point*, the *Western Point* and the lowest point of Heaven: The Spaces, &c. but see Fig. 10.

<sup>112</sup> *Manilius* in the beginning of his first Book tells us *Mercury* was the Inventor of that Art, which he intended for the Subject of his Astrological Poem.

<sup>113</sup> *Manilius* in the beginning of his first Book tells us *Mercury* was the Inventor of that Art, which he intended for the Subject of his Astrological Poem.

<sup>114</sup> This and the seven following Verses relate to the several particulars of *Medea's* story.

<sup>115</sup> I use this Interpretation rather than that of *Scaliger* and others, because I think *Manilius* speaks only of that famous Siege of *Thebes*, when the seven Generals attackt it; and as the Story says, *Capaneus* had almost ruin'd the Town before he was struck with Thunder.

<sup>116</sup> *Oedipus* Married his own Mother *Jocasta*, and had Children by her; so that each Son was Brother to the Father, and Grand-Child to the Mother.

<sup>117</sup> This respects the Story of *Atrous* and *Thyestes*.

<sup>118</sup> *Xerxes* is said to have dug a Channel round Mount *Athos*, and to have made a Bridge over the *Hellespont*.

<sup>119</sup> Thus, for instance, in whatever Sign the Lot of *Fortune* is plac'd, the next that belongs to the next Sign, is the Lot of *Warfare*: *Civil Employments* must be given to the third, &c.

<sup>120</sup> For the Lot of *Fortune* being in all Nativities that belong to *Day* to be accounted for from the *Sun*, and in all Nativities that belong to *Night* from the *Moon*; and those two Planets not always possessing the same place in every Nativity, and the other *Lots* following the disposition of that of *Fortune*; it is very evident that the same *Lot* is not to be always applied to the same Sign.

<sup>121</sup> For instance, let the *Sun* be in the 20th Degree of *Aries*, the *Moon* in the 10th Degree of *Libra*; from the 20th Degree of *Aries* (counting thro' the following Signs *Taurus*, *Gemini*, &c) to the 10th Degree of *Libra*; are 170 Degrees: Let the *Horoscope* be the 10th Degree of *Cancer*; from that 10th Degree of *Cancer*, count thro' the following Signs, viz. *Leo*, *Virgo*, &c. and you will find the Number 170 to end in the 10th Degree of *Capricorn*: Therefore in the 10th Degree of *Capricorn* place the Lot of *Fortune*: This I take to be the meaning of *Manilius*.

<sup>122</sup> Suppose the Sun to be in the 21, 49' of *Leo*, the Moon in the 26, 31' of *Virgo*; the *Horoscope* in the, 1, 0' of *Leo*; The Moon is distant from the Sun 325, 18', which number being distributed amongst the Antecedent Signs, viz. *Cancer*, *Gemini*, *Taurus*, &c. ends in the 5, 42' of *Virgo*, that there is the place of the *Lot of Fortune*.

<sup>123</sup> To explain this Method which the *Chaldeans* us'd to find the *Horoscope*, *Scaliger* gives this instance: Let the Sun's place be the 13, 25' of *Libra*, let the Birth be at the end of the *Seventh* Hour of the Day: Now because every Sign hath thirty Degrees, and fifteen Degrees make one Hour, these *Seven* Hours are three Signs and an half, or one Hundred and five Degrees: Now reckon those Degrees thro' the following Signs, viz. *Scorpius*, *Centaurus*, &c. The Number ends in the 28125' of *Capricorn*, and therefore that is the *Horoscope*.

<sup>124</sup> *Sic media extremis*, &c. The middle Signs here are *Aries* and *Libra*, and these are said to be opposite to the Extremes, *Cancer* and *Capricorn*, because in them the Days are equal, but in the others unequal to the Nights: This I take to be the meaning of the Poet, rather than what *Scaliger* and other Interpreters pretend.

<sup>125</sup> Thus in *Cancer* the Days are longest; in *Capricorn*, which is a Sign adverse to *Cancer*, the Nights are of the same length, that the Days were of in *Cancer*: The like holds in *Leo*, and *Aquarius*, and so in the rest.

<sup>126</sup> The *Italians* divided all the time betwixt the Rising and Setting of the Sun into *Twelve* Hours, and all the time between the Setting and Rising of the Sun into *Twelve* Hours: And therefore, those times being various and unequal, the Hours must likewise be unequal.

<sup>127</sup> According to the Opinion of some Ancient Astronomers, who plac'd the Winter Solstice in the Eighth Degree of *Capricorn*, the Summer Solstice in the Eighth Degree of *Cancer*, and the Equinox in the Eighth Degrees of *Aries* and *Libra*: Thus in the End of this Book, Has quidam vires octava in parte reponunt.

<sup>128</sup> *Eudoxus* wrote of the Sphere at the 36th Degree, Elevation of the Pole, and *Manilius* follows him.

<sup>129</sup> A *Stadium* in *Manilius* is half of a Degree, and therefore in the whole *Zodiack* there are 720 *Stadia*. In the *Zodiack* are 360 Degrees, to every Hour we reckon, 15 Degrees, therefore every Hour is equal to 30 *Stadia*, and for the same Reason, each Hour containing 60 Minutes, every *Stadium* is equal to two Minutes.

<sup>130</sup> The rising and Setting of the Signs according to *Manilius*. Rising. Signs. Stadia. Hours. Minutes. Degrees. *Aries*. 40 1 20' 20 *Taurus*. 48 1 36' 24 *Gem*. 56 1 52' 28 *Cancer*. 64 2 8' 32 *Leo*. 72 2 24' 26 *Virgo*. 80 2 40' 40 *Libra*. 80 2 40' 40 *Scorp*. 72 2 24 36 *Cent*. 64 2 8' 32 *Capr*. 56 1 52' 28 *Aquar*. 48 1 36' 24 *Pisces*. 40 1 20' 20

Signs Stadia. Hours. Min. Deg. Setting Signs. Stadia. Hours. Min. Deg. Aries. 80 2 40' 40 Taur. 72 2 24' 36 Gem. 64 2 8' 32 Canc. 56 1 52' 28 Leo. 48 1 36' 24 Virg. 40 1 20 20 Lib. 40 1 20' 20 Scorp. 48 1 36' 24 Cent. 56 1 52' 28 Capr. 64 2 8' 32 Aquar. 72 2 24' 36 Pisces. 80 2 40' 40 Signs. Stadia. Hours. Min. Deg.

<sup>131</sup> Let the Child be born in the Fourth Hour of the Day, add five to four, the Sum is 9, Multiply 9 by 10, the Product is 90. Let the Sun be in the 10th Degree of *Gemini*, add 10 to 90, the Sum is 100, of this 100 give 30 to *Gemini*, the Sign in which the Sun is, 30 more to the following Sign *Taurus*: 30 to the next *Aries*, 10 remain, therefore the 10th Degree of *Pisces* is the *Horoscope*.

<sup>132</sup> Let the Birth be in the Seventh Hour of *Night*, add to that the Twelve Hours of the *Day*, and that Seventh Hour will be the Nineteenth, from the *Suns* Rising: Then add, multiply, and work, as in the former Method.

<sup>133</sup> Let the longest Day in *Cancer* be of 16 Hours, the shortest Night of 8: Divide those 16 Hours into 6 parts, each part contains 2 Hours 40 Minutes: Therefore allow *Leo* 2 Hours 40 Min. for his Rising time: Divide likewise the 8 Hours of Night into 6 parts, each part will contain 1 Hour 20. *m.* and that is the rising time of *Taurus*. The Difference between the Rising Times of these two Signs is 1 Hour 20 Min. Divide this Difference into three equal parts, each part will contain 26 Min. 40 Sec. Add these 26 Min. and 40 Sec. to the Rising time of *Taurus*, and the whole Sum makes up the Rising time of *Gemini*, viz. 1 Hour, 46 Min. 40 Sec. To this add another third part to make up the Rising time of *Cancer*, viz. 2 Hours 13 Min. 20 Sec. And so of the rest, as in the following Scheme. Signs Hours Min. Sec. Signs Aries. 0 53 20 Pisces. Taur. 1 20 0 Aqua. Gem. 1 46 40 Capr. Cancer 2 13 20 Cent. Leo. 2 40 0 Scorp. Virg. 3 6 40 Libra. But it must always be observed, that the *Southern* or *Winter* Signs are oppos'd to the *Northern* or *Summer* Signs. The Rising-time of the *Summer* is the Setting-time of the *Winter*; and the Setting-time of the *Summer* the Rising-time of the *Winter* Signs.

<sup>134</sup> The Example which *Manilius* himself gives, sets this Doctrine in its true Light. Let the longest Night in *Capricorn* be of 15 Hours, the Day consequently must be of 9. Thus the Night exceeds the Day by 3 Hours. Divide these 3 Hours into 3 Parts, give one Part, that is, 1 Hour to the Middle Sign, viz. *Aquarius*, and thence conclude that in *Capricorn* the Day encreases half an Hour, and in *Pisces* an Hour and half; *Aquarius* being the Middle Sign in which the Days encrease one Hour.

<sup>135</sup> According to the Doctrine of *Manilius* (let the Example be the same with that in the preceding Note) in *Aries* the Day encreases one Hour and half, in *Taurus* one Hour, in *Gemini* half an Hour.

<sup>136</sup> There being 24 Hours belonging to each Day, and but 12 Signs, more than 24 Days in each Month, and 12 Months in every Year.

<sup>137</sup> A Table of the Years and Months that belong to each Sign. Signs. Years. Months Signs. Aries. 10 8 Pisces. Taurus. 12 8 Aquar. Gemini. 14 8 Capr. Cancer. 16 8 Sagit. Leo. 18 8 Scorp. Virgo. 20 8 Libra.

<sup>138</sup> This was never finished by the Poet, or is now lost.

<sup>139</sup> The Poet did not think of the *Palladium* as *Scaliger* imagines, but only of the Fire at *Troy*, which parted to let *Aeneas* go through with his Father, and his Household Gods.

<sup>140</sup> *Manilius* makes only short Reflections on History, and therefore is frequently obscure: He says here, that it was impossible one single *Aeneas* should have rais'd the Glory and Reputation of ruin'd *Troy*, and made it then conquer, when it was overthrown, by building *Rome* which subdu'd the whole World; for *Rome* rose out of the Ruins of *Troy*; unless some over-ruling Power and Fate had ordain'd it should be so.

<sup>141</sup> The Stories of *Mutius Scaevola*, *Horatius Cocles*, the Virgin *Claelia*, and the Combat between the three *Horatij* on the *Roman*, and the three *Curiatij* on the *Alban* side, are well known.

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<sup>145</sup> Short Reflections on the great Accidents in the Second and Third *Carthaginian* Wars, together with the Death of *Hannibal*.

<sup>146</sup> *Pompey* the Great, was a very notable Example of the variety of Fortune, being on a sudden rais'd to the highest, and as soon thrown down to the lowest Condition in the World.

<sup>147</sup> *Cum jam etiam posses alium cognoscere Magnum*: I hope I have given this Verse a better Sense, than the other Interpreters have done.

<sup>148</sup> *Caesar* is said to be sprung from Heaven, because he was descended from *Aeneas* the Son of *Venus*: After his Murther an unusual Star appear'd, which the Flatterers of *Augustus* said was the Soul of his Father *Caesar*.

<sup>149</sup> *Furius Camillus* was the restorer of *Rome*, after it had been taken and burnt by the *Gauls*: Of the Family of the *Decij* there were Three, who voluntarily devoted themselves to Death, for the Good and Prosperity of their Country: *Cato Vticensis*, who kill'd himself that he might not survive the Liberty of *Rome*.

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<sup>151</sup> Alluding to the Tryal of skill between *Pallas* and *Arachne*, describ'd by *Ovid*, in the Sixth Book of his *Metamorphosis*.

<sup>152</sup> *M. Curius Dentatus* and *Serranus* were both fetcht from the Plough, to Command the *Roman* Armies, fought bravely, and Triumpht.

<sup>153</sup> For this the Poets fancy'd to be the Bull that carry'd *Europa* into *Crete*.

<sup>154</sup> *Scaliger* thinks *Manilius* means such as keep Beasts for publick Shews, and to fight in the Theaters; and this Interpretation I rather follow than that of *Huetius*, who fancies the Poet means by this pompous Description no more than innocent, honest Butchers.

<sup>155</sup> *Palamedes* is said to be the first Man amongst the *Greeks*, who invented Cyphers, and taught Men to cast Account: I have enlarg'd his Character, and taken notice of his invention of Letters.

<sup>156</sup> *Servius Sulpitius*, the Great Lawyer, and Acquaintance of *Cicero*.

<sup>157</sup> Of the Docility of *Elephants*, we meet with numerous Examples: *Seneca* mentions one, that play'd at Ball: Another, that would Dance on a Rope, &c. The Travellers in the *East* are full of strange Stories concerning those Animals; and *Lipsius* in his Epistles, will furnish any Man with more Stories than he will readily believe.

<sup>158</sup> If *Alchymy* was more Antient than *Manilius*, as *Huetius* himself grants, I see no Reason why the Poet might not speak of the *Alchymists*: The Interpretation I have given, I am sure, sounds better than that of *Huetius*.

<sup>159</sup> The *Tenths*: This is a new word, but answers to *Decanica* in *Manilius*: *Decanica* signifies Ten Degrees, and the *Decanus* is Lord of Ten Degrees: The several Lords are these, In *Aries* *Aries* *Taurus* *Gemini* In *Taurus* *Cancer* *Leo* *Virgo* In

*Gemini Libra Scorpius Sagittar. In Cancer Capricor. Aquarius Pisces In Leo Aries Taurus Gemini In Virgo Cancer Leo Virgo In Libra Libra Scorpius Sagittar. In Scorpius Capricor. Aquarius Pisces In Sagittar. Aries Taurus Gemini In Capricor. Cancer Leo Virgo In Aquarius Libra Scorpius Sagittar. In Pisces Aries Taurus Pisces*

<sup>160</sup> *Quantum est quo veniat Omne*, I have follow'd the Interpretation of *Scaliger*; but do not reject the Opinion of *Huetius*: Though of less force than *Scaliger*'s.

<sup>161</sup> Alluding to the Custom of the *Romans*, who, when they design'd to build a City, took a Plow and made Furrow a where the Walls were to stand.

<sup>162</sup> *Vossius*, In his Observations on *Catullus*, P. 204. Reads, —*Taurum que que minantem Fluctibus.*—

<sup>163</sup> *Germany*, which comprehends all the Northern tract of Land beyond *Thrace*.

<sup>164</sup> *Rome* had Temples Dedicated to her, and was look'd upon to be a Goddess.

<sup>165</sup> *Vossius out of his Ancient Manuscript Reads*, *Qua genitus Caesar que que meus qui hanc condidit urbem.*

<sup>166</sup> I know *Donata Regna* may bear another Sense, but this will do as well.

<sup>167</sup> Whom in the time of *Agustus*, the *Germans* destroy'd, and cut off all the Legions he Commanded.

<sup>168</sup> Thus when *Aries* and *Libra* are Eccliptick, the two next Eccliptick are *Pisces* and *Virgo*.

<sup>169</sup> Alluding to *Julius Caesar*, Deify'd by *Augustus*.

<sup>170</sup> —*Celerique Sagittaè / Delphinus certans*— We may read,—*Celerique Sagitta Delphinus certans*—and interpret the words, not as others do, The Dolphin seated opposite to the Arrow: But The Dolphin of equal swiftness with the Arrow.

<sup>171</sup> The *Ram* having a Golden Fleece, as the Poets fancy'd, the King of *Jolcos* kill'd him that he might enjoy the Treasure, and *Jason* being sent to fetch this Golden Fleece carried away *Medea* the King's Daughter.

<sup>172</sup> The *Ship* hath two Rudders, a Northern, and a Southern Rudder.

<sup>173</sup> A River of *Jolchos*, whither *Jason* with the *Argonauts* first Sailed.

<sup>174</sup> *Typhis*, the Pilot to the *Argonauts*, who in his Voyage steer'd thro' the dangerous moving Rocks called the *Symplegadae*.

<sup>175</sup> The *Graecian Navy* lay Wind-bound till *Iphigenia* was Sacrificed, and appeased the anger of *Diana*.



<sup>176</sup> Vossius, in his Observations on *Catullus*, Reads—*Invehit undis Persida*—The Expression is bold, and therefore proper for the Poet. That *Xerxes* dug a new Channel, and made a Bridge over the *Hellespont*, are known stories.

<sup>177</sup> *Manilius* mentions several notable defeats at Sea, such was that of the *Athenians* near *Syracuse*, which brought the *Athenians* very low: such were those of the *Carthaginians* by the *Romans*: And that of *Antony* by *Augustus* near *Actium*.

<sup>178</sup> Heavens great Fortune: Because the Conquerour was to be deify'd.

<sup>179</sup> *Orion* is a very large and bright Constellation, and deserves this pompous Description.

<sup>180</sup> *Instar erit Populi*: This is one of *Manilius's* bold Expressions, which my English cannot reach.

<sup>181</sup> Alluding to the officious Salutations, which the Clients amongst the *Romans* carried early every Morning to their Patrons.

<sup>182</sup> *Manilius* is very accurate in describing the particular Niceties observ'd in the Roman racing: Those are not now observ'd amongst us, and therefore we must be content with such Expressions as our Language will afford.

<sup>183</sup> An Exercise much us'd amongst the *Romans*; the Horse-man rode one Horse, and led another, and in the midst of the Race would throw himself on the led Horse, and so back again as often as he was required; or else would stand upon the Horses back, and in that posture ride the Course.

<sup>184</sup> *Salmoneus* built a Bridge of Brass, and driving Chariots over it fancy'd he Thundred: This he did to procure himself divine Honours, but was kill'd by a Thunder-bolt for his impious attempt.

<sup>185</sup> A Family amongst the *Romans*, famous for their seditious Harangues, which they made to the People of *Rome* out of the Desks, or Rostra, standing in the Market place.

<sup>186</sup> Amongst the *Romans* one Man would take several Balls, and toss them, sometimes behind, and sometimes before, now on this hand, and now on the other, so that some of them should be always up in the Air: And this feat of Activity *Manilius* Describes.

<sup>187</sup> The Story of *Meleager* runs thus: At his Birth his Mother heard one of the Destinies say, the Child should live till the stick that then lay in the Fire was burnt: The Mother snatch'd the stick out of the Fire, and perserv'd it. When *Meleager* was grown a Man, he with a great many others went to hunt a Wild Bore; at the same time *Atalante* a Nymph of extraordinary Beauty came into the

Field, and had the good Fortune to wound the Bore first: *Meleager* fell in Love with *Atalante*, and having kill'd the Bore presented the Head to her: His two Uncles who were present at the Hunting thought themselves injur'd, and would not suffer a Woman to carry off their Spoil. *Meleager* in defence of *Atalante* kills his two Uncles: *Meleager's* Mother, to revenge the Death of her two Brothers, puts the stick into the Fire, as that burnt *Meleager* wasted.

<sup>188</sup> *Formidine Mortis: Huetius Reads Formidine Pennae:* For when they Hunted, they us'd to see stakes in the ground, to which they ty'd Feathers which frighted the Deer, and made them keep within that compass, or take that way the Hunters thought most convenient for their sport.

<sup>189</sup> *Philoctetes* was Servant to *Hercules*, and when *Hercules* burnt himself, he left his Bow and Arrows to *Philoctetes*: Without these Arrows *Troy* could not be taken: Now it happened that *Philoctetes*, either by a contrivance of *Vlysses*, or because, being wounded by one of the Poisoned Arrows, he became offensive to the *Grecian* Camp, was sent away to *Lemnos*: But the Siege going on slowly, he was fetcht back again: With his Arrows he killed the chiefest of the Remaining Commanders, and so *Troy* was taken.

<sup>190</sup> *Teucer* was Brother to *Ajax*, and he with his Bow beat back *Hector* when he came to burn the *Grecian* Navy.

<sup>191</sup> The following Verses relate to *Alcon* the *Cretan*, who shot a Snake that lay twisted round the Head of his Son, and did not touch the Boy.

<sup>192</sup> This Goat or *Hoedus Scaliger* could not find, but *Huetius* says, the *Single Hoedus* is put by *Manilius* for those two *Haedi* that are in the left hand of *Heniochus*, or the *Driver*: Thus *Horace*. — *Archeri cadentis Impetus, aut orientis Hoedi, and Propertius Purus & Orion, purus & Hoedus erit.*

<sup>193</sup> The Poets fancy'd *Orpheus* went down to Hell, charm'd *Pluto* and the Destinies, and brought back his Wife *Eurydice*.

<sup>194</sup> Alluding to the Fable, which says *Jupiter* Courted *Leda* in the shape of a Swan.

<sup>195</sup> Several Feats of Activity amongst the *Romans*, in which they equall'd if not excell'd all the following Ages.

<sup>196</sup> The common Subjects upon which *Sophocles*, *Euripides*, and other Tragaedians amongst the Ancients wrote their Plays.

<sup>197</sup> A fam'd *Comedian*, who flourish'd in the hundred and fourteenth Olympiad.

<sup>198</sup> *Pompey* having conquered *Mithridates*, brought to *Rome* more valuable Jewels than ever had been seen there: And from that time, as *Pliny* in the first Chapter

of his 37<sup>th</sup>. Book complains, the Romans began to value and admire Jewels.

<sup>199</sup> The Romans did not only put Notorious Malefactors in Chains, but likewise chained them to their Keepers; and this Custom the Poet hints at.

<sup>200</sup> Vossius out of his Ancient Manuscript reads, Et Coeli meditatus iter vestigia perdet, Et Perna pendens populum suspendet ab ipsa.

<sup>201</sup> These were the several Orders in the Roman Common-Wealth. FINIS.